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1 Kings

1 Kings - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of 1 Kings

1. David guides Solomon to become his successor (1:1–2:46)
2. Solomon reigns (3:1–11:43)
3. Solomon becomes wise and wealthy (3:1–4:43)
4. Solomon builds Yahweh's temple and his palace (5:1–8:66)
5. Solomon's wealth and wisdom (9:1–10:29)
6. Solomon builds shrines for foreign gods and will be punished (11:1–43)
7. The kingdom divides (12:1–14:31)
8. The Israelites revolt against Rehoboam (12:1–19)
9. Jeroboam becomes the king of the northern tribes (12:20–33)
10. Prophets prophesy against Jeroboam (13:1–14:20)
11. Concluding events of Rehoboam's reign (14:21–31)
12. Kings of Israel and Judah (15:1–22:53)
13. King Abijah and King Asa of Judah (15:1–24)
14. King Nadab of Israel (15:25–32)
15. King Baasha of Israel (15:33–16:7)
16. King Elah of Israel (16:8–14)
17. King Zimri of Israel (16:15–22)
18. King Omri of Israel (16:23–28)
19. King Ahab of Israel (16:29–22:40)
20. King Jehoshaphat of Judah (22:41–50)
21. King Ahaziah of Israel (22:51–53)

What is the book of 1 Kings about?
The book of 1 Kings describes what happened to the people of Israel after King David died. It tells how his son Solomon succeeded him as king. It then relates how, after Solomon died, his former kingdom split into two kingdoms, Israel and Judah. The book tells what the kings were like who ruled over those kingdoms. It uses David's conduct as a standard to measure the conduct of these later kings, since "David had done right in the eyes of Yahweh, and he had not turned from all that he had commanded him all of the days of his life, except in the matter of Uriah the Hittite" (15:5). While some of the kings were godly and righteous, others were wicked. The book describes how Yahweh sent prophets to the kings and people of Israel and Judah to call them back to obedience to him. The last section of the book describes the great confrontation between the prophet Elijah and King Ahab of Israel, who was more wicked than any king who had come before him.

What is the purpose of the book of 1 Kings?
The book of 1 Kings is part of a long history that also includes the preceding books of 1 Samuel and 2 Samuel and the following book of 2 Kings. The purpose of the entire history is to show that Yahweh was not at fault when the Israelites were conquered and exiled from their land. Instead, this happened because the people had disobeyed Yahweh and broken their covenant with him.

Who wrote the book of 1 Kings?
The author of 1 Kings does not identify himself by name in the book. However, many interpreters believe that the prophets in Israel recorded the events that are related in this book (and in the entire history of which it is a part) in order to demonstrate that the people had disobeyed Yahweh. These prophets wanted to encourage the people to obey Yahweh once more. It is possible that a prophet, or several prophets, or someone connected with the prophets, wrote or compiled 1–2 Samuel and 1–2 Kings in the form in which we have them today. While different people may therefore have written different parts of the book, these notes will refer to whoever wrote any given part of 1 Kings as "the author."

What title should translators use for this book?
Translators can use the traditional title of 1 Kings or First Kings. Translators may also consider a different title such as "The First Book about the Kings of Israel and Judah."

Is it all right to translate the book of 1 Kings before translating the books of 1 Samuel and 2 Samuel?
It is best to translate the books of 1 Samuel and 2 Samuel before 1 Kings, since 1 Kings continues from where 2 Samuel ends.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

The role of the king
The book of 1 Kings focuses on the lives of various kings. Their role was more than just political. The king in ancient Israel was seen as Yahweh's appointed representative, entrusted with the task of leading the people to obey the covenant Yahweh had made with them. His success or failure was directly tied to his

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faithfulness to God. The king was responsible for upholding justice, protecting vulnerable people, and ensuring that the Israelites remained faithful to Yahweh as their God. When the king sinned or worshiped other gods, the entire nation suffered the consequences, because the king was no longer leading the people to live in the way that Yahweh wants people to live.

The centrality of the temple
A major theme in 1 Kings is that Yahweh's temple in Jerusalem was to be the central place of worship for the Israelites, rather than the "high places" where the Canaanites had previously worshiped their foreign gods. The book describes in detail how King Solomon had his workers construct this temple as a place where Yahweh would be recognized as especially present. The temple served as the primary location for sacrifices, prayers, and festivals. It symbolized the covenant relationship between Yahweh and the Israelites. The dedication of the temple marked a high point in Israel's history. Its subsequent neglect and the establishment of rival places of worship by unfaithful kings directly led to the nation's spiritual decline.

The significance of the prophets
Throughout 1 Kings, Yahweh speaks to the Israelites through prophets who serve as his messengers. Prophets such as Nathan, Ahijah, Jehu, Elijah, and Micaiah spoke truth to powerful leaders held them accountable for their actions. The prophets often challenged the king's actions when they conflicted with God's law. They performed signs and wonders to authenticate their message and demonstrate God's power. They did this to confront the idolatry and worship of foreign gods that plagued the kingdom. The prophets' words and deeds served as a powerful reminder that Yahweh's power and authority were greater than those of any human ruler, and so it was vital for the king and people to live in a faithful and obedient covenant relationship with Yahweh.

Part 3: Translation Issues in This Book

"And it happened"
The author often uses the phrase "And it happened" to introduce a new event in the story or a new development within an episode. To translate this phrase in its various occurrences, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event or development. (See: Introduction of a New Event)

"behold" or "look"
The author and characters often use the word "behold" to focus their listeners' attention on what they are about to say. While the word literally means "look," the speakers do not want their listeners to look at something. Instead, they want them to pay careful attention to something they are about to say. For example, Nathan says "Behold" in 1:14 in order to call Bathsheba's attention to his promise to come and support her appeal to David. When the author is calling attention to a sudden or unexpected development, it may be appropriate to translate "behold" as "suddenly." For example, when the author says in 18:7 that "Obadiah {was} on the road, and behold, Elijah met him," the meaning is "and suddenly Elijah met him." (See: Metaphor)

"to this day"
In 1 Kings 8:8, 9:13, 9:21, 10:12, and 12:19, the author uses the phrase "to this day." By that phrase, he is referring to the time at which he was writing. Translators should be aware that "to this day" refers to a time that is now in the past. They should avoid giving the impression that "to this day" means the present day of the translation's readers. Translators might decide to say something such as "at the time when this is being written" or "at the time of this writing." (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

"in the eyes of"
The author and characters often speak of something being good or bad "in the eyes of" someone. This means that that person considered this to be a good or bad thing to do. For example, when the author says in 3:10 of Solomon's request for wisdom that "the thing was good in the eyes of the Lord," he means that Yahweh considered that it was good for Solomon to have requested this. When the author says in 14:22 that "Judah did evil in the eyes of Yahweh," he means that the people of that kingdom did what Yahweh considered to be evil. (See: Idiom)

"to the face of"
The expression "to the face of" can have different shades of meaning, depending on the context.

- The author and characters often use the word "face" to represent the presence of a person or group, since people can see the face of someone who is present. For example, when the author says in 1:23 of Bathsheba that "she came to the face of the king," he means that she came into the presence of the king.
- The focus may also be on something being in front of or before a person or thing, either in space or in time. For example, when the author says in 7:49 that the lampstands in the temple were "to the face of" the inner sanctuary, he means that they were positioned in front of it.

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- The focus may also be on the relationship or interaction between people or groups, as in 8:33, where Solomon prays to Yahweh about the possibility that the Israelites may be "struck to the face of an enemy." He means that they might be defeated in front of enemy soldiers, that is, as they opposed those soldiers in battle. (See: Metonymy)

In other contexts, the author or a character may use the word "face," describing part of a person, in order to represent the whole person. For example, when the author says in 8:14 about Solomon that "the king turned his face around," he means that Solomon, who had previously been looking toward the temple, turned himself entirely around in order to speak to the people behind him, who had gathered for the temple dedication. (See: Synecdoche)

"fathers" meaning "ancestors"
The author and characters often use the term "fathers" to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. (See: Metaphor)

"into the hand of" or "into your hand"
The author and characters often use the word "hand" to represent power, capability, or control. For example, in 22:6, false prophets promise Ahab that God will give the city of Ramoth Gilead "into the hand of the king," meaning God will enable him to recapture it and bring it under his control.

The word "hand" may also represent agency, as when the author says in 2:25 that in order to execute Adonijah, "King Solomon sent by the hand of Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada." The "hand" of Benaiah represents his agency in executing Adonijah. This usage may be applied to words as well as to actions. In 17:5, the author speaks of the promise that Yahweh had "spoken by the hand of Elijah" to the widow in Zarephath. He means that Yahweh spoke this promise through the agency of Elijah.

Translation notes will help distinguish the difference between these shades of meaning when that may not be clear from the context. (See: Metonymy)

In other contexts, the author or a character may use the word "hand," describing part of a person, in order to represent the whole person. For example, the word "hand" may represent an entire person in the act of possessing or conveying something, as when the author says in 15:18 that King Asa "took all of the silver and the gold that was remaining in the storerooms of the house of Yahweh and the storerooms of the house of the king, and he gave them into the hand of his servants." Those servants carried the silver and gold to King Ben Hadad of Aram with the message that Asa wanted to make an alliance with him. So the silver and gold being in their "hand" represents their possession and conveyance of it. (See: Synecdoche)

"house" meaning "temple"
The author and characters often use the term "house" to mean the temple that Solomon built for Yahweh, as if the temple were a house in which Yahweh lived. The term indicates that Yahweh was especially present in his temple. If it would be clearer in your language, you could say "temple" in your translation rather than "house." (See: Metaphor)

"listen" or "hear"
The author and characters often use the terms "listen" or "hear" to mean complying with what someone has said. For example, when King Hiram tells King Solomon in 5:8, "I have heard what you sent to me," he means that he has agreed to do what Solomon has sent messengers to ask him to do. When the phrase applies to God, it means to answer prayer. For example, when Yahweh tells Solomon in 9:3, "I have heard your prayer," he means, "I will answer your prayer by doing what you have asked." (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

"my lord" or "your servant"
Many times throughout the book, even though people are addressing a king or other leader directly, they speak of him in the third person as "my lord" to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. You might have people say, for example, "you, my lord the king." Some cultures may have a specific form that they use to address rulers, and if your culture does, you could use that form in your translation. The UST models one way to do that. It has people say, "Your Majesty."

Similarly, many times throughout the book, people speak of themselves in the third person as "your servant" to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. You might have people say, for example, "I, your servant." (See: First, Second or Third Person)

name of a person representing that person and associated or accompanying people
The author and characters often use the name of a person to represent that person and others who are associated with or accompanying that person. For example, when the author says in 6:14 that "Solomon built the house," meaning the temple, he is using Solomon to represent the many workers he engaged

who were actually involved in constructing the temple. (See: Synecdoche)

name of nation, tribe, or city representing its people or army
The author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its people or its army. For example, when the author says in 4:25 that "Judah and Israel dwelled in safety," he means that the people of the tribe of Judah and the people of the rest of the nation of Israel dwelled in safety. When the author says in 11:16 that "all of Israel" remained in Edom for six months, he means that the entire Israelite army did so. (See: Metonymy)

"saying" or "and said"
The author and characters frequently use the term "saying" to introduce direct quotations. The author also uses the phrase "and said" to introduce direct quotations after a variety of other verbs of speaking ("answered," "swore," "called," "cried," etc.). In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent these expressions explicitly. (See: Quotations and Quote Margins)

"shall"
The ULT represents the Hebrew instructional verb form with the English helping verb "shall." For example, when David tells Solomon in 2:6 "you shall act according to your wisdom," he is instructing him to act that way. Other ways to say this are "you are to act according to your wisdom," "you should act according to your wisdom," "I want you to act according to your wisdom," or "act according to your wisdom." Translate this form with the most natural way in your language for giving instructions.

"sons of" or "son of"
The author and characters often speak of "the sons of" a person to mean the nation or tribe that consists of his descendants. For example, in 6:1 the author speaks of the "sons of Israel" to mean the Israelites. In 11:33, the prophet Ahijah speaks of the "sons of Ammon" to mean the Ammonites. In this case, "sons" does not mean first-generation offspring, but later descendants. (See: Metaphor)

In other contexts, the authors and characters use the expression "son of" to indicate that a person has the characteristic of something. For example, in 1:52 Solomon says that Adonijah must prove to be a "son of valor," meaning that he must show that he is a trustworthy person. In 4:30, the author uses the expression "sons of the east" to describe people who belonged to the desert tribes that lived to the east of the land of Israel. In such contexts, you may be able to use an equivalent expression from your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. (See: Idiom)

"strike/struck"
In many places, the author says that soldiers "struck" an opposing army, city, or king, as if they had only hit them. But in various contexts, he means that they either attacked, defeated, or killed those opponents. For example, when the author says in 15:20 that Ben Hadad, the king of Aram, "struck Ijon and Dan and Abel Beth Maacah and all Chinnereth, with all of the land of Naphtali," he means that Ben Hadad attacked those cities and regions in order to force King Baasha of Israel to break off his invasion of Judah and send his troops to those locations instead. When Solomon speaks in 8:33 of a situation in which the Israelites "are struck to the face of an enemy," he means that an enemy army would have defeated the Israelite army. And when the author says in 15:27 that Baasha "struck" Nadab, the son of Jeroboam, at Gibbethon, he means that Baasha killed Nadab. Consider carefully how to translate the term "struck" in each context where it does not actually mean "hit." (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

travel descriptions marked for change in elevation ("went up," "went down")
In keeping with what was usual in the biblical language and culture, the author and characters often indicate whether people are going up to a higher elevation or going down to a lower elevation when they travel. For example, Nathan tells David in 1:25 that Adonijah has "gone down" to En Rogel. The author says in 1:40 that the people who supported Solomon "went up" with him from Gihon back to Jerusalem. If your language does not mark travel for change in elevation, you can translate instances with simple expressions such as "went," "gone," or "came." (See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit)

"walking" representing "living"
The author and characters often speak of how a person lives as if that were a way or path that the person was walking along. For example, in 2:3, David tells Solomon, regarding Yahweh, to "walk in his ways." David means that he wants Solomon to live as Yahweh wants people to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly in such cases. (See: Metaphor)

1 Kings - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Abishag begins to take care of King David (1:1–4)
2. Adonijah tries to become the next king (1:5–10)
3. Nathan advises Bathsheba how to respond (1:11–14)
4. Bathsheba and Nathan inform King David about Adonijah (1:15–27)
5. King David responds by appointing Solomon as the next king (1:28–37)
6. Solomon is proclaimed as the next king (1:38–40)
7. Jonathan informs Adonijah, Joab, and the people with them about Solomon (1:41–48)
8. Solomon spares Adonijah's life (1:49–53)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The next king

In this culture, when a king became old or died, it was customary for one of his sons to become the next king. King David had several different wives who had borne him many sons, and he had told one of his wives, Bathsheba, that her son Solomon would become the next king. However, Adonijah, David's oldest living son, felt that he should be king instead. He invited many important people to a feast, and they all agreed to make him the next king, rather than Solomon. However, some other important people went to King David and told him what Adonijah was doing. When David heard about it, he reasserted that he wanted Solomon to succeed him as king. Then everyone who had supported Adonijah ran away and no longer supported him. Describe all of these events in such a way that your readers will understand that the narrative of this chapter is about who will be the next ruler after King David.

The role of the prophet Nathan

A key element in the story that this chapter tells is the intervention of the prophet Nathan. In ancient Israel, prophets were God's messengers, and they often played a crucial role in political affairs. Nathan's advice to Bathsheba and his direct appeal to David were vital. His authority came from God, and his words were intended to ensure that Yahweh's will for the kingdom was carried out so that Solomon would be the next king. The prophet's word was more authoritative than human tradition or political maneuvering. It was Nathan's intervention that ultimately ensured that Solomon would become king. Consider carefully how to describe Nathan's role and actions in a way that your readers will understand.

The significance of anointing

The anointing of a new king with oil was a symbolic and religious act. It was a physical sign that God had chosen and set apart a person for the task of ruling. When Zadok the priest anointed Solomon at Gihon, this was a public declaration that Yahweh had chosen him and set him apart, so that he was now the legitimate king. The sounding of a shofar (ram's horn) and the public acclamation "May King Solomon live!" confirmed that Yahweh had sanctioned the transfer of power and that the people had accepted it. This effectively ended Adonijah's attempted coup.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Symbolic actions

In this chapter, people perform several different kinds of actions that have symbolic significance in this culture. When someone sits on a throne, it indicates that this person has power and authority. When people bow or prostrate themselves before someone else, it indicates that they are honoring and giving respect to that person. When someone is anointed with oil, it indicates that this person is being commissioned to accomplish a specific task or fill a specific role. If the significance of these actions would not be clear to your readers, you may explain their meaning in the text of your translation or in a footnote. See the notes on the verses that describe these actions for translation options. (See: Symbolic Action)

"he will sit on my throne"

Sitting on a throne, an ornamental and ceremonial chair, is a symbolic action that indicates that a person has power and rules as king. In this chapter, there are several references to who will sit on the throne of Israel after David. These are references to who will be the next king after David dies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could explain what this action means. For example, you might have people ask David who "will sit on your throne to rule," or you might have David speak of who "will sit on my throne as king." (See: Symbolic Action)

In some places in this chapter, however, people speak of the "throne" of Israel not to mean the ceremonial chair of the king but to represent the kingdom itself. This is the case in (1:37), for example, when Benaiah says he hopes that Yahweh will make Solomon's throne greater than David's. He is wishing that Yahweh will make Solomon's kingdom even greater than David's. See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:1 (#4)

וַיְכַסֻּ֖הוּ בַּבְּגָדִ֑ים וְלֹ֥א יֵחַ֖ם לֽוֹ׃

“and they covered him with garments, but it was not warm for him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people, although the next verse shows that he means David’s servants generally. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and even when he was covered with garments, it was not warm for him] or [and although his servants covered him with garments, it was not warm for him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:1 (#1)

וְהַמֶּלֶךְ דָּוִד זָקֵן בָּבָא בַּיָּמִים

“Now King David had aged, he had come into days”

Here the author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 1:1 (#3)

בָּבָא בַּיָּמִים

“he had come into days”

The author is using **he had come into days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “he had become very old.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated this phrase in Joshua 13:1 and Joshua 23:1. Alternate translation: [he had gotten on in years] or [he had become old]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:1 (#2)

זָקֵן בָּבָא בַּיָּמִים

“had aged, he had come into days”

The phrases **had aged** and **had come into days** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [had grown very old]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 1:2 (#2)

לַאדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“for my lord the king”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how characters in the book, in order to show respect, often speak of David and other rulers in the third person as “my lord the king,” even though they are speaking to that ruler directly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [for you, my lord the king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 1:2 (#3)

וְעָמְדָה לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“and let her stand to the face of the king”

The author is using **stand to the face of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “enter the service of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 16:21. Alternate translation: [and let her wait on you] or [and let her become one of your royal servants]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:2 (#1)

לַאדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“for my lord the king”

Since one servant is speaking on behalf of a group of **servants**, it may be more natural in your language to say “our” rather than **my**, here and at the end of the verse. Alternate translation: [for our lord the king]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 1:3 (#1)

וַיְבַקְשׁוּ נַעֲרָה יָפָה בְּכֹל גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּמְצְאוּ אֶת־אֲבִישַׁג הַשּׁוּנַמִּית

“And they sought a beautiful young woman in all of the border of Israel, and they found Abishag the Shunammitess”

Here and in the next verse, the author is introducing **Abishag the Shunammitess** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of

introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 1:3 (#2)

גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the border of Israel”

Here, **the border of Israel** represents the entire territory of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:4 (#1)

וְהַמֶּלֶךְ לֹא יְדָעָהּ

“but the king did not know her”

The author is referring to sexual relations in a polite way by using the phrase **did not know her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [but the king did not make love with her]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 1:5 (#2)

מִתְנַשֵּׂא

“was lifting himself up”

Here the author is speaking as if Adonijah were actually **lifting himself up** or raising his physical body higher. This expression means that he believed he deserved to become the next king and began acting like an important person. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was thinking highly of himself] or [was putting himself forward]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 1:5 (#4)

אֲנִי אֶמְלֹךְ

“I, I will reign”

Adonijah is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will reign** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize his belief that he will be the next king. In other words, he is boasting. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [The next king will be me!]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:5 (#5)

וַיַּעַשׂ לוֹ רֶכֶב וּפָרָשִׁים וַחֲמִשִּׁים אִישׁ רָצִים לְפָנָיו

“And he made for himself a chariot and horses and 50 men running to his face”

Having **50 men** run ahead of his **chariot** to clear the way and announce his coming was a symbolic action by which Adonijah asserted his importance. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 15:1. Alternate translation: [And he had 50 men run ahead of his chariot to show how important he was]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:5 (#1)

וְאֲדֹנִיָּה בֶן־חַגִּית מִתְנַשֵּׂא

“Now Adonijah, the son of Haggith, was lifting himself up”

Here and in the next verse, the author is reintroducing **Adonijah** as a participant in the story. He was first introduced in 2 Samuel 3:4. The author now provides further details about his appearance and reminds readers of his birth order to help them understand what happens next in the story. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 1:5 (#3)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

See the discussion of the term “saying” in the introduction to 1 Kings. It introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly, here or in its other instances in the book.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 1:6 (#1)

מִיָּמָיו

“from his days”

Here the term **days** represents a period of time, Adonijah’s lifetime, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [during his whole life]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:6 (#3)

וְאֹתָ֥ו יָלְדָ֖ה

“and she had borne him”

The implication is that Haggith bore Adonijah to David as his next child after the birth of Absalom and that, since Absalom and David’s two older sons by different mothers were now dead, Adonijah was David’s oldest surviving son. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he was David’s eldest surviving son]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:6 (#2)

וְאֹתָ֥ו יָלְדָ֖ה

“and she had borne him”

The pronoun **she** refers to Haggith, Adonijah’s mother, whom the author mentions in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and his mother Haggith had borne him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:7 (#2)

צְרוּיָֽה

“Zeruiah”

The word **Zeruiah** is the name of a woman, one of David’s sisters.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 1:7 (#3)

וַיַּעְזְר֣וּ אַחֲרֵי֮ אֲדֹנִיָּה֒

“And they helped after Adonijah”

The author is using the phrase **helped after** as a common expression of his culture to mean “supported” or “joined the side of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they became Adonijah’s followers and helped him] or [And they supported Adonijah]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:7 (#1)

וַיִּהְי֥וּ דְבָרָ֖יו

“And his words were”

Here, **words** represents what Adonijah said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he spoke]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:9 (#1)

וּמְרִיאִ֔

“and fatling”

In this verse, the word **fatling** is singular in form, but it refers to many fattened animals that Adonijah sacrificed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “fatling.” Alternate translation: [and fatlings]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 1:9 (#2)

אֶת־כָּל־אֶחָיו֙ & וּלְכָל־אַנְשֵׁ֣י יְהוּדָ֔ה

“all of his brothers & and to all of the men of Judah”

The author is using the term **all** as a generalization in these phrases, since he indicates in the next verse that Adonijah did not invite some of the **men of Judah**, and he did not invite his brother Solomon. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that shows that this is a generalization. Alternate translation: [all of his other brothers ... and to all of the other men of Judah]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 1:10 (#1)

וְאֶת־שְׁלֹמֹ֥ה אָחִ֖יו

“or his brother Solomon”

Solomon was Adonijah’s **brother** because they had the same father, David, but they had different mothers. It is also clear from the narrative that Solomon was younger than Adonijah. Your language may have its

own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [or his younger half-brother Solomon]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 1:11 (#1)

הֲלֹ֣וא שָׁמַ֔עְתָּ כִּֽי־מָלַ֗ךְ אֲדֹנִיָּ֛הוּ בֶּן־חַגִּ֥ית וַאֲדֹנֵ֖ינוּ דָּוִ֑ד לֹ֥א יָדֵֽע

“Have you not heard that Adonijah, the son of Haggith, reigns, and our master David does not know”

Nathan is using the question form to inform Bathsheba of something she does not know and to express his alarm. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for those purposes, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You need to be aware that Adonijah, the son of Haggith, reigns, and our master David does not know!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 1:12 (#4)

וּמַלְּטִ֖י

“and escape”

This is an imperative, but Nathan is using it to describe what the results would be if Bathsheba followed his counsel. Use a form in your language that indicates a result. Alternate translation: [and that way you will be able to escape]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 1:12 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֔ה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce their main topic. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 1:12 (#3)

אִיעָצְךָ֣ נָּ֔א עֲצַ֖ת & עֲצָ֑ה

“let me counsel you counsel”

Nathan is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [let me give you some counsel]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 1:12 (#2)

לְכִי

“come”

Nathan is not asking Bathsheba to **come** somewhere. He is saying **come** to encourage her to do what he suggests. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [go ahead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:13 (#4)

וְאָמַרְתְּ֣ אֵלָ֔יו הֲלֹא־אַתָּ֥ה אֲדֹנִ֖י הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ נִשְׁבַּ֣עְתָּ לַאֲמָתְךָ֣ לֵאמֹ֑ר כִּֽי־שְׁלֹמֹ֤ה בְנֵךְ֙ יִמְלֹ֣ךְ אַחֲרַ֔י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֑י וּמַדּ֗וּעַ מָלַ֛ךְ אֲדֹנִיָּֽהוּ

“and you shall say to him, ‘My lord the king, you, have you not sworn to your female servant, saying, “Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”? Then why does Adonijah reign”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [and remind him that he, your lord the king, swore to you, his female servant, that your son Solomon would surely reign after him, yes, that Solomon would sit on his throne. Then ask him why Adonijah is reigning instead.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:13 (#9)

כִּֽי־שְׁלֹמֹ֤ה בְנֵךְ֙ יִמְלֹ֣ךְ אַחֲרַ֔י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִֽי

“Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. David used this repetition to make a solemn pronouncement in poetic form about his successor. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. It may be clearer in your language to connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, yes, he will sit on my throne]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 1:13 (#10)

וְהוּא יֵשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאִי

“and he will sit on my throne”

See the introduction to this chapter for a discussion of the symbolic action of sitting on a **throne** and for suggestions of how you might translate the references to that action in this chapter.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:13 (#1)

לְכִי וּבֹאִי ׀ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ דָּוִד

“Go, and come to King David”

Nathan is saying **Go** to mean that Bathsheba should take action. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Take action and come to King David]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:13 (#2)

לְכִי וּבֹאִי ׀ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ דָּוִד

“Go, and come to King David”

In a context such as this, your language might say “go” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [Take action and go to King David]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 1:13 (#3)

וְאָמַרְתְּ אֵלָיו֙ הֲלֹא־אַתָּ֣ה אֲדֹנִ֔י הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ נִשְׁבַּ֣עְתָּ לַאֲמָתְךָ֣ לֵאמֹ֑ר כִּי־שְׁלֹמֹ֤ה בְנֵךְ֙ יִמְלֹ֣ךְ אַחֲרַ֔י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֑י וּמַדּ֗וּעַ מָלַ֛ךְ אֲדֹנִיָּֽהוּ

“and you shall say to him, ‘My lord the king, you, have you not sworn to your female servant, saying, “Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”? Then why does Adonijah reign”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Nathan said (level 1). Nathan is quoting what he wants Bathsheba to say to King David (level 2). This includes something that Nathan wants Bathsheba to remind David that he said to her (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 1:13 (#5)

וְאָמַרְתְּ

“and you shall say”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how the ULT represents the Hebrew instructional verb form with the English helping verb “shall.” Decide as a team how you will represent this form in your translation in various contexts. Alternate translation: [and I want you to say]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 1:13 (#6)

הֲלֹא־אַתָּ֣ה אֲדֹנִ֔י הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ נִשְׁבַּ֣עְתָּ לַאֲמָתְךָ֣ לֵאמֹ֑ר כִּי־שְׁלֹמֹ֤ה בְנֵךְ֙ יִמְלֹ֣ךְ אַחֲרַ֔י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֑י

“My lord the king, you, have you not sworn to your female servant, saying, “Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

Nathan is encouraging Bathsheba to use the question form to remind David of his promise and to express her alarm that Adonijah is trying to become king instead of Solomon. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for those purposes, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I recall well, my lord the king, that you swore to your female servant, saying, “Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne.”]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 1:13 (#7)

הֲלֹא־אַתָּ֣ה & נִשְׁבַּ֣עְתָּ

“you, have you not sworn”

Nathan wants Bathsheba to state the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **have you not sworn** already includes this meaning. He wants her to do that to emphasize the personal role of David in saying that Solomon would be the next king. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [have you not sworn personally]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:13 (#11)

וּמַדּ֗וּעַ מָלַ֛ךְ אֲדֹנִיָּֽהוּ

“Then why does Adonijah reign”

Nathan is encouraging Bathsheba to use the question form **Then why does Adonijah reign?** to express disapproval and protest. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So Adonijah should not be reigning!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 1:13 (#8)

לַאֲמָתְךָ

“to your female servant”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how characters in the book, in order to show humility, often speak of themselves in the third person as **your servant**. Nathan is encouraging Bathsheba to do this by calling herself **your female servant**. Alternate translation: [to me, your female servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 1:14 (#2)

וַאֲנִי֙ אָבוֹא אַחֲרַ֔יִךְ

“and I, I will come after you”

Nathan is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will come** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that his action will take place at the same time as Bathsheba’s action of **speaking** with King David. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and right then, I will come after you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:14 (#1)

הִנֵּ֥ה

“Behold”

See the discussion of the expression “behold” in the introduction to 1 Kings to decide how to represent it in your translation here and throughout the book.

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 1:14 (#3)

וּמְלֵאתִ֖י אֶת־דְּבָרָֽיִךְ

“and I will fill your words”

Nathan is using **I will fill your words** as a common expression of his culture to mean “I will confirm what you have said.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I will confirm what you have said]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:15 (#4)

מְשָׁרֶ֖ת אֶת־הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“was serving the king”

Since the author uses the phrase **the king** earlier in the verse, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [was serving him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:15 (#2)

הַחַדְרָה

“into the room”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **the room**, he means David’s bedroom. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and she went into his bedroom to speak with him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:15 (#1)

וַתָּבֹ֥א בַת־שֶׁ֖בַע

“So Bathsheba came”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [So Bathsheba went]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 1:15 (#3)

וְהַמֶּ֣לֶךְ זָקֵ֔ן מְאֹ֖ד וַאֲבִישַׁ֣גְ הַשּׁוּנַמִּ֑ית מְשָׁרֶ֖ת אֶת־הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“Now the king had aged greatly, and Abishag the Shunammitess was serving the king”

Here the author is providing background information to help readers understand what is happening in the story. In your translation, introduce this information

in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 1:16 (#1)

וַתִּקֹּ֥ד בַּת־שֶׁ֖בַע וַתִּשְׁתַּ֣חוּ לַמֶּ֑לֶךְ

“And Bathsheba bowed and prostrated herself to the king”

Bowing and prostrating oneself to someone was a symbolic action by which a person showed great respect and submission. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And Bathsheba bowed down and stretched herself out completely on the ground in front of the king to show him honor]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:16 (#2)

מַה־לָּֽךְ

“What to you”

The king is using **What to you** as a common expression of his culture to mean “What do you want?” or “What is your concern?” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What is your concern]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:17 (#2)

בַּיהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ כִּֽי־שְׁלֹמֹ֥ה בְנֵ֖ךְ יִמְלֹ֣ךְ אַחֲרָ֑י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִֽי &

“by Yahweh your God, ‘Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [by Yahweh your God that Solomon my son will surely reign after you, that yes, he will sit on your throne]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:17 (#1)

אַתָּ֥ה נִשְׁבַּ֖עְתָּ

“you, you swore”

Bathsheba is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you swore** already includes this meaning. She is doing that to emphasize the personal role of David in swearing this oath. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [you swore personally]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:17 (#3)

כִּֽי־שְׁלֹמֹ֥ה בְנֵ֖ךְ יִמְלֹ֣ךְ אַחֲרָ֑י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִֽי

“Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13.

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 1:18 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֖ה

“But now”

The expression that the ULT translates here as **But now** is the same one that it translates as “And now” in many other contexts. The ULT translates the expression this way when a speaker is drawing a contrast while introducing his main point. See how you translated the comparable expression “And now” in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 1:18 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֖ה אֲדֹנִ֣י הַמֶּ֑לֶךְ

“and now, my lord the king”

Some ancient manuscripts read “and now.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “and you.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 1:19 (#2)

לְכָל־בְּנֵ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ

“to all of the sons of the king”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [to all of the other sons of the king]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 1:19 (#1)

שׁוֹר וּמְרִיא־וְצֹאן

“ox and fatling and sheep”

In this verse, the words **ox**, **fatling**, and **sheep** are all singular in form, but each term refers to a group of animals that Adonijah has sacrificed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms of these words in your translation. Alternate translation: [oxen and fatlings and sheep]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 1:19 (#3)

עַבְדְּךָ

“your servant”

When speaking to David, who is Solomon’s father, Bathsheba calls Solomon **your servant** rather than “your son.” She is probably doing that to emphasize that Solomon is serving David loyally and not going against his wishes the way Adonijah is doing. In your translation, you may be able to use a phrase that makes Solomon’s relationship and loyalty to David clear, here and in 1:26. Alternate translation: [your loyal son]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 1:20 (#1)

וְאַתָּה

“And you”

Some ancient manuscripts read “And you.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “And now.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 1:20 (#3)

מִמִּי יֵשֵׁב עַל־כִּסֵּא אֲדֹנִי־הַמֶּלֶךְ אַחֲרָיו

“who will sit on the throne of my lord the king after him”

Here, David’s **throne** represents his royal authority and rule. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [who will rule the Israelites as your successor]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:20 (#2)

עֵינֵי כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עָלֶיךָ

“the eyes of all of Israel are on you”

Bathsheba is using the common expression of her culture **the eyes of all of Israel are on you** to mean “all the Israelites are depending on you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the Israelites are looking to you] or [all the Israelites are depending on you]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:21 (#3)

וְהָיִיתִי אֲנִי וּבְנִי שְׁלֹמֹה חַטָּאִים

“that I will be, I and my son Solomon, offenders”

To make her appeal to David more effective, Bathsheba is first naming herself and then naming herself along with another person who is important to David, to show that the consequence she is describing would affect him as well. It might seem that her expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [that I and my son Solomon will be offenders]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 1:21 (#2)

אֲבֹתָיו

“his fathers”

Bathsheba is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See the discussion of this image in the introduction to 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 1:21 (#1)

כִּשְׁכַּב אֲדֹנִי־הַמֶּלֶךְ עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“when my lord the king lies down with his fathers”

Bathsheba is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **lies down with his fathers**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you

could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [when you, my lord the king, have passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 1:23 (#1)

וַיַּגִּ֥ידוּ לַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“And they declared to the king”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the king was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:23 (#2)

נָתָ֥ן הַנָּבִֽיא

“Nathan the prophet”

The person speaking to David is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Nathan the prophet is here]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 1:23 (#4)

וַיִּשְׁתַּ֥חוּ לַמֶּ֖לֶךְ עַל־אַפָּ֑יו אָ֖רְצָה

“and he prostrated himself to the king with his nose to the ground”

The phrase **prostrated himself to the king with his nose to the ground** was a symbolic action by which Nathan showed complete submission and respect to King David. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:23 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֥י הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into the presence of the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:24 (#1)

אַתָּ֣ה אָמַ֔רְתָּ אֲדֹנִיָּ֥הוּ יִמְלֹ֖ךְ אַחֲרָ֑י וְה֣וּא יֵשֵׁ֔ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֔י

“you, have you said, ‘Adonijah will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [have you yourself said that Adonijah will reign after you, and he will sit on your throne]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:24 (#3)

אַתָּ֣ה אָמַ֔רְתָּ

“you, have you said”

See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [have you personally said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:24 (#4)

אֲדֹנִיָּ֥הוּ יִמְלֹ֖ךְ אַחֲרָ֑י וְה֣וּא יֵשֵׁ֔ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֔י

“Adonijah will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13.

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 1:24 (#2)

אַתָּ֣ה אָמַ֔רְתָּ אֲדֹנִיָּ֥הוּ יִמְלֹ֖ךְ אַחֲרָ֑י וְה֣וּא יֵשֵׁ֔ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֔י

“you, have you said, ‘Adonijah will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne”

Nathan is using the question form to clarify that David has not authorized Adonijah to become king. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [as I understand it, you never said, ‘Adonijah will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne.’]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 1:25 (#2)

יָרַ֗ד

“he has gone down”

To translate this expression and the several similar ones in this chapter that say “down” or “up,” see the introduction to 1 Kings for a discussion of how

speakers in this culture marked travel for change in elevation. In this particular context, Nathan may be saying **he has gone down** to mean that Adonijah has gone down from Jerusalem to some place away from the city where he can act more freely. Alternate translation: [he has gone away]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 1:25 (#7)

יְחִי הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲדֹנִיָּהוּ

“May King Adonijah live”

Nathan is reporting how Adonijah’s guests are saluting him with the courteous expression that people in this culture would use to wish a ruler a long and prosperous reign. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Long live King Adonijah]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 1:25 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation of what made Nathan ask his question in the previous verse. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word or phrase to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [You see,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 1:25 (#5)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

Here, **to his face** represents being in Adonijah’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in his presence] or [as his guests]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:25 (#4)

וְהִנָּם אֹכְלִים וְשֹׁתִים

“And behold them, eating and drinking”

Nathan is using **behold them** as a common expression of his culture to indicate that something is happening at the very moment he is speaking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And at this very moment they are eating and drinking]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:25 (#6)

וַיֹּאמְרוּ֙ יְחִ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אֲדֹנִיָּ֖הוּ

“And they are saying, ‘May King Adonijah live”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And they are wishing Adonijah a long reign as king]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:25 (#3)

שׁ֣וֹר וּמְרִיא־וְצֹ֑אן

“ox and fatling and sheep”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:19.

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 1:26 (#1)

וְלִ֨י אֲנִי־עַבְדֶּ֜ךָ וּלְצָדֹ֣ק הַכֹּהֵ֗ן

“But to me, me your servant, and to Zadok the priest”

To make his appeal to David more effective, Nathan is first naming himself, and then naming himself along with other people to show that they are affected as well. It might seem that his expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [But to me, your servant, and to Zadok the priest]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 1:27 (#3)

אֶת־עבדיך

“your servants”

Some ancient manuscripts read “your servants.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “your servant.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 1:27 (#1)

אִם־מֵאֵת֙ אֲדֹנִ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ נִהְיָ֥ה הַדָּבָ֖ר הַזֶּ֑ה וְלֹ֤א הוֹדַעְתָּ֙ אֶת־עבדיך מִֽי־יֵשֵׁ֣ב עַל־כִּסֵּ֔א אֲדֹנִ֥י־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ אַחֲרָֽיו

“Has this thing been done from with my lord the king and you have not made your servants know who will sit on the throne of my lord the king after him”

Nathan is using the question form to express doubt that the king would have made a decision about succession without telling his closest advisors. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I do not believe that my lord the king would have done this thing without making his servants know who would sit on the throne of my lord the king after him.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 1:27 (#2)

אִם־מֵאֵת֙ אֲדֹנִ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ נִהְיָ֥ה הַדָּבָ֖ר הַזֶּ֑ה

“Has this thing been done from with my lord the king”

The expression **Has this thing been done** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Has my lord the king done this thing]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:28 (#1)

וַיֹּ֖אמֶר

“and said”

See the discussion of the phrase “and said” in the introduction to 1 Kings. It introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly, here or in its other instances in the book.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 1:28 (#2)

וַתָּבֹאכִ֖ל לִפְנֵ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“And she came to the face of the king”

In this instance, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And she came into the presence of the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:28 (#3)

וַתַּעֲמֹ֖ד לִפְנֵ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“and she stood to the face of the king”

In this instance, **to the face of** represents being in front of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and she stood in front of the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:29 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָ֔ה

“The life of Yahweh”

Following the custom of his culture, David is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. The content of the oath is in the next verse. The guarantee is in this verse. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 4:9. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh, who has rescued my life from every distress]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 1:30 (#1)

כִּֽי־כַאֲשֶׁר֩ נִשְׁבַּ֨עְתִּי לָ֜ךְ & כִּ֣י כֵ֗ן אֶֽעֱשֶׂ֛ה הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּ֖ה

“that just as I swore to you & surely thus I will do this day”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **just as I swore to you** with the information about what David would do. Alternate translation: [that surely thus I will do this day just as I swore to you]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 1:30 (#3)

כִּֽי־שְׁלֹמֹ֣ה בִנְךָ֗ יִמְלֹךְ֙ אַחֲרַ֔י וְה֥וּא יֵשֵׁ֖ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֑י תַּחְתָּ֔יו

“Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne in my place”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, yes, he will sit on my throne in my place]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 1:30 (#2)

לֵאמֹר כִּי־שְׁלֹמֹה בְנֵךְ יִמְלֹךְ אַחֲרַי וְהוּא יֵשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאִי תַּחְתָּי כִּי כֵּן אֶעֱשֶׂה הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“saying, ‘Surely Solomon your son will reign after me, and he will sit on my throne in my place,’ surely thus I will do this day”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [that surely Solomon your son would reign after me, and he would sit on my throne in my place, surely thus I will do this day]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:31 (#1)

וַתִּקֹּד בַּת־שֶׁבַע אַפַּיִם אָרְצָה וַתִּשְׁתַּחוּ לַמֶּלֶךְ

“And Bathsheba bowed, nostrils {to} the ground, and she prostrated herself to the king”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 1:16 and 1:23.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:31 (#2)

יְחִי אֲדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ דָּוִד לְעֹלָם

“May my lord King David live to forever”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [Long live my lord King David]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 1:32 (#1)

קִרְאוּ

“Call”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Call** is plural. David is speaking to several of his servants. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 1:32 (#2)

לְפָנַי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into the presence of the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:33 (#1)

קְחוּ עִמָּכֶם & אֶת־אַדֹנֵיכֶם וְהַרְכַּבְתֶּם & אֶת־שְׁלֹמֹה בְנִי & וְהוֹרַדְתֶּם אֹתוֹ

“Take & your master with you, and you shall make Solomon my son ride & and you shall bring him down”

The words **you** and **your** and the implied “you” in the imperative **Take** are plural in this verse and the next two verses because David is addressing Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah. So use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 1:33 (#3)

קְחוּ עִמָּכֶם אֶת־עַבְדֵי אֲדֹנֵיכֶם

“Take the servants of your master with you”

By sending his royal bodyguards with Solomon, David was ensuring Solomon’s safety. At the same time, this was a symbolic action that demonstrated that Solomon had royal authority. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Take my royal bodyguards with you to protect Solomon and to show that he is the new king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:33 (#4)

וְהַרְכַּבְתֶּם אֶת־שְׁלֹמֹה בְנִי עַל־הַפִּרְדָּה אֲשֶׁר־לִי

“and you shall make Solomon my son ride on the female mule that is to me”

Having Solomon ride on his own **mule** was a symbolic action by which David showed that Solomon was his chosen successor as king, since this mule was a symbol of royal authority. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [have Solomon my son ride on my royal mule]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:33 (#2)

אֶת־עַבְדֵי אֲדֹנֵיכֶם

“the servants of your master”

By **the servants of your master**, David is referring to the Cherethites and Pelethites, his royal bodyguards, as 1:38 and the similar use of this phrase in 2 Samuel 20:6 indicate. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the Cherethites and Pelethites] or [my royal bodyguards]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:33 (#5)

אֶל־גִּחוֹן

“to Gihon”

Gihon was a spring on the west side of Jerusalem. David may have chosen this location for the proclamation of Solomon as king because it was a public place where many people gathered. However, since Adonijah had proclaimed himself king at En Rogel on the east side of Jerusalem, David may also have chosen Gihon to symbolize his opposition to Adonijah and his full support for Solomon. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the potential significance of this action. Alternate translation: [to Gihon, on the opposite side of Jerusalem from En Rogel]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:34 (#5)

יְחִי הַמֶּלֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה

“May King Solomon live”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [Long live King Solomon]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 1:34 (#1)

וּמְשַׁחוּ אֹתוֹ שָׁם צָדוֹק הַכֹּהֵן וְנָתָן הַנָּבִיא לְמֶלֶךְ

“And Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet shall anoint him there as king”

The act of **anointing** was a symbolic action by which Zadok and Nathan would show that Solomon was being appointed as the legitimate king of Israel. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet shall pour oil on his head to show that he is the legitimate king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:34 (#3)

וּתְקַעְתֶּם בַּשּׁוֹפָר

“And you shall blow on a shofar”

The act of blowing on a **shofar** was a symbolic action by which David’s supporters showed that Solomon was being proclaimed as the new king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And you shall blow on a shofar to proclaim him as king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:34 (#4)

וַאֲמַרְתֶּם יְחִי הַמֶּלֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה

“and you shall say, ‘May King Solomon live”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and you shall proclaim that Solomon is the king]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:34 (#2)

וּמְשַׁחוּ אֹתוֹ צָדוֹק הַכֹּהֵן וְנָתָן הַנָּבִיא &

“And Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet shall anoint him”

David is addressing **Zadok** and **Nathan** in the third person in order to give them specific instructions. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use second-person forms. Alternate translation: [And you, Zadok the priest, and you, Nathan the prophet, shall anoint him]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 1:35 (#3)

וְהוּא יִמְלֹךְ תַּחְתָּנִי

“and he, he will reign in my place”

David is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he will reign** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the personal role of Solomon as the one who will reign in his place. See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [and he is the one who will reign in my place]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 1:35 (#1)

וַעֲלִיתֶֽם אַחֲרָ֖יו

“And you shall go up after him”

Going up **after** Solomon, that is, having him lead the way back to Jerusalem while they followed, was a symbolic action by which the people showed their support for Solomon as the new king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And you shall walk behind him to show your support as he leads the way back here to Jerusalem]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:35 (#2)

וּבָ֣א וְיָשַׁ֔ב עַל־כִּסְאִ֑י

“and he shall come and sit on my throne”

Sitting on David’s **throne** was a symbolic action by which Solomon showed that he was becoming king with authority over Israel and Judah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he shall come and take authority as king] or [and he shall come and assume his role as king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:36 (#1)

אָמֵ֔ן

“Truly”

Benaiah is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling of agreement with the king’s command and loyalty to him. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what Benaiah was feeling, or you could say what made him agree so strongly. Alternate translation: [Yes, indeed!] or [I strongly agree!]

See: Exclamations

1 Kings 1:36 (#2)

כֵּ֚ן יֹאמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵ֖י אֲדֹנִ֣י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“May Yahweh, the God of my lord the king, say thus”

By **say thus**, Benaiah is not just wishing that Yahweh would say the same thing that David has just said. He is wishing that Yahweh would make this happen. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh, the God of my lord the king, make this happen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:37 (#2)

וְיגַדֵּ֛ל אֶת־כִּסְאֹ֖ו מִמְּכִסֵּ֣א אֲדֹנִ֑י הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ דָּוִֽד

“And may he make his throne greater than the throne of my lord King David”

Here, **throne** represents royal authority or rule. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And may he make his reign greater than the reign of my lord King David]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:37 (#1)

הָיָ֣ה & עִם־אֲדֹנִ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ כֵּ֖ן יהי עִם־שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“has been with my lord the king, so may he be with Solomon”

The phrase **has been with** is a common expression of his culture to mean “has helped.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has helped my lord the king, so may he help Solomon]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:38 (#2)

וְהַכְּרֵתִי֙ וְהַפְּלֵתִ֔י

“and the Cherethite and the Pelethite”

In this verse, the words **Cherethite** and **Pelethite** are singular in form, but they refer to all of the members of these groups. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of these words. Alternate translation: [and the Cherethites and the Pelethites]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 1:38 (#1)

וַיֵּ֣רֶד צָדֹ֣וק הַכֹּהֵ֗ן וְנָתָ֤ן הַנָּבִיא֙ וּבְנָיָ֣הוּ בֶן־יְהוֹיָדָ֔ע וְהַכְּרֵתִי֙ וְהַפְּלֵתִ֔י וַיַּרְכִּ֖בוּ אֶת־שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה עַל־פִּרְדַּ֥ת הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ דָּוִ֛ד וַיֹּלִ֥לֻכוּ אֹתֹ֖ו עַל־גִּחֹֽון

“Then Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet and Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethite

and the Pelethite went down, and they made Solomon ride on the female mule of King David. And they brought him to Gihon"

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [Then Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet and Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethite and the Pelethite made Solomon ride on the female mule of King David, and they went down and brought him to Gihon]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 1:39 (#2)

כָּל־הָעָֽם

"all of the people"

The author says **all of the people** as a generalization to mean all those who were present at this ceremony. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [all of the people who were there]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 1:39 (#3)

יְחִ֥י הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹֽה

"May King Solomon live"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [Long live King Solomon]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 1:39 (#1)

וַיִּתְקְע֣וּ בַשּׁוֹפָ֑ר

"And they blew on the shofar"

Here the pronoun **they** represents the person whom Zadok, Nathan, and Benaiah instructed to blow **on the shofar** to proclaim that Solomon was the new king. (It is likely that a single **shofar** would have been used for this official purpose.) Alternate translation: [And they had someone blow on a shofar]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:40 (#1)

וְהָעָם֙ מְחַלְלִ֣ים בַּחֲלִלִ֔ים וּשְׂמֵחִ֖ים שִׂמְחָ֣ה גְדוֹלָ֑ה

"And the people were piping with pipes and rejoicing a great rejoicing"

The author is using two constructions in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same constructions in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying these things. Alternate translation: [And the people were making music on pipes and rejoicing very greatly]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 1:40 (#2)

וַתִּבָּקַ֥ע הָאָ֖רֶץ בְּקוֹלָֽם

"And the earth was split by their sound"

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And they made a very loud sound, such as there is during an earthquake]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 1:40 (#3)

וַתִּבָּקַ֥ע הָאָ֖רֶץ בְּקוֹלָֽם

"And the earth was split by their sound"

The expression **was split** is a passive verbal form. If you decide to represent the author's actual overstatement in your translation, if your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the sound they made split the earth]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:41 (#2)

וְכָל־הַקְּרֻאִ֖ים

"and all of the called ones"

The expression **called ones** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and all of the ones he had called]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:41 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֣ע אֲדֹנִיָּ֗הוּ וְכָל־הַקְּרֻאִים֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אִתּ֔וֹ וְהֵ֖ם כִּלּ֣וּ לֶֽאֱכֹ֑ל

"And Adonijah and all of the called ones who {were} with him heard, and they had finished eating"

The connector **and** in **and they had finished eating** indicates that Adonijah and his guests **heard** the noise

at the same time as when they **finished eating**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Adonijah and all of the called ones who were with him heard the sound just as they finished eating]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Kings 1:41 (#3)

מַדּ֣וּעַ קוֹל־הַקְּרִיָּ֔ה הוֹמָֽה

“Why is the sound of the city being noisy”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [Why is the city being noisy]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 1:42 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ חַיִּ֣ל אַתָּ֔ה וְטוֹב֙ תְּבַשֵּׂ֔ר

“you are a man of valor, and you will bring good news”

Adonijah is using **a man of valor** as a common expression of his culture to mean “an important person” or “a worthy person.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are an important person, and you will bring good news]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:42 (#3)

אִ֣ישׁ חַיִּ֣ל אַתָּ֔ה וְטוֹב֙ תְּבַשֵּׂ֔ר

“you are a man of valor, and you will bring good news”

Adonijah assumes that his listeners will understand that, based on the customs of this culture, he believes that someone has sent Jonathan to bring **good news** to him, since Jonathan, as a high priest’s son, is person of rank. (See the comparable episode in 2 Samuel 18:19–23, where Joab does not want to send Ahimaaz, similarly a person of rank as a high priest’s son, to bring bad news to David.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:42 (#1)

בֹּ֣א כִֽי־אִ֣ישׁ חַיִּ֣ל אַתָּ֔ה וְטוֹב֙ תְּבַשֵּׂ֔ר

“Come, for you are a man of valor, and you will bring good news”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you are a man of valor, and you will bring good news, come]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 1:44 (#1)

וְהַכְּרֵתִ֥י וְהַפְּלֵתִ֖י

“and the Cherethite and the Pelethite”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:38. Alternate translation: [and the Cherethites and the Pelethites]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 1:45 (#2)

וַתֶּהֳמֶ֥ם הַקִּרְיָֽה

“and the city is agitated”

The expression **is agitated** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and this has agitated the people of the city] or [and this has excited the people of the city]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:45 (#3)

שְׁמַעְתֶּֽם

“you have heard”

The word **you** is plural here because Jonathan means that Adonijah and all of his guests **have heard** this **sound**. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 1:45 (#1)

וַתֶּהֳמֶ֥ם הַקִּרְיָֽה

“and the city is agitated”

Here, **the city** represents the people of the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use

an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the people of the city are agitated]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:46 (#1)

כִּסֵּא הַמְּלוּכָה

“the throne of the kingdom”

Jonathan is using this possessive form to describe the **throne** that symbolizes the Israelite king’s rule over his **kingdom**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the royal throne]

See: Possession

1 Kings 1:47 (#2)

לֵאמֹר֮ יֵיטֵב֒ אלהיך אֶת־שֵׁשֶׁם שְׁלֹמֹה֙ מִשְּׁמֶ֔ךָ וְיגַדֵּ֖ל אֶת־כִּסְאֲא֑וֹ מִכִּסְאֲאֶֽךָ

“saying, ‘May God make the name of Solomon better than your name, and may he make his throne greater than your throne”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him that they wished that God would make the name of Solomon better than his name and make Solomon’s throne greater than his throne]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:47 (#4)

יֵיטֵב֒ אלהיך אֶת־שֵׁשֶׁם שְׁלֹמֹה֙ מִשְּׁמֶ֔ךָ

“May God make the name of Solomon better than your name”

Here, **name** represents reputation or honor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [May God make the reputation of Solomon better than your reputation]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:47 (#5)

וְיגַדֵּ֖ל אֶת־כִּסְאֲא֑וֹ מִכִּסְאֲאֶֽךָ

“and may he make his throne greater than your throne”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:37. Alternate translation: [and may he make his reign greater than your reign]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:47 (#3)

לֵאמֹר֮

“saying”

While you may have decided that in other contexts it was not be necessary to represent the term “saying” explicitly in your translation when it introduces a direct quotation, it may be helpful to do that here. Alternate translation: [They said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 1:47 (#6)

וַיִּשְׁתַּ֥חוּ הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ עַל־הַמִּשְׁכָּֽב

“And the king bowed himself on the bed”

Bowing himself on his bed was a symbolic action by which David worshiped God in order to join in his servants’ prayer for Solomon. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And on his bed, the king bowed his head in worship to join in their prayer]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:47 (#1)

אֶת־אֲדֹנֵ֣ינוּ

“our master”

By **our**, Jonathan means to include both himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Kings 1:48 (#6)

וְעֵינַ֖י רֹא֑וֹת

“and my eyes are seeing”

David is speaking here as if he were actually **seeing** Solomon sitting on his throne. He means that this has happened during his own lifetime. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while I am still alive to experience it]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 1:48 (#3)

אֲשֶׁשָׁר נָתַתָן הַיּוֹם יֹשֵׁשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאִאי וְעֵינַגי רֹאוֹת

“who today has given a sitter on my throne, and my eyes are seeing”

The word that the ULT translates as **and** indicates that Yahweh **has given** someone to sit on David’s throne (that is, to be the next king) at the same time when David’s **eyes** were still **seeing**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [who today has given a sitter on my throne while I am still alive to see it]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Kings 1:48 (#4)

יֹשֵׁשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאִאי

“a sitter on my throne”

Here, **a sitter on my throne** represents someone who would rule as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [someone to succeed me as king] or [a son to continue my dynasty]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 1:48 (#1)

כָּכָה אָמַמַר הַמֶּמֶלֶךְ בָּרוּוּךְ יְהוָוָה אֱלֹהֵהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵאֵל אֲשֶׁשָׁר נָתַתָן הַיּוֹם יֹשֵׁשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאִאי וְעֵינַגי רֹאוֹת

“thus said the king, ‘Blessed {be} Yahweh, the God of Israel, who today has given a sitter on my throne, and my eyes are seeing”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [the king said that he blessed Yahweh, the God of Israel, who today had given a sitter on his throne, and his eyes were seeing]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:48 (#5)

וְעֵינַגי רֹאוֹת

“and my eyes are seeing”

King David is using **my eyes** to mean all of him in the act of seeing Solomon sit on his throne. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I myself am seeing]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 1:48 (#2)

בָּרוּוּךְ יְהוָוָה

“Blessed {be} Yahweh”

The expression **Blessed be Yahweh** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May people bless Yahweh] or [May people praise Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:49 (#2)

וַיֶּחֶרְדוּוּ & כָּל־הַהַקְּרֵאִים אֲשֶׁשֶׁר לַאֲדֹנִיָּיָהוּ

“Then all of the called ones who {were} with Adonijah trembled”

By **trembled**, the author means that the guests at Adonijah’s feast were shaking with fear because they realized that they had supported the wrong person to be king and might be punished. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Then all of the called ones who were with Adonijah trembled with fear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:49 (#1)

כָּל־הַהַקְּרֵאִים אֲשֶׁשֶׁר לַאֲדֹנִיָּיָהוּ

“all of the called ones who {were} with Adonijah”

The expression **the called ones** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [all of the ones whom Adonijah had called, who were still with him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:49 (#3)

וַיֵּלְכוּ אִאֵישׁ לְדַרְכּוֹ

“And they went, a man to his way”

The author is using the phrase **a man to his way** as a common expression of his culture to mean “each one in the direction of his own home.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they all went separately back to their own homes]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:50 (#3)

וַיֵּ֥לֶךְ

“and went”

By **went**, the author means that Adonijah went to the sacred tent. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and went to the sacred tent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:50 (#4)

וַיַּחֲזֵ֖ק בְּקַרְנ֣וֹת הַמִּזְבֵּֽחַ

“and grasped the horns of the altar”

Grasping the **horns of the altar** was a symbolic action by which Adonijah showed that he was seeking sanctuary and asking for mercy. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and grasped the horns of the altar to seek sanctuary and ask for mercy]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 1:50 (#1)

מִפְּנֵ֣י שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“from the face of Solomon”

Here, **from the face of** is a common expression of the culture that means “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on account of Solomon]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:50 (#2)

וַיָּ֖קָם

“And he arose”

The implication is that Adonijah **arose** from the table and left the feast that he was hosting at En Rogel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he left En Rogel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:51 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֔ר יִשָּׁבַ֥ע־לִ֛י כַּיּ֥וֹם הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה אִם־יָמִ֤ית אֶת־עַבְדּוֹ֙ בֶּחָ֔רֶב

“saying, ‘Let King Solomon swear to me as today if he will kill his servant with the sword”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and has said that he wants you to swear as today that you will not kill him with the sword]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 1:51 (#3)

כַּיּ֥וֹם

“as today”

Adonijah is using the expression **as today** as a common expression of his culture to mean “first.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [first]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:51 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּ֥ד לִשְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

“And it was declared to Solomon”

The expression **it was declared** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared to Solomon]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:51 (#4)

יִשָּׁבַ֥ע־לִ֛י כַּיּ֥וֹם הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“Let King Solomon swear to me as today”

By **Let King Solomon swear to me as today**, Adonijah means he wants Solomon to promise not to kill him before he, Adonijah, lets go of the altar. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I will not let go of the horns of the altar until King Solomon swears to me first] or [I will not leave the sanctuary unless King Solomon swears to me first]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 1:51 (#5)

אִם־יָמִ֣ית אֶת־עַבְדּ֔וֹ בֶּחָֽרֶב

“if he will kill his servant with the sword”

Adonijah anticipates that, following the custom of his culture, Solomon would swear an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. Alternate translation: [that he will not kill his servant with the sword]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 1:51 (#6)

אִם־יָמִ֣ית אֶת־עַבְדּ֔וֹ בֶּחָֽרֶב

“if he will kill his servant with the sword”

Adonijah is not referring to a specific **sword**. He means any sword that David might command his soldiers to use to kill him. Adonijah is likely referring to beheading. 2 Samuel 16:9 suggests that this would have been the punishment for rebellion against the king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that he will not command his soldiers to cut my head off with a sword]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 1:52 (#3)

לֹא־יִפֹּ֥ל מִשַּׂעֲרָתְתָּ֖ו אָֽרְצָה

“from his hair shall not fall to the ground”

Solomon is using one small part of Adonijah, a single strand from his **hair**, to emphasize that he will not harm him at all. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will not harm him in the slightest way]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 1:52 (#2)

לֹא־יִפֹּ֥ל מִשַּׂעֲרָתְתָּ֖ו אָֽרְצָה

“from his hair shall not fall to the ground”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [nothing from his hair shall fall to the ground] or [not a single one of his hairs shall fall to the ground]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 1:52 (#4)

וְאִם־רָ֥עָה תִמָּצֵא־בֹ֖ו

“But if evil is found in him”

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But if I find evil in him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 1:52 (#1)

לְבֶן־חַ֑יִל

“a son of valor”

In certain contexts, biblical authors and characters use the common expression of their culture **son of** to indicate that a person has the characteristic of something. In this case, Solomon means that Adonijah would have to prove that he was a person of trustworthy character by taking no further actions to try to become king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a man of trustworthy character]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 1:52 (#5)

וְאִם־רָ֥עָה תִמָּצֵא־בֹ֖ו

“But if evil is found in him”

Here Solomon is speaking as if **evil** were an object that could be **found** inside of Adonijah. He is describing the possibility of discovering that Adonijah has been acting with evil intentions. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But if I find evidence that his intentions are evil]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 1:53 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֖ח הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“And King Solomon sent”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [And King Solomon sent some soldiers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 1:53 (#2)

וַיָּבֹא וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ לַמֶּלֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה

“And he came and prostrated himself to King Solomon”

Prostrating himself was a symbolic action by which Adonijah showed submission to Solomon as the legitimate king of Israel. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [he came and bowed to the ground in front of King Solomon to show his submission]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. David’s last advice to Solomon (2:1–12)
2. Solomon’s punishment of Adonijah (2:13–25)
3. Solomon’s punishment of Abiathar (2:26–27)
4. Solomon’s punishment of Joab (2:28–35)
5. Solomon’s punishment of Shimei (2:36–46)

The author says in 2:12, “And Solomon sat on the throne of David his father, and his kingdom was established greatly.” He says similarly in 2:46, “And the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon.” These two statements introduce and conclude the four accounts in which Solomon deals with the men who could have been a threat to him (Adonijah, Abiathar, Joab, and Shimei). Try to translate the statements in such a way that your readers will recognize their similarity and understand that the author uses them to mark off this group of accounts.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

David’s final instructions to Solomon

This chapter begins with David giving Solomon his final instructions. This was the equivalent of a final will and testament. David’s words to Solomon are a summary of his life’s wisdom, and they are also a transfer of the spiritual and political responsibilities of the kingship. David charges Solomon to follow Yahweh’s laws, reminding him that the covenant promises that Yahweh made to his family were conditional on their obedience. David also gives specific instructions regarding several individuals. He tells Solomon to punish people who had harmed him and his kingdom but to reward people who had helped him. This demonstrates that in this culture, a king had the right to issue decrees that would be carried out even after his death. Consider how your language indicates that a person is speaking from a position of power and authority, but also consider how a father would speak to a son even if he were in royal authority over him.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Phrases the author uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns

In 2:10–11, the author describes the death and burial of David and says for how many years he ruled as king. This is the first instance in the book of these particular phrases that the author will use regularly to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. So that your readers will appreciate their role, be careful to translate these phrases consistently in each of their occurrences.

1 Kings 2:1 (#3)

וַיִּקְרְבוּ יְמֵי־דָוִד לָמוּת

“Now the days of David to die approached”

Here, the word **days** represents “time,” since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Now the time for David to die approached]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:1 (#1)

וַיִּקְרְבוּ יְמֵי־דָוִד לָמוּת וַיְצַו אֶת־שְׁלֹמֹה בְּנוֹ

“Now the days of David to die approached, and he commanded Solomon his son”

Here the author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 2:1 (#2)

וַיִּקְרְבוּ יְמֵי־דָוִד לָמוּת וַיְצַו

“Now the days of David to die approached, and he commanded”

The author is speaking of these **days** as if they had been a living thing that could have approached. Your language may speak of time in a similar way. If not,

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the time came for David to die, so he commanded] or [Now when David was about to die, he commanded]

See: Personification

1 Kings 2:1 (#4)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 2:2 (#3)

הָאָֽרֶץ

“the earth”

Here, **the earth** represents “people on earth.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people on earth]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:2 (#4)

וְחָזַקְתָּ֖ וְהָיִ֥יתָ לְאִֽישׁ

“So you shall be strong, and you shall be a man”

David is using the term **man** to represent a person who is courageous. He means that an experienced, full-grown man would be courageous in situations where younger, inexperienced boys and youths would not. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [So you shall be strong, and you shall be courageous]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:2 (#1)

אָנֹכִ֣י הֹלֵ֔ךְ בְּדֶ֖רֶךְ כָּל־הָאָֽרֶץ

“I am going in the way of all of the earth”

David is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **going in the way of all of the earth**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to death in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to pass away] or [My time to die has come]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 2:2 (#5)

וְחָזַקְתָּ֖ וְהָיִ֥יתָ לְאִֽישׁ

“So you shall be strong, and you shall be a man”

The phrases **you shall be strong** and **you shall be a man** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [So you must be very determined]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 2:2 (#2)

אָנֹכִ֣י הֹלֵ֔ךְ

“I am going”

David is using the present tense **I am going** to describe something that is going to happen in the future. He is doing that in order to show that the event will happen soon. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [I am about to go]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 2:3 (#1)

וְשָׁמַרְתָּ֞ אֶת־מִשְׁמֶ֣רֶת ׀ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ

“And you shall keep the keeping of Yahweh your God”

David is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And you shall keep the charge of Yahweh your God]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 2:3 (#2)

אֶת־מִשְׁמֶ֣רֶת ׀ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ

“the keeping of Yahweh your God”

The author is using the possessive form to describe a **keeping** that **Yahweh** has required. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the things that Yahweh your God requires you to keep]

See: Possession

1 Kings 2:3 (#4)

חֻקֹּתָ֣יו מִצְוֹתָ֗יו וּמִשְׁפָּטָ֛יו וְעֵדְוֹתָ֖יו

“his statutes, his commandments, and his judgments, and his testimonies”

The terms **statutes**, **commandments**, **judgments**, and **testimonies** mean similar things. David is using these terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [everything that he has commanded]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 2:3 (#5)

כַּכָּתוּב בְּתוֹרַ֣ת מֹשֶׁ֔ה

“as written in the law of Moses”

The expression **as written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as Moses wrote in the law]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:3 (#6)

אֵ֚ת כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר תַּעֲשֶׂ֔ה וְאֵ֖ת כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּפְנֶ֖ה שָֽׁם

“in} all that you do and everywhere that you turn there”

The phrases **all that you do** and **everywhere that you turn there** mean similar things. David is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [in everything that you seek to accomplish]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 2:3 (#7)

וְאֵ֖ת כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּפְנֶ֖ה שָֽׁם

“and everywhere that you turn there”

It might seem that the expression **everywhere that you turn there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and everywhere that you go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 2:3 (#3)

לָלֶ֣כֶת בִּדְרָכָ֑יו

“to walk in his ways”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how the author and characters use the idea of walking to mean living. Alternate translation: [to live as he wants people to live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:4 (#6)

בָּנֶ֔יךָ

“your sons”

Here Yahweh was speaking as if future generations were actually **sons**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:4 (#12)

לֹֽא־יִכָּרֵ֥ת לְךָ֖ אִ֣ישׁ מֵעַ֑ל

“a man to you will not be cut off from upon”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative **not** and the verb **cut off**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [a man to you will always be on]

See: Double Negatives

1 Kings 2:4 (#13)

לֹֽא־יִכָּרֵ֥ת לְךָ֖ אִ֣ישׁ

“a man to you will not be cut off”

The expression **will not be cut off** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will not cut off a man to you]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:4 (#15)

מֵעַ֛ל כִּסֵּ֥א יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“from upon the throne of Israel”

The **throne of Israel** represents rule and authority as king over Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or

plain language. Alternate translation: [from reigning over Israel] or [from being the king of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:4 (#2)

לְמַעַן֙ יָקִ֣ים יְהוָ֔ה אֶת־דְּבָר֖וֹ

“so that Yahweh may raise up his word”

David is speaking as if Yahweh’s **word**, or what Yahweh said, were an object that Yahweh could **raise up**. He means that Yahweh will cause what he said to happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that Yahweh may make what he said happen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:4 (#7)

לְפָנָ֑י

“to my face”

Here, **to my face** represents being in Yahweh’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in my presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:4 (#10)

בְּכָל־לְבָבָ֥ם וּבְכָל־נַפְשָׁ֖ם

“with all of their heart and with all of their soul”

In this verse, the words **heart** and **soul** are singular in form, but they refer to all David’s sons as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms of these words. Alternate translation: [with all of their hearts and with all of their souls] or [with their entire beings]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 2:4 (#11)

לְדָוִ֣ד אִ֔ישׁ

“a man to you”

The phrase **a man to you** is a possessive form. It means “a man who belongs to you,” and it describes someone who is a male descendant of David. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [one of your male descendants]

See: Possession

1 Kings 2:4 (#14)

לֹֽא־יִכָּרֵ֥ת לְךָ֖ אִ֑ישׁ

“a man to you will not be cut off”

Here Yahweh is speaking as David’s descendants could be **cut off** from the throne. This image depicts someone being removed from power as if they were being physically separated from the throne, like a branch being cut from a tree. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a man to you will not be removed] or [I will not remove a man to you]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:4 (#1)

לְמַעַן֙ יָקִ֣ים יְהוָ֔ה אֶת־דְּבָר֖וֹ

“so that Yahweh may raise up his word”

Here, **word** represents what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that Yahweh may raise up what he said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:4 (#8)

בֶּאֱמֶ֔ת

“in truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [truly] or [sincerely]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:4 (#9)

בְּכָל־לְבָבָ֥ם וּבְכָל־נַפְשָׁ֖ם

“with all of their heart and with all of their soul”

Yahweh is referring to all of a person by naming two major components of a person, his **heart** and his **soul**. These represent overlapping aspects of the inner life of a person, representing a person’s thoughts, feelings, desires, and intentions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with their entire being]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:4 (#3)

לֵאמֹר֮ אִם־יִשְׁמְרוּ֒ בָּנֶ֣יךָ אֶת־דַּרְכָּם֒ לָלֶ֣כֶת לְפָנַ֗י בֶּאֱמֶ֤ת בְּכָל־לְבָבָם֙ וּבְכָל־נַפְשָׁ֔ם לֵאמֹ֖ר לֹא־יִכָּרֵ֣ת לְךָ֔ אִ֥ישׁ מֵעַ֖ל כִּסֵּ֣א יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“saying, ‘If your sons keep their way, to walk to my face in truth with all of their heart and with all of their soul,’ saying, ‘a man to you will not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel”

If you have been representing the term “saying” in your translation when it introduces a direct quotation, you could probably omit the second instance of **saying** here, since it occurs within the same quotation as the first instance. Alternate translation: [when he said, ‘If your sons keep their way, to walk to my face in truth with all of their heart and with all of their soul, then a man to you will not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 2:4 (#5)

יִשְׁמְרוּ֒ בָּנֶ֣יךָ אֶת־דַּרְכָּם

“your sons keep their way”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [your sons live as they should]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:4 (#4)

לֵאמֹר֮ אִם־יִשְׁמְרוּ֒ בָּנֶ֣יךָ אֶת־דַּרְכָּם֒ לָלֶ֣כֶת לְפָנַ֗י בֶּאֱמֶ֤ת בְּכָל־לְבָבָם֙ וּבְכָל־נַפְשָׁ֔ם לֵאמֹ֖ר לֹא־יִכָּרֵ֣ת לְךָ֔ אִ֥ישׁ מֵעַ֖ל כִּסֵּ֣א יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“saying, ‘If your sons keep their way, to walk to my face in truth with all of their heart and with all of their soul,’ saying, ‘a man to you will not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [saying that if my sons kept their way, to walk to his face in truth with all of their heart and with all of their soul, then a man to me would not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 2:5 (#1)

אַתָּ֣ה יָדַ֔עְתָּ

“you, you know”

David is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you know** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Solomon knows what Joab has done, and so he has a responsibility to punish Joab. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [you know quite well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:5 (#4)

דְּמֵ֤י מִלְחָמָה֙ בַּחֲגֹ֣רָתוֹ֔ אֲשֶׁ֖ר בְּמָתְנָ֑יו וּבְנַעֲלֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁ֖ר בְּרַגְלָֽיו

“the blood of war on his belt that {was} on his loins and on his sandal that {was} on his feet”

David is using the fact that Joab got the **blood** of his victims on his **belt** and **sandal** to indicate that Joab murdered them treacherously at close range. (Joab had pretended that he wanted to speak with Abner privately, 2 Samuel 3:26–27, and he had pretended that he was coming close to Amasa to greet him 2 Samuel 20:8–10.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and he murdered his victims treacherously at close range]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:5 (#5)

וּבְנַעֲלֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁ֖ר בְּרַגְלָֽיו

“and on his sandal that {was} on his feet”

In this verse, the word **sandal** is singular in form, but it refers to both of Joab’s sandals. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural or dual form of “sandal.” Alternate translation: [and on his sandals that were]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 2:5 (#2)

אֵת֣ אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂ֣ה לִ֔י יוֹאָ֖ב בֶּן־צְרוּיָ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֔ה

“what Joab, the son of Zeruiah, did to me, what he did”

Joab did not do the things that David describes directly **to** David. When David says that these were things that Joab **did to me**, he is speaking of the effects of Joab’s actions on him. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful

to your readers. Alternate translation: [how Joab, the son of Zeruiah, harmed me by what he did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:5 (#3)

וַיָּ֤שֶׂם דְּמֵי־מִלְחָמָה֙ בְּשָׁלֹ֔ם

“For he put the blood of war in peace”

David is speaking as if **peace** were actually a container into which Joab had put **the blood of war**. He means that Joab took revenge during a time of peace against people who had killed others during a war. (In 2 Samuel 3:30, the author says explicitly, in the case of Abner, how wrong this was.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For he took revenge during a time of peace against people who had killed others during a war]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:6 (#2)

וְעָשִׂ֣יתָ כְחָכְמָתֶ֑ךָ

“And you shall act according to your wisdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And you shall act wisely toward him] or [And you shall act shrewdly toward him]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:6 (#3)

וְלֹֽא־תוֹרֵ֥ד שֵׂיבָתוֹ֙ בְּשָׁלֹ֔ם שְׁא֖וֹל

“and you shall not let his gray hair go down in peace to Sheol”

By using the phrase **you shall not let his gray hair go down in peace to Sheol**, David is referring in an indirect way to Solomon executing Joab. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use an indirect way of referring to this in your language, as the UST does, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [make sure that you execute him]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 2:6 (#6)

בְּשָׁלֹ֔ם

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:6 (#4)

וְלֹֽא־תוֹרֵ֥ד שֵׂיבָתוֹ֙ בְּשָׁלֹ֔ם שְׁא֖וֹל

“and you shall not let his gray hair go down in peace to Sheol”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the verbal phrase **go down in peace**, which is negative in this context from David’s perspective. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and you shall make sure that that old man dies a violent death by execution, as he deserves]

See: Double Negatives

1 Kings 2:6 (#1)

וְעָשִׂ֣יתָ כְּחָכְמָתֶ֑ךָ וְלֹֽא־תוֹרֵ֥ד שֵׂיבָתוֹ֙ בְּשָׁלֹ֔ם שְׁא֖וֹל

“And you shall act according to your wisdom, and you shall not let his gray hair go down in peace to Sheol”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses, since the second clause explains the purpose for the action that the first phrase describes. You could also use a connecting word that more specifically shows the relationship between the clauses. Alternate translation: [And so that you do not let his gray hair go down in peace to Sheol, you shall act according to your wisdom] or [And you shall act according to your wisdom, so that you do not let his gray hair go down in peace to Sheol]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Kings 2:6 (#5)

שֵׂיבָתוֹ֙

“his gray hair”

David is using **gray hair** to represent Joab in his old age. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that old man]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:7 (#1)

וְלִבְנֵי בַרְזִלַּי הַגִּלְעָדִי תַּעֲשֶׂה־חֶסֶד וְהָיוּ בְּאֹכְלֵי שֻׁלְחָנֶךָ כִּי־כֵן קָרְבוּ אֵלַי בְּבָרְחִי מִפְּנֵי אַבְשָׁלוֹם אָחִיךָ

“But to the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite do covenant faithfulness, and let them be among the eaters at your table. For thus they came near to me, when I fled from the face of Absalom your brother”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But since the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite came near to me when I fled from the face of Absalom your brother, do covenant faithfulness to them, and let them be among the eaters at your table]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:7 (#2)

וְלִבְנֵי בַרְזִלַּי הַגִּלְעָדִי תַּעֲשֶׂה־חֶסֶד

“But to the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite do covenant faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **covenant faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [But act in a kind way toward the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:7 (#3)

וְלִבְנֵי

“But to the sons of”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, David is using the word in a generic sense that could include both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [the family of] or [the sons and daughters of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 2:7 (#4)

בְּאֹכְלֵי שֻׁלְחָנֶךָ

“among the eaters at your table”

The phrase **eaters at your table** represents those who regularly eat with the king in his palace. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [among those who dine with you in your palace]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:7 (#6)

מִפְּנֵי

“from the face of”

Here, **from the face of** is a common expression of the culture that means “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on account of]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:7 (#5)

קָרְבוּ אֵלַי

“they came near to me”

David says that Barzilla and his family **came near to me** to mean that they helped and supported him. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they assisted me]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:7 (#7)

אָחִיךָ

“your brother”

Absalom and Solomon had the same father, David, but they had different mothers. Absalom was also older than Solomon. Your language may have its own term or expression for their relationship, marking these things. Alternate translation: [your half-brother]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 2:8 (#4)

וְהִנֵּה קִלְלַנִי

“And he, he cursed me”

David is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he cursed** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize the contrast between the bad thing that Shimei did and the good thing that Barzillai did. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language

may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And for his part, he cursed me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:8 (#5)

בְּיוֹם לְכָתִּתִי מַחֲנָיִם וְהוּא־יָרַד לִקְרָאתִי הַיַּרְדֵּן

“on the day of my going to Mahanaim. But he, he went down to meet me {at} the Jordan”

David is referring to how **Shimei** cursed him as he fled from his son Absalom and went to **Mahanaim** (see 2 Samuel 16:5–10). David is then referring to how he returned to Jerusalem after Absalom’s death. When he was about to cross the **Jordan** to go back to Jerusalem, Shimei met him and asked for forgiveness (see 2 Samuel 19:15–23). If it would be helpful in your language, you could make those ideas more explicit or include some extra information in a footnote. Alternate translation: [on the day of my going to Mahanaim to escape from Absalom. And he himself went down to meet me at the Jordan when I was returning to Jerusalem after Absalom died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:8 (#10)

אִם־אֲמִיתְךָ בֶּחָרֶב

“If I should kill you with the sword”

Following the custom of his culture, David was swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. Alternate translation: [I will not kill you with the sword]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 2:8 (#2)

עִמְּךָ שִׁמְעִי בֶן־גֵּרָא בֶן־הַיְמִינִי מִבַּחֲרִים

“with you {is} Shimei, the son of Gera, the Benjaminite from Bahurim”

David is using the phrase **with you** as a common expression of his culture to indicate that Shimei is still alive in Solomon’s kingdom and therefore under his jurisdiction and authority. (David does not mean that Shimei is nearby Solomon. Solomon later required Shimei to live near him in Jerusalem, as 2:36 indicates, but he had not done that yet.) If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Shimei, the son of Gera, the Benjaminite from Bahurim, is still there for you to deal with]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:8 (#8)

וְהוּא־יָרַד לִקְרָאתִי

“But he, he went down to meet me”

See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [But he came personally to meet me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:8 (#3)

וְהוּא קִלְלַנִי קְלָלָה נִמְרֶצֶת

“And he, he cursed me with a severe curse”

David is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And he, he cursed me severely]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 2:8 (#9)

לֵאמֹר אִם־אֲמִיתְךָ בֶּחָרֶב

“saying, ‘If I should kill you with the sword”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him that I would not kill him with the sword]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 2:8 (#11)

אִם־אֲמִיתְךָ בֶּחָרֶב

“If I should kill you with the sword”

David was not referring to a specific **sword**. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:51. Alternate translation: [If I should kill you with a sword]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 2:8 (#12)

אִם־אֲמִיתְךָ בֶּחָרֶב

“If I should kill you with the sword”

David was using himself to represent the soldiers whom he would command to kill Shimei. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will not command my soldiers to cut your head off with a sword]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:8 (#6)

וְהוּא־יָרַד לִקְרָאתִי

“But he, he went down to meet me”

In a context such as this, your language might say **came** instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [But he himself came down to meet me]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 2:8 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Now listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:8 (#7)

וְהוּא־יָרַד לִקְרָאתִי

“But he, he went down to meet me”

In keeping with the conventions of his culture, David is marking travel for change in elevation. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [But he himself came to meet me]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 2:9 (#2)

אַל־תְּנַקֶּהוּ

“may you not acquit him”

David is using a figure of speech here that emphasizes a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with a mild expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in a strong way. Alternate translation: [be sure that you punish him]

See: Litotes

1 Kings 2:9 (#6)

וְהוֹרַדְתָּ אֶת־שֵׂיבָתוֹ בְּדָם שְׁאוֹל

“And you shall make his gray hair go down with blood to Sheol”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:6. Alternate translation: [and you shall make sure that that old man dies a violent death by execution, as he deserves]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 2:9 (#3)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:9 (#5)

וְהוֹרַדְתָּ אֶת־שֵׂיבָתוֹ בְּדָם שְׁאוֹל

“And you shall make his gray hair go down with blood to Sheol”

Here, **blood** represents a violent death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And you shall make that old man go down violently to Sheol]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:9 (#4)

וְהוֹרַדְתָּ אֶת־שֵׂיבָתוֹ בְּדָם שְׁאוֹל

“And you shall make his gray hair go down with blood to Sheol”

Here, one part of an elderly person, **gray hair**, represents the entire person. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:6. Alternate translation: [And you shall make that old man go down with blood to Sheol]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:9 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“But now”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:18.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:10 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב דָּוִד עִם־אֲבֹתָיו וַיִּקָּבֵר בְּעִיר דָּוִד

“And David lay down with his fathers, and he was buried in the City of David”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he will also use throughout the book to conclude his accounts of the reigns of other kings. The occurrence of these recurring phrases signals the end of a story. Use a natural form in your language for expressing the conclusion of a story, and try to translate all the occurrences of these phrases consistently so that their purpose will be evident. Alternate translation: [text]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 2:10 (#3)

אֲבֹתָיו

“his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:10 (#4)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“and he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:10 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב דָּוִד עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And David lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And David passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 2:11 (#1)

וְהַיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ דָּוִד עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה בְּחֶבְרוֹן מָלַךְ שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים וּבִירוּשָׁלַם מָלַךְ שְׁלֹשִׁים וְשָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים

“And the days that David had reigned over Israel {were} 40 years. In Hebron he had reigned 7 years, and in Jerusalem he had reigned 33 years”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could state the smaller numbers first and then give the total. Alternate translation: [David reigned in Hebron 7 years, and he reigned in Jerusalem 33 years. So all the days that David reigned over Israel {were} 40 years]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 2:11 (#2)

וְהַיָּמִים & אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה

“And the days & were} 40 years”

Here, **days** represent time, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the time … was 40 years]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:12 (#1)

וּשְׁלֹמֹה יָשַׁב עַל־כִּסֵּא דָּוִד אָבִיו וַתִּכֹּן מַלְכֻתּוֹ מְאֹד

“And Solomon sat on the throne of David his father, and his kingdom was established greatly”

The author is using this statement to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 2:12 (#2)

וּשְׁלֹמֹה יָשַׁב עַל־כִּסֵּא דָּוִד אָבִיו

“And Solomon sat on the throne of David his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:20. Alternate translation: [Then Solomon succeeded his father David as king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:12 (#3)

וַתִּכֹּן מַלְכֻתּוֹ

“and his kingdom was established”

The expression **was established** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is God. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh established his kingdom]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 2:13 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֗א אֲדֹנִיָּ֤הוּ בֶן־חַגִּית֙ אֶל־בַּת־שֶׁ֣בַע אֵם־שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה

“Now Adonijah, the son of Haggith, came to Bathsheba, the mother of Solomon”

The author is introducing a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 2:13 (#3)

הֶשָּׁלֹ֖ום & שָׁלֽוֹם

“in} peace & In} peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peaceful … Peaceful]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:13 (#4)

שָׁלֽוֹם

“In} peace”

Adonijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yes, I have come in peace]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 2:13 (#2)

בַּת־שֶׁ֣בַע אֵם־שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה

“Bathsheba, the mother of Solomon”

The author identifies Bathsheba here as **the mother of Solomon**, and he seems to mean that Adonijah came to speak to her in her official role of queen mother. That was an important and honored role in the royal courts of this culture, as Solomon’s respectful actions in 2:19 show. Your language may have its own term or expression for this role and relationship. Alternate translation: [Bathsheba, the queen mother]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 2:14 (#1)

דָּבָ֥ר לִֽי אֵלַ֖יִךְ

“A word {is} to me for you”

Adonijah is using **A word is to me for you** as a common expression of his culture to mean “I have something to discuss with you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have a matter to discuss with you] or [I would like to speak with you about something]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:14 (#2)

דַּבֵּ֖ר

“Speak”

This is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. Alternate translation: [You may speak]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 2:15 (#6)

וַתִּסֹּ֤ב הַמְּלוּכָה֙ וַתְּהִ֣י לְאָחִ֔י

“But the kingdom turned and became to my brother”

Adonijah is speaking of **the kingdom** of Israel as if it had been a living thing that could have **turned** and moved from him to his **brother**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But my brother became the king instead]

See: Personification

1 Kings 2:15 (#5)

וַתִּסֹּ֤ב הַמְּלוּכָה֙ וַתְּהִ֣י לְאָחִ֔י כִּ֥י מֵיְהוָ֖ה הָֽיָתָ֑ה לֹֽו

“But the kingdom turned and became to my brother, for it was to him from Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But since it was to him from Yahweh, the kingdom turned and became to my brother]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:15 (#8)

מֵיְהוָ֖ה הָֽיָתָ֑ה לֹֽו

“it was to him from Yahweh”

Adonijah is using **it was to him from Yahweh** as a common expression of his culture to mean “Yahweh

wanted him to have it." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh wanted him to have it]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:15 (#1)

אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ

"You, you know"

See how you translated the same expression in 2:5. Alternate translation: [You know quite well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:15 (#3)

וְעָלַי שָׂשָׂמוּ כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל פְּנֵיהֶם לִמְלֹךְ

"and all of Israel had set their faces on me to reign"

Adonijah is using **had set their faces on me** as a common expression of his culture to mean "were expecting me to be their next king." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and all of the Israelites were looking to me as their next king] or [and all of the Israelites were expecting me to reign]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:15 (#7)

לְאָחִי

"to my brother"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:7. Alternate translation: [my younger brother] or [my half-brother]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 2:15 (#4)

וְעָלַי & כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"and all of Israel & on me"

Adonijah is saying **all** as an overstatement for emphasis. It is not true that every Israelite wanted him to be the king. Instead, as Bathsheba said in 1:20, the Israelites were waiting for David to tell them who the next king would be. However, it would be good to show in your translation that Adonijah is making an overstatement to try to persuade Bathsheba to do what he wants. So we recommend that you do not translate his statement as a less emphatic one.

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 2:15 (#2)

וְעָלַי שָׂשָׂמוּ כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל פְּנֵיהֶם לִמְלֹךְ

"and all of Israel had set their faces on me to reign"

Adonijah is using the term **Israel** to mean the Israelite people, who were descendants of a man named Israel, also known as Jacob. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all of the Israelites had set their faces on me to reign]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:16 (#2)

שְׁאֵלָה אַחַת אָנֹכִי שֹׁאֵל מֵאִתָּךְ

"one request I am requesting from you"

Adonijah is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [I would like to make one request of you]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 2:16 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

"And now"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:16 (#4)

אַל־תָּשֹׁב אֶת־פָּנָי

"Do not turn away my face"

Adonijah is using **turn away my face** as a common expression of his culture to mean "refuse my request." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, here and in verses 17 and 20 you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Please do not turn me down] or [Please do not refuse my request]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:16 (#5)

דַּבֵּר

“Speak”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:14. Alternate translation: [You may speak]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 2:16 (#3)

אַל־תָּשֵׁשִׁבִי אֶת־פָּנָי

“Do not turn away my face”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please do not turn away my face]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 2:17 (#1)

אִמְרִי־נָא לִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ כִּי לֹא־יָשִׁישִׁיב אֶת־פָּנֶיךָ

“Please speak to King Solomon, for he will not turn away your face”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he will not turn away your face, please speak to King Solomon]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:18 (#2)

אָנֹכִי אֲדַבֵּר

“I, I will speak”

Bathsheba is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will speak** already includes this meaning. She is doing that to emphasize that she is making a promise to Adonijah. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I promise that I will speak]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:18 (#1)

טֹוב

“Good”

In this context, Bathsheba is not necessarily using the expression **Good** to mean that she thinks that what Adonijah is asking is a good thing. Instead, she is using the expression to indicate that she agrees with his request and will do what he asks. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Okay] or [I agree]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:19 (#2)

וַיָּקָם֩ הַמֶּ֨לֶךְ לִקְרָאתָ֜הּ וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ־לָ֗הּ

“And the king arose to meet her, and he bowed down to her”

When Solomon **arose** and **bowed down** to Bathsheba, those were symbolic actions by which he showed great respect for her as the queen mother. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And the king stood up respectfully to greet her and bowed down to honor her]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 2:19 (#3)

וַיָּ֤שֶׂם כִּסֵּא֙ לְאֵ֣ם הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ וַתֵּ֥שֶׁב לִֽימִינֹ֖ו

“and he set a throne for the mother of the king, and she sat at his right side”

The setting of a throne for Bathsheba at Solomon’s right side was a symbolic action by which Solomon showed his great respect for his mother and her high status in the kingdom. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he honored his mother by placing a throne for her at his right side]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 2:19 (#4)

לְאֵ֣ם הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ

“for the mother of the king”

The term **mother of the king** refers to the queen mother, the king’s mother, who had special honor and authority in the royal court. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [for her as the queen mother]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 2:19 (#1)

וַתָּבֹא בַת־שֶׁבַע

“And Bathsheba came”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [And Bathsheba went]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 2:20 (#5)

אִמִּי

“my mother”

Solomon is using the courteous expression that a king in this culture would use to address his mother. The queen mother was an important figure in the royal courts of this culture. There may be a comparable expression from your culture that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [my lady]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 2:20 (#2)

אַל־תָּשֹׁב אֶת־פָּנָי

“Do not turn away my face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:16. Alternate translation: [Please do not turn me down] or [Please do not refuse my request]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:20 (#4)

שַׁאֲלָ֣ה

“Request”

This is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. Alternate translation: [You may make your request]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 2:20 (#3)

שַׁאֲלָ֣ה אִמִּי כִּ֚י לֹא־אָשִׁ֣יב אֶת־פָּנָיִךְ

“Request, my mother, for I will not turn away your face”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since **for I will not turn away your face** gives the reason for the result described in **Request, my mother**. Alternate translation: [I will not turn away your face, so request, my mother]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:20 (#1)

שְׁאֵלָה אַחַת קְטַנָּה אָנֹכִי שֹׁאֶלֶת מֵאִתָּךְ

“One small request I am requesting from you”

Bathsheba is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [I would like to make one small request of you]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 2:21 (#2)

אָחִ֖יךָ

“your brother”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:7. Alternate translation: [your half-brother] or [your older brother]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 2:21 (#1)

יִתַּ֨ן אֶת־אֲבִישַׁגשׁוּנַמִּ֜ית לַאֲדֹנִיָּ֗הוּ

“Let Abishag the Shunammitess be given to Adonijah”

The expression **be given** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Give Abishag the Shunammitess to Adonijah] or [Allow Adonijah to marry Abishag the Shunammitess]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:22 (#6)

וְלוֹ֙ וּלְאֶבְיָתָ֣ר

“and for him and for Abiathar”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [and not only for him, but also for Abiathar]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:22 (#1)

וַיַּעַן֙ הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה וַיֹּ֥אמֶר לְאִמּ֖וֹ

“And King Solomon answered and said to his mother”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:28. Alternate translation: [And King Solomon answered his mother]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 2:22 (#2)

וְלָמָּה֩ אַתְּ שֹׁאֶ֨לֶת אֶת־אֲבִישַׁגְ הַשּׁוּנַמִּ֜ית לַאֲדֹנִיָּ֗הוּ

“And why are you requesting Abishag the Shunammitess for Adonijah”

Solomon is using the question form to express strong disapproval. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not be requesting Abishag the Shunammitess for Adonijah!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 2:22 (#4)

וְשַׁאֲלִי־לוֹ֙ אֶת־הַמְּלוּכָ֔ה

“Then request for him the kingdom”

In this figure of speech, Solomon actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he says. He does not really want his mother to request the kingdom for Adonijah. Instead, he is expressing his anger at what she has already requested, suggesting that she might as well ask for the kingdom itself. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [By asking this, you are effectively asking me to let him become the king]

See: Irony

1 Kings 2:22 (#5)

וְשַׁאֲלִי־לוֹ֙ אֶת־הַמְּלוּכָ֔ה

“Then request for him the kingdom”

Solomon’s response shows that requesting to marry the previous king’s consort was a symbolic action equivalent to claiming the throne. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this request in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [By asking that I allow him to marry a woman who was a consort of the previous king, you are effectively asking me to let him become the king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 2:22 (#3)

וְשַׁאֲלִי־לוֹ֙ אֶת־הַמְּלוּכָ֔ה כִּֽי־הוּא֙ אָחִ֣י הַגָּד֔וֹל מִמֶּ֖נִּי

“Then request for him the kingdom, for he is my brother, older than me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Then, since he is my brother, older than me, request for him the kingdom]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:23 (#5)

דִּבֶּ֣רְ & אֶת־הַדָּבָ֔ר הַזֶּ֖ה

“has spoken this word”

Here, **word** represents what Adonijah requested by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has made this request]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:23 (#1)

כֹּ֣ה יַעֲשֶׂה־לִּ֣י אֱלֹהִ֗ים וְכֹ֥ה יוֹסִ֛יף כִּֽי־בְנַפְשׁ֥וֹ דִבֶּ֖רְ אֲדֹנִיָּ֣הוּ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֥ר הַזֶּֽה

“Thus may God do to me, and thus may he add, for against his life Adonijah has spoken this word”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since against his life Adonijah has spoken this word, thus may God do to me, and thus may he add]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:23 (#4)

בְנַפְשׁ֥וֹ דִבֶּ֖רְ אֲדֹנִיָּ֣הוּ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֥ר הַזֶּֽה

“against his life Adonijah has spoken this word”

Solomon is using **against his life** as a common expression of his culture to mean “at the cost of his life” or “causing his own death.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have

that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the cost of his life Adonijah has spoken this word] or [Adonijah has caused his own death by speaking this word]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:23 (#2)

כֹּה֩ יַֽעֲשֶׂה־לִּ֨י אֱלֹהִ֜ים וְכֹ֣ה יוֹסִ֗יף

“Thus may God do to me, and thus may he add”

Following the custom of his culture, Solomon is swearing an oath by stating one part of a condition but not the other. In this case, Solomon states the second part of a condition (“then”) but not the first part (“if”). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explicitly state the first part of this condition. Alternate translation: [If I do not execute Adonijah, thus may God do to me, and thus may he add]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 2:23 (#3)

וְכֹ֣ה יוֹסִ֗יף

“and thus may he add”

Solomon is using **thus may he add** as a common expression of his culture to mean “may he do even worse.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 3:17. Alternate translation: [and more besides] or [and may he do even worse]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:24 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֱכִינַ֣נִי וַיּוֹשִׁיבֵ֗נִי עַל־כִּסֵּא֙ דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֔י

“who has established me and made me sit on the throne of David my father”

The phrase **established me and made me sit** expresses a single idea. The term **established** tells how God has **made** Solomon **sit on the throne**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [who has made me sit securely on the throne of David my father]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 2:24 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָ֔ה

“the life of Yahweh”

Following the custom of his culture, Solomon is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express such an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 2:24 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֱכִינַ֣נִי וַיּוֹשִׁיבֵ֗נִי עַל־כִּסֵּא֙ דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֔י

“who has established me and made me sit on the throne of David my father”

Here, **throne** represents being king and having authority to rule. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [who has established me as the king who will rule as David my father did]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:24 (#4)

וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂה־לִּ֖י בַּ֣יִת כַּאֲשֶׁ֑ר דִּבֶּֽר

“and who has made a house for me, just as he said”

Solomon is speaking as if a royal dynasty, a succession of kings who are all descendants of an original king, were actually a **house**. He is referring to what Yahweh **said** to David in 2 Samuel 7:11, “Yahweh will make a house for you. ... I will raise up after you your seed ... and I will establish his kingdom.” Solomon says here that Yahweh has made a house **for me** because he is part of that promised royal dynasty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and who has made me part of the royal dynasty he promised to David]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:24 (#5)

יוּמַ֖ת אֲדֹנִיָּֽהוּ

“Adonijah shall be killed”

The expression **shall be killed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will have my soldiers kill Adonijah]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:25 (#2)

בּוֹ

“him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Adonijah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Adonijah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:25 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח֩ & בְּיַד֙ בְּנָיָ֣הוּ בֶן־יְהוֹיָדָ֔ע

“And & sent by the hand of Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada”

The **hand** of Benaiah represents his agency in acting on behalf of Solomon, with his authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [authorized Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, to act on his behalf]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:25 (#3)

וַיָּמֹ֖ת

“and he died”

Here the word **and** introduces what happened as a result of Benaiah attacking Adonijah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different word or phrase that introduces a result. Alternate translation: [so that he died] or [and as a result, he died]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:26 (#5)

לֹ֣א אֲמִיתְךָ֗

“I will not kill you”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how the author and characters often use the name of one person who is involved in something, often the person who is responsible for it or who is directing it, to represent everyone who is involved. In this case, Solomon does not mean that he personally will not kill Abiathar, but that he will not direct someone to kill him. Alternate translation: [I will not have one of my soldiers kill you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:26 (#4)

וּבַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה לֹ֣א אֲמִיתְךָ֔ כִּי־נָשָׂ֗אתָ אֶת־אֲרוֹן֙ אֲדֹנָ֣י יְהוִ֔ה לְפָנֵ֖י דָּוִ֑ד אָבִ֔י וְכִ֣י הִתְעַנִּ֔יתָ בְּכֹ֖ל אֲשֶׁר־הִתְעַנָּ֥ה אָבִֽי

“but I will not kill you on this day, because you carried the Box of my Lord Yahweh to the face of David my father and because you were afflicted with everything {with} which my father was afflicted”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [but because you carried the Box of my Lord Yahweh to the face of David my father and because you were afflicted with everything with which my father was afflicted, I will not kill you on this day]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:26 (#7)

הִתְעַנִּ֔יתָ בְּכֹ֖ל אֲשֶׁר־הִתְעַנָּ֥ה אָבִֽי

“you were afflicted with everything {with} which my father was afflicted”

The expression **you were afflicted** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [everything that afflicted my father also afflicted you] or [you shared in all of my father’s afflictions]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:26 (#6)

לִפְנֵ֥י דָוִ֖ד

“to the face of David”

Here, **the face of David** represents David’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. (Solomon is describing what Abiathar did in 2 Samuel 15:24–29.) Alternate translation: [into the presence of David]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:26 (#2)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an assertion. Alternate translation: [Truly]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:26 (#3)

אִ֣ישׁ מָ֔וֶת אָ֖תָּה

“you {are} a man of death”

Solomon is using the phrase **a man of death** as a common expression of his culture to mean “someone who deserves to die.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you deserve to die]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:26 (#1)

עַל־שָׂדֶ֙יךָ֙

“to your fields”

Solomon is using Abiathar’s **fields** to represent all of the property on which Abiathar lives, including his home. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to your home]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:27 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר דִּבֶּ֙ר עַל־בֵּ֣ית עֵלִ֔י בְּשִׁלֹ֖ה

“that he had spoken concerning the house of Eli at Shiloh”

You may want to arrange the phrases in this sentence in such a way as to make clear that this was not something that Yahweh had said would happen to Eli and his family there **at Shiloh**. Instead, it was something that Yahweh had **spoken** in Shiloh. Alternate translation: [that he had spoken at Shiloh concerning the house of Eli]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 2:27 (#3)

בֵּ֣ית עֵלִ֔י

“the house of Eli”

Here, **the house of Eli** represents the descendants of Eli. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Eli]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:27 (#1)

אֶת־דְּבַ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה

“the word of Yahweh”

Here, **word** represents what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the pronouncement of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:28 (#1)

וְהַשְּׁמֻעָה֙ בָּ֣אָה עַד־יוֹאָ֔ב כִּֽי־יוֹאָ֥ב נָטָ֖הּ אַחֲרֵ֣י אֲדֹנִיָּ֑הוּ וְאַחֲרֵ֥י אַבְשָׁל֖וֹם לֹ֥א נָטָֽה

“And the report came to Joab, for Joab had turned aside after Adonijah, but he had not turned aside after Absalom”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could put the first phrase at the end, since the next two phrases give the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since Joab had turned aside after Adonijah, though he had not turned aside after Absalom, the report came to Joab]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 2:28 (#3)

יוֹאָ֥ב נָטָ֖הּ אַחֲרֵ֣י אֲדֹנִיָּ֑הוּ וְאַחֲרֵ֥י אַבְשָׁל֖וֹם לֹ֥א נָטָֽה

“Joab had turned aside after Adonijah, but he had not turned aside after Absalom”

The phrase **turned aside** speaks of loyalty here as if it were a path that a person could walk on. Earlier, Joab had not stopped being loyal to David and become loyal to Absalom instead. However, Joab had now stopped being loyal to King David (who wanted Solomon to be king) and had become loyal to Adonijah instead. That is what the author means. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Joab had stopped being loyal to David and to Solomon, his chosen king, and had become loyal instead to Adonijah, even though earlier he had not stopped being loyal to David and become loyal to Absalom]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:28 (#4)

וַיַּחֲזֵ֖ק בְּקַרְנ֣וֹת הַמִּזְבֵּֽחַ

“and he grasped the horns of the altar”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:50. Alternate translation: [and he grasped the horns of the altar to claim the right of safety within the sanctuary]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 2:28 (#2)

וְהַשְּׁמֻעָה֙ בָּ֣אָה עַד־יוֹאָ֔ב

“And the report came to Joab”

The author is speaking of **the report** as if it were a living thing that could travel to Joab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And someone reported these things to Joab]

See: Personification

1 Kings 2:29 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּ֖ד

“And it was declared”

The expression **it was declared** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:29 (#2)

לַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה כִּֽי־נָ֥ס יוֹאָ֖ב אֶל־אֹ֣הֶל יְהוָ֑ה וְהִנֵּ֥ה אֵצֶ֖ל הַמִּזְבֵּֽחַ

“to King Solomon that Joab had fled to the tent of Yahweh, and behold, {he was} beside the altar”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [to King Solomon, “Joab has fled to the tent of Yahweh, and behold, he is beside the altar”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Kings 2:30 (#6)

לֵאמֹ֔ר כֹּה־דִבֶּ֥ר יוֹאָ֖ב וְכֹ֣ה עָנָ֑נִי

“saying, “Thus Joab spoke, and thus he answered me”

The author is using these phrases to indicate that Benaiah reported to Solomon what Joab had said to him. These are not the actual words that Benaiah spoke. So it may be more natural in your language to express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him what Joab had said in response to him]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Kings 2:30 (#3)

כֹּה־אָמַ֥ר הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ צֵ֥א

“Thus says the king, ‘Come out”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [The king orders you to come out!]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 2:30 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֤א בְנָיָ֙הוּ֙

“And Benaiah came”

In a context such as this, your language might say **went** instead of “came.” Alternate translation: [And Benaiah went]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 2:30 (#5)

דָּבָ֔ר

“word”

Here, **word** represents the report that Benaiah gave Solomon by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a report]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:30 (#4)

כִּֽי־פֹ֖ה אָמ֥וּת

“for here I will die”

In this figure of speech, Joab actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of his words. Rather than truly wanting to die, he is defiantly saying that he will not come out of the tent, believing that he will not **die** if he remains there. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you are going to kill me, you are going to have to come in and kill me here]

See: Irony

1 Kings 2:30 (#7)

כֹּה־דִבֶּ֥ר יוֹאָ֖ב וְכֹ֣ה עָנָ֑נִי

“Thus Joab spoke, and thus he answered me”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second phrase emphasizes the meaning of the first one by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, if you choose to represent this as a direct quotation, you could

combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Thus Joab replied to me]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 2:30 (#2)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר אֵלָ֜יו

“and he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Benaiah, while the pronoun **him** refers to Joab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Benaiah said to Joab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:31 (#1)

וּפְגַע־בּ֖וֹ וּקְבַרְתּ֑וֹ

“and attack him and bury him”

Solomon assumes that Benaiah will know that he means that Benaiah is to **attack** and kill Joab even though he is still inside the sacred tent, where Israelites ordinarily would have sanctuary. Solomon was able to order this because the Law of Moses said in Exodus 21:14 that a murderer was not entitled to sanctuary within the sacred tent. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and attack and kill him there in the sacred tent, since as a murderer he is not entitled to sanctuary. Then bury him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:31 (#4)

וְהֲסִירֹ֣תָ

“And you shall remove”

Here, the word **and** introduces what will happen as a result of Benaiah executing and burying Joab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a result. Alternate translation: [And in that way you will remove] or [And as a result, you will remove]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 2:31 (#5)

בֵּ֖֥ית אָבִֽי

“the house of my father”

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 9:20. Alternate translation: [my extended family]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 2:31 (#2)

וּפְגַע־בּ֖וֹ

“and attack him”

By **attack him**, Solomon means that Benaiah is to kill Joab. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and kill him with your sword]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:31 (#3)

וְהֲסִירֹ֣תָ ׀ דְּמֵ֣י חִנָּ֗ם אֲשֶׁר֩ שָׁפַ֨ךְ יוֹאָ֜ב מֵעָלַ֗י וּמֵעַ֛ל בֵּ֥֖ית אָבִֽי

“And you shall remove the blood that Joab poured out without cause from upon me and from upon the house of my father”

Solomon is speaking as if Joab had actually **poured out** the **blood** of Abner and Amasa when he murdered them **without cause**. Solomon is also speaking as if their blood were now **upon** him and his extended family. He means that as the king, he is responsible to provide justice for these innocent victims by executing their murderer, and if he does not, God will hold him and his family accountable. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you shall ensure that God does not hold me and the house of my father accountable for failing to punish Joab for murdering two innocent men]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:32 (#1)

וְהֵשִׁ֤יב יְהוָה֙ אֶת־דָּמ֔וֹ עַל־רֹאשׁ֑וֹ

“And Yahweh will return his blood on his head”

Solomon is using **return his blood on his head** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh will hold Joab morally and legally responsible and punish him for the **blood** (that is, the murders) of Abner and Amasa. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He has blood on his hands, and Yahweh will hold him accountable for that] or [And Yahweh will punish him for committing murder]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:32 (#2)

אֶת־דָּמֹו

“his blood”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **blood** that Joab shed when he murdered Abner and Amasa. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the blood that he shed]

See: Possession

1 Kings 2:32 (#3)

צַדִּקִ֥ים וְטֹבִ֖ים מִמֶּ֑נּוּ

“more righteous and better than him”

The terms **more righteous** and **better** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [much more righteous]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 2:32 (#4)

וְאָבִ֣י דָוִ֔ד לֹ֥א יָדָ֖ע

“and my father David did not know”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and my father David did not know his intentions]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 2:33 (#6)

יִהְיֶ֥ה שָׁלֹ֛ום

“will be peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [it will be peaceful]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:33 (#3)

זַרְעֹו֙ & וּלְזַרְעֹ֔ו

“his seed & and for his seed”

Here, Solomon is speaking of a person’s descendants as if they were **seed**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his offspring ... and for his offspring] or [his descendants ... and for his descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:33 (#1)

וְשָׁ֣בוּ דְמֵיהֶ֗ם בְּרֹ֤אשׁ יֹואָב֙ וּבְרֹ֣אשׁ זַרְעֹ֔ו

“And their blood will return on the head of Joab and on the head of his seed”

See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [And Joab and his seed will experience the just consequences for their murders]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:33 (#4)

וּלְבֵיתֹ֑ו

“and for his house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [and for his dynasty]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:33 (#5)

וּלְכִסְאֹ֑ו

“and for his throne”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [and for his kingdom]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:33 (#2)

דְּמֵיהֶ֗ם

“their blood”

Here, **blood** represents the deaths or murders of these men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their deaths] or [their murders]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:34 (#3)

בְּבֵיתֹ֑ו

“in his house”

Here, **house** represents the entire location where Joab lived, including the surrounding land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent

expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [on his own land]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:34 (#1)

וַיִּפְגַּע־בּוֹ

“and attacked him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Joab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and attacked Joab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:34 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“And he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:35 (#1)

תַּחְתָּתָיו

“in place of him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Joab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [in place of Joab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:36 (#1)

שָׁ֣ם & מִשָּׁ֔ם

“there & from there”

Since Solomon is in Jerusalem as he is speaking with Shimei, it may be more natural in your language to say “here” rather than **there**. Alternate translation: [here ... from here]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:36 (#2)

אָ֥נָה וָאָֽנָה

“where or where”

Solomon is using **where or where** as a common expression of his culture to mean “to any other place.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to any other place]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:37 (#3)

בְּיוֹם֙ צֵאתְךָ֔

“on the day of your going out”

Solomon is using the expression **the day of your going out** to refer to any occasion on which Shimei might leave Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if on any occasion you leave the city]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:37 (#1)

וְהָיָה֙ ׀ בְּיוֹם֙ צֵאתְךָ֔ וְעָבַרְתָּ֖ אֶת־נַ֣חַל קִדְרוֹ֑ן יָדֹ֣עַ תֵּדַ֔ע כִּֽי־מ֥וֹת תָּמ֖וּת

“And it will happen on the day of your going out and you pass over the wadi of Kidron, knowing, you shall know that dying, you shall die”

Solomon is using the instructional form **you shall know** to indicate something that Shimei is to know right then, at the time when he is speaking, not at some future time when he might **pass over the wadi of Kidron**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could put the information that Shimei is to know this at the beginning of the sentence. Alternate translation: [And knowing, you shall know that it will happen, on the day of your going out and you pass over the wadi of Kidron, that dying, you shall die]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 2:37 (#2)

בְּיוֹם֙ צֵאתְךָ֔ וְעָבַרְתָּ֖ אֶת־נַ֣חַל קִדְרוֹ֑ן

“on the day of your going out and you pass over the wadi of Kidron”

Solomon is using one way of leaving Jerusalem (crossing **the wadi of Kidron**, which was on the east side of Jerusalem) to mean leaving Jerusalem in any way at all. Solomon may refer to this way of leaving Jerusalem because it is the one that Shimei is most likely to use to return to his home in Bahurim. However, the example of the wadi of Kidron also provides a limit to how far Shimei may go from the city in any direction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation:

[if at any time you go farther from Jerusalem in any direction than the distance to the wadi of Kidron]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:37 (#4)

יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע כִּי מוֹת תָּמוּת

“knowing, you shall know that dying, you shall die”

Solomon is repeating forms of the verbs “know” and “die” in order to intensify his expression of the ideas that they convey. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you shall know for certain that you shall surely die]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 2:37 (#5)

דָּמְךָ יִהְיֶה בְרֹאשֶׁךָ

“Your blood will be on your head”

Solomon is using **Your blood will be on your head** as a common expression of his culture to mean “You will be responsible for your own death.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 3:29. Alternate translation: [You will be responsible for your own death] or [You will have dug your own grave]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:38 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֲדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ כֵּן יַעֲשֶׂה עַבְדֶּךָ

“Just as my lord the king has spoken, thus will your servant do”

See how you translated the expression “my lord the king” in 1:2 and the expression “your ... servant” in 1:13. Alternate translation: [Just as you, my lord the king, have spoken, thus will I, your servant, do]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 2:38 (#1)

טטֹוב הַדָּבָר

“The word is good”

Shimei is using the term **word** to represent what Solomon has said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What you have said is good]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:38 (#2)

טטֹוב הַדָּבָר

“The word is good”

As in the case of Bathsheba in 2:18, Shimei is not necessarily using the expression **good** to mean that she thinks that what Solomon is requiring is a good thing. Instead, he is using the expression to indicate that he agrees to do what Solomon is requiring. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:18. Alternate translation: [I agree to do what you have said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:39 (#2)

וַיַּגִּידוּ לְשִׁמְעִי

“And they declared to Shimei”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Shimei was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:39 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to 1 Kings.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 2:40 (#1)

וַיָּקָם שִׁמְעִי

“So Shimei arose”

The author does not mean that Shimei was sitting down or lying down and stood up. Instead, he is using the term **arose** to mean that Shimei took action. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [So Shimei took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:40 (#2)

וַיַּחֲבֹשׁ אֶת־חֲמֹרוֹ וַיֵּלֶךְ

“and saddled his donkey and went”

The author is using saddling the **donkey**, the first thing that Shimei did in order to travel to Gath, to represent his entire journey. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and saddled his donkey and rode on it]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 2:40 (#3)

וַיֵּלֶךְ שִׁמְעִי וַיָּבֵא

“And Shimei went and brought back his”

Since the author says in the previous sentence that Shimei **went** to Gath, it may not be natural in your language to repeat the term **went** in this sentence. If not, you can leave out the second instance of the word. Alternate translation: [Then Shimei returned with]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 2:41 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּד לִשְׁלֹמֹה

“And it was declared to Solomon”

The expression **it was declared to Solomon** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared to Solomon]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:42 (#5)

יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע כִּי מוֹת תָּמוּת

“knowing, you shall know that dying, you shall die”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:37. Alternate translation: [you shall know for certain that you shall surely die]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 2:42 (#6)

יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע

“knowing, you shall know”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:37. Alternate translation: [know for certain]

See: Statements — Other Uses

1 Kings 2:42 (#2)

וְאָעִיד בְּךָ לֵאמֹר בְּיוֹם צֵאתְךָ וְהָלַכְתָּךְ אָנָה וָאָנָה יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע כִּי מוֹת תָּמוּת

“and testify against you, saying, ‘On the day of your going out, and you go where or where, knowing, you shall know that dying, you shall die”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and testify against you that on the day of your going out, if you went where or where, knowing, you would know that dying, you would die?]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 2:42 (#4)

וְהָלַכְתָּךְ אָנָה וָאָנָה

“and you go where or where”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:36. Alternate translation: [and you go to any other place]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:42 (#7)

וַתֹּאמֶר אֵלַי טוֹב הַדָּבָר שָׁמָעְתִּי

“And you said to me, ‘The word I have heard is good”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you told me that the word you had heard was good]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 2:42 (#1)

הֲלֹוא הִשְׁבַּעְתִּיךָ בַיהוָה וָאָעִד בְּךָ לֵאמֹר בְּיוֹם צֵאתְךָ וְהָלַכְתָּךְ אָנָה וָאָנָה יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע כִּי מוֹת תָּמוּת

“Did I not make you swear by Yahweh and testify against you, saying, ‘On the day of your going out, and you go where or where, knowing, you shall know that dying, you shall die”

Solomon is using the question form to rebuke Shimei and remind him that he had commanded something and that Shimei had agreed. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that

purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I certainly made you swear by Yahweh and testified against you, saying, 'On the day of your going out, and you go where or where, knowing, you shall know that dying, you shall die'!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 2:42 (#8)

טֹוב הַדָּבָר שָׁמָעְתִּי

"The word I have heard is good"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:38. Alternate translation: [I accept the conditions you describe]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:42 (#3)

בְּיֹום צֵאתְךָ

"On the day of your going out"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:37. Alternate translation: [if on any occasion you leave the city]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:43 (#1)

וּמַדּוּעַ לֹא שָׁמַרְתָּ אֵת שְׁבֻעַת יְהוָה וְאֶת־הַמִּצְוָה אֲשֶׁר־צִוִּיתִי עָלֶיךָ

"So why did you not keep the oath of Yahweh and the command that I commanded upon you"

Solomon is using the question form to rebuke Shimei for breaking his oath. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So you ought to have kept the oath of Yahweh and the command that I commanded upon you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 2:43 (#2)

אֵת שְׁבֻעַת יְהוָה

"the oath of Yahweh"

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **oath** that he made Shimei swear to **Yahweh**. This is not stated explicitly in 2:37–38, but the solemn form of Solomon's pronouncement and Shimei's agreement, "The word is good," apparently constituted Solomon making Shimei swear. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the oath that you swore to Yahweh]

See: Possession

1 Kings 2:43 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַמִּצְוָה אֲשֶׁר־צִוִּיתִי עָלֶיךָ

"and the command that I commanded upon you"

Solomon is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and the command that I imposed on you] or [and the command that I gave you]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 2:44 (#1)

אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ֠ אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה אֲשֶׁשֶׁר יָדַעַ֨תְ לְבָבֶךָ אֲשֶׁשֶׁר עָשִׂ֜יתָ לְדָוִ֣ד אָבִ֗י

"You, you know all of the evil that your heart knows, which you did to David my father"

In this context, the **heart** represents a person's conscience. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your own conscience is making you fully aware of all the evil that you did to David my father]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 2:44 (#3)

אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה אֲשֶׁשֶׁר יָדַעַ֨תְ לְבָבֶךָ אֲשֶׁשֶׁר עָשִׂ֜יתָ לְדָוִ֣ד אָבִ֗י

"all of the evil that your heart knows, which you did to David my father"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [all of the evil things that you did to David my father, which your heart knows]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 2:44 (#2)

אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ֠

"You, you know"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:5. Alternate translation: [You know quite well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 2:44 (#4)

וְהֵשִׁ֧יב יְהוָ֛ה אֶת־רָעָתְךָ֖ בְּרֹאשֶֽׁךָ

“And Yahweh will return your evil on your head”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:32. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will hold you accountable for the evil things you have done] or [And Yahweh will punish you for the evil things you have done]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 2:45 (#1)

וְהַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה בָּר֖וּךְ

“But King Solomon will be blessed”

In making a solemn royal pronouncement to Shimei, Solomon is speaking of himself regally in the third person. Your language may have a regal form that it could use here. (For example, in some languages, kings and queens speak of themselves in the plural.) You could also use the first person. Alternate translation: [But I, King Solomon, will be blessed]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 2:45 (#2)

וְהַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה בָּר֖וּךְ

“But King Solomon will be blessed”

The expression **will be blessed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh will bless King Solomon] or [But Yahweh will bless me, King Solomon]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:45 (#3)

וְכִסֵּ֥א דָוִ֖ד יִהְיֶ֣ה נָכ֑וֹן לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָ֥ה

“and the throne of David will be established to the face of Yahweh”

The expression **will be established** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will establish the throne of David to his face]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 2:45 (#4)

וְכִסֵּ֥א דָוִ֖ד

“and the throne of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:48. Alternate translation: [and the dynasty of David]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:45 (#5)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, the **face** of Yahweh represents his presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:46 (#3)

בְּיַד־שְׁלֹמֹֽה

“in the hand of Solomon”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the power of Solomon] or [under the control of Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 2:46 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵּ֣א

“and he went out”

The implication is that Benaiah brought Shimei out of the palace in order to kill him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he brought him out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 2:46 (#2)

וְהַמַּמְלָכָ֖ה נָכֹנָ֑ה

“And the kingdom was established”

The expression **was established** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is God. Alternate translation: [So Yahweh established the kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh appears to Solomon, and Solomon asks for wisdom (3:1–15)
2. Solomon demonstrates that Yahweh has given him great wisdom (316–28)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Royal alliances through marriage

This chapter opens with Solomon marrying the daughter of Pharaoh. In the ancient world, rulers married the daughters of other rulers in order to form alliances with their kingdoms. Marrying into the Egyptian royal family was a significant diplomatic initiative by Solomon. It secured a powerful alliance with the dominant empire of the time, and this provided stability on Israel's southern border. This marriage, however, also introduced a religious tension, since the foreign princess, Pharaoh's daughter, brought her own gods and customs with her. As chapter 11 later describes, when Solomon built shrines in Jerusalem for other gods so that his foreign wives could worship them there, this greatly angered Yahweh and led to great trouble for the people of Israel.

The significance of "high places"

The author notes at the beginning of this chapter that Solomon and the people were offering sacrifices at "high places." Before Solomon built the temple in Jerusalem, it was common for the Israelites to worship and offer sacrifices at various local shrines built on the tops of hills. While the law of Moses commanded that all sacrifices eventually be made at a single, central sanctuary, this practice was tolerated until the temple was completed. So the author is not condemning Solomon's actions at the "great high place" of Gibeon, since he was worshiping Yahweh there. However, the worship of foreign gods at high places became a serious problem later in the history of Israel, as the books of 1 Kings and 2 Kings describe. So the author is being careful to specify that Solomon worshiped at Gibeon, and Yahweh appeared to him there, only because the temple had not yet been constructed.

Dreams as revelations from God

A pivotal moment in this chapter is Yahweh's appearance to Solomon in a dream. In ancient Israelite culture, dreams were one of the primary ways in which God communicated with his people, especially with prophets and kings. In this dream, when Yahweh asked Solomon what he wanted, Solomon asked for "a hearing heart to judge your people, to discern between good and evil." His request for the spiritual and judicial discernment needed to rule justly pleased Yahweh, since he was prioritizing the welfare of the people and his role as God's representative over personal wealth or power.

1 Kings 3:1 (#2)

וַיִּקַּ֣ח אֶת־בַּת־פַּרְעֹ֔ה

"And he took the daughter of Pharaoh"

When the author says that Solomon **took** Pharaoh's daughter, the implication is that he married her. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he married the daughter of Pharaoh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:1 (#3)

וְאֶת־בֵּ֖ית יְהוָ֑ה

"and the house of Yahweh"

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of the use of the term **house** to mean "temple." Alternate translation: [and the temple of Yahweh] or [and Yahweh's temple]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:1 (#1)

וַיִּתְחַתֵּ֥ן שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה אֶת־פַּרְעֹ֑ה

"And Solomon made himself a son-in-law to Pharaoh"

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you described the same relationship in 1 Samuel 18:18. Alternate translation: [And Solomon made himself a daughter's husband to Pharaoh]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 3:2 (#1)

רַ֚ק הָעָ֔ם מְזַבְּחִ֖ים בַּבָּמ֑וֹת

"However, the people were sacrificing at the high places"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. Readers might have been scandalized that Solomon was sacrificing at a high place, and the author wants them to appreciate that Solomon did

this only because the temple had not yet been built. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 3:2 (#2)

רַ֗ק

“However”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [In the meantime] or [Meanwhile]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 3:2 (#5)

לְשֵׁ֣ם יְהוָ֔ה

“for the name of Yahweh”

In this context, the term **name** could refer to: (1) people calling on Yahweh by name as their God and thus worshiping him. What Solomon says in 8:41–43 in his prayer of dedication for the temple suggests that this could be the meaning. Alternate translation: [for the worship of Yahweh] or (2) the reputation of Yahweh. This would be similar to the meaning of [name] in 1:47. Alternate translation: [for the reputation of Yahweh] or [to make Yahweh’s greatness known]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:2 (#3)

הָעָ֖ם מְזַבְּחִ֣ים בַּבָּמ֑וֹת כִּ֚י לֹא־נִבְנָ֣ה בַ֔יִת לְשֵׁ֥ם יְהוָ֖ה עַ֣ד הַיָּמִ֣ים הָהֵֽם

“the people were sacrificing at the high places because a house had not been built for the name of Yahweh up to those days”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [because a house had not been built for the name of Yahweh up to those days, the people were sacrificing at the high places]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:2 (#6)

הַיָּמִ֣ים הָהֵֽם

“those days”

The author is using the term **those days** to refer to a specific time, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:2 (#4)

לֹא־נִבְנָ֣ה בַ֔יִת

“a house had not been built”

The expression **had not been built** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one had built a temple]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 3:3 (#3)

בְּחֻקּ֣וֹת דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֔יו

“in the statutes of David his father”

In this context, the word **statutes** could mean: (1) the customs that David followed, specifically in obedience to Yahweh. Alternate translation: [in the customs of David his father] or [in the obedient manner of David his father] or (2) instructions that David gave to Solomon to obey Yahweh. Alternate translation: [according to the instructions that David his father had given him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:3 (#1)

וַיֶּ֤אֱהַב שְׁלֹמֹה֙ אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה לָלֶ֖כֶת בְּחֻקּ֣וֹת דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֑יו

“And Solomon loved Yahweh, to walk in the statutes of David his father”

The second phrase describes the result of what the first phrase describes. It may be helpful to use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [And Solomon loved Yahweh, and as a result, he walked in the statutes of David his father] or [And because Solomon loved Yahweh, he walked in the statutes of David his father]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:3 (#2)

לָלֶ֖כֶת בְּחֻקּ֣וֹת דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֑יו

“to walk in the statutes of David his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [to live as David his father had lived]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:4 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ הַמֶּלֶךְ גִּבְעֹנָה לִזְבֹּחַ שָׁשָׁם כִּי הִהֵיא הַבָּמָה הַגְּדוֹלָה

“And the king went to Gibeon to sacrifice there, for it was the great high place”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 2:39, where it similarly introduces a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 3:4 (#2)

וַיֵּלֶךְ הַמֶּלֶךְ גִּבְעֹנָה לִזְבֹּחַ שָׁשָׁם כִּי הִהֵיא הַבָּמָה הַגְּדוֹלָה

“And the king went to Gibeon to sacrifice there, for it was the great high place”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since Gibeon was the great high place, the king went to sacrifice there]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:5 (#1)

שְׁאַל

“Ask”

This is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:14. Alternate translation: [You may ask]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 3:6 (#3)

לְפָנָיִךָ

“to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents being in Yahweh’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:6 (#4)

וּבִישָׁרַת לֵבָב

“and in uprightness of heart”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s inner motives and intentions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and with upright motives and intentions]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:6 (#5)

וַתִּשְׁמֹר־לוֹ אֶת־הַחֶסֶד הַגָּדוֹל הַזֶּה וַתִּתֶּן־לוֹ בֵּן יֹשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאוֹ

“And you have kept for him this great covenant faithfulness, and you have given to him a son sitting on his throne”

Here, the word **and** introduces an explanation of how God kept his covenant faithfulness to David. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a connecting word that more specifically shows this relationship. Alternate translation: [And you have kept for him this great covenant faithfulness by giving to him a son sitting on his throne]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 3:6 (#1)

אַתָּה עָשִׂיתָ עִם־עַבְדְּךָ דָוִד אָבִי חֶסֶד גָּדוֹל כַּאֲשֶׁר הָלַךְ לְפָנֶיךָ בֶּאֱמֶת וּבְצֶדֶק וּבְיֹשֶׁר לֵבָב עִמָּךְ

“You, you did great covenant faithfulness with your servant David, my father because he walked to your face in faithfulness and in righteousness and in uprightness of heart with you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because your servant David, my father, walked to your face in faithfulness and in righteousness and in uprightness of heart with you, you, you did great covenant faithfulness with him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:6 (#2)

אַתָּה עָשִׂיתָ

“You, you did”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:17. Alternate translation: [You personally did]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 3:6 (#6)

יֹשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאוֹ

“sitting on his throne”

Here, **sitting on his throne** represents ruling as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [who is ruling the Israelites as he did]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:6 (#7)

כַּיּ֖וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“as {it is} this day”

Solomon is using the term **this day** to refer to a specific time, his own present time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as it is at this time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:7 (#2)

אַתָּה֙ הִמְלַ֣כְתָּ

“you, you have made & reign”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [you have personally made]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 3:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּה֙

“And now”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 3:7 (#3)

אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֔

“your servant”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [me, your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 3:7 (#5)

לֹ֣א אֵדַ֔ע צֵ֥את וָבֹֽא

“I do not know going out or coming in”

Solomon is using **I do not know going out or coming in** as a common expression of his culture to mean that he does not know how to be a leader. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 18:13. Alternate translation: [I do not know my way around] or [I do not know how to be a leader]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 3:7 (#4)

וְאָנֹכִ֖י נַ֣עַר קָטֹ֑ן

“but I {am} a little child”

Solomon is speaking as if he actually were a **little child**. He means that he feels very inexperienced and inadequate as a ruler. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but I am very inexperienced]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:8 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יִמָּנֶ֖ה וְלֹ֣א יִסָּפֵ֑ר מֵרֹֽב

“who can not be numbered and can not be counted from abundance”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. (If you reflect the phrase **from abundance**, you may not wish also to reflect the word **abundant**. See the discussion in the “Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit” note to this verse.) Alternate translation: [who from abundance cannot be numbered and cannot be counted] or [who, because they are so abundant, cannot be numbered and cannot be counted]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:8 (#1)

עַם־רָ֖ב אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יִמָּנֶ֖ה וְלֹ֣א יִסָּפֵ֑ר מֵרֹֽב

“an abundant people who can not be numbered and can not be counted from abundance”

It might seem that saying both **abundant** and **from abundance** would be extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could use just one expression or the other in your translation. Alternate translation: [a people who are so abundant that they cannot be numbered and cannot be counted]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 3:8 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִמָּנֶה וְלֹא יִסָּפֵר

“who can not be numbered and can not be counted”

The expressions **cannot be numbered** and **cannot be counted** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom no one can number and whom no one can count]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 3:8 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִמָּנֶה וְלֹא יִסָּפֵר

“who can not be numbered and can not be counted”

The phrases **cannot be numbered** and **cannot be counted** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [who cannot be counted at all] or [whom no one can count at all]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 3:9 (#1)

לֵ֣ב שֹׁמֵ֔עַ

“a hearing heart”

In this context, the term **heart** represents either the thoughts or the will. The phrase **a hearing heart** could mean: (1) a mind that is able to listen well to both sides of an argument or legal dispute and recognize which one is correct. Alternate translation: [a discriminating mind] or (2) a will that is attentive and yielded to God’s guidance and promptings. Alternate translation: [a yielded will]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:9 (#3)

כִּ֚י מִ֣י יוּכַ֔ל לִשְׁפֹּ֖ט אֶת־עַמְּךָ֣ הַכָּבֵ֑ד הַזֶּֽה

“For who is able to judge this your heavy people”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that he is not capable of judging so many people. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [For I do not feel able to judge this your heavy people!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 3:9 (#2)

לְהָבִ֖ין בֵּ֥ין־ט֖וֹב לְרָֽע

“to discern between good to evil”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good** and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [to recognize when people are doing something good and when they are doing something evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 3:9 (#4)

כִּ֚י מִ֣י יוּכַ֔ל לִשְׁפֹּ֖ט אֶת־עַמְּךָ֣ הַכָּבֵ֑ד הַזֶּֽה

“For who is able to judge this your heavy people”

In this context, the term **heavy** could mean: (1) that judging God’s people was an important responsibility that felt to Solomon as if it were a burden that he would be carrying. Alternate translation: [For who is able to bear the important responsibility of judging this your people] or (2) that the Israelites are a great people in the sense of being numerous, as the previous verse describes. Alternate translation: [For who is able to judge such a numerous people as yours]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:10 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י אֲדֹנָֽי

“in the eyes of the Lord”

The author is using the common expression of his culture **in the eyes of** to mean “in the judgment of” or “in the opinion of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of the Lord]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 3:10 (#1)

וַיִּיטַ֤ב הַדָּבָר֙ בְּעֵינֵ֣י אֲדֹנָ֔י כִּ֥י שָׁאַ֖ל שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה אֶת־הַדָּבָ֥ר הַזֶּֽה

“And the thing was good in the eyes of the Lord, that Solomon had requested this thing”

It might seem that saying **thing** twice would be extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could use the expression just once in your translation. Alternate translation: [And it was good in the eyes of the Lord that Solomon had requested this thing]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 3:11 (#3)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ אֹיְבֶ֑יךָ

“the life of your enemies”

God is using the term **life** to represent the end of life, that is, the death of these **enemies**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the death of your enemies]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:11 (#2)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ אֹיְבֶ֑יךָ

“the life of your enemies”

In this verse, the word **life** is singular in form, but it refers to all enemies as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “life.” Alternate translation: [the lives of your enemies]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 3:11 (#1)

יָמִ֣ים רַבִּ֔ים

“many days”

Here, **many days** represents a long time or a long life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a long life]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:11 (#4)

לִשְׁמֹ֥עַ מִשְׁפָּֽט

“to hear justice”

By **to hear justice**, God means “to understand legal cases and make right decisions when judging them.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to understand justice] or [to know how to administer justice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:12 (#1)

הִנֵּ֥ה

“behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:12 (#3)

נָתַ֥תִּי לְךָ֖

“I have given to you”

God is using the past tense **I have given** to describe something that is going to happen in the future. He is doing that in order to show that the event will certainly happen. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [I will give you]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 3:12 (#6)

לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents being before a person in time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before you]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:12 (#2)

כִּדְבָרֶ֑יךָ

“according to your word”

Here, **word** represents what God said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what you have said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:12 (#4)

לֵ֣ב חָכָ֤ם וְנָבוֹן֙

“a wise and discerning heart”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s thoughts. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a wise and discerning mind]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:12 (#5)

חָכָ֣ם וְנָבוֹן

“wise and discerning”

The terms **wise** and **discerning** mean similar things. God is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [very discerning]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 3:12 (#7)

לֹא־יָקֻ֥ם כָּמ֖וֹךָ

“and one like you will not arise”

Here God is using the term **arise** to mean “come to be,” as if a person who came into existence stood up from the ground. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one like you will not live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:13 (#1)

נָתַ֥תִּי לָ֛ךְ

“I have given to you”

See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [I will give to you]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 3:13 (#2)

כָּל־יָמֶֽיךָ

“all of your days”

God is using the term **days** to mean a specific time, specifically Solomon’s lifetime, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout your lifetime]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:14 (#1)

וְאִ֣ם ׀ תֵּלֵ֣ךְ בִּדְרָכַ֗י לִשְׁמֹ֤ר חֻקַּי֙ וּמִצְוֹתַ֔י

“And if you walk in my ways to keep my statutes and my commandments”

If the connection between the first and second phrases is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word other than **to** in order to show how the second phrase relates to the first one. Alternate translation: [And if you walk in my ways by keeping my statutes and my commandments]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 3:14 (#3)

אֶת־יָמֶ֖יךָ

“your days”

Here, **days** represents a period of time, specifically Solomon’s lifetime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your life]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:14 (#2)

חֻקַּי֙ וּמִצְוֹתַ֔י

“my statutes and my commandments”

The terms **statutes** and **commandments** mean similar things. God is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [all of my laws]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 3:15 (#1)

וַיִּקַ֥ץ שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה וְהִנֵּ֣ה חֲלֽוֹם

“And Solomon awoke, and behold, {it had been} a dream”

The author is beginning to describe what happened at the end of this story as a result of the events within the story itself. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the conclusion of a story.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 3:15 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being “in front of” the sacred tent where the **Box** of Yahweh was. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:16 (#1)

תְּבֹאנָה שְׁתַּיִם נָשִׁים זֹנוֹת אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“two women, prostitutes, came to the king”

The author is introducing these women as new participants in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [a certain two women, who were prostitutes, came to the king]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 3:16 (#2)

תְּבֹאנָה & אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“came to the king”

The implication is that these women came to the king seeking justice and asking him to make a decision about their dispute. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [came to the king for justice] or [came to the king to ask him to settle a dispute]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:16 (#3)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

Here, **to his face** represents being in front of the king. That was where people would stand who wanted the king to settle a dispute for them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:17 (#1)

אֲנִי֙ וְהָאִשָּׁה הַזֹּאת֙ יֹשְׁבֹ֣ת בְּבַ֔יִת אֶחָ֖ד וָאֵלֵ֥ד עִמָּ֖הּ בַּבָּֽיִת

“I and this woman are dwelling in one house, and I gave birth with her in the house”

The first woman is providing background information to help King Solomon understand all of the details that she describes next in the story. The crucial point is that there are no other witnesses to what happened. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 3:17 (#2)

אֲנִי֙ וְהָאִשָּׁה הַזֹּאת֙

“I and this woman”

In some languages, people name others before they name themselves. It may be more natural in your language to have the woman who is speaking do that here. Alternate translation: [this woman and I]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 3:18 (#2)

אֵין־זָ֣ר אִתָּ֔נוּ בַּבַּ֖יִת זוּלָתִ֣י שְׁתֵּ֑ינוּ בַּבָּֽיִת

“no stranger {was} with us in the house, only we two {were} in the house”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [no one but the two of us was in the house]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 3:18 (#3)

אֵין־זָ֣ר

“no stranger”

The woman does not mean that no one who was a **stranger**, a person unknown to the two of them, was present. She is using the term “stranger” to mean “anyone else.” You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [no other person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:18 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי֮ לְלִדְתִּ֒י

“on the third day of my giving birth”

In this culture, the current day was considered the first day, the next day was considered the second day, and the day after that was considered **the third day**. In your translation, describe these days as your language and culture naturally would. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [two days after I gave birth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:19 (#1)

וַיָּ֣מָת בֶּן־הָאִשָּׁ֣ה הַזֹּאת֮ לָ֣יְלָה֒ אֲשֶׁ֣ר שָׁכְבָ֔ה עָלָֽיו

“And the son of this woman died {at} night, because she lay on him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because she lay on him, the son of this woman died at night]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:20 (#1)

וַאֲמָתְךָ֖ יְשֵׁנָ֑ה

“and your female servant was asleep”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [while your female servant was sleeping]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 3:21 (#1)

וְאֶתְבּוֹנֵ֣ן אֵלָ֔יו בַּבֹּ֖קֶר

“But I looked carefully upon him in the morning”

In this second instance, the woman is using the phrase **in the morning** to mean “after it had gotten lighter.” The implication is that she could then see more clearly. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But I looked carefully upon him after it had gotten light and I could see more clearly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:21 (#2)

בְּנִ֖י אֲשֶׁ֥ר יָלָ֖דְתִּי

“my son whom I had borne”

It might seem that the expression **my son whom I had borne** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [my own son] or [the son I had borne]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 3:22 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:23 (#1)

זֹ֣את אֹמֶ֗רֶת זֶ֤ה־בְּנִי֙ הַחַ֔י וּבִנֵּ֖ךְ הַמֵּ֑ת וְזֹ֣את אֹמֶ֔רֶת לֹ֥א כִ֖י בִּנֵּ֣ךְ הַמֵּ֔ת וּבְנִ֥י הֶחָ֖י

“This one says, ‘This {is} my son, the living one, and your son {is} the one having died,’ but that one says, ‘No, but your son {is} the one having died, and my son {is} the living one”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [This one says that her son is the living one and the other woman’s son is the one who died, but that one says that, on the contrary, the other woman’s son is the one who died and her own son is the living one]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 3:24 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

Here, **the face of the king** represents the presence of the king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into the presence of the king] or [to the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 3:24 (#1)

קְח֥וּ

“Get”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Get** is plural because Solomon is addressing his servants as a group. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 3:25 (#3)

אֶת־הַחַ֖יִּ֑

“half”

A **half** means one part out of two equal parts. Alternate translation: [one of the two pieces]

See: Fractions

1 Kings 3:25 (#4)

לְאַחַת & לְאֶחָת

“to one & to the other”

King Solomon is using the adjectives **one** and **other** as nouns to mean certain people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [to one of these women ... to the other woman]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 3:25 (#1)

גִּזְרוּ & וּתְנוּ

“Divide & and give”

The implied “you” in the imperatives **Divide** and **give** is plural because Solomon is addressing his servants as a group. So use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 3:25 (#2)

לִשְׁנָיִם

“in two”

The king is using the adjective **two** as a noun to mean pieces into which the baby would be divided. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [into two pieces]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 3:26 (#6)

תְּנוּ־לָהּ֩ אֶת־הַיָּלְדָ֨ הַחַ֜י וְהָמֵ֣ת אַל־תְּמִיתֻ֗הוּ

“give the living child to her, but killing, you must not kill him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about not killing the child, which follows directly from Solomon’s instructions, before the instruction to give him to the other woman, which is new information. Alternate translation: [killing, you must not kill him, but give the living child to her]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 3:26 (#7)

וְהָמֵ֣ת אַל־תְּמִיתֻ֗הוּ

“but killing, you must not kill him”

The woman is repeating forms of the verb “kill” in order to intensify her expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you must certainly not kill him]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 3:26 (#10)

גְּזֹ֖רוּ

“Divide”

The word **Divide** here is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. Alternate translation: [Go ahead and divide]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 3:26 (#3)

נִכְמְרוּ֙ רַחֲמֶ֣יהָ עַל־בְּנָ֔הּ

“her compassions for her son were kindled”

The word **compassions** appears in the plural form here. The plural form suggests strong and intense feelings of love and concern that the woman had for her baby. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use singular forms and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [her compassion for her son was greatly kindled] or [his decision greatly kindled her compassion for her son]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Kings 3:26 (#8)

וְזֹ֣את אֹמֶ֔רֶת

“But this one was saying”

The word that the ULT translates as **But** indicates that the second woman **was saying** that the servants should divide the child at the same time as when the first woman was saying not to kill the child. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [At the same time, this one was saying]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Kings 3:26 (#1)

וַתֹּאמֶר הָאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר־בְּנָהּ הַחַי אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ כִּי־נִכְמְרוּ רַחֲמֶיהָ עַל־בְּנָהּ

“And the woman whose son {was} the living one spoke to the king, for her compassions for her son were kindled”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because her compassions for her son were kindled, the woman whose son was the living one spoke to the king]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:26 (#2)

נִכְמְרוּ רַחֲמֶיהָ עַל־בְּנָהּ

“her compassions for her son were kindled”

The expression **her compassions for her son were kindled** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his decision kindled her compassions for her son]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 3:26 (#4)

נִכְמְרוּ רַחֲמֶיהָ עַל־בְּנָהּ

“her compassions for her son were kindled”

The author is speaking of **compassions** being **kindled** as if they were a fire that could be lit. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she felt great compassion for her son]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:26 (#5)

בִּבְיִ אֲדֹנִי

“Please, my lord”

The woman is making an exclamation that expresses a strong feeling, fear for the life and safety of her child. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what the woman was feeling, or you could say what made her afraid. Alternate translation: [Oh, no, my lord!] or [Stop, my lord!]

See: Exclamations

1 Kings 3:26 (#9)

גְּזָרוּ

“Divide”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Divide** is plural because the woman is addressing a group of Solomon’s servants. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 3:26 (#11)

גְּזָרוּ

“Divide”

The second woman is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Divide him between us] or [Go ahead and divide him between us]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 3:27 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“and said”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:28.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 3:27 (#2)

תְּנוּ־לָהּ אֶת־הַיֶּלֶד הַחַי וְהָמֵת לֹא תְמִיתֻהוּ

“Give the living child to her, and killing, you shall not kill him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about not killing the baby before the information about giving the baby to the woman. See what you decided to do with the order of this information in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Killing, you shall not kill the living child, but give him to her]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 3:27 (#3)

תְּנוּ

“Give”

The implied "you" in the imperative **Give** is plural because Solomon is addressing his servants as a group. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

1 Kings 3:27 (#4)

לָהּ

"to her"

The implication is that King Solomon ordered the baby to be given to the woman who wanted the baby to live rather than be killed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the woman who pleaded for his life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 3:28 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"And all of Israel heard"

The author is saying **all of Israel** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And people throughout Israel heard]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 3:28 (#3)

וַיִּרְאוּ מִפְּנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ כִּי־רָאוּ כִּי־חָכְמַת אֱלֹהִים בְּקִרְבּוֹ לַעֲשׂוֹת מִשְׁפָּט

"and they were afraid from the face of the king, because they saw that the wisdom of God was within him to do justice"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and because they saw that the wisdom of God was within him to do justice, they were afraid from the face of the king]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 3:28 (#6)

חָכְמַת אֱלֹהִים בְּקִרְבּוֹ

"the wisdom of God was within him"

The author is speaking of **wisdom** as if it were an object that could be inside a person. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God had given him great wisdom]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 3:28 (#2)

אֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּט אֲשֶׁר שָׁפַט הַמֶּלֶךְ

"the judgment that the king had judged"

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [how the king had judged this case]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 3:28 (#4)

מִפְּנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

"from the face of the king"

Here, **from the face of** is a common expression of the culture that means "because of" or "on account of." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on account of the king]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 3:28 (#7)

חָכְמַת אֱלֹהִים בְּקִרְבּוֹ

"the wisdom of God was within him"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God had made him very wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 3:28 (#5)

רָאוּ

"they saw"

Here, **saw** is speaking of the people recognizing or understanding Solomon's wisdom as if they had physically seen it with their eyes. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they recognized]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. The important officials in Solomon's government (4:1–19)
2. The extent and prosperity of Solomon's kingdom (4:20–28)
3. Solomon's great wisdom (4:29–34)

There are lists of Solomon's officials and deputies in 4:2–6 and 4:7–19. You may wish to present these lists in the way that lists would appear in your culture. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar lists in 2 Samuel 3:2–5, 2 Samuel 5:13–16, 2 Samuel 8:15–18, and 2 Samuel 20:23–26. For example, for the first list, you might put the first part of verse 2 on a separate line as a summary of Solomon's government. You might then put the name of each official on a separate line, like this:

Now King Solomon was king over all of Israel. And these {were} the officials who {were} to him. Azariah, the son of Zadok, was the priest. Elihoreph and Ahijah, the sons of Shisha, were scribes. Jehoshaphat, the son of Ahilud, was the recorder. And Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, was over the army. And Zadok and Abiathar were priests. And Azariah, the son of Nathan, {was} over the deputies. And Zabud, the son of Nathan, {was} a priest, a friend of the king. And Ahishar was over the house. And Adoniram, the son of Abda, was over the forced labor.

For the second list, you might put verse 7 and the first part of verse 8 on a separate line as an introduction to this list of district governors. You might then put the name of each official and the description of his district on a separate line, like this:

Now to Solomon {were} 12 deputies over all of Israel, and they sustained the king and his house. A month in the year, it was upon one to sustain. And these {were} their names. Ben Hur, in the hill country of Ephraim. Ben Deker, in Makaz and in Shaalbim and Beth Shemesh and Elon Beth Hanan. Ben Hesed, in Arubboth (to him {was} Sokoh and all of the land of Hepher). Ben Abinadab, all of Naphoth Dor. (Taphath, the daughter of Solomon, was to him for a wife.) Baana, the son of Ahilud, in Taanach and Megiddo and all of Beth Shan that {is} beside Zarethan from below Jezreel, from Beth Shan to Abel Meholah, as far as from the other side of Jokmeam. Ben Geber, in Ramoth Gilead (to him {were} the villages of Jair, the son of Manasseh, that {were} in Gilead; to him {was} the region of Argob, which {was} in Bashan, 60 great cities with a wall and a bar of bronze). Ahinadab, the son of Iddo, in Mahanaim. Ahimaaz, in Naphtali. (He also took Basemath, the daughter of Solomon, for a wife.) Baana, the son of Hushai, in Asher and Bealoth. Jehoshaphat, the son of Paruah, in Issachar. Shimei, the son of Ela, in Benjamin. Geber, the son of Uri, in the land of Gilead, the land of Sihon, the king of the Amorite, and Og, the king of Bashan, and {there was} one deputy who {was} in the land.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The structure of Solomon's administration
This chapter provides a detailed list of Solomon's top officials and administrators. This shows how Solomon organized his kingdom to manage its vast resources. The list includes a diverse group of officials, such as priests, scribes, army commanders, and twelve "deputies" or district governors. This administrative structure was essential for governing the expanding kingdom, collecting taxes, and ensuring that all parts of Israel contributed to the central government. Significantly, Solomon created twelve administrative districts of roughly equal population. These did not coincide with the traditional tribal boundaries. This would have encouraged Israelites to see themselves as citizens of the larger kingdom rather than as members of separate tribes.

Supplying Solomon's royal court
In this chapter, the author describes the extensive provisions that were required each day for Solomon's royal court. The list of foods, including large quantities of flour, grain, and various animals, underscores the prosperity of the kingdom under Solomon's reign. But it also illustrates the burden that supporting his royal court placed on the people. This became a source of contention when Solomon's son Rehoboam became king, and it was ultimately the cause for most of the Israelite tribes rebelling against him, as chapter 12 describes.

1 Kings 4:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה מֶ֖לֶךְ עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

"Now King Solomon was king over all of Israel"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 4:4 (#1)

וּבְנָיָ֖הוּ בֶּן־יְהוֹיָדָ֑ע עַל־הַצָּבָ֣א

“And Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, was over the army”

The author is speaking as if Benaiah had actually been **over** or physically above the army. He means that Benaiah was in charge of the army as its commander. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning of this expression plainly, here and in the next two verses. Alternate translation: [And Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, was in charge of the army] or [And Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada, commanded the army]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 4:4 (#2)

וְצָדוֹק וְאֶבְיָתָר כֹּהֲנִים

“And Zadok and Abiathar were priests”

Since the author describes in 2:26–27 how Solomon banished Abiathar, and since he states in 4:2 that Zadok’s son Azariah had become **the priest** (that is, the high priest) by this time, he does not mean that Zadok and Abiathar served together as high priests during Solomon’s reign as they did during David’s reign, as 2 Samuel 8:16 and 2 Samuel 20:25 describe. Instead, the author is probably indicating that Zadok and Abiathar, as former high priests, retained the honorary title of **priests**. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:5 (#1)

כֹּהֵן

“was} a priest”

In this context, the term **priest** does not refer to someone who offers sacrifices but to a high-ranking royal official. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 8:18 and 2 Samuel 20:26. Alternate translation: [a chief official]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:5 (#2)

רֵעֶה הַמֶּלֶךְ

“a friend of the king”

The similar description of Hushai in 2 Samuel 15:37 as “the friend of David” suggests that the word **friend** in this context means “counselor.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a counselor to the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:6 (#2)

הַמַּס

“the forced labor”

The term **forced labor** describes the group of men whom Solomon required to work for him. The author provides a fuller description of this system in 5:13–18. If your readers would not be familiar with the term **forced labor**, you could use the name of a similar system that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the levy] or [the compulsory labor force]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 4:6 (#1)

הַבָּיִת

“the house”

Here, **house** represents the palace staff and administration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the palace staff]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:7 (#1)

וְאֶת־בֵּיתוֹ

“and his house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:6. Alternate translation: [and his palace officials and staff]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:7 (#2)

יִהְיֶה עַל־אחד

“was upon one”

The author is using the phrase **was upon one** as a common expression of his culture to mean “it was the responsibility of each one.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it was the responsibility of each one]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 4:8 (#1)

בֶּן־חוּר בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם

“Ben Hur, in the hill country of Ephraim”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language, here and throughout this list. Alternate translation: [Ben Hur was the governor in the hill country of Ephraim]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 4:13 (#1)

חוֹמָה וּבְרִיחַ נְחֹשֶׁת

“with} a wall and a bar of bronze”

In this verse, the words **wall** and **bar** are singular in form, but they refer to all the walls and bars of these cities as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms. Alternate translation: [with walls and bars of bronze]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 4:13 (#2)

וּבְרִיחַ נְחֹשֶׁת

“and a bar of bronze”

When the author notes that the gates of these cities each had a **bar of bronze**, he is indicating that these bronze bars made the gates very difficult to break through. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and gates that the people could make very secure, since they had bronze bars]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:15 (#1)

גַּם־הוּא לָקַח אֶת־בָּשְׂמַת בַּת־שְׁלֹמֹה לְאִשָּׁה

“He also took Basemath, the daughter of Solomon, for a wife”

The author is not using the term **also** to mean that Ahimaaz married Basemath in addition to being a deputy. He means that just as Ben Abinadab married a daughter of Solomon, so Ahimaaz married a daughter of Solomon. Express this meaning in a way that would be clear in your language. It may not be necessary to represent the term “also” in your translation. Alternate translation: [Like Ben Abinadab, Ahimaaz married a daughter of Solomon, Basemath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:19 (#1)

הָאֱמֹרִי

“the Amorite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Amorite**. He means Amorites in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Amorites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 4:20 (#1)

יְהוּדָה וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“Judah and Israel”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to 1 Kings of how the author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its people. That is what the author is doing here. Alternate translation: [the people of Judah and Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:20 (#2)

כַּחוֹל אֲשֶׁר־עַל־הַיָּם לָרֹב

“like the sand that {is} at the sea for abundance”

The author says **like the sand that is at the sea for abundance** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [more numerous than anyone could count]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 4:20 (#3)

אֹכְלִים וְשֹׁתִים וּשְׂמֵחִים

“eating and drinking and rejoicing”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [They were eating and drinking and rejoicing]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 4:21 (#2)

מַגִּשִׁים מִנְחָה

“bringing tribute”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [They were bringing tribute]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 4:21 (#1)

הַנָּהָרׇ

“the River”

The author assumes that readers will know that **the River** refers to the Euphrates River. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the Euphrates River]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:22 (#3)

שְׁלֹשִׁים כֹּרׇ סֹלֶת וְשִׁשִּׁים כֹּכָר קָמַח

“30 cors of fine flour and 60 cors of flour”

Each of these **cors** was equivalent to 220 liters or nearly 60 gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Kings 4:22 (#2)

וַיְהִי לֶחֶם־שְׁלֹמֹה

“And the bread of Solomon & was”

Here the author is using **Solomon** to represent the king himself and all of the people whom he fed in his palace. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the food that was required for Solomon and his royal household]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:22 (#1)

וַיְהִי לֶחֶם־שְׁלֹמֹה

“And the bread of Solomon & was”

The author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the food of Solomon]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 4:23 (#1)

וּבַרְבֵּרִים אֲבוּסִים

“and fattened fowl”

The expression **fattened fowl** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and fowl that people had fattened]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 4:24 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [This was because] or [The reason was that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 4:24 (#2)

עֵבֶר הַנָּהָר

“beyond the River”

The author assumes that readers will know that, in this context, **beyond the River** refers to the territory on the Israelite side of the Euphrates River, that is, west of that river. You could indicate that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on this side of the Euphrates River] or [west of the Euphrates River]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 4:24 (#4)

מַלְכֵי

“the kings of”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **kings** who ruled over the territory that was **beyond the river**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the kings whose territory was]

See: Possession

1 Kings 4:24 (#5)

וְשָׁלוֹם הָיָה לוֹ

“And peace was to him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And conditions were peaceful for him]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 4:24 (#3)

בְּכָל

“over all of”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [He ruled over all of]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 4:24 (#6)

וְשָׁלֹ֥ום הָיָ֖ה לֹ֑ו מִכָּל־עֵ֥בְרָ֛יו מִסָּבִֽיב

“And peace was to him from all of his sides, from all around”

The phrases **from all his sides** and **from all around** mean similar things. The author is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And peace completely surrounded him] or [And his kingdom was completely surrounded by peaceful conditions]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 4:25 (#1)

וַיֵּשֶׁב֙ יְהוּדָ֣ה וְיִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“And Judah and Israel dwelled”

See how you translated the same expression in 4:20. Alternate translation: [And the people of Judah and Israel dwelled]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:25 (#2)

לָבֶ֖טַח

“in safety”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **safety**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [safely]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 4:25 (#3)

אִ֣ישׁ

“a man”

The author is not referring to a specific **man**. He means people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [each person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 4:25 (#4)

תַּ֤חַת גַּפְנֹו֙ וְתַ֣חַת תְּאֵנָתֹ֔ו

“under his vine and under his fig tree”

The author is using two plants that produce fruit, the grape **vine** and the **fig tree**, to represent agricultural prosperity in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [enjoying agricultural abundance]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 4:25 (#5)

מִדָּ֖ן וְעַד־בְּאֵ֣ר שָׁ֑בַע

“from Dan and to Beersheba”

The author is referring to all of Israel by naming two extremes, **Dan** (in the far north) and **Beersheba** (in the far south). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout the territory of Israel]

See: Merism

1 Kings 4:25 (#6)

כֹּ֖ל יְמֵ֥י שְׁלֹמֹֽה

“all of the days of Solomon”

Here, **days** represents a period of time, specifically Solomon’s lifetime, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout the lifetime of Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:26 (#2)

אַרְבָּעִ֥ים אָֽלֶף

“40,000”

The traditional Hebrew text reads **40,000**. The ULT follows that reading. The parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 9:25 and some Greek manuscripts of the Old Testament read "4,000." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 4:26 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ לִשְׁלֹמֹ֔ה אַרְבָּעִ֥ים אֶ֖לֶף אֲרֻוֹ֣ת סוּסִ֑ים לְמֶרְכָּבֹ֔ו וּשְׁנֵ֥ים־עָשָׂ֖ר אֶ֥לֶף פָּרָשִֽׁים

"And 40,000 stalls of horses were to Solomon for his chariotry, and 12,000 horsemen"

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **12,000 horsemen** with the information about **40,000 stalls of horses**. Alternate translation: [And 40,000 stalls of horses and 12,000 horsemen were to Solomon for his chariotry]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 4:27 (#1)

וְאֵ֣ת כָּל־הַקְּרֵ֗ב אֶל־שֻׁלְחַ֛ן הַמֶּ֥לֶךְ־שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

"and all of the {ones} near to the table of King Solomon"

Here, being **near** Solomon's **table** represents eating meals with him in his palace. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all of the people whom King Solomon entertained for meals]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:27 (#3)

אִ֣ישׁ חָדְשׁ֑וֹ

"a man his month"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [each man providing food during his assigned month]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 4:27 (#2)

הַקְּרֵֽב

"the {ones} near"

The author is using the adjective **near** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. The ULT indicates that by adding the word **ones**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the ones who came near to] or [the ones who sat at]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 4:27 (#4)

לֹ֥א יַעְדִּ֖ירוּ דָּבָֽר

"They did not let a thing lack"

The author is emphasizing a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with a mild expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in a strong way. Alternate translation: [They provided everything that was needed] or [They made sure everything was fully supplied]

See: Litotes

1 Kings 4:28 (#1)

וְלָרֶ֖כֶשׁ

"and for the steed"

The author is not referring to a specific **steed**. He means steeds in general, that is, fast horses that messengers could ride to communicate news and decrees quickly throughout the kingdom. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and for the steeds]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 4:28 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִהְיֶה־שָּׁ֖ם

"where it should be there"

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where it should be]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 4:28 (#3)

כְּמִשְׁפָּטֹ֑ו

"according to his ordinance"

The author is using the possessive form in **his ordinance** to mean the regulation that applied to each official. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [according to what the king had ordered him to do]

See: Possession

1 Kings 4:29 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּן֩ אֱלֹהִ֨ים חָכְמָ֜ה לִשְׁלֹמֹ֗ה וּתְבוּנָ֤ה הַרְבֵּה֙ מְאֹ֔ד

“And God gave wisdom to Solomon and very much understanding”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **understanding**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [And God made Solomon wise and able to understand very much]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 4:29 (#2)

וְרֹ֣חַב לֵבָ֔ב כַּחֹ֖ול אֲשֶׁ֣ר עַל־שְׂפַ֣ת הַיָּֽם

“and breadth of heart like the sand that {is} on the shore of the sea”

The point of this comparison is that just as there are very many grains of **sand that is on the shore of the sea**, so God gave Solomon **breadth of heart** (that is, capacity of mind) to learn and remember very many things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and capacity to know very many things, just as there are very main grains of sand on the shore of the sea]

See: Simile

1 Kings 4:29 (#3)

וְרֹ֣חַב לֵבָ֔ב

“and breadth of heart”

The author is speaking as if Solomon’s **heart** were very wide or had great **breadth**. In this context, the heart represents the mind, as able to obtain knowledge. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and capacity of mind for great knowledge]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 4:30 (#2)

מִצְרָ֑יִם

“Egypt”

Here, **Egypt** represents the people of Egypt and, in this context, probably the especially wise individuals among them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Egyptian people] or [the greatest Egyptian sages]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:30 (#1)

כָּל־בְּנֵ֥י־קֶ֖דֶם

“all of the sons of the east”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how, in certain contexts, biblical authors and characters use the expression **sons of** to indicate that people had the characteristic of something. In this case, the people in view had the characteristic of belonging to desert tribes that lived to the **east** of the land of Israel. While the people of those tribes were generally respected for their wisdom, the author probably is referring to specific individuals among them who were especially renowned as wise. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the tribes that lived to the east of Israel] or [any of the greatest Arabian sages]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 4:31 (#3)

וַיְהִי־שְׁמֹ֖ו בְּכָל

“And his name was in all of”

Here, **name** represents Solomon’s reputation or fame. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And his reputation extended to]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 4:31 (#2)

מֵאֵיתָ֥ן

“than Ethan”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [he was even wiser than Ethan]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 4:31 (#1)

הָאָדָם

“man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 4:33 (#1)

הָעֵצִים מִן־הָאֶרֶז אֲשֶׁר בַּלְּבָנוֹן וְעַד הָאֵזוֹב אֲשֶׁר יֹצֵא בַּקִּיר

“trees, from the cedar that {is} in Lebanon and to the hyssop that comes out in the wall”

The author is referring to all kinds of trees by naming two extremes, the very large **cedar that is in Lebanon** and the very small **hyssop that comes out in the wall**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [trees of all sizes] or [trees of all kinds]

See: Merism

1 Kings 4:33 (#2)

עַל־הַבְּהֵמָה וְעַל־הָעוֹף וְעַל־הָרֶמֶשׂ וְעַל־הַדָּגִים

“about the beast and about the bird and about the creeping thing and about the fish”

The author is not referring to a specific **beast**, **bird**, **creeping thing**, or **fish**. He means such creatures in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [about beasts and about birds and about creeping things and about fish]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 4:33 (#3)

עַל־הַבְּהֵמָה וְעַל־הָעוֹף וְעַל־הָרֶמֶשׂ וְעַל־הַדָּגִים

“about the beast and about the bird and about the creeping thing and about the fish”

In some languages, it may not be natural or necessary to repeat the word “about” before each term in this list. If that is the case for your language, you can leave out this word after its first occurrence. Alternate translation: [about beasts and birds and creeping things and fish]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 4:34 (#2)

מִכָּל־הָעַמִּים & כָּל־מַלְכֵי

“from all of the peoples & with all of the kings of”

The author says **from all of the peoples** and **from with all the kings of the earth** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [from many nations and from many kings]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 4:34 (#1)

וַיָּבֹאוּ

“And they came”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people came]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is the beginning of the author’s description of how Solomon built a temple for Yahweh. It relates how Solomon made an agreement with King Hiram of Tyre to supply him with cedar and cypress logs and how Solomon made thousands of men work to cut and transport blocks of stone for the temple.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Ancient political and trade alliances

This chapter describes a significant alliance that King Solomon made with King Hiram of Tyre. This was a crucial political and economic agreement. Tyre was a powerful Phoenician city-state known for its maritime trade and skilled craftsmen. Israel, by contrast, had vast resources such as timber, but it lacked the expertise to harvest and transport them efficiently. The alliance was mutually beneficial. Solomon provided food to Hiram’s people, who could not grow much food for themselves, and Hiram provided the master craftsmen and the beautiful cedar wood needed for the temple. This alliance highlights how ancient kingdoms relied on such strategic partnerships to secure resources and manpower for large-scale projects.

The use of forced labor
The chapter mentions Solomon's use of forced labor to build the temple and other structures. This workforce was made up of two main groups, (1) laborers from a large number of non-Israelite people living in the land and (2) a smaller, rotating group of Israelite supervisors. (The author describes this system in more detail in 9:15–23.) While, for the Israelites, this labor was a form of national service and not permanent slavery, it still put a heavy demand on the populace. This practice, common in ancient empires for large construction projects, shows the immense power of the king but also the social cost of such grand undertakings. This led to discontent that would later help cause the division of the kingdom.

1 Kings 5:1 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

"all of the days"

The author is using the term **days** to mean time, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time] or [continually]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 5:1 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח חִירָם מֶלֶךְ־צֹר אֶת־עֲבָדָיו אֶל־שְׁלֹמֹה כִּי שָׁמַע כִּי אֹתָהוּ מָשְׁחוּ לְמֶלֶךְ תַּחַת אָבִיהוּ כִּי אֹהֵב הָיָה חִירָם לְדָוִד כָּל־הַיָּמִים

"And Hiram, king of Tyre, sent his servants to Solomon when he heard that they had anointed him as king in place of his father, for Hiram was a friend to David all of the days"

The author is reintroducing **Hiram** as a participant in the story. He first appeared in 2 Samuel 5:11. If your language has its own way of reintroducing participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [And Hiram, king of Tyre, who had been a friend to David all of the days, sent his servants to Solomon when he heard that they had anointed him as king in place of his father]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 5:1 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁלַח חִירָם מֶלֶךְ־צֹר אֶת־עֲבָדָיו אֶל־שְׁלֹמֹה כִּי שָׁמַע כִּי אֹתָהוּ מָשְׁחוּ לְמֶלֶךְ תַּחַת אָבִיהוּ

"And Hiram, king of Tyre, sent his servants to Solomon when he heard that they had anointed him as king in place of his father"

The author is describing one event, Hiram sending his servants to Solomon, before describing another event that preceded it, the Israelites anointing Solomon as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [And when Hiram, king of Tyre, heard that they had anointed Solomon as king in place of his father, he sent his servants to him]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 5:1 (#3)

אֹתָהוּ מָשְׁחוּ

"they had anointed him"

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he had been anointed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:2 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח שְׁלֹמֹה

"And Solomon sent"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language, here and in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And Solomon sent messengers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 5:2 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

"saying"

Make sure that it is clear in your translation that this is not what Solomon said to his own messengers. It is what he told them to say to Hiram on his behalf. Alternate translation: [to say to him on his behalf]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 5:3 (#3)

בַּבַּיִת

"a house"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [a temple]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 5:3 (#6)

הַמִּלְחָמָה אֲשֶׁשֶׁר סָבְבֻהוּ

“the warfare {with} which they surrounded him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **warfare**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the wars they fought against him on all sides]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 5:3 (#1)

אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ

“You, you know”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:5. Alternate translation: [You know quite well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:3 (#2)

אֶת־דָּוִד אָבִי כִּי לֹא יָכֹל

“David my father, that he was not able”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [that David my father was not able]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 5:3 (#4)

לְשֵׁם יְהוָה

“for the name of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [for the worship of Yahweh] or [for the reputation of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 5:3 (#5)

מִפְּנֵי

“from the face of”

Here, **from the face of** is a common expression of the culture that means “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on account of]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 5:3 (#9)

רגלו

“his foot”

In this verse, the word **foot** is singular in form, but it refers to both of David’s feet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “foot.” Alternate translation: [his feet]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 5:3 (#7)

סְבָבֻהוּ

“they surrounded him”

The pronoun **they** refers to David’s enemies. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [his enemies surrounded him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:3 (#8)

עַד תֵּת־יְהוָה אֹתָם תַּחַת כַּפּוֹת רגלו

“until Yahweh put them under the soles of his foot”

Solomon is speaking as if David had performed a symbolic action against his enemies. In this culture, victorious soldiers would make defeated enemies lie face down on the ground, and they would then step on their necks to demonstrate their complete triumph (as in Joshua 10:24, for example). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [until Yahweh enabled him to defeat them all completely]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 5:4 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 5:5 (#5)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר אֶתֵּתֶן תַּחְתֶּיךָ עַל־כִּסְאֶךָ

“whom I will put in your place on your throne”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [whom I will make succeed you as king] or [whom I will make rule the Israelites after you]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 5:5 (#1)

וְהִנֵּנִי אֹמֵר

“And behold me, saying”

Solomon is using a common expression of his culture, **behold me**, to indicate that he is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 12:11. Alternate translation: [And I am currently intending]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 5:5 (#4)

לֵאמֹר בִּנְךָ אֲשֶׁר אֶתֵּן תַּחְתֶּיךָ עַל־כִּסְאֶךָ הוּא־יִבְנֶה הַבַּיִת לִשְׁמִי

“saying, ‘Your son, whom I will put in your place on your throne, he, he will build the house for my name”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him that his son, whom he would put in David’s place on his throne, would build the house for his name]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 5:5 (#2)

וְהִנֵּנִי אֹמֵר

“And behold me, saying”

In this context, the term **saying** means “intending.” The idea is that Solomon has been **saying** to himself that he will do this. Alternate translation: [And behold me, intending]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 5:5 (#6)

הוּא־יִבְנֶה

“he, he will build”

See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [he is the one who will build]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:5 (#3)

לְשֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה

“for the name of Yahweh my”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:3. Alternate translation: [for the worship of Yahweh] or [for the reputation of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 5:6 (#4)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 5:6 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 5:6 (#2)

צַוֵּה

“command”

The word translated as **command** is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please command]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 5:6 (#3)

וְיִכְרְתוּ

“and may they cut”

Here Solomon is using the pronoun **they** to refer to Hiram’s workers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and may your workers cut]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:6 (#5)

אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ

“you, you know”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:5. Alternate translation: [You know quite well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:7 (#2)

בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה

“Blessed {be} Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:48. Alternate translation: [May people bless Yahweh] or [May people praise Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 5:7 (#3)

עַל

“over”

Here, Hiram is speaking of Solomon as if he were positioned **over** the people. He is indicating Solomon’s role as their ruler. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to rule]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 5:7 (#1)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“the words of Solomon”

Here, **words** represents what Solomon said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Solomon had sent the messengers to tell him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 5:8 (#4)

אֶת־כָּל־חֶפְצְךָ

“all of your desire”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [everything you want] or [everything that you have asked]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 5:8 (#1)

שָׁמַעְתִּי אֵת אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַחְתָּ אֵלָי

“I have heard what you sent to me”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of this use of the term “heard.” Alternate translation: [I agree to do what you sent messengers to ask me to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 5:8 (#3)

אֲנִי אֶעֱשֶׂה

“I, I will do”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:26. Alternate translation: [I agree to command my servants to do]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 5:8 (#2)

אֲנִי אֶעֱשֶׂה

“I, I will do”

Hiram is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will do** already includes this meaning. He is doing that because he is making an agreement with Solomon. See how you translated the similar expression “I, I will speak” in 2:18. Alternate translation: [I agree to do]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:9 (#2)

וַאֲנִי אֲשִׁימֵם דֹּבְרוֹת

“and I, I will set rafts”

See how you translated the similar expression “I, I will do” in 5:8. Alternate translation: [and for my part, I will set rafts]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:9 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר־תִּשְׁלַח אֵלָי

“that you send to me”

Hiram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that you send messengers to indicate to me] or [that you designate to me]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 5:9 (#7)

וְאַתָּה תַּעֲשֶׂה אֶת־חֶפְצִי

“And you, you will do my desire”

See how you translated the similar expression "I, I will do all of your desire" in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And I would like you to agree to do what I desire]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:9 (#8)

לָֽתֵת לֶ֣חֶם בֵּיתִ֔י

"by giving the bread of my house"

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:22. Alternate translation: [by providing food for my royal household]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 5:9 (#1)

עֲ֠בָדַי יֹרְד֨וּ

"And my servants will bring down"

Hiram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And my servants will bring down the trees that they cut]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 5:9 (#5)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תִשָּׂ֑א

"And you, you will lift"

See how you translated the similar expression **I, I will set** earlier in this verse. Alternate translation: [And for your part, you will lift]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 5:9 (#6)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תִשָּׂ֑א

"And you, you will lift"

Hiram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And for your part, you will have your servants lift the logs out of the sea and bring them to Jerusalem]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 5:9 (#3)

עַד־הַמָּקֹ֖ום

"to the place"

Hiram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and float them to the place]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 5:10 (#1)

עֲצֵי־אֲרָזִ֖ים וַעֲצֵי־בְרֹושִׁ֑ים כָּל־חֶפְצֹֽו

"trees of cedar and trees of cypress, all of his desire"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as many trees of cedar and trees of cypress as he desired]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 5:11 (#2)

עֶשְׂרִ֣ים אֶ֠לֶף כֹּ֨ר חִטִּ֜ים & וְעֶשְׂרִ֣ים כֹּ֗ר שֶׁ֚מֶן כָּתִ֔ית

"20,000 cors of wheat & and 20 cors of beaten oil"

Each of these **cors** was equivalent to 220 liters or nearly 60 gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Kings 5:11 (#3)

לְבֵיתֹֽו

"for his house"

Here the author is using the term **house** to represent the people who lived and worked in Hiram's royal palace. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for his royal household]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 5:11 (#4)

שָׁנָ֖ה בְּשָׁנָֽה

"year by year"

The author is using **year by year** as a common expression of his culture to mean "every year" or "each year." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from

your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from year to year] or [every year]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 5:11 (#1)

וּשְׁלֹמֹהֹ֗ נָתַ֤ן לְחִירָם֙ עֶשְׂרִ֣ים אֶ֣לֶף כֹּ֣ר חִטִּ֔ים מַכְלַ֖ת לְבֵיתֹ֑ו וְעֶשְׂרִ֥ים כֹּ֛ר שֶׁ֥מֶן כָּתִ֖ית

“And Solomon gave to Hiram 20,000 cors of wheat {as} food for his house and 20 cors of beaten oil”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **oil** together with the information about the **wheat**. Alternate translation: [And Solomon gave to Hiram 20,000 cors of wheat and 20 cors of beaten oil as food for his house]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 5:12 (#2)

וַיְהִ֥י שָׁלֹ֖ם בֵּ֣ין חִירָ֑ם וּבֵ֣ין שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה וַיִּכְרְת֥וּ בְרִ֖ית שְׁנֵיהֶֽם

“And peace was between Hiram and between Solomon, and the two of them cut a covenant”

The author is describing one event, peace being between Hiram and Solomon, before describing another event that preceded it, the two of them making a covenant. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [And Hiram and Solomon cut a covenant, and peace was between the two of them]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 5:12 (#3)

וַיִּכְרְת֥וּ בְרִ֖ית שְׁנֵיהֶֽם

“and the two of them cut a covenant”

The author is using **cut a covenant** as a common expression of his culture to mean “made a covenant.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 11:1. Alternate translation: [and the two of them made a covenant] or [and Hiram and Solomon made a covenant]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 5:12 (#1)

וַיהוָ֣ה נָתַ֤ן חָכְמָה֙ לִשְׁלֹמֹ֔ה כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּר־לֹ֖ו וַיְהִ֣י שָׁלֹ֔ם בֵּ֣ין חִירָ֑ם וּבֵ֣ין שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה וַיִּכְרְת֥וּ בְרִ֖ית שְׁנֵיהֶֽם

“And Yahweh gave wisdom to Solomon, just as he had spoken to him. And peace was between Hiram and between Solomon, and the two of them cut a covenant”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about Yahweh giving wisdom to Solomon last in this verse, since it seems to apply to the description in the following verses of how Solomon administered this project. Alternate translation: [And peace was between Hiram and between Solomon, and the two of them cut a covenant. And Yahweh gave wisdom to Solomon, just as he had spoken to him.]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 5:13 (#3)

יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 5:13 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַל הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה מַ֖ס

“And King Solomon brought up forced labor”

In this context, the author is not saying **brought up** to mean that Solomon made these men travel to a higher elevation, Lebanon, although they did that. Instead, he is using **brought up forced labor** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Solomon forced these men to do this work. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And King Solomon raised a levy] or [And King Solomon called up a work force]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 5:13 (#2)

מַ֖ס

“forced labor”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:6.

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 5:14 (#1)

שְׁנַיִם חֳדָשִׁים בְּבֵיתָוֹ

“two months in his house”

In this verse, the word **house** is singular in form, but it refers to all the workers’ homes as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “house.” Alternate translation: [two months in their houses]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 5:14 (#2)

שְׁנַיִם חֳדָשִׁים בְּבֵיתָוֹ

“two months in his house”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and then they were two months in their houses]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 5:14 (#3)

וַאֲדֹנִירָם עַל־הַמַּס

“And Adoniram was over the forced labor”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:4. Alternate translation: [And Adoniram was in charge of the forced labor]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 5:15 (#1)

וַיְהִיְ לִשְׁלֹמֹה שִׁבְעִים אֶלֶף נֹשֵׂא סַבָּל וּשְׁמֹנִים אֶלֶף חֹצֵב

“And it was to Solomon 70,000, a carrier of a burden, and 80,000, a quarrier”

In this verse, the words **carrier of a burden** and **quarrier** are singular in form, but they refer to all the workers as groups. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of these terms. Alternate translation: [And there were to Solomon 70,000 burden carriers and 80,000 quarriers]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 5:15 (#2)

שִׁבְעִים אֶלֶף נֹשֵׂא סַבָּל וּשְׁמֹנִים אֶלֶף חֹצֵב בָּהָר

“70,000, a carrier of a burden, and 80,000, a quarrier in the hill country”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the quarriers before the information about the carriers, since the quarriers would first dig out the stones and the carriers would then drag them away. Alternate translation: [80,000 quarriers in the hill country and 70,000 burden carriers]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 5:15 (#3)

שִׁבְעִים אֶלֶף נֹשֵׂא סַבָּל

“70,000, a carrier of a burden”

Here the author uses a general expression, **a carrier of a burden**, for someone who would transport goods by picking them up and carrying them. However, the huge blocks of stone that the other workers were cutting for the temple were far too heavy for anyone to carry. Even a large group of men could not have picked them up and carried them. So use a term here in your translation that indicates more generally that these men transported the stone blocks. (They probably did this by mounting the stones on sledges and pulling the sledges over a series of round wooden logs that teams of men would move from the rear to the front in succession.) Alternate translation: [70,000 transporters] or [70,000 haulers of stone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 5:15 (#4)

חֹצֵב

“a quarrier”

A **quarrier** is a person who cuts stone out of rock formations. If your readers would not be familiar with what a quarrier is, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [a stone cutter] or [a person who cut stone]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 5:16 (#1)

לְבַד מִשָּׂרֵי הַנִּצָּבִים לִשְׁלֹמֹהֹ אֲשֶׁר עַל־הַמְּלָאכָה

“apart from the commanders of the deputies of Solomon who {were} over the work”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **commanders** who were **deputies of Solomon**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in

another way. Alternate translation: [apart from the deputies of Solomon who were commanders over the work]

See: Possession

1 Kings 5:17 (#1)

וַיְצַו הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיַּסִּעוּ

"And the king commanded, and they removed"

The author is explaining in more detail what the quarriers did whom he describes in 5:15. You may be able to use a form of a verb in your language that makes clear that the author is not describing something that Solomon **commanded** after he put these 80,000 men to work. Alternate translation: [As the king had commanded, the quarriers removed]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 5:17 (#2)

אֲבָנִים יְקָרוֹת

"valuable stones"

By **valuable stones**, the author means stones that had been carefully chosen and skillfully prepared for use in the temple foundation. He does not necessarily mean that they were precious stones such as marble or porphyry. The surviving portions of Solomon's temple indicate that it was built of limestone blocks. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [high-quality limestone blocks]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 5:17 (#3)

אַבְנֵי גָזִית

"stones of hewing"

The author is using the possessive form to describe **stones** that were characterized by **hewing**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [stones that they cut into shape]

See: Possession

1 Kings 5:18 (#1)

בֹּנֵי שְׁלֹמֹה וּבֹנֵי חִירָם

"the builders of Solomon and the builders of Hiram"

The author is using the term **builders** to refer to all of the men whose labor contributed to the building of the temple. He does not mean that they were all involved in constructing the temple itself. As the context shows, most of them were involved in collecting and transporting the materials. You may wish to use a more general term in your translation. Alternate translation: [Solomon's workers and Hiram's workers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 5:18 (#2)

וְהַגִּבְלִים

"and the Gebalites"

The workers from the city of Gebal were experts in squaring stones for buildings. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the men he brought in from the city of Gebal, who were experts in squaring stones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the author's description of how Solomon built a temple for Yahweh. It describes the design, dimensions, and decorations of the temple.

1. Introductory statement (6:1)
2. Dimensions and features of the temple (6:2–10)
3. Yahweh's encouragement to Solomon (6:11–13)
4. The paneling, decoration, and gilding of the temple (6:14–22, 29–30)
5. The cherubs (6:23–28)
6. The doors (6:31–35)
7. The courtyard (6:36)
8. Concluding statement (6:37–38)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The significance of quiet on the temple building site

The author notes in 6:7 that "hammers or the chisel, any implement of iron, was not heard in the house in its being built." This detail speaks to the sacred nature of the building project. The stones were prepared offsite, and the wood was meticulously carved before being brought to the temple area. This practice ensured that the construction process was peaceful and reverent, without the noise of hammering, chiseling,

or carving. This was a physical manifestation of God's command for a peaceful and pure place of worship, distinguishing the temple from ordinary man-made structures.

The numerical significance of dimensions
The author describes the measurements of the temple in detail. He notes its length of 60 cubits, width of 20 cubits, and height of 30 cubits. All of these numbers are even multiples of ten, and the width and height divide evenly into the length. The author also notes that the inner sanctuary or Holy of Holies was 20 cubits long, wide, and high, so it was a perfect cube. As the notes to 6:31 and 6:33 explain, it appears that the doors of the temple and the inner sanctuary were perfect squares and even divisions (one fifth and one fourth) of the dimensions of the walls in which they were set. These precise and harmonious dimensions were intended to create a sacred space. The author reports them in detail to emphasize that the temple's design was not Solomon's idea but the fulfillment of specific instructions that Yahweh had given to David for a sanctuary appropriate to his perfections and presence.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"cubit"
Throughout this chapter, the author gives distance measurements in "cubits." These cubits were a unit of measurement corresponding to the distance between an average person's elbow and middle fingertip, or about 46 centimeters or about 18 inches. If it would be helpful to your readers, throughout this chapter you could express these lengths in modern measurements, either in the text of your translation or in a footnote. The UST models one way to do that.

"by the cubit"
In many places in this chapter, the author uses the phrase "by the cubit" to express a distance the way people in his culture would. In your translation, express this distance the way a speaker of your language naturally would. For example, when the author says of the temple porch in 6:3, "Ten by the cubit {was} its depth," you might say, "It was ten cubits deep." (See: Idiom)

"house"
Throughout this chapter, the author uses the term "house" to mean the temple that Solomon built for Yahweh. He is speaking as if the temple were a house in which Yahweh lived. The term "house" indicates that Yahweh was especially present in his temple. If it would be clearer in your language, you could say "temple" in your translation rather than "house." (See: Metaphor)

name of a person representing that person and associated or accompanying people
Throughout this chapter, the author uses Solomon to represent the many workers who were involved in constructing the temple. For example, he says of Solomon in 6:4 that "he made for the house windows with narrowed frames." He means that Solomon's workers did this. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, in this instance and throughout this chapter, as the UST does. (See: Synecdoche)

"second"
Several times throughout this chapter, the author uses the term "second." If your language would not represent a number in such a form, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. For example, in 6:1, rather than say "the second month," you might say "month two." In 1:1, rather than say "the second wing," you might say "the other wing." (See: Ordinal Numbers)

1 Kings 6:1 (#4)

בַּשָּׁנָה הָרְבִיעִ֣ית בְּחֹ֣דֶשׁ זִ֗ו הִ֚וא הַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִ֔י לִמְלֹ֖ךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל׃

"in the fourth year, in the month of Ziv (it {is} the second month), of the reigning of Solomon over Israel"

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **the fourth year** and the information about **the reigning of Solomon** together. Alternate translation: [in the fourth year of the reigning of Solomon over Israel, in the month of Ziv (it is the second month)]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 6:1 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

"And it happened"

See how you translated the phrase "And it happened" in 2:39, where it similarly introduces a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 6:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁמוֹנִ֣ים שָׁנָ֔ה וְאַרְבַּ֥ע מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה

"in year 80 and year 400"

The author is describing the time between one year and another in the way that is characteristic of his culture. In your translation, express this the way a speaker of your language naturally would. Alternate translation: [in the 480th year]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 6:1 (#5)

בְּחֹדֶשׁ זִו֙ הוּא֙ הַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִ֔י

“in the month of Ziv (it {is} the second month”

The author is providing background information to help readers recognize that **Ziv** was the official name at this time for the month that they knew simply as **the second month**. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 6:1 (#9)

וַיִּבֶן

“that he built”

Since the author says in 6:38 that Solomon “built” the temple over the course of “seven years,” he does not mean here that Solomon **built the house of Yahweh** entirely **in the fourth year** of his reign. Your language may have a verb form or verbal phrase that you can use in your translation that indicates the beginning of an action. Alternate translation: [that he began to build]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 6:1 (#11)

הַבַּ֖יִת לַיהוָֽה

“the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 6:1 (#3)

בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל

“the sons of Israel”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [the Israelite people]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 6:1 (#6)

בְּחֹדֶשׁ זִו֙ הוּא֙ הַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִ֔י

“in the month of Ziv (it {is} the second month”

The **second month** of the Hebrew calendar, which the author identifies as the **month of Ziv**, includes the months of April and May on Western calendars. You could convert the Hebrew month into approximate dates on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the dates will be different every year, and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may just want to give the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar and say in a footnote approximately what time of year that is on your calendar.

See: Hebrew Months

1 Kings 6:1 (#10)

וַיִּבֶן

“that he built”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:26. Alternate translation: [that Solomon had his workers build] or [that Solomon commanded his workers to begin to build]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 6:1 (#8)

הַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִ֔י

“is} the second month”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the term “second.” Alternate translation: [month two]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 6:1 (#7)

הוּא֙ הַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִ֔י

“it {is} the second month”

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that this was the **second month** of the agricultural year, not the **second month** of Solomon’s **fourth year** of **reigning**. Alternate translation: [it is the second month of the year]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:2 (#1)

שִׁשִּׁ֤ים־אַמָּה֙ & וְעֶשְׂרִ֣ים & וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֔ים אַמָּ֖ה

“60 cubits & and 20 & and 30 cubits”

See the discussion of the term “cubits” in the introduction to this chapter for suggestions as to how you

might represent the lengths that the author is using the term to indicate.

See: Biblical Distance

1 Kings 6:2 (#2)

וְעֶשְׂרִ֖ים

“and 20”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and 20 cubits]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:3 (#2)

הֵיכַ֥ל

“the nave of”

While, in other contexts, the term translated as **nave** can mean “palace” or “temple,” the author is using it in a specialized sense here. He is referring to a specific architectural feature of Solomon’s temple, the main hall that was the equivalent of the Holy Place in the sacred tent. If your culture has a term for such a feature, you could use that in your translation, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the main hall]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 6:3 (#3)

עֶ֣שֶׂר בָּאַמָּ֑ה

“Ten by the cubit”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how the author uses the phrase **Ten by the cubit** to express a distance in a way characteristic of his culture. Alternate translation: [Ten cubits]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 6:3 (#1)

עַל־פְּנֵי֙ הֵיכַ֣ל הַבַּ֔יִת & עַל־פְּנֵ֥י רֹ֖חַב הַבָּ֑יִת & עַל־פְּנֵ֥י הַבָּֽיִת

“on the face of the nave of the house & on the face of the width of the house & on the face of the house”

In each of these instances, the phrase **on the face of** represents being in front of something. The author is using the phrase in three slightly different ways. In the first instance, he means that the **porch** was in front of the **nave of the house**. That is, priests would walk across the porch to enter the main hall of the temple. In the second instance, he means that the porch was in front of the entire **width of the house**. That is, its length of**20 cubits** corresponded to the width of the **house** or temple. In the third instance, the author means that the porch extended out **Ten** cubits in front of the temple. If it would be helpful in your language, in your translation you could use equivalent expressions or plain language. Alternate translation: [that was in front of the nave of the house ... corresponding to the width of the house ... extending outward from the house]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 6:4 (#1)

חַלֹּונֵ֥י שְׁקֻפִ֖ים אֲטֻמִֽים

“windows with narrowed frames”

By **windows with narrowed frames**, the author means windows with narrowed or beveled frames that were wider on the inside of the wall than on the outside. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [windows that were narrower on the outside than on the inside] or [windows with frames that widened toward the inside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:5 (#1)

אֶת־קִירֹ֣ות הַבַּ֗יִת סָבִ֤יב לְהֵיכָל֙ וְלַדְּבִ֔יר

“the walls of the house all around, of the nave and of the inner sanctuary”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that is, against the walls of the house all around, both the wall of the nave and the wall of the inner sanctuary]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:5 (#2)

אֶת־קִירֹ֣ות הַבַּ֗יִת סָבִ֤יב לְהֵיכָל֙ וְלַדְּבִ֔יר

“the walls of the house all around, of the nave and of the inner sanctuary”

The author is clarifying that the **addition** that Solomon had his workers build extended all the way around the sides and back of the temple building. If he had simply said **the wall of the house**, some readers

might have understood this not to include the back third of the temple, which consisted of the Most Holy Place. So he adds that the addition rested against the **walls** of both the **nave** and the **inner sanctuary**. Readers in some cultures might consider these to be the same wall, and so it may be more natural for you to express this in your translation by using a singular form. Alternate translation: [extending around the outer wall of both the nave and the inner sanctuary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:5 (#3)

וְלַדְּבִיר

“and of the inner sanctuary”

Here the author is using a technical architectural term that occurs only in the descriptions of Solomon’s temple here in 1 Kings, in the parallel passages in 2 Chronicles, and in Psalm 28:2. He means the innermost part of the temple, which corresponded to the Holy of Holies or Most Holy Place in the sacred tent. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use one of those names, as the UST does, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the innermost part of the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:6 (#1)

היצוע הַתַּחְתֹּנָה

“The lowest addition”

While the author is using the same word here that is translated as **addition** in the previous verse, here he is using a feminine form to mean one part of the structure, specifically one of its three floors. In the previous verse and in 6:10, the author uses the masculine form to mean the entire structure. If your language uses forms of different gender in the same way, you could do that here in your translation. If not, you could indicate the meaning explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The lowest floor of the addition]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:6 (#3)

וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁית

“and the third”

The term **third** refers here to the highest of the three levels of rooms built alongside the temple walls, as mentioned in verse 5 and in verse 8. If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **third**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [and floor three] or [and the highest floor]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 6:6 (#4)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [This was possible because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 6:6 (#2)

וְהַתְּיכֹנָה & וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁית

“and the middle & and the third”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the middle floor … and the third floor]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:7 (#1)

וְהַבַּיִת בְּהִבָּנֹתוֹ & נִבְנָה

“And the house, in its being built, was built”

The expressions **in its being built** and **was built** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use these forms, you could express the idea with active forms or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [When the workers built the temple, they built it]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:7 (#4)

בַּבַּיִת בְּהִבָּנֹתוֹ

“in the house in its being built”

The expression **in its being built** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in the temple while the workers were building it]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:7 (#2)

וּמַקָּבֶת֙ וְהַגַּרְזֶ֔ן כָּל־כְּלִ֥י בַרְזֶ֖ל לֹא־נִשְׁמַ֥ע

“So hammers or the chisel, any implement of iron, was not heard”

The expression **was not heard** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [So no one heard hammers or the chisel, any implement of iron]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:7 (#3)

וּמַקָּבֶת֙ וְהַגַּרְזֶ֔ן כָּל־כְּלִ֥י בַרְזֶ֖ל לֹא־נִשְׁמַ֥ע

“So hammers or the chisel, any implement of iron, was not heard”

The author is not referring to a specific **chisel**. He means **any** chisel or any similar **implement of iron** that would have made a loud sound when it struck **stone**. Since this is his meaning, it may also be more natural to use a singular form of “hammer” instead of the plural form **hammers**. Alternate translation: [So no hammer or chisel, no implement of iron, was heard]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 6:8 (#2)

אֶל־כֶּ֣תֶף הַבַּ֔יִת הַיְמָנִ֑ית

“was} to the shoulder of the house {at} the right”

The author is using the term **shoulder** to mean the side of the **house** or temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was on the side of the temple at the right, near the front]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 6:8 (#3)

אֶל־כֶּ֣תֶף הַבַּ֔יִת הַיְמָנִ֑ית

“was} to the shoulder of the house {at} the right”

The author is speaking of directions in the way characteristic of his culture. He does not mean that if someone were standing in front of the temple, facing the porch, that this entrance would be on that person’s **right**. Instead, people of this culture spoke of directions as if a person were facing east, toward the sunrise. The south would be to the right of such a person. So the author means that this entrance was on the south side of the temple. (It was actually on the left of a person who was standing in front of the temple, facing the porch.) Alternate translation: [was on the south side of the temple, near the front]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:8 (#4)

וּבְלוּלִ֖ים יַעֲל֑וּ

“and they went up by stairs”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific individuals. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people went up] or [and the priests went up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 6:8 (#5)

עַל־הַתִּיכֹנָ֔ה וּמִן־הַתִּיכֹנָ֖ה אֶל־הַשְּׁלִשִֽׁים

“onto the middle, and from the middle to the third”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [onto the middle floor, and they also went up by stairs from the middle floor to the third floor]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:8 (#1)

הַצֶּ֥לַע הַתִּיכֹנָ֖ה

“the middle chamber”

The author is not referring to a specific **middle chamber**. He means the rooms on the middle level in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the middle chambers] or [the second floor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 6:9 (#1)

וַיִּבֶן֙ אֶת־הַבַּ֔יִת וַיְכַלֵּֽהוּ

“And he built the house and finished it”

Together, the verbs **built** and **finished** express a single idea. The word **finished** tells to what degree Solomon **built** the temple, that is, to completion. (The author is referring specifically to the walls of the temple.) If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way, here and in

6:14. Alternate translation: [And he finished building the house]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 6:9 (#2)

וּשְׂדֹרֹ֥ת בָּאֲרָזִֽים

“and boards of cedars”

The author is probably using the plural form **cedars** because these **beams** and **boards** came from many different cedar trees. It may be more natural in some languages to use a singular form to indicate the composition of these beams and boards, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [of cedar]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Kings 6:10 (#3)

חָמֵ֣שׁ אַמּ֔וֹת קוֹמָתֹ֖ו

“five cubits {was} its height”

The author expects readers to understand that each of the three levels of rooms was five cubits high. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [five cubits was the height of each of its levels]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:10 (#2)

עַל־כָּל־הַבַּ֑יִת

“against all of the house”

The author is saying **all of the house** as a generalization for emphasis. The context makes clear that no part of the addition was in front of the temple, where there was a porch. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [all around the sides and back of the temple]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 6:10 (#1)

וַיִּבֶן֙ אֶת־הַיצוּעַ֔ עַל־כָּל־הַבַּ֖יִת חָמֵ֣שׁ אַמּ֑וֹת קוֹמָתֹ֔ו וַיֶּאֱחֹ֥ז אֶת־הַבַּ֖יִת בַּעֲצֵ֥י אָֽרֶז׃

“And he built the addition against all of the house, five cubits {was} its height, and it held {onto} the house with wood of cedars”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about how the addition **held {onto}** to the temple with the information that Solomon built it **against** or right next to the temple. Alternate translation: [And he built the addition against all of the house, and it held onto the house with wood of cedars. Five cubits was its height]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 6:11 (#2)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 6:11 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ דְּבַר־יְהוָ֔ה אֶל־שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

“And the word of Yahweh was to Solomon”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh spoke a message to Solomon. If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 7:4. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh spoke a message to Solomon]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 6:12 (#3)

וַהֲקִמֹתִ֤י אֶת־דְּבָרִי֙ אִתְּךָ֔ אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבַּ֖רְתִּי אֶל

“then I will make my word stand with you that I spoke to”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [then I will make happen for you what I said when I spoke with]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 6:12 (#2)

אִם־תֵּלֵ֣ךְ בְּחֻקֹּתַ֗י וְאֶת־מִשְׁפָּטַ֤י תַּעֲשֶׂה֙ וְשָׁמַרְתָּ֣ אֶת־כָּל־מִצְוֹתַ֔י לָלֶ֥כֶת בָּהֶ֖ם

“if you walk in my statutes and do my judgments and keep all of my commandments by walking in them”

It might seem that saying **if you walk ... by walking in them** would be to express extra information in a way that would not be natural in your language. If so, if you choose to retain the image of walking in your

translation, you could choose to express it only once. Alternate translation: [if you walk in all of my laws]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 6:12 (#1)

אִם־תֵּלֵךְ בְּחֻקֹּתַי וְאֶת־מִשְׁפָּטַי תַּעֲשֶׂה וְשָׁמַרְתָּ אֶת־כָּל־מִצְוֹתַי לָלֶכֶת בָּהֶם

“if you walk in my statutes and do my judgments and keep all of my commandments by walking in them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. You may have chosen to indicate that the image of walking represents living, and you may have chosen to express the meaning of the similar terms “statutes” and “commandments” with a single term. (You can include the further term that occurs here, **judgments**, in such a single term.) Alternate translation: [if, by obeying all of my laws, you live as I want people to live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 6:12–13 (#1)

הַבַּיִת הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה בֹנֶה אִם־תֵּלֵךְ בְּחֻקֹּתַי וְאֶת־מִשְׁפָּטַי תַּעֲשֶׂה וְשָׁמַרְתָּ אֶת־כָּל־מִצְוֹתַי לָלֶכֶת בָּהֶם וַהֲקִמֹתִי אֶת־דְּבָרִי אִתָּךְ אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתִּי אֶל־דָּוִד אָבִיךָ: וְשָׁכַנְתִּי בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא אֶעֱזֹב אֶת־עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“This house that you are building, if you walk in my statutes and do my judgments and keep all of my commandments by walking in them, then I will make my word stand with you that I spoke to David your father, and I will dwell in the midst of the sons of Israel, and I will not forsake my people Israel”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine 6:12 and 6:13 into a verse bridge in order to put the information together that Yahweh would “dwell” in the **house** or temple that Solomon was **building**.

See: Verse Bridges

1 Kings 6:14 (#1)

וַיִּבֶן שְׁלֹמֹה אֶת־הַבַּיִת וַיְכַלֵּהוּ

“And Solomon built the house and finished it”

The author interrupted his account of the construction of the temple in 6:11–13 to report what Yahweh told Solomon. He is now resuming that account where he left off at 6:10, with the outer walls and roof in place but nothing on the interior of the walls. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for reminding readers where a story has left off. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see what you did in the similar case of 1 Samuel 29:1, where the biblical author similarly resumes a story after an interruption. Alternate translation: [Now Solomon’s workers had finished building the temple walls and roof]

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 6:15 (#1)

קִירוֹת הַסִּפֻּן

“the walls of the ceiling”

The author is using the possessive form to describe the part of the **walls** that were near the **ceiling**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the part of the walls near the ceiling] or [the top of the walls]

See: Possession

1 Kings 6:16 (#1)

אֶת־עֶשְׂרִים אַמָּה

“20 cubits”

By saying that Solomon **built 20 cubits**, the author means that he built a structure that extended out 20 cubits from the back wall of the temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a structure 20 cubits deep]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 6:16 (#2)

הַקִּירוֹת

“the walls”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the part of the walls near the ceiling] or [the top of the walls]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:16 (#3)

וַיִּבֶן לוֹ

“And he built {them} for it”

The pronoun **them** refers to the 20 cubits that the author speaks of earlier in this verse, meaning a

structure 20 cubits deep. The pronoun **it** refers to the **house** or temple. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And he built that area 20 cubits deep for the temple]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 6:17 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of it”

Here, **to the face of it** represents being in front of the inner sanctuary. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of it]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 6:17 (#1)

הַבָּיִת

“the house”

As the author indicates, by **the house** he means **the nave**, that is, the rest of the temple, the main room in front of the inner sanctuary. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the rest of the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:18 (#2)

מִקֻּלַּעַת פְּקָעִים

“carving of gourds”

The author is not referring to a specific **carving**. He means carvings in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [carvings of gourds]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 6:18 (#3)

וּפְטוּרֵי צִצִּים

“and opened ones of flowers”

The expression **opened ones** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language, here and in verses 29 and 35. Alternate translation: [and flowers that had opened]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:18 (#4)

אֵין אֶבֶן נִרְאָה

“no stone was seen”

The expression **was seen** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one saw any stone]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:18 (#1)

מִקֻּלַּעַת פְּקָעִים וּפְטוּרֵי צִצִּים

“carving of gourds and opened ones of flowers”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [it was decorated with carving of gourds and opened ones of flowers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:21 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the inner sanctuary. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 6:21 (#3)

וַיְצַפֵּם

“and he overlaid it”

The pronoun **it** probably refers to the exterior wall of the inner sanctuary, which faced the main hall. The author described in the previous verse how all of its interior walls were overlaid with gold. Here he is describing how its one exterior wall was also overlaid. Alternate translation: [and he overlaid the outside wall of the inner sanctuary]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 6:21 (#1)

אֶת־הַבַּיִת מִפְּנִימָה

“the house on the inside”

Since the author has already described in the previous verse how Solomon overlaid the inner sanctuary with gold, here the term **house** probably refers to the rest of the temple, that is, the nave or main hall. Alternate translation: [the interior walls of the rest of the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:22 (#1)

וְאֶת־כָּל־הַבַּיִת צִפָּה זָהָב עַד־תֻּמּ֔וֹ כָּל־הַבָּיִת

“So he overlaid all of the house {with} gold until finishing all of the house”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition. The author is using a poetic form to provide a summary statement of the entire process of overlaying the temple interior with gold. It would be good to show this to your readers by representing both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. There may be a natural way to do this in your language. Alternate translation: [So he overlaid the temple interior with gold until there was no part of it that was not overlaid with gold]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 6:22 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־לַדְּבִיר

“that {was} to the inner sanctuary”

This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [that was in front of the inner sanctuary] or (2) Alternate translation: [that was associated with the inner sanctuary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:23 (#2)

עֶשֶׂר אַמּ֖וֹת קוֹמָתֽוֹ

“Ten cubits {was} its height”

Here the author is beginning to describe one of the cherubs. He describes its height in this sentence and its wingspan in the next verse. In the following two verses, he then describes the wingspan and height of the other cherub. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine 6:23–26 into a verse bridge in order to describe both cherubs together rather than each one separately.

See: Verse Bridges

1 Kings 6:23 (#1)

עֲצֵי־שָׁ֑מֶן

“wood of oil”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **wood** that comes from a tree whose fruit produces **oil**. In other words, he means wood from an olive tree, or olive wood. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way, here and in verses 31, 32, and 33. Alternate translation: [olive wood]

See: Possession

1 Kings 6:24 (#1)

עֶ֣שֶׂר אַמּ֗וֹת מִקְצֹ֚עוֹת כְּנָפָ֔יו וְעַד־קְצֹ֖עוֹת כְּנָפָֽיו

“Ten cubits {were} from the ends of its wings and to the ends of its wings”

This second sentence in the verse means basically the same thing as the first one. However, it is not redundant or unnecessary. The author is building up to his statement in 6:27 that the wings of the cherubs stretched across the entire 20-cubit width of the Holy of Holies. The movement from **five** to **ten** to an implied twenty creates a sense of majesty around these cherubs, which represented the presence of Yahweh in his temple. It would be good to give your readers the experience the author intended by including this sentence separately in your translation rather than combining it with the first sentence in some way.

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 6:24 (#2)

עֶ֣שֶׂר אַמּ֗וֹת מִקְצֹ֚עוֹת כְּנָפָ֔יו וְעַד־קְצֹ֖עוֹת כְּנָפָֽיו

“Ten cubits {were} from the ends of its wings and to the ends of its wings”

The author is describing the distance from one extreme to another in the way that was characteristic of his culture. He uses the plural form **ends** where other languages might use a singular form. In your translation, express this the way people of your culture would describe the distance between two extremes. Alternate translation: [It was ten cubits from one end of its wings to the other]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 6:25 (#1)

הַכְּרוּב הַשֵּׁנִֽי

“was} the second cherub”

Since the author describes the second cherub's height in the next verse, he seems to be describing the second cherub's wingspan here. Alternate translation: [was the wingspan of the second cherub]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:27 (#1)

הַבַּ֫יִת הַפְּנִימִ֥י

"the inner house"

Here the author uses the expression **the inner house** to mean the same part of the temple that he calls "the inner sanctuary" in the rest of this chapter. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the inner sanctuary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:27 (#2)

וַיִּפְרְשׂוּ֙ אֶת־כַּנְפֵ֣י הַכְּרֻבִ֔ים

"And they spread out the wings of the cherubs"

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. He is putting the focus on the way the wings of the cherubs **spread out** across the whole width of the Holy of Holies, not on who put them in this position. Use an expression to convey this meaning that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the wings of the cherubs were spread out] or [And the wings of the cherubs extended outward]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 6:29 (#1)

קָלַ֣ע

"he carved"

The workers first carved these designs into the walls, and then they overlaid the walls with gold. (The author describes this sequence explicitly in 6:32 in the case of the doors.) See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of why the author describes the carvings and overlay of the two parts of the temple in the order that he does. Your language may have a verb form or verb phrase that you can use in your translation to indicate that the action in this verse preceded the action in 6:22. Alternate translation: [he had carved]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 6:29 (#2)

פְּתוּחֵ֥י מְקֻלָּעוֹת֖

"with} engravings of carvings"

The author is using a possessive form to describe **carvings** that were **engravings**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [engraved carvings]

See: Possession

1 Kings 6:29 (#3)

מִלִּפְנִ֥ים וְלַחִיצֽוֹן

"from the inside and to the outside"

The author is using the adjectives **inside** and **outside** as nouns to mean certain parts of the temple. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [from the inside room and to the outside room] or [in both the inner sanctuary and the main hall]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 6:31 (#2)

חֲמִשִּׁ֑ית

"were} a fifth"

A **fifth** means one part out of five equal parts.

See: Fractions

1 Kings 6:31 (#1)

הָאַ֣יִל מְזוּזֹ֔ות חֲמִשִּׁ֖ית

"The lintel, the doorposts, {were} a fifth"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The length of the lintel and the height of the doorposts were each one fifth of the 20-cubit length and height of the inner sanctuary wall]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:32 (#1)

עָלָ֣יו & הַכְּרוּבִ֖ים וְעַל־הַתְּמֹרֹ֑ות

"them & on the cherubs and on the palm trees"

The context indicates that the workers also **beat out** the **gold** that they had **overlaid** on the **flowers**. You

can include the flowers in this statement if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the cherubs, the palm trees, and the flowers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:33 (#1)

מֵאֵאת רְבִעִֽית

“from a fourth”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [from a fourth of the width of the wall] or [one fourth as wide as the wall]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 6:33 (#2)

מֵאֵאת רְבִעִֽית

“from a fourth”

A **fourth** means one part out of four equal parts.

See: Fractions

1 Kings 6:34 (#1)

קְלָעִֽים

“the curtains {of”

Some ancient manuscripts read “curtains.” The ULT follows that reading. One ancient manuscript and several ancient versions read “leaves.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 6:35 (#1)

מְיֻשָּׁ֣ר עַל־הַמְּחֻקָּֽה

“smoothed onto the carved things”

The expression **smoothed onto the carved things** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [which the workers smoothed onto the carvings]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:36 (#1)

אֶת־הֶחָצֵ֖ר הַפְּנִימִֽית

“the inner courtyard”

The expression **inner courtyard** represents a wall that Solomon’s workers built in order to create a courtyard around the temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the wall of the inner courtyard]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 6:37 (#3)

בַּשָּׁנָה֙ הָרְבִיעִ֔ית

“In the fourth year”

By **the fourth year**, the author means the fourth year of Solomon’s reign as king. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [In the fourth year of the reign of Solomon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:37 (#1)

בַּשָּׁנָה֙ הָרְבִיעִ֔ית יֻסַּ֖ד בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֑ה בְּיֶרַ֖ח זִֽו

“In the fourth year, the house of Yahweh was founded, in the month of Ziv”

In this verse and the next one, the author is concluding his account of how Solomon had his workers build a temple for Yahweh. Here he repeats what he said at the beginning of the account, in 6:1, about when Solomon began the project. That repetition signals the impending conclusion of the account, which ends in the next verse with the author’s statement of when Solomon completed the project. Use a natural form in your language for concluding an account with a brief summary of what it has described.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 6:37 (#5)

יֻסַּ֖ד בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֑ה

“the house of Yahweh was founded”

The expression **was founded** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [workers laid the foundation of the house of Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 6:37 (#4)

בַּשָּׁנָה֙ הָֽרְבִיעִ֔ית

“In the fourth year”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **fourth**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In year four]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 6:37 (#2)

בַּשָּׁנָה֙ הָֽרְבִיעִ֔ית יֻסַּ֖ד בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֑ה בְּיֶ֖רַח זִֽו

“In the fourth year, the house of Yahweh was founded, in the month of Ziv”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **month** of Ziv with the information about the **year**. Alternate translation: [In the fourth year, in the month of Ziv, the house of Yahweh was founded]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 6:38 (#3)

בְּיֶ֖רַח בּ֑וּל

“in the month of Bul”

See how you decided to represent a Hebrew month in 6:1.

See: Hebrew Months

1 Kings 6:38 (#1)

וּבַשָּׁנָה֙ הָֽאַחַ֣ת עֶשְׂרֵ֔ה

“And in year 11”

If your language would not use a form such as **year 11**, you could describe this year with a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [And in the eleventh year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 6:38 (#2)

בְּיֶ֖רַח בּ֑וּל הֽוּא־הַחֹ֥דֶשׁ הַשְּׁמִינִ֖י

“in the month of Bul (it {is} the eighth month”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1, where the author was also explaining that a month he describes by a name was one that his readers likely knew by a number.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 6:38 (#5)

לְכָל־דְּבָרָ֣יו וּלְכָל־מִשְׁפָּטֽוֹ

“in all of its matters and according to all of its plans”

The pronoun translated as **its** could also mean “his.” The author could be saying that: (1) by the date he names, the workers had completed every part of the temple according to the design they were working from. Alternate translation: [in every single part, just as designed] or (2) that the workers had done what Solomon had told and required them to do. Alternate translation: [according to all of his words and all of his requirements] or [just as Solomon had said and required it should be]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 6:38 (#4)

כָּלָ֥ה הַבַּ֖יִת

“the house finished”

The author is speaking of the **house** as if it had been a living thing that could have **finished** its own construction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the workers finished building the temple]

See: Personification

1 Kings - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes the author’s description of how Solomon built a temple for Yahweh. It first describes how Solomon built a palace for himself, near the temple and of the same design, after the temple was completed. It then returns to the story of the temple and describes how Solomon brought a craftsman named Hiram to Jerusalem to make many different bronze articles for the temple. The chapter concludes with a description of the bronze and gold furnishings of the temple.

1. Solomon’s Palace Complex (7:1–12)
2. Summary (7:1)
3. The House of the Forest of Lebanon (7:2–5)
4. The Hall of Pillars (7:6)
5. The Hall of the Throne (7:7)
6. Solomon’s residence and the house for Pharaoh’s daughter (7:8)
7. The stones of the palace (7:9–11)

1 Kings - Chapter 7 Introduction

8. The courtyard (7:12)
9. The work of Hiram (7:13–45)
10. Recruitment of Hiram (7:13–14)
11. The pillars (7:15–22)
12. The sea (7:23–26)
13. The stands (7:27–39)
14. Summary of Hiram's work (7:40–45)
15. Composition and weight of the temple furnishings (7:45–51)
16. Bronze furnishings (7:45–47)
17. Gold furnishings (7:48–50)
18. Concluding statement (7:51)

There is a list in 7:40–45 that summarizes all of the bronze articles that Hiram made for the temple. You may wish to present this list in the way that lists would appear in your culture. See how you decided to represent the lists in 4:2–6 and 4:7–19. For example, you might put the second part of verse 40 on a separate line as an introduction to the list. You might then put the description of each item on a separate line, and you could put the second part of verse 45 on a separate line as the conclusion to the list:

And Hiram finished doing all of the work that he did for King Solomon {for} the house of Yahweh: two pillars, and the bowls of the capitals that were on the head of the two pillars, and the two networks for covering the two bowls of the capitals that were on the head of the pillars, and the 400 pomegranates for the two networks, two rows of pomegranates for one network to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the faces of the pillars, and the ten stands, and the ten basins on the stands, and the one sea, and the 12 cattle under the sea, and the pots and the shovels and the bowls. And all these vessels that Hiram made for King Solomon, for the house of Yahweh, were polished bronze.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Artistic craftsmanship as a form of worship

In this chapter, the author gives a detailed description of the various bronze items that Hiram made for the temple, including the two great pillars, the great basin or sea, and the movable stands. Beyond having functions that were vital to the priests' work in the temple area, these were works of art created by a master craftsman, Hiram of Tyre. The exquisite detail that Hiram worked into these articles, including pomegranates, lilies, and cherubim, shows the high value that Solomon and the Israelites placed on artistic skill in the service of God. The craftsmanship was considered a form of worship, and the beauty of these objects was meant to reflect the glory of God, in whose service they were used.

The great basin or sea and the bronze stands

The great water basin or sea and the ten bronze stands were central components of the temple's courtyard. The sea was an enormous bronze basin that held water for the priests to wash themselves, symbolizing ritual purity before entering God's presence. It rested on twelve bronze oxen, which were not objects of worship but symbolic representations of the twelve tribes of Israel. The bronze stands were elaborate carts used to move smaller basins, also for washing sacrifices. These objects were essential for the sacrificial system, emphasizing that purity was a prerequisite for approaching a holy God. They underscored the meticulous care and religious significance of every detail within the temple complex.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Ancient bronze casting

What the author says in 7:46 suggests that Hiram made bronze objects for the temple by hollowing out the shape of the object in clay in the ground and then pouring in hot liquid bronze and letting it cool. Use a term in your translation that will express this accurately. For example, it may be better to say that Hiram "cast" the objects than that he "molded" them.

How many rows of pillars were there in the House of the Forest of Lebanon?

The author says in 7:2 that the House of the Forest of Lebanon rested "upon four rows of pillars." However, in 7:3 he describes "45 pillars, 15 the row." That suggests that there were only three rows. To make these statements agree, some ancient and modern versions have said either "three rows" in verse 2 or "60 pillars" in verse 3. However, we do not recommend that you change either number. The exact details of the construction of this building are no longer clearly understood, and the explanation of the apparent difference in the numbers probably lies in a better understanding of those details. For example, the four rows of pillars described in verse 2 may have formed part of the four exterior walls of the building. The three rows of pillars described in verse 3 may have stood inside the hall and held up the cedar boards that formed the ceiling. (They would also have given the hall the appearance of a forest, which may be why it had the name the House of the Forest of Lebanon.) This is not certain, but it is one possibility, and it illustrates how a better understanding of the construction of this building

could explain what seems like a discrepancy. So we recommend that you simply translate the text and not try to harmonize these numbers.

Was the master craftsman of the palace named Hiram or Huram?
In 7:13, the author describes how Solomon brought a man named Hiram from Tyre to make all of the bronze articles for the temple. (This was a different man from the one named Hiram who was the king of Tyre.) In 2 Chronicles 2:13, however, this man's name is spelled "Huram." To make clear that this is the same person, some versions use the name Huram here in 1 Kings as well. However, we do not recommend that you change the name either here or in 2 Chronicles to make the accounts in both books match. The difference in spelling may reflect how Hebrew pronunciation changed during the time between the writing of 1 Kings and 2 Chronicles. So we recommend that you simply translate the names as they appear in each text and not try to harmonize them.

"the work of"
In his descriptions of the articles that Hiram made from bronze for the temple, the author uses the expression "the work of" several times. The term "work" comes from the same root as the Hebrew verb that means "do" or "make." It may be helpful to use some form of the verb "make" to translate this expression. Here are examples of how that might be done.

7:19 And the capitals that {were} on the head of the pillars {were} the work of a lily "And the capitals that were on the top of the pillars were made in the shape of lilies"

7:22 And on the head of the pillars {was} the work of a lily. "And decorations that were each made in the shape of a lily were on top of the pillars"

7:22 And the work of the pillars was finished "And Hiram finished making the pillars"

7:26 and its lip {was} like the work of the lip of a cup "and its lip was made like the lip of a cup"

7:28 And this {was} the work of the stand And this is how the stands were made

7:29 the work of descent "made to hang down"

7:31 the work of a pedestal "made as a pedestal" or "made to be a pedestal"

7:33 And the work of the wheels was like the work of the wheel of the chariot "And the wheels were made the way chariot wheels are made"

(See: Idiom)

1 Kings 7:1 (#2)

וְאֶת־בֵּיתוֹ֙ בָּנְתָ֣ה שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה שְׁלֹ֥שׁ עֶשְׂרֵ֖ה שָׁנָ֑ה וַיְכַ֖ל אֶת־כָּל־בֵּיתֽוֹ

"And Solomon built his house 13 years, and he finished all of his house"

Together, the verbs **built** and **finished** express a single idea. The word **finished** tells to what degree Solomon **built** his palace over the course of these 13 years, that is, to completion. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And then Solomon took 13 years to finish building his house] or [And Solomon completed constructing his palace after a further 13 years]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 7:1 (#3)

וְאֶת & בָּנְתָ֣ה שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה

"And Solomon built"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:26. Alternate translation: [And Solomon had his workers build]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 7:1 (#4)

בֵּיתוֹ֙

"his house"

The term **house** in this chapter usually refers to Solomon's entire palace complex, which included the House of the Forest of Lebanon (7:2–5), the Porch of Pillars (7:6), the Porch of the Throne (7:7), Solomon's personal residence (7:8), and the surrounding courtyard (7:12). However, in (7:8) the author refers to Solomon's residence itself as his "house." So you may wish to use a term other than "house" in your translation to refer to the entire complex. Alternate translation: [his palace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:1 (#1)

וְאֶת־בֵּיתוֹ֙ בָּנְתָ֣ה שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה שְׁלֹ֥שׁ עֶשְׂרֵ֖ה שָׁנָ֑ה וַיְכַ֖ל אֶת־כָּל־בֵּיתֽוֹ

"And Solomon built his house 13 years, and he finished all of his house"

In this verse, the author is introducing a new event in the story, Solomon building his **house** or palace. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 7:2 (#1)

אֶת־בֵּ֣ית ׀ יַ֣עַר הַלְּבָנ֑וֹן

“the House of the Forest of Lebanon”

This was not a **House** in which anyone lived. It was a great ceremonial hall in which Solomon kept his collection of shields and weapons. Solomon may also have hosted large public assemblies and royal ceremonies in this hall. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a term other than “house” to describe this building. Alternate translation: [the Forest of Lebanon Hall]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 7:2 (#2)

מֵאָ֣ה אַמָּ֗ה & וַחֲמִשִּׁ֤ים אַמָּה֙ & וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים אַמָּ֔ה

“100 cubits & and 50 cubits & and 30 cubits”

See the discussion of the term “cubits” in the introduction to chapter 6, and see how you decided to describe the lengths that the author expresses in cubits in that chapter.

See: Biblical Distance

1 Kings 7:2 (#3)

עַל

“upon”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The structure rested upon]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:3 (#1)

וְסָפ֥וּן בָּאֲרָ֖ז

“And it was covered with cedar”

The expression **it was covered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And cedar covered it] or [And the workers covered it with cedar]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:3 (#2)

הָעַמּוּדִ֔ים אַרְבָּעִ֖ים וַחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה עָשָׂ֑ר הַטּ֖וּר

“45 pillars, 15 the row”

The author is using the phrase **15 the row** as a common expression of his culture to mean that there were 15 **pillars** in each **row** that he is describing. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [45 pillars that were in rows of 15]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:5 (#1)

הַפְּתָחִ֥ים וְהַמְּזוּזֹ֖ות רְבֵעִ֣ים שָׁשֶׁ֑ה

“the entrances and doorposts {were} square {in} frame”

The phrase **entrances and doorposts** expresses a single idea, that these **entrances** were framed by these **doorposts**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [the entrances framed by the doorposts were square]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 7:6 (#3)

וְאוּלָ֣ם עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֗ם וְעַמֻּדִ֤ים וְעָ֙ב עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

“And a porch {was} on their face, and pillars and a roof {were} on their face”

Here, **face** represents the front of the building. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a porch was in front of it, and pillars and a roof were in front of it]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 7:6 (#4)

וְאוּלָ֣ם עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֗ם וְעַמֻּדִ֤ים וְעָ֙ב עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

“And a porch {was} on their face, and pillars and a roof {were} on their face”

It might seem that repeating the phrase **on their face** would be extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could represent this phrase only once. Alternate translation: [And a porch with pillars and a roof was in front of it]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:6 (#1)

אוּלָ֣ם הָעַמּוּדִ֔ים

“the Porch of Pillars”

This building had a name that used the same term that the author uses to describe the “porch” of the temple in 6:3. That suggests that this building was located just outside the House of the Forest of Lebanon. (The fact that its length was equal to the width of that building supports this idea.) It probably served as a ceremonial entranceway for that building. However, this building also had a **porch** of its own. So if it would be clearer in your language, you could use a name for this building as a whole that uses a term other than “porch.” Alternate translation: [the Colonnade of Pillars]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 7:6 (#2)

וְאוּלָ֣ם עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֗ם וְעַמֻּדִ֛ים וְעָ֥עֵב עַל־פְּנֵיהֶֽם

“And a porch {was} on their face, and pillars and a roof {were} on their face”

The author seems to be using the pronoun **their** to refer to the **Pillars** of this entryway. He is using those pillars to represent the entire building, whose most prominent feature they were. Alternate translation: [And a porch was on the face of this building, and pillars and a roof were on its face]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 7:7 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִשְׁפֹּ֖ט־שָׁ֑ם

“where he would judge there”

It might seem that the expression **where he would judge there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it, here and in verse 8. Alternate translation: [where he would judge]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:7 (#3)

וְסָפִ֥ון בָּאֶ֛רֶז מֵהַקֶּ֥רֶשׁ עַד־הַקִּ֖יר

“And it was covered with cedar from the floor to the floor”

The author is using **from the floor to the floor** as a common expression of his culture to mean “over the entire floor.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And its entire floor was covered with cedar]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:7 (#4)

וְסָפִ֥ון בָּאֶ֛רֶז מֵהַקֶּ֥רֶשׁ עַד־הַקִּ֖יר

“And it was covered with cedar from the floor to the floor”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:3. Alternate translation: [And cedar covered its entire floor] or [And the workers covered its entire floor with cedar]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:7 (#1)

וְאוּלָ֣ם הַכִּסֵּ֔א & אֻלָ֖ם הַמִּשְׁפָּ֑ט

“And & the Porch of the Throne & the Porch of Judgment”

This building was known by two names that each used the same term that describes the “porch” of the temple in 6:3. However, it is clear that this building was not a mere entrance. It was a formal hall in which Solomon judged cases. So if it would be clearer in your language, you could use a name for this building that uses a term other than “porch.” Alternate translation: [the Hall of the Throne ... the Hall of Judgment]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 7:8 (#2)

מִבֵּיתֹ֥ לָאוּלָ֖ם

“from the house of the porch”

By **the house of the porch**, the author seems to mean the building most recently mentioned that had the word “porch” in its name, which would be the Porch of the Throne (the Porch of Judgment). Alternate translation: [from the Porch of the Throne]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:8 (#3)

מִבֵּיתֹ֥ לָאוּלָ֖ם

“from the house of the porch”

The author is using the term **from** to mean that Solomon's residence was a separate building within the palace complex from the Porch of the Throne and the two buildings that adjoined it. Alternate translation: [set back from the Porch of the Throne] or [away from the Porch of the Throne and its adjoining buildings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:8 (#1)

הֶֽחָצֵר֙ הָאֲחֶ֣רֶת

"in} the other courtyard"

The author calls this the **other courtyard** to distinguish it from the temple courtyard that he describes in 6:36. He describes the construction of this courtyard in 7:12. You could indicate this distinction explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the palace courtyard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:8 (#4)

כַּמַּעֲשֶׂ֣ה הַזֶּ֔ה הָיְתָ֖ה

"was like this work"

The author means that the work that Solomon's builders did to construct his residence was **like** the **work** they did to construct the Porch of the Throne (and its adjoining buildings). This seems to refer to the materials they used, their method of construction, and the architectural style and details. It does not seem to be a description of the size of Solomon's residence. (The author does not give its dimensions.) Alternate translation: [was of similar construction to the Porch of the Throne]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:8 (#6)

כָּאוּלָ֖ם הַזֶּֽה

"like this porch"

As in the first instance earlier in the verse, here the term **porch** seems to refer to the Porch of the Throne. Alternate translation: [of similar construction to the Porch of the Throne]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:8 (#5)

וּבַ֤יִת יַֽעֲשֶׂה֙ לְבַת־פַּרְעֹ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר לָקַ֖ח שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

"And he made a house for the daughter of Pharaoh, whom Solomon had taken"

The pronoun **whom** refers to the daughter of Pharaoh, while the pronoun **he** refers to Solomon. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And he made a house for the daughter of Pharaoh, whom he had taken]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 7:9 (#1)

כָּל־אֵ֙לֶּה֙ אֲבָנִ֣ים יְקָרוֹת֔

"All of these {were} valuable stones"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [All of these buildings were built with valuable stones]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:9 (#2)

אֲבָנִ֣ים יְקָרוֹת֔

"were} valuable stones"

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:17. Alternate translation: [were built with high-quality limestone blocks]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:9 (#3)

מְגֹרָ֣רוֹת בַּמְּגֵרָ֑ה

"sawn with the saw"

The author is not referring to a specific **saw**. He means saws in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [sawn with saws]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 7:9 (#5)

וּמִמַּ֖עַל עַד־הַטְּפָחוֹ֑ת

"and from the foundation to the eaves"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [and the stonework extended from the foundation to the eaves]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:9 (#6)

וּמִחָ֖וץ עַד־הֶחָצֵ֣ר הַגְּדוֹלָֽה

“and from outside to the great courtyard”

The author is speaking as if the stonework of the palace buildings extended from them to the **great courtyard** that was **outside** of them. He means that the wall of the great courtyard had stones and workmanship of the same quality as those in the buildings it surrounded. The author does not mean that the entire courtyard was paved with stones. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the workers used the same kind of stonework to build the wall of the great courtyard outside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:9 (#4)

מְגֹרְרוֹת֙ בַּמְּגֵרָ֔ה

“sawn with the saw”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [trimmed with saws]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 7:10 (#1)

וּמְיֻסָּ֣ד אֲבָנִ֔ים יְקָרוֹת֙

“And it was founded with valuable stones”

The expression **it was founded** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he founded it with valuable stones] or [And its foundation consisted of valuable stones]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:12 (#2)

וְלַחֲצַ֖ר בֵּ֣ית־יְהוָ֑ה הַפְּנִימִ֔ית

“and for the inner courtyard of the house of Yahweh”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [just as for the inner courtyard of the house of Yahweh]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 7:12 (#3)

בֵּ֣ית־יְהוָ֑ה

“the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 7:12 (#1)

שְׁלֹשָׁ֤ה טוּרִים֙ גָּזִ֣ית

“three rows {of} hewn stone”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Its wall consisted of three rows of hewn stone]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:13 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֖ח הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה וַיִּקַּ֖ח אֶת־חִירָ֥ם מִצֹּֽר

“And King Solomon sent and took Hiram from Tyre”

Here and in the next verse, the author is introducing this man named **Hiram** as a new participant in the story. This is not the same man by that name who was the king of Tyre, whose friendship with Solomon the author describes in chapter 5. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [And King Solomon sent and took a certain man named Hiram from Tyre]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 7:14 (#2)

וַיִּמָּלֵ֣א אֶת־הַחָכְמָ֗ה וְאֶת־הַתְּבוּנָה֙ וְאֶת־הַדַּ֣עַת

“And he was filled with wisdom and understanding and knowledge”

The author is speaking as if Hiram had been a container that these qualities **filled**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he had been given wisdom and understanding and knowledge]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 7:14 (#4)

וַיִּמָּלֵא אֶת־הַחָכְמָה וְאֶת־הַתְּבוּנָה וְאֶת־הַדַּעַת

“And he was filled with wisdom and understanding and knowledge”

The terms **wisdom** and **understanding** and **knowledge** mean similar things. The author is using these three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And God had given him very great skill] or [And he had very great skill]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 7:14 (#1)

בֶּן־אִשָּׁה אַלְמָנָה הוּא מִמַּטֵּה נַפְתָּלִי וְאָבִיו אִישׁ־צֹרִי חֹרֵשׁ נְחֹשֶׁת

“He {was} the son of a woman, a widow, from the tribe of Naphtali, and his father was a man of Tyre, a crafter of bronze”

The author is describing Hiram’s parents as he continues to introduce him as a new participant in the story. Introduce Hiram’s parents in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He was the son of a certain woman from the tribe of Naphtali. His father, who had passed away, was a certain man who had lived in Tyre and had been a crafter of bronze]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 7:14 (#3)

וַיִּמָּלֵא אֶת־הַחָכְמָה וְאֶת־הַתְּבוּנָה וְאֶת־הַדַּעַת

“And he was filled with wisdom and understanding and knowledge”

The expression **was filled** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And God had filled him with wisdom and understanding and knowledge] or [And God had given him wisdom and understanding and knowledge]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:14 (#5)

וַיַּעַשׂ אֶת־כָּל־מְלַאכְתּוֹ

“and he did all of his work”

The author is saying **all of his work** as a generalization for emphasis. He means specifically that Hiram did all of the work that Solomon asked him to do. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and he did all the work that Solomon asked him to do]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 7:15 (#2)

וְחוּט שְׁתַּיִם־עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה יָסֹבּ אֶת־הָעַמּוּד הַשֵּׁנִי

“and a cord of 12 cubits surrounded the second pillar”

The author is not saying that there was such a **cord** around this **pillar** all the time. He is indicating what the circumference of the pillar was, by reference to how someone in his culture would measure that circumference. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the second pillar was 12 cubits in circumference] or [and the measurement of the distance around the second pillar was 12 cubits]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:15 (#1)

שְׁמֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה קוֹמַת הָעַמּוּד הָאֶחָד וְחוּט שְׁתַּיִם־עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה יָסֹבּ אֶת־הָעַמּוּד הַשֵּׁנִי

“18 cubits {was} the height of the one pillar, and a cord of 12 cubits surrounded the second pillar”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [18 cubits was the height of the one pillar, and 18 cubits was the height of the second pillar. A cord of 12 cubits surrounded the one pillar, and cord of 12 cubits surrounded the second pillar] or [18 cubits was the height of each pillar, and a cord of 12 cubits surrounded each pillar]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:15 (#3)

אֶת־הָעַמּוּד הַשֵּׁנִי

“the second pillar”

See the discussion of the term “second” in the introduction to chapter 6, and see how you decided to represent that term in your translation throughout that chapter. Alternate translation: [the other pillar] or [pillar number two]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 7:16 (#2)

רָאשֵׁ֣י הָֽעַמּוּדִ֗ים

“the heads of the pillars”

The author is using the term **heads** to mean the tops of these **pillars**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [the tops of the pillars]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:16 (#4)

חָמֵ֣שׁ אַמּ֗וֹת קוֹמַת֙ הַכֹּתֶ֣רֶת הָאֶחָ֔ת וְחָמֵ֥שׁ אַמּ֛וֹת קוֹמַ֥ת הַכֹּתֶ֖רֶת הַשֵּׁנִֽית

“Five cubits {was} the height of one capital, and five cubits {was} the height of the second capital”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it, here and in verses 17 and 18. Alternate translation: [Five cubits was the height of each capital]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:16 (#1)

כֹּתָרֹ֨ת

“capitals”

These **capitals** were a kind of decorative top piece that was placed on top of pillars or columns. If your readers would not be familiar with what a capital is, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [decorative tops] or [ornamental tops]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 7:16 (#3)

מֻצָ֖ק נְחֹֽשֶׁת

“casting of bronze”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [They were casting of bronze] or [They were bronze castings]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:17 (#1)

שְׂבָכִ֤ים מַעֲשֵׂה֙ שְׂבָכָ֔ה גְּדִלִ֖ים מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה שַׁרְשְׁרוֹת֙ לַכֹּתָרֹ֣ת אֲשֶׁ֔ר עַל־רֹ֖אשׁ הָעַמּוּדִֽים

“Networks, a work of netting, strands, a work of chains, {were} to the capitals that {were} on the head of the pillars”

This could mean: (1) that Hiram covered the capitals with decorative bronze **netting** and that he made the **strands** of the netting by twisting bronze wires together, as one would do to make **chains** (not in the sense of chains composed of separate links, but in the sense of a strong cord). Alternate translation: [The capitals on top of the pillars had decorative netting made from bronze that had been formed into thick strands, as for chains] or (2) that Hiram covered the capitals with decorative bronze netting and then draped chains over the netting that he had made by twisting bronze into thick strands. Alternate translation: [The capitals on top of the pillars had for decoration bronze netting and chains made of strands of twisted bronze]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:17 (#2)

רֹ֖אשׁ הָעַמּוּדִֽים

“the head of the pillars”

In this verse, the word **head** is singular in form, but it refers to all the tops of the pillars as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “head,” here and in verses 18, 19, and 22. Alternate translation: [the heads of the pillars] or [the tops of the pillars]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 7:18 (#4)

הַשְּׂבָכָֽה

“network”

In this verse, the word **network** is singular in form, but it refers to all networks as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “network” or a plural expression, here and in verses 20, 41, and 42. Alternate translation: [networks] or [set of networks]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 7:18 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ אֶת־הָעַמּוּדִ֗ים & רֹ֚אשׁ הָרִמֹּנִ֔ים

“And he made pillars & the head of the pomegranates”

Some ancient manuscripts read “And he made pillars” and “the head of the pomegranates.” The ULT follows those readings. Other ancient manuscripts read “And he made pomegranates” and “the head of the pillars.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 7:18 (#2)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ אֶת־הָעַמּוּדִ֗ים וּשְׁנֵי֙ טוּרִ֣ים סָבִ֔יב עַל־הַשְּׂבָכָ֖ה הָאֶחָ֑ת לְכַסּ֞וֹת אֶת־הַכְּתָרֹ֤ת אֲשֶׁר֙ עַל־רֹ֣אשׁ הָרִמֹּנִ֔ים וְכֵ֖ן עָשָׂ֣ה לַכֹּתֶ֥רֶת הַשֵּׁנִֽית

“And he made pillars, and two rows all around on one network, to cover the capitals that were on the head of the pomegranates, and thus he did for the second capital”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the purpose of the pomegranates (**to cover the capitals**) right after the statement that Hiram **made** them. Alternate translation: [And he made pomegranates to cover the capitals that were on the head of the pillars, and two rows all around on one network, and thus he did for the second capital]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 7:18 (#5)

וְכֵ֖ן עָשָׂ֣ה לַכֹּתֶ֥רֶת הַשֵּׁנִֽית

“and thus he did for the second capital”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Thus he did for the first capital, and thus he did for the second capital] or [Thus he did for each capital]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:18 (#3)

וּשְׁנֵי֙ טוּרִ֣ים סָבִ֔יב עַל־הַשְּׂבָכָ֖ה הָאֶחָ֑ת

“and two rows all around on one network”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [with two rows all around each network]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 7:19 (#1)

וְכֻתָּרֹ֗ת אֲשֶׁר֙ עַל־רֹ֣אשׁ הָעַמּוּדִ֔ים מַעֲשֵׂ֥ה שׁוּשַׁ֖ן בָּאוּלָֽם

“And the capitals that {were} on the head of the pillars {were} the work of a lily, on the porch”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **porch** with the information about the **pillars**. Alternate translation: [And the capitals that were on the head of the pillars on the porch were the work of a lily]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 7:19 (#2)

מַעֲשֵׂ֥ה שׁוּשַׁ֖ן

“were} the work of a lily”

To translate the phrase **the work of** here and in its several further occurrences in the rest of this chapter, see the discussion of that phrase in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [were made in the shape of lilies]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:19 (#3)

אַרְבַּ֥ע אַמּֽוֹת

“four cubits”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The lily-shaped top portion of the capitals was four cubits high]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:20 (#1)

וְכֻתָּרֹ֗ת עַל־שְׁנֵי֙ הָעַמּוּדִ֔ים גַּם־מִמַּ֥עַל ׀ לְעֻמַּ֖ת הַבֶּ֣טֶן אֲשֶׁ֑ר לְעֵ֥בֶר שבכה

“And the capitals on the two pillars also from above, from near the belly that was on the other side of the network”

In the previous verse, the author described the upper part of each capital. In this verse, he describes the lower part of each capital, the part just **above** the pillars. As he specifies which part he is referring to, he

provides new information about the shape of this part. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could show in your translation that he is providing new information. Alternate translation: [And as for the part of the capitals just above the two pillars, the part that was on the other side of the network, it was shaped like a belly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:20 (#2)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר לְעֵבֶר שבכה

“that was on the other side of the network”

The author is describing the location of this part of the **capitals** relative to the **network** of bronze strands in a way characteristic of his culture. He means that if someone were looking at the capitals, they would see the network of bronze strands, and they would see the belly-shaped lower part of the capital behind or **on the other side of** those bronze strands. Express this in the way people of your culture describe the location of one thing relative to another, or use plain language to express the meaning. Alternate translation: [that was behind the network] or [that was covered by the network]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:20 (#4)

עַל הַכֹּתֶרֶת הַשֵּׁנִית

“on the second capital”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:18. Alternate translation: [on the first capital, and also on the second capital] or [on each capital]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:20 (#3)

וְהָרִמֹּנִֽים

“and the pomegranates”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [there the pomegranates]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 7:21 (#1)

וַיָּ֤קֶם אֶת־הָעַמֻּדִים֙

“And he set up the pillars”

The author is using Hiram, whom he represents with the pronoun **he**, one person who was involved in this action, to represent everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Hiram and his workers set up the pillars]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 7:21 (#3)

וַיִּקְרָ֛א אֶת־שְׁמ֥וֹ יָכִ֖ין

“and called its name Jachin”

It might seem that the expression **called its name** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and called it Jachin] or [and named it Jachin]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:21 (#2)

אֶת־הָעַמּ֣וּד הַיְמָנִ֔י & אֶת־הָעַמּ֖וּד הַשְּׂמְאלִ֑י

“the right pillar & the left pillar”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:8. Alternate translation: [the south pillar ... the north pillar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:22 (#1)

וְעַ֣ל רֹ֣אשׁ הָעַמּוּדִ֗ים מַעֲשֵׂ֤ה שׁוֹשָׁן֙ וַתִּתֹּ֣ם מְלֶ֔אכֶת הָעַמּוּדִֽים

“And on the head of the pillars {was} the work of a lily. And the work of the pillars was finished”

In this verse, the author is concluding his account of how Hiram cast massive pillars with ornate capitals for the temple porch. In the first sentence, he repeats what he said in 7:19 about the lily-shaped decorations on top of the capitals. That repetition signals the impending conclusion of the account, which ends in the next sentence with the author’s statement that once the pillars were set up, the work on them was **finished**. Use a natural form in your language for concluding an account with a brief summary of what it has described.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 7:22 (#2)

וַתִּתֹּ֣ם מְלֶ֔אכֶת הָעַמּוּדִֽים

“And the work of the pillars was finished”

The expression **was finished** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Hiram finished the work of the pillars]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:23 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ אֶת־הַיָּ֔ם מוּצָֽק

“And he made a cast sea”

Here, the term **cast** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he made a sea by casting it in bronze]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:23 (#3)

עֶ֚שֶׂר בָּֽאַמָּ֔ה

“ten by the cubit”

To translate the expression **by the cubit** here and in the rest of this chapter, see how you translated the same expression in 6:3 and throughout chapter 6. Alternate translation: [ten cubits wide]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:23 (#4)

מִשְּׂפָתוֹ֙ עַד־שְׂפָתֹ֔ו

“from its lip to its lip”

The author is using the term **lip** to mean the brim of this **sea**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly here and in verses 24 and 26. Alternate translation: [from one brim to the other] or [across its width]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:23 (#2)

אֶת־הַיָּ֔ם מוּצָֽק

“a cast sea”

This was a very large water basin. It was called a **sea** because it contained so much water. In your translation, you could indicate explicitly what it actually was if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:24 (#2)

עֶ֚שֶׂר בָּֽאַמָּ֔ה & שְׁנֵ֥י טוּרִ֖ים֙

“ten in a cubit & in} two rows”

It is not clear whether the author means that there were ten gourds per cubit in each row, for a total of 600, or ten gourds per cubit in both rows, for a total of 300. Since the meaning is uncertain, try to translate these expressions in a way that allows for both possibilities. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:24 (#1)

הַפְּקָעִ֗ים יְצֻקִ֛ים בְּיִצֻקָ֥תֹו

“The gourds were cast when it was cast”

The expressions **were cast** and **was cast** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use such forms, you could express this idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Hiram cast the gourds when he cast the sea]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:25 (#1)

בָּקָ֣ר

“cattle”

In this verse, the word **cattle** is singular in form, but it refers to these 12 bronze statues of bulls. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a plural form to express this meaning here and in verses 29 and 44. Alternate translation: [bulls]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 7:25 (#2)

שְׁלֹשָׁ֣ה פֹנִ֗ים ׀ צָפ֣וֹנָה וּשְׁלֹשָׁה֮ פֹּנִים֒ ׀ יָ֣מָּה וּשְׁלֹשָׁ֗ה ׀ פֹּנִ֤ים נֶ֙גְבָּה֙ וּשְׁלֹשָׁה֮ פֹּנִים֒ מִזְרָ֣חָה

“three facing northward and three facing westward and three facing southward and three facing eastward”

It might seem that repeating the phrase **three facing** four times would be extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could represent this phrase just once in your translation. Alternate translation: [which faced outward to the north, west, south, and east in groups of three]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:26 (#4)

אַלְפַּיִם בַּתּ֖וֹת יָכִ֑יל

“It contained 2,000 baths”

These **baths** were each equivalent to 22 liters or nearly six gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Kings 7:26 (#2)

וּשְׂפָתָ֗ו כְּמַעֲשֵׂ֤ה שְׂפַת־כּוֹס֙ פֶּ֣רַח שׁוֹשָׁ֔ן

“and its lip {was} like the work of the lip of a cup, the blossom of a lily”

This could mean: (1) that the shape of the **lip** or brim of the sea was like the shape of the **lip** or edge of a cup and like the shape of the **blossom of a lily**. Alternate translation: [and the brim of the sea was shaped like the edge of a cup and like the blossom of a lily] or (2) that the shape of the **lip** or brim of the sea was like the shape of the **lip** or edge of a cup and that it had decorations in the shape of the **blossom of a lily**. Alternate translation: [and the brim of the sea was shaped like the edge of a cup, and it had lily blossoms as decorations]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:26 (#1)

טֶ֔פַח

“was} a handbreadth”

A **handbreadth** was a unit of measurement corresponding to the width of a man’s hand measured across the palm, or about eight centimeters or about three and a half inches. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this width in modern measurements, either in the text of your translation or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Distance

1 Kings 7:26 (#3)

וּשְׂפָתָ֗ו כְּמַעֲשֵׂ֤ה שְׂפַת־כּוֹס֙ פֶּ֣רַח שׁוֹשָׁ֔ן

“and its lip {was} like the work of the lip of a cup, the blossom of a lily”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the lip of a cup** and **the blossom of a lily** curve outward, so the **lip** or brim of the sea curved outward. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and its brim was fashioned to curve outward, like the edge of a cup and like a lily blossom]

See: Simile

1 Kings 7:28 (#1)

הַמְּכוֹנָֽה

“the stand”

In this verse, the word **stand** is singular in form, but it refers to all the stands as a group. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the stands] or [each stand]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 7:29 (#2)

וּמִתַּ֨חַת֙ לָֽאֲרָיוֹת֙ וְלַבָּקָ֔ר לְיוֹת֙ מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה מוֹרָ֔ד

“and from below to the lions and to the cattle {were} wreaths, the work of descent”

The phrase **the work of descent** could indicate: (1) that these **wreaths** were crafted to appear as if they were hanging down from the panels. Alternate translation: [and below the lions and cattle were wreaths that appeared to hang down from the panels] or (2) that these **wreaths** were hammered or embossed onto the surface of the panels. Alternate translation: [and below the lions and cattle, wreath designs were worked into the panels]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:29 (#3)

וּמִתַּ֨חַת֙ לָֽאֲרָיוֹת֙ וְלַבָּקָ֔ר

“and from below to the lions and to the cattle”

As he did in 6:32, here the author also mentions only two of three terms he has introduced in a preceding sentence. You may wish to indicate that what he says applies to the third term as well. See what you did in 6:32. Alternate translation: [and below the lions, bulls, and cherubs]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:29 (#1)

וְעַל־הַשֶּׁלַבִּ֗ים כֵּ֚ן מִמָּ֣עַל וּמִתַּ֨חַת֙ לָֽאֲרָיוֹת֙ וְלַבָּקָ֔ר לְיוֹת֙ מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה מוֹרָ֔ד

“And on the frames {was} a pedestal from above, and from below to the lions and to the cattle {were} wreaths, the work of descent”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **wreaths** that

were below the **lions** and **cattle** in the first part of this sentence. That way it would follow directly from the author's introduction of these decorations in the previous sentence. Alternate translation: [And from below to the lions and to the cattle were wreaths, the work of descent, and on the frames was a pedestal from above]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 7:30 (#2)

לַכִּיֹּר

"to the basin"

The author assumes that his readers will know that each of these stands supported a **basin** in which the priests washed the parts of animals that they would burn as sacrifices. (The parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 4:6 says this specifically.) The author therefore assumes that readers will know that by **the basin**, he means the basin that each of these stands supported. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the basin that the stand supported]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:30 (#3)

הַכְּתֵפֹת יְצֻקֹות מֵעֵבֶר אֵצֶל לְיֹות

"The shoulders were cast on the side of each {with} wreaths"

The expression **were cast** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Hiram decorated the side of each support with wreaths that he cast in bronze]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:30 (#1)

וְאַרְבָּעָה & וְאַרְבָּעָה פַּעֲמֹתָיו כְּתֵפֹת לָהֶם מִתַּחַת לַכִּיֹּר

"And four & And its four corners, shoulders {were} to them, from below to the basin"

The author is using the term **shoulders** to mean supports for the **basin** that each stand held and transported. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And there were supports on the four corners of each stand to hold up a basin]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:31 (#3)

לַכֹּתֶרֶת

"the capital"

The author is using the term **capital** to describe the structure on top of the stand that he calls a **pedestal** later in this verse and in 7:29. He uses that term because the structure was placed on top of the stand, just like the decorative features on top of the pillars that he also calls "capitals" in 7:16–20. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the term "pedestal" here instead to make clear that the author is referring to that, not to the features of the pillars. Alternate translation: [the pedestal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:31 (#4)

וּפִּיהָ עָגֻל מַעֲשֵׂה־כֵן

"And its mouth {was} circular, the work of a pedestal"

See the discussion of the phrase **the work of** in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [And its mouth was circular because it was made to be a pedestal] or [And its mouth was circular so that it could serve as a pedestal]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:31 (#7)

וּמִסְגְּרֹתֵיהֶם מְרֻבָּעוֹת לֹא עֲגֻלֹות

"But their panels were square, not circular"

The pronoun **their** refers to the bronze stands. The author is repeating a detail he described in 7:27–28 to indicate that these stands had a combination of round and square elements. Alternate translation: [But the panels of the stands were square, not round]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 7:31 (#1)

וּפִיהוּ & וּפִּיהָ & פִּיהָ מִקְלָעֹות

"And its mouth & And its mouth & its mouth {were} carvings"

The pronoun translated as **its** in the first instance is masculine, so it refers to the "basin" described in the previous verse. The pronoun translated as **its** in the second and third instances is feminine, so it refers to the **capital**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the mouth of the

basin ... And the mouth of the capital ... the mouth of the capital]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 7:31 (#2)

וּפִֽיהוּ & וּפִֽיהָהּ

“And its mouth & And its mouth”

The author is using the term **mouth** in these first two instances to mean the openings of the basin and the capital. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the opening of the basin ... And the opening of the capital]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:31 (#5)

אַמָּ֣ה וָחֵצִ֔י הָאַמָּ֖ה

“a cubit and half of a cubit”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [it was a cubit and half of a cubit across]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:31 (#6)

וְגַם־עַל־פִּֽי־הָהּ֙ מִקְלָעֹ֔ות

“and also on its mouth {were} carvings”

Here, the **mouth** or opening of the capital (pedestal) represents the rim around that opening. The author means that there were **carvings** on the rim of the pedestal, just as there were on the rim of the sea, as he describes in 7:24. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and there were also carvings around the rim of the pedestal]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 7:32 (#2)

וִֽידֹ֣ות הָאֹופַנִּ֔ים בַּמְּכֹונָ֖ה

“and the hands of the wheels {were} in the stand”

When he says that the **hands of the wheels** were **in the stand**, the author means that the axles of the wheels were cast as part of the stand itself, rather than as separate pieces that were added afterwards. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the axles of the wheels were cast as part of the stand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:32 (#1)

וִֽידֹ֣ות הָאֹופַנִּ֔ים בַּמְּכֹונָ֖ה

“and the hands of the wheels {were} in the stand”

The author is using the term **hands** to mean axles of the wheels, which he describes in 7:30. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and the next verse. Alternate translation: [and the axles of the wheels were in the stand]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:33 (#2)

יְדֹותָ֣ם וְגַבֵּיהֶ֔ם וְחִשֻּׁקֵיהֶ֖ם וְחִשֻּׁרֵיהֶ֑ם הַכֹּ֖ל מוּצָֽק

“Their hands and their rims and their spokes and their hubs, the whole was cast”

The expression **was cast** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Hiram cast every part of these wheels from bronze, including their axles, rims, spokes, and hubs]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:33 (#1)

וּמַעֲשֵׂה֙ הָאֹופַנִּ֔ים כְּמַעֲשֵׂ֖ה אֹופַ֣ן הַמֶּרְכָּבָ֑ה

“And the work of the wheels {was} like the work of the wheel of a chariot”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the wheel of a chariot** is open, with **spokes** connecting the rim to the hub, so the **wheels** of these stands were open, with **spokes**, **rims**, and **hubs**. In this culture, carts designed to bear heavy loads had solid wooden wheels. The author is indicating Hiram’s skill and ingenuity in casting open metal wheels that could support the weight of the water that the basin held (900 kilograms or 2,000 pounds) in addition to the weight of the bronze basin itself and its bronze stand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Hiram made the wheels open, like chariot wheels, but they were still able to support the weight of the stand and its basin when it was full of water]

See: Simile

1 Kings 7:34 (#1)

וְאַרְבַּע כְּתֵפוֹת אֶל אַרְבַּע פִּנּוֹת הַמְּכֹנָה הָאֶחָת מִן־הַמְּכֹנָה כְּתֵפֶיהָ

“And four shoulders {were} to the four corners of one stand, from the stand {were} its shoulders”

If it would not be natural in your language to repeat the terms **four** and **shoulders**, you could shorten this description. Alternate translation: [And the shoulders that were to the four corners of one stand were from the stand] or [And the supports on the four corners of the base were cast as part of the base itself]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:35 (#3)

יְדֹתֶיהָ

“its hands”

In this context, the author is probably using the term **hands** to mean support bars that held the pedestal securely in place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and the next verse. Alternate translation: [its support bars]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:35 (#1)

וּבְרֹאשׁ הַמְּכוֹנָה חֲצִי הָאַמָּה קוֹמָה עָגֻל ׀ סָבִיב

“And on the head of the stand, half of a cubit {was} the height, circular all around”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And on the head of the stand there was a pedestal, half of a cubit was its height, and it was circular all around]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:35 (#2)

וּבְרֹאשׁ הַמְּכוֹנָה

“And on the head of the stand”

As in 7:16–22, the author is using the term **head** to mean “top.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [And on the top of each stand]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:36 (#2)

עַל־הַלֻּחֹתֹת יְדֹתֶיהָ וְעַלְ ומסגרתיה כְּרוּבִים אְרָיוֹת וְתִמֹרֹת כְּמַעַר־אִישׁ וְלִיוֹת סָבִיב

“cherubs, lions, and palm trees on the plates of its hands and on its panels, according to the bare space of each, and wreaths all around”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **wreaths all around** with the information about the carvings of **cherubs, lions, and palm trees**. Alternate translation: [cherubs, lions, and palm trees and wreaths all around on the plates of its hands and on its panels, according to the bare space of each]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 7:36 (#1)

וַיְפַתַּח

“And he engraved”

The pronoun **he** refers to Hiram. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Hiram engraved]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 7:37 (#1)

כָּזֹאת עָשָׂה אֵת עֲשֶׂר הַמְּכֹנָוֹת

“Like this he made the ten stands”

In this verse, the author is concluding the account he gives in 7:27–37 of how Hiram cast these **ten stands** to hold and transport water basins in the temple area. Use a natural form in your language for concluding an account.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 7:38 (#1)

אַרְבָּעִים בַּתּ יָכִיל ׀ הַכִּיּוֹר & הָאֶחָד

“One basin contained 40 baths”

These **baths** were each equivalent to 22 liters or nearly six gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote. See what you did in 7:26.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Kings 7:38 (#2)

הָאֶחָד & כִּיּוֹר & עַל־הַמְּכוֹנָה הָאֶחַת לְעֶשֶׂר הַמְּכֹנוֹת

“One basin {was} on one stand, for the ten stands”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [One basin was on each of the ten stands]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 7:39 (#2)

עַל־כֶּ֙תֶף הַבַּ֣יִת מִיָּמִ֔ין & כֶּ֖תֶף הַבַּ֣יִת מִשְּׂמֹאלֹ֑ו

“on the shoulder of the house from the right & the shoulder of the house from its left”

See the discussion in a note to 6:8 of how, in these descriptions of the temple, the author is speaking of directions in the way that is characteristic of his culture. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate the directions he is speaking of, particularly since he uses the terms **eastward** and **south** later in the verse. Alternate translation: [in front of the south side of the temple ... in front of the north side of the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:39 (#3)

מִכֶּ֙תֶף הַבַּ֣יִת הַיְמָנִ֔ית קֵ֖דְמָה מִמּ֥וּל נֶֽגֶב

“from the right shoulder of the house, eastward toward the south”

By **from the right shoulder of the house, eastward toward the south**, the author means at the southeast corner of the temple. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in front of the southeast corner of the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:39 (#1)

עַל־כֶּ֙תֶף הַבַּ֣יִת מִיָּמִ֔ין & כֶּ֖תֶף הַבַּ֣יִת מִשְּׂמֹאלֹ֑ו

“on the shoulder of the house from the right & the shoulder of the house from its left”

As in 6:8, the author is using the term **shoulder** to mean the side of the **house** or temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in front of the right side of the temple ... in front of the left side of the temple]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:40 (#2)

וַיְכַ֣ל חִירָ֔ם לַֽעֲשׂ֖וֹת אֶת־כָּל־הַמְּלָאכָ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֛ה לַמֶּ֥לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה בֵּ֣ית יְהוָֽה

“And Hiram finished doing all of the work that he did for King Solomon {for} the house of Yahweh”

Beginning with this sentence and continuing through the next five verses, the author concludes his entire account in 7:13–40 of how Hiram made many types of bronze items for Yahweh’s temple. In the next five verses, he gives a summary of all the items, and in this sentence, he introduces that summary. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the conclusion of an account that summarizes what it has described.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 7:40 (#1)

אֶת־הַכִּיֹּרֹ֖ות

“basins”

Some ancient manuscripts read “basins.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “pots,” as in the summary in 7:45. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 7:41 (#1)

וְגֻלֹּ֖ת הַכֹּתָרֹ֑ת

“and the bowls of the capitals”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **capitals** that were in the shape of **bowls**. (This refers to the bottom part of the capitals, as 7:20 indicates.) If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the bowl-shaped capitals]

See: Possession

1 Kings 7:41 (#2)

רֹ֣אשׁ הָֽעַמּוּדִ֗ים שְׁתָּ֫יִם

“the head of the two pillars”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:16. Alternate translation: [the tops of the two pillars]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:42 (#1)

פְּנֵי הָעַמּוּדִים

“the faces of the pillars”

The author is using the term **faces** to mean the tops of these **pillars**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the tops of the pillars]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 7:44 (#1)

הַבָּקָר שְׁנֵים־עָשָׂר

“the 12 cattle”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:25. Alternate translation: [the 12 bulls]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 7:45 (#1)

נְחֹשֶׁת מְמֹרָט

“were} polished bronze”

Here, the term **polished** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [were bronze that workers polished after Hiram cast them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:46 (#1)

יְצָקָם הַמֶּלֶךְ

“the king cast them”

The author is using **the king** (Solomon, who directed this action) to represent everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Hiram and his workers cast them, as the king had commissioned them to do]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 7:46 (#2)

בְּמַעֲבֵה הָאֲדָמָה

“in the clay of the ground”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **ground** that consists largely of **clay**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in the clayey ground]

See: Possession

1 Kings 7:47 (#3)

לֹא נֶחְקַר מִשְׁקַל הַנְּחֹשֶׁת

“The weight of the bronze was not sought out”

The expression **was not determined** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one determined the weight of the bronze]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 7:47 (#1)

וַיַּנַּח שְׁלֹמֹה אֶת־כָּל־הַכֵּלִים

“And Solomon let all of the vessels rest”

The author is speaking of these **vessels** as if they had been living things that could **rest**. (He is speaking as if weighing the vessels would have caused them some exertion.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Solomon did not weigh the vessels]

See: Personification

1 Kings 7:47 (#2)

מֵרֹב מְאֹד מְאֹד

“from great, great abundance”

The author is repeating the word **great** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [because Hiram used such a great abundance of bronze to make them]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 7:48 (#2)

לֶחֶם הַפָּנִים

“was} the bread of the face”

Here, the term **face** represents the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [was the Bread of the Presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 7:48 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַשֻּׁלְחָן אֲשֶׁר עָלָיו לֶחֶם הַפָּנִים זָהָב

“and the table that on it {was} the bread of the face, gold”

The author specifies that this **table** was made of **gold** after describing the table itself in order to emphasize that it was made from that precious metal. If it would be more natural in your language, here and in the next two verses, you could use the adjective “golden” within the description of the articles themselves to provide the information that these vessels for the house of Yahweh were made of gold. Alternate translation: [and the golden table that had the bread of the face on it]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 7:49 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the inner sanctuary. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 7:49 (#1)

וְחָמֵשׁ

“and five”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the five lampstands]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 7:49 (#3)

וְהַפְּרָחִ

“and the blossom”

In this verse, the word **blossom** is singular in form, but it refers to all the floral decorations as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “blossom” or an equivalent term. Alternate translation: [and the blossoms] or [and the flowers]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 7:49 (#4)

וְהַפְּרָחִ

“and the blossom”

The author assumes that readers will know that the golden lampstand in the sacred tent had decorations of flowers, and so Solomon had his workers make **lampstands** of a similar design for the temple. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the floral designs on the lampstands]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 7:50 (#1)

וְהַכַּפּוֹת

“and the palms”

The author is using the term **palms** to mean some implement that the priests used in the temple area that had a cupped shape. This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [incense dishes] or (2) Alternate translation: [spoons] or [ladles]

See: Idiom

1 Kings - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues to describe Solomon’s reign as king of Israel.

1. Solomon brings the ark into the temple (8:1–11)
2. Solomon tells the Israelites how the temple fulfills Yahweh’s promise (8:12–21)
3. Solomon dedicates the temple by praying to Yahweh (8:22–53)
4. Prayer for Yahweh to confirm David’s descendants as kings (8:22–26)
5. General request for Yahweh to hear prayers addressed to him in the temple (8:27–30)
6. Request for Yahweh to do justice when people swear oaths at the temple (8:31–32)
7. Request for Yahweh to help the Israelites after enemies defeat them (8:33–34)
8. Request for Yahweh to help the Israelites during famine and plague (8:35–40)
9. Request for Yahweh to answer the prayers of foreigners (8:41–43)

10. Request for Yahweh to help the Israelites when he tells them to fight enemies (8:44–45)
11. Request for Yahweh to bring back Israelites who are exiled (8:46–50)
12. Conclusion: Affirmation of God's Covenant (8:52–53)
13. Solomon blesses the congregation, offers sacrifices, and hosts a feast (8:54–66).

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The transfer of the Box of the Covenant to the temple
At the beginning of this chapter, the author describes how Solomon gathered the Israelite leaders for a ceremony to transfer the Box of the Covenant of Yahweh to a permanent home in the temple. The Box was the most sacred object in ancient Israel. It contained the stone tablets that Moses had put inside it when Yahweh met with the Israelites at Mount Sinai and made his covenant with them. Yahweh was understood to be present in a special way above the Box. Placing the Box in the Holy of Holies inside the temple made it the true center of Israelite worship. The fact that the priests could no longer see the Box once it was placed in the innermost sanctuary emphasized its immense holiness and the sacredness of God's presence.

Solomon's allusions to Deuteronomy in his prayer of dedication
Most of this chapter consists of Solomon's prayer of dedication for the temple. In that prayer, he makes many allusions to what Moses said in the book of Deuteronomy, especially the warnings of what would happen to the Israelites if they were disobedient. In chapters 28 and 30 of Deuteronomy, Moses warned of consequences such as famine, disaster, defeat, and exile if the people turned away from Yahweh. In his prayer, Solomon echoes this language as he prays about such consequences. At the same time, similarly echoing what Moses said, Solomon repeatedly asks that if the Israelites repent, confess their sins, and pray toward the temple, even from exile, Yahweh will hear from heaven, forgive their sins, and restore them. If you have already translated the book of Deuteronomy, try to translate phrases from that book that also appear in Solomon's prayer the same way you translated them there. This will help readers recognize how Solomon is acknowledging the promises that Yahweh made through Moses and praying that he will fulfill them.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you, may you hear"

As he asks Yahweh to "hear" (answer) prayers, several times Solomon states the pronoun "you" separately, even though the verb translated as "may you hear" already includes this meaning. He does that to ask that this action take place at the same time as the action of someone making a "supplication." (It is clear that this is the significance of this construction from the way Solomon says "when" or "if" to introduce some other circumstances under which people would pray and under which he is asking Yahweh to respond.) If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning, here and in the rest of the chapter. (See: Pronouns — When to Use Them)

1 Kings 8:1 (#1)

רָאשֵׁ֣י הַמַּטּ֔וֹת

"the heads of the tribes"

Here, **heads** means "leaders." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the tribes]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:1 (#5)

לְהַעֲלוֹת

"to bring up"

To translate this expression and the similar one, "brought up" in verse 4, see how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [to bring]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:1 (#2)

הָאָבֹ֖ת

"fathers of"

The author is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He is using the word **fathers** to mean "father's houses." In ancient Israel, that expression described extended families, comprising three or four generations, led by a man who was the father, grandfather, or great-grandfather of he family members. The household also included servants. You can supply this word in your translation or use an equivalent expression. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated the similar expression in Joshua

14:1. Alternate translation: [father's houses of] or [extended families of]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:1 (#6)

מֵעִ֣יר דָּוִ֔ד הִ֖יא צִיּ֑וֹן

"from the City of David (it {is} Zion"

The author is providing background information to help readers recognize that **the City of David** was the name that people used at this time for the part of Jerusalem that they knew as **Zion**. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 8:1 (#7)

מֵעִ֣יר דָּוִ֔ד הִ֖יא צִיּ֑וֹן

"from the City of David (it {is} Zion"

The author assumes that readers will know that Solomon gathered these leaders to bring the Box from the City of David to the temple he had built. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from the City of David (it is Zion) to the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:1 (#3)

לִבְנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

"the sons of Israel"

To translate the expression **the sons of Israel** here and in verses 9 and 63, see how you translated that expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:1 (#4)

אֶל־הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה

"to King Solomon"

Since the author has already mentioned Solomon earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [to himself]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:2 (#6)

בֶּחָ֑ג

"at the feast"

By **at the feast**, the author means the Feast of Booths (sometimes called the Feast of Tabernacles). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to celebrate the Feast of Booths]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:2 (#1)

כָּל־אִ֣ישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"all of the men of Israel"

Here the masculine term **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [all of the people of Israel]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 8:2 (#3)

בְּיֶ֣רַח הָאֵתָנִ֔ים בֶּחָ֖ג הַה֣וּא הַחֹ֑דֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִֽי

"in the month of Ethanim, at the feast (it {is} the seventh month"

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about that this was **the seventh month** with the information that it was **the month of Ethanim**. Alternate translation: [in the month of Ethanim (it is the seventh month), at the feast]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 8:2 (#4)

בְּיֶ֣רַח הָאֵתָנִ֔ים בֶּחָ֖ג הַה֣וּא הַחֹ֑דֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִֽי

"in the month of Ethanim, at the feast (it {is} the seventh month"

The author is providing background information to help readers recognize that **Ethanim** was the official name at this time for the month that they knew simply as **the seventh month**. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 8:2 (#2)

כָּל־אִ֣ישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"all of the men of Israel"

The author is saying **all of the men of Israel** as an generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [a great number of Israelites]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 8:2 (#5)

הָאֵתָנִים

“Ethanim”

The **seventh month** of the Hebrew calendar, here called **Ethanim**, includes the last part of September and the first part of October on Western calendars. You could convert the Hebrew day and month into an approximate date on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the date will be different every year, and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may just want to give the number of the day and the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar and say in a footnote approximately what time of year that is on your calendar.

See: Hebrew Months

1 Kings 8:4 (#1)

כָּל־כְּלֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ

“all of the vessels of holiness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the idea of **holiness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the holy vessels] or [the consecrated vessels]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 8:5 (#2)

לִפְנֵי הָאָרוֹן

“to the face of the Box”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the Box. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of the Box]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:5 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִסָּפְרוּ וְלֹא יִמָּנוּ

“that were not counted and were not numbered”

The expressions **were not counted** and **were not numbered** mean similar things. The author is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [that could not be counted at all]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:5 (#1)

וְכָל־עֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הַנּוֹעָדִים עָלָיו

“and all of the congregation of Israel, the ones having congregated themselves to him”

The author is saying **all** as a generalization for emphasis. He clarifies in the next phrase that he means specifically all those Israelites who had **congregated themselves** in Jerusalem for this occasion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and the great crowd of Israelites who had congregated themselves to him]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 8:5 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִסָּפְרוּ וְלֹא יִמָּנוּ

“that were not counted and were not numbered”

The expressions **were not counted** and **were not numbered** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use such forms, you could express these ideas with active forms or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that no one could count or number] or [that no one could count at all]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:6 (#1)

אֶל־דְּבִיר הַבַּיִת אֶל־קֹדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים

“into the inner sanctuary of the house, into the Holy of Holies”

The author is providing background information to help readers recognize that by **the inner sanctuary** he means the part of the temple that they may have known as **the Holy of Holies**. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [into the inner sanctuary of the house, that is, into the Holy of Holies]

See: Background Information

1 Kings 8:6 (#2)

הַבַּיִת

“the house”

See how you translated the term “house” in 3:1. Alternate translation: [the temple]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:7 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

The word **For** introduces not a reason but background information, a reminder of the description of the cherubs in 6:27 and of how their touching outspread wings created a reverential **place** for the ark. It may be natural in your language to use a term here that introduces background information. Alternate translation: [Now]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:8 (#4)

וְלֹ֣א יֵרָא֔וּ הַחֻ֖צָה

“but they were not seen on the outside”

The expression **were not seen** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but no one outside the temple could see them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:8 (#3)

עַל־פְּנֵ֣י הַדְּבִ֑יר

“at the face of the inner sanctuary”

Here, **at the face of** represents being in front of the inner sanctuary. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of the inner sanctuary] or [through the entrance to the inner sanctuary]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:8 (#5)

עַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“to this day”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to 1 Kings. The author is using this phrase to refer to the time when he was writing. In your translation, make clear that the phrase refers to a time that is now in the past. Avoid giving the impression the phrase means “to the present day.” If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 5:5. Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:8 (#1)

וַיֵּרָא֣וּ רָאשֵׁ֔י הַבַּדִּ֖ים

“and the heads of the poles were seen”

The expression **were seen** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the priests could see the heads of the poles]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:8 (#2)

רָאשֵׁ֔י הַבַּדִּ֖ים

“the heads of the poles”

The author is using the term **heads** to mean the ends of these **poles**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ends of the poles]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:9 (#2)

בְּחֹרֵ֑ב

“at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also called Mount Sinai in other passages in the Bible.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 8:9 (#1)

אֵ֣ין בָּאָרֹ֗ן רַ֚ק שְׁנֵי֙ לֻחֹ֣ת הָאֲבָנִ֔ים

“Nothing {was} in the Box except the two tablets of stone”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Kings 8:9 (#3)

כָּרַת

“cut”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [cut a covenant]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:9 (#4)

כָּרַת

“cut”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:12. Alternate translation: [made a covenant]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:10 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 8:10 (#2)

וְהֶעָנָן

“that the cloud”

The implication is that this was the special cloud that manifested Yahweh’s presence. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the cloud that manifested Yahweh’s presence]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:11 (#1)

וְלֹא־יָכְלוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים לַעֲמֹד לְשָׁרֵת מִפְּנֵי הֶעָנָן

“And the priests were not able to stand to minister from the face of the cloud”

The author is using **from the face of** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the priests were not able to stand to minister because of the cloud]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:11 (#2)

וְלֹא־יָכְלוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים לַעֲמֹד לְשָׁרֵת מִפְּנֵי הֶעָנָן

“And the priests were not able to stand to minister from the face of the cloud”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because of the cloud, the priests were not able to stand to minister]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:11 (#4)

כִּי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [This was because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:11 (#3)

לַעֲמֹד לְשָׁרֵת

“to stand to minister”

The author is using **stand to minister** as a common expression of his culture to mean “continue to minister” or “keep performing their duties.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to continue to minister] or [to keep ministering]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:12 (#1)

יְהוָה אָמַר לִשְׁכֹּן בָּעֲרָפֶל

“Yahweh said he would dwell in a dark cloud”

Some ancient manuscripts read, “Yahweh said he would dwell in a dark cloud.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read, “For Yahweh set the sun in the heavens, but he said he would dwell in a thick cloud.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it

uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 8:12 (#2)

יְהוָה אָמַר לִשְׁכֹּן בָּעֲרָפֶל

“Yahweh said he would dwell in a dark cloud”

Solomon assumes that his listeners will know that he referring to what **Yahweh said** to Moses about how he would be present with the Box when it was in the tent of meeting, “I will appear in a cloud over the atonement lid” (Leviticus 16:2). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh told Moses that he would dwell in a dark cloud in the sacred tent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:13 (#4)

עוֹלָמִים

“for} ages”

Solomon is using the plural **ages** where Hebrew speakers commonly used a singular form and said “to forever” (as Bathsheba does in 1:31, for example). This suggests that he is using the plural form to emphasize that he hopes that Yahweh will be present in this temple not just for as long as anyone in the present age can imagine but for all ages to come. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a singular form and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [for an immeasurable span of time]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Kings 8:13 (#2)

בָּנֹה בָנִיתִי

“Building, I have built”

Solomon is repeating forms of the verb “build” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I have indeed built]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 8:13 (#3)

בֵּית זְבֶל לָךְ מָכוֹן לְשִׁבְתְּךָ עוֹלָמִים

“a house of habitation for you, a place for your dwelling {for} ages”

The terms **house of habitation** and **place for your dwelling** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [a house that can always be your dwelling]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:13 (#1)

בָּנֹה בָנִיתִי בֵּית זְבֶל לָךְ מָכוֹן לְשִׁבְתְּךָ עוֹלָמִים

“Building, I have built a house of habitation for you, a place for your dwelling {for} ages”

After speaking to the people, Solomon is now speaking to Yahweh. He could be saying: (1) that Yahweh’s appearance in a cloud in the temple confirms that Yahweh will indeed dwell in this temple. Alternate translation: [So it is clear that you are going to dwell in this house that I have built for you to live in] or (2) that while Yahweh said he would live in a cloud, Solomon has instead built him a splendid temple to live in. (The word translated as **habitation** might also mean [exaltation.]) Alternate translation: [But I have built a splendid temple for you in which you can always dwell]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:14 (#2)

וְכָל־קְהַל יִשְׂרָאֵל עֹמֵד

“Now all of the assembly of Israel was standing”

The people were **standing** as a symbolic action that showed respect for Yahweh and for King Solomon and expressed their eagerness to receive a blessing from Solomon as Yahweh’s representative. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Now all of the Israelites who were present were standing to express their respect and expectation]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 8:14 (#1)

וַיַּסֵּב הַמֶּלֶךְ אֶת־פָּנָיו

“And the king turned his face around”

The author is using one part of Solomon, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of turning around. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the

meaning plainly. See the discussion of this use of the term “face” in the introduction to 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [And the king turned around to face the people]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 8:15 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר֩ דִּבֶּ֨ר בְּפִ֜יו אֶת־דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֗י וּבְיָדֹו֙ מִלֵּ֔א

“who spoke by his mouth to David my father and fulfilled by his hand”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that Yahweh has now **fulfilled** something **by his hand** before the information that this was something he **spoke by his mouth**. Alternate translation: [who has fulfilled by his hand what he spoke by his mouth to David my father]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 8:15 (#1)

בָּר֣וּךְ יְהוָ֔ה

“Blessed {be} Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:48. Alternate translation: [May people bless Yahweh] or [May people praise Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:15 (#3)

וּבְיָדֹו֙ מִלֵּ֔א

“and fulfilled by his hand”

Here, **hand** represents the power of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and fulfilled by his own action]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:16 (#5)

לִֽהְיֹ֥ות שְׁמִ֖י שָׁ֑ם

“for my name to be there”

To translate this expression and the similar ones in the rest of this chapter, see how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [for people to worship me there] or [to make my reputation known there]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:16 (#1)

מִן־הַיֹּ֗ום אֲשֶׁ֤ר הֹוצֵ֙אתִי֙ אֶת־עַמִּ֣י & יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל מִמִּצְרַ֖יִם לֹֽא־בָחַ֣רְתִּי בְעִ֑יר מִכֹּ֣ל שִׁבְטֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל לִבְנֹ֤ות בַּ֙יִת֙ לִֽהְיֹ֣ות שְׁמִ֔י שָׁ֖ם וָאֶבְחַ֥ר בְּדָוִ֖ד לִֽהְיֹ֥ות עַל־עַמִּ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“From the day when I brought out my people, Israel, from Egypt, I did not choose a city from all of the tribes of Israel to build a house for my name to be there. But I chose David to be over my people Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [that from the day when he brought out his people Israel from Egypt, he did not choose a city from all of the tribes of Israel to build a house for his name to be there. But he did choose David to be over his people Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 8:16 (#2)

הַיֹּ֗ום

“the day”

Yahweh is using the term **day** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:16 (#3)

בְעִ֑יר מִכֹּ֣ל שִׁבְטֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל לִבְנֹ֤ות בַּ֙יִת֙

“a city from all of the tribes of Israel to build a house”

Yahweh is not speaking of a **city** that would **build a house** for him. He is speaking of a city where such a temple would be located. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [a city from all of the tribes of Israel in which to have a temple built]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:16 (#4)

מִכֹּ֣ל שִׁבְטֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל

“from all of the tribes of Israel”

Here, **tribes** represents the territories in which the tribes lived. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from anywhere within the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:16 (#6)

וָאֶבְחַר בְּדָוִד

“But I chose David”

Yahweh was speaking of David in the third person, even though he was addressing him directly. That is because he was making a proclamation similar to the one in 2:45. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [But I chose you, David]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 8:16 (#7)

לִֽהְיוֹת עַל־עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to be over my people Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:4. Alternate translation: [to rule my people Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:17 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ עִם־לְבַ֣ב דָּוִ֔ד אָבִ֖י לִבְנ֣וֹת בַּ֑יִת

“And it was with the heart of David my father to build a house”

Solomon is using **it was with the heart of David** as a common expression of his culture to mean “David earnestly wanted” or “David strongly desired.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [And David my father had his heart set on building a house] or [And David my father earnestly wanted to build a house]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:18 (#2)

יַ֣עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָיָ֣ה עִם־לְבָבְךָ֔ לִבְנ֖וֹת בַּ֣יִת לִשְׁמִ֑י הֱטִיבֹ֣תָ כִּֽי־הָיָ֔ה עִם־לְבָבֶֽךָ

“Because it was with your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was with your heart”

It might seem that repeating the expression **it was with your heart** would be to convey extra information in a way that was not natural in your language. If so, you could shorten represent this expression only once in your translation. Alternate translation: [You did well to have it with your heart to build a house for my name]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:18 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֶל־דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֔י יַ֣עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָיָ֣ה עִם־לְבָבְךָ֔ לִבְנ֖וֹת בַּ֣יִת לִשְׁמִ֑י הֱטִיבֹ֣תָ כִּֽי־הָיָ֔ה עִם־לְבָבֶֽךָ

“But Yahweh said to David my father, ‘Because it was with your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was with your heart”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh told David my father that because it was with his heart to build a house for his name, he did well that it was with his heart]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 8:18 (#3)

לְבָבְךָ֔ & הֱטִיבֹ֣תָ

“your heart & you did well”

The words **you** and **your** are singular here and in the next verse because they refer to David. So use singular forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 8:19 (#1)

רַ֗ק אַתָּה֙ לֹ֣א תִבְנֶ֣ה הַבַּ֔יִת כִּ֣י אִם־בִּנְךָ֗ הַיֹּצֵ֤א מֵֽחֲלָצֶ֙יךָ֙ הֽוּא־יִבְנֶ֥ה הַבַּ֖יִת לִשְׁמִֽי

“However, you, you will not build the house, but rather your son coming out from your loins, he, he will build the house for my name”

If you translated the previous verse so that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [However, he, David, would not build the house, but rather his son coming out from his loins, he would be the one to build the house for his name]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 8:19 (#3)

בִּנְךָ֗ הַיֹּצֵ֤א מֵֽחֲלָצֶ֙יךָ֙

“your son coming out from your loins”

The implication of the expression **coming out from your loins** is that David would be the actual father of this son (that is, this would not be an adopted or foster son). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 7:12. Alternate translation: [your own biological son]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:19 (#2)

אַתָּ֣ה לֹ֤א תִבְנֶ֙ה֙ & הִ֣וא־יִבְנֶ֔ה

“you, you will not build & he, he will build”

Yahweh is stating the pronouns **you** and **he** separately, even though the verbs translated as **you will build** and **he will build** already include their meanings. He is doing that in order to emphasize a contrast. See how you translated the expression “he, he cursed” in 2:8, which similarly emphasizes a contrast. Alternate translation: [you will not be the one who will build ... he will be the one who will build]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 8:20 (#3)

וָאֵשֵׁ֣ב עַל־כִּסֵּא֮ יִשְׂרָאֵל֒

“and I sit on the throne of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [and I am ruling the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:20 (#1)

וַיָּ֤קֶם יְהוָה֙ אֶת־דְּבָר֔וֹ אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֵּ֖ר

“And Yahweh has raised up his word that he spoke”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh has made happen the things that he described]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:20 (#2)

וָאָקֻ֗ם תַּחַת֙ דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֔י

“And I have arisen in place of David my father”

Solomon is speaking as if he had actually arisen or stood up in place of David. He means that he has taken his late father’s former role as king. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I have taken the place of David my father] or [And I have succeeded David my father]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:21 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־שָׁ֣ם בְּרִית־יְהוָ֔ה

“where the Covenant of Yahweh {is} there”

It might seem that the expression **where the Covenant of Yahweh is there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where the Covenant of Yahweh is] or [that contains the Covenant of Yahweh]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:21 (#3)

כָּרַ֥ת

“he cut”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:9. Alternate translation: [he made]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:21 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־שָׁ֣ם בְּרִית־יְהוָ֔ה

“where the Covenant of Yahweh {is} there”

Here, the **Covenant of Yahweh** represents the two stone tablets that the author describes in 8:9, on which the terms of the covenant between Yahweh and the Israelites were written. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [where the two stone tablets are] or [that contains the two stone tablets]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:21 (#4)

אֲבֹתֵ֑ינוּ

“our fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:22 (#3)

וַיִּפְרֹ֖שׂ כַּפָּ֑יו הַשָּׁמָֽיִם

“And he spread out his palms to the heavens”

Based on what the author says in 8:54, that Solomon got up “from bowing on his knees with his palms spread out toward the heavens,” the author means implicitly here that when Solomon assumed a posture of prayer by raising his hands, he also knelt down. The parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 6:13 states this specifically. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he knelt down and spread out his palms to the heavens]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:22 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

In this context, this expression indicates that Solomon turned around again and faced the altar of burnt offerings that was in the temple court. (While he was **in front of** the crowd of Israelites from their perspective, from his perspective, they were behind him.) Alternate translation: [facing]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:22 (#2)

וַיִּפְרֹשׂ כַּפָּיו הַשָּׁמָיִם

“And he spread out his palms to the heavens”

Spreading out **his palms toward the heavens** was a symbolic action by which Solomon showed he was praying to God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And he spread out his palms to the heavens in prayer] or [And he assumed a posture of prayer]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 8:23 (#4)

בְּכָל־לִבָּם

“with all of their heart”

Here, the **heart** represents people’s motives and desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in complete devotion]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:23 (#2)

לַעֲבָדֶיךָ

“with your servants”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [with us, your servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 8:23 (#1)

לַעֲבָדֶיךָ & לְפָנֶיךָ

“with your servants & to your face”

The word **your** is singular here and through verse 53 because it refers to Yahweh. (In the expression “your sons” in 8:25, it is also singular, since it refers to David.) So use singular forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 8:23 (#3)

הַהֹלְכִים לְפָנֶיךָ

“walking to your face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [who live as they should in your presence]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:24 (#3)

כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“as this day”

Solomon is using **as this day** as a common expression of his culture to mean “as is true right now” or “as can be seen at this present time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as is the case right now]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:24 (#2)

וַתְּדַבֵּר בְּפִיךָ וּבְיָדְךָ מִלֵּאתָ

“And you spoke with your mouth, and by your hand you fulfilled”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:15. Alternate translation: [And you have fulfilled by your hand what you spoke by your mouth]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 8:24 (#1)

אֵת אֲשֶׁר־דִּבַּרְתָּ לֽוֹ

“what you spoke to him”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [just as you spoke to him]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:25 (#2)

לֵאמֹר֮ לֹא־יִכָּרֵת֣ לְךָ֣ אִישׁ֮ מִלְּפָנַי֒ יֹשֵׁ֣ב עַל־כִּסֵּא֮ יִשְׂרָאֵל֒ רַ֗ק
אִם־יִשְׁמְרוּ֙ בָּנֶ֔יךָ אֶת־דַּרְכָּם֙ לָלֶ֣כֶת לְפָנַ֔י כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר הָלַ֖כְתָּ לְפָנָֽי

“saying, ‘A man to you will not be cut off from to my face, sitting on the throne of Israel, if only your sons will keep their way, to walk to my face just as you have walked to my face”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him that a man to him would not be cut off from to your face, sitting on the throne of Israel, if only his sons would keep their way, to walk to your face just as he had walked to your face]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 8:25 (#4)

יִשְׁמְרוּ֙ בָּנֶ֔יךָ אֶת־דַּרְכָּם֙ לָלֶ֣כֶת לְפָנַ֔י כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר הָלַ֖כְתָּ לְפָנָֽי

“your sons will keep their way, to walk to my face just as you have walked to my face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [your descendants will live as they should in my presence, just as you have lived in my presence]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:25 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֗ה

“And now”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:25 (#3)

לֹא־יִכָּרֵת֣ לְךָ֣ אִישׁ֮ מִלְּפָנַי֒ יֹשֵׁ֣ב עַל־כִּסֵּא֮ יִשְׂרָאֵל֒

“A man to you will not be cut off from to my face, sitting on the throne of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [One of your descendants will always rule as the king of Israel in my presence]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:26 (#1)

יֵאָמֶן נָא֙ דבריך אֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבַּ֔רְתָּ לְעַבְדְּךָ֖ דָּוִ֣ד אָבִֽי

“may your word please be confirmed that you spoke to your servant David, my father”

Solomon is using the term **word** to represent what God said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may what you said when you spoke to your servant David, my father, please be confirmed]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:26 (#2)

יֵאָמֶן נָא֙ דבריך אֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבַּ֔רְתָּ

“may your word please be confirmed that you spoke”

The expression **may ... be confirmed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [please confirm your word that you spoke] or [please confirm what you said when you spoke]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:27 (#2)

אֱלֹהִ֔ים

“God”

Even though Solomon is addressing God directly, he is speaking of him in the third person to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [you, God]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 8:27 (#3)

הִנֵּ֣ה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Indeed]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:27 (#4)

הַשָּׁמַיִם וּשְׁמֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם֮

“the heavens and the heavens of the heavens”

In this context, the term **heavens** refers to the sky, while the phrase **the heavens of the heavens** describes the spiritual realm beyond the sky that is God’s abode. Translators whose languages have separate words for the sky and for God’s abode may be able to use those terms here in their translations. Alternate translation: [the sky and heaven itself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:27 (#1)

כִּֽי הֲאֻמְנָ֣ם יֵשֵׁ֤ב אֱלֹהִים֙ עַל־הָאָ֔רֶץ

“But will God truly dwell on the earth”

Solomon is using the question form to make a strong statement. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [But God will not truly dwell on the earth!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 8:28 (#2)

אֶל־תְּפִלַּ֥ת עַבְדְּךָ֖ וְאֶל־תְּחִנָּתֹ֑ו

“to the prayer of your servant and to his supplication”

Together, the terms **prayer** and **supplication** express a single idea. The word **supplication** tells what kind of **prayer** this is. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [to my prayer for help] or [to the requests I am making as I pray]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:28 (#4)

לִשְׁמֹ֣עַ אֶל־הָרִנָּ֔ה וְאֶל־הַתְּפִלָּ֖ה

“to listen to the cry and to the prayer”

The terms **cry** and **prayer** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to listen to the fervent prayer] or [to answer the fervent prayer]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:28 (#3)

לִשְׁמֹ֣עַ אֶל־הָרִנָּ֔ה וְאֶל־הַתְּפִלָּ֖ה

“to listen to the cry and to the prayer”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of this use of the term “listen.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate explicitly in your translation, here and in verses 28, 30, and 52, that the term in the context of Solomon’s prayer means “answer.” Alternate translation: [to answer the cry and the prayer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:28 (#5)

הַתְּפִלָּ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר עַבְדְּךָ֖ מִתְפַּלֵּ֑ל

“the prayer that your servant is praying”

Solomon is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [the prayer that your servant is offering]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 8:28 (#6)

לְפָנֶ֖יךָ

“to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents being in front of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:28 (#1)

וּפָנִ֣יתָ

“Yet may you turn”

Solomon is speaking here as if paying attention were actually to **turn** toward someone. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yet may you pay attention]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:29 (#3)

לַ֣יְלָה וְיֹ֑ום

“night and day”

Solomon is referring to all of time by naming its two major components, **night** and **day**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time]

See: Merism

1 Kings 8:29 (#4)

אָמַ֣רְתָּ יִהְיֶ֥ה שְׁמִ֖י שָׁ֑ם

“you have said, ‘My name will be there”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [you have said that your name would be there]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 8:29 (#5)

יִהְיֶ֥ה שְׁמִ֖י שָׁ֑ם

“My name will be there”

Here, Yahweh’s **name** represents his presence and authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [People will worship me there] or [My reputation will be known there]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:29 (#6)

הַתְּפִלָּ֔ה

“the prayer”

Solomon is not referring to a specific **prayer**. He means prayers in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the prayers] or [any prayer]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 8:29 (#7)

יִתְפַּלֵּ֥ל & אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה

“will pray toward this place”

Here and in verses 30 and 35, Solomon refers to people directing their prayers toward the temple. Praying in the direction of the temple was a symbolic action by which worshipers showed that they recognized the temple as the place where Yahweh was especially present with his people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [will direct their prayers to you at this temple] or [will pray to you while facing this temple in which you are especially present]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 8:29 (#1)

לִֽהְיוֹת֤ עֵינֶ֙יךָ֙ פְּתֻחוֹת֙ אֶל־הַבַּ֣יִת הַזֶּ֔ה

“that your eyes may be opened to this house”

The expression **may be opened** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that you may open your eyes to this temple] or [that you may keep your eyes open to this temple]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:29 (#2)

לִֽהְיוֹת֤ עֵינֶ֙יךָ֙ פְּתֻחוֹת֙ אֶל־הַבַּ֣יִת הַזֶּ֔ה

“that your eyes may be opened to this house”

Solomon is speaking as if he wants Yahweh always to be looking at the temple. He means that he wants Yahweh always to be listening to the prayers that people offer toward the temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that your ears may be opened to this house] or [that you may always listen to what people pray toward this temple]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:30 (#1)

תְּחִנַּ֔ת & אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִתְפַּלְל֖וּ

“the supplication of & that they will pray”

Solomon is not referring to a specific **supplication**. He means supplications in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any supplication ... that they may make]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 8:30 (#2)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תִשְׁמַ֔ע

“And you, may you hear”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of Solomon’s use of the explicit pronoun “you” in this phrase that he repeats several times in his prayer. Alternate translation: [And as they are praying, may you hear]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:30 (#3)

תִּשְׁמַ֣ע אֶל־מְקֹ֣ום שִׁבְתְּךָ֔

“may you hear in the place of your dwelling”

The implication is that Solomon expects God to hear and respond from his dwelling place in heaven. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, here and in verses 39, 43, and 49. Alternate translation: [may you pay attention and respond from the place of your dwelling]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:30 (#4)

אֶל־מְקֹ֣ום שִׁבְתְּךָ֔ אֶל־הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“in the place of your dwelling, in the heavens”

The terms **in the place of your dwelling** and **in the heavens** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase, here and in verses 39, 43, and 49. Alternate translation: [in the heavens where you dwell]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:30 (#5)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֖ וְסָלָֽחְתָּ׃

“and may you hear and forgive”

The phrase **hear and forgive** expresses a single idea. The word **forgive** tells in what way Solomon is asking Yahweh to **hear** (that is, answer) the prayer. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way, here and in verses 34, 36, and 39. Alternate translation: [and may you answer by forgiving]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:31 (#6)

לְהַאֲלֹתֹ֖ו

“to adjure him”

The implication is that the person who may have committed the offense would have to swear an oath at the altar that he was innocent. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [that he is innocent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:31 (#8)

לִפְנֵ֥י מִזְבַּחֲךָ֖

“to the face of your altar”

Here, **to the face of your altar** represents being in front of the altar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of your altar]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:31 (#1)

אֵת֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֶֽחֱטָ֣א אִישׁ֮ לְרֵעֵ֣הוּ

“Whoever sins, a man against his neighbor”

In this verse, Solomon is introducing the first part of a possible condition. He is asking Yahweh to do the things he describes in the next verse if this condition happens. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [If someone sins, a man against his neighbor] or [Suppose someone sins, a man against his neighbor]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Kings 8:31 (#2)

אֵת֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֶֽחֱטָ֣א אִישׁ֮ לְרֵעֵ֣הוּ

“Whoever sins, a man against his neighbor”

Solomon is using **a man against his neighbor** as a common expression of his culture to describe what one person might do to another person. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Suppose one person sins against another]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:31 (#4)

וְנָשָׂ֤א־בֹו֙ אָלָ֔ה לְהַאֲלֹתֹ֖ו

“and he lifts an oath against him to adjure him”

The pronoun **he** refers to the offended party, while the pronoun **him** refers to the person who may have committed the offense. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the neighbor lifts an oath against the man to adjure the man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:31 (#5)

וְנָשָׂא־בּוֹ אָלָה

“and he lifts an oath against him”

The author is using **lifts an oath** as a common expression of his culture to mean “makes someone swear an oath.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he puts him under an oath] or [and he makes him swear an oath]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:31 (#9)

בַּבַּיִת הַזֶּה

“in this house”

By **in this house**, Solomon specifically means in the courtyard of the temple, where the altar was located. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the court of this temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:31 (#3)

אֵתְּ אֲשֶׁר יֶחֱטָא אִישׁ לְרֵעֵהוּ

“Whoever sins, a man against his neighbor”

The implication is that it is uncertain whether a person has actually wronged another person, and so resolution through an oath at the altar is required. You could indicate this uncertainty in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Suppose one person may have sinned against another]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:31 (#7)

וּבָא אָלָה

“and an oath comes”

Here the term **oath** represents the person who is making the oath. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and a person who is under such an oath comes] or [and a person who is required to swear such an oath comes]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:32 (#1)

וְעָשִׂיתָ וְשָׁפַטְתָּ אֶת־עֲבָדֶיךָ

“and act and judge your servants”

Solomon is first describing one event, in which Yahweh would **act** to punish the **wicked** and reward the **righteous** (as the rest of the verse describes). He is then describing another event that would precede it, in which Yahweh would **judge** people as either righteous or wicked. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would happen. Alternate translation: [and judge your servants and do]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 8:32 (#2)

וְעָשִׂיתָ וְשָׁפַטְתָּ

“and act and judge”

The phrase **act and judge** expresses a single idea. The word **act** tells in what way Yahweh would **judge**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and actively judge]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:32 (#3)

רָשָׁע & צַדִּיק

“the wicked & the righteous”

The author is using the adjectives **wicked** and **righteous** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [the wicked person … the righteous person] or [the person who is wicked … the person who is righteous]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 8:32 (#4)

לְהָתֵת דַּרְכּוֹ בְּרֹאשׁוֹ & לָלֶתֶת

“to put his way on his head & to give”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:32. Alternate translation: [to punish him for the wrong things he has done]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:33 (#1)

בֶּהִנָּגֵף עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי אוֹיֵב אֲשֶׁר יֶחֶטְאוּ־לָךְ

“When your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy because they have sinned against you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:31. Alternate translation: [If your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy because they have sinned against you] or [Suppose your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy because they have sinned against you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Kings 8:33 (#3)

בָּהִנָּגֵף עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי אוֹיֵב

“When your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy”

See the discussion of the term “struck” in the introduction to 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [When your people Israel are defeated to the face of an enemy] or [Suppose your people Israel are defeated to the face of an enemy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:33 (#6)

וְשָׁשָׁבוּ אֵלֶיךָ

“and they turn back to you”

Solomon is speaking as if the Israelites, within the possible condition he is describing, had been walking away from God but then **turned back** to walk toward him again. He means that they would have stopped sinning and started living in the manner in which God wants people to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they repent] or [and they stop sinning]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:33 (#7)

וְהוֹדَוּ אֶת־שְׁמֶךָ

“and they confess your name”

Here, Yahweh’s **name** represents his reputation, and in this context, specifically his deserved reputation as a righteous God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and they acknowledge your righteous character] or [and they acknowledge that you were right to have punished them in this way]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:33 (#2)

בָּהִנָּגֵף עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי אוֹיֵב אֲשֶׁר יֶחֶטְאוּ־לָךְ

“When your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy because they have sinned against you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [When your people Israel sin against you and so are struck to the face of an enemy] or [Suppose your people Israel sin against you and, as a result, they are struck to the face of an enemy]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:33 (#4)

בָּהִנָּגֵף עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי אוֹיֵב

“When your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of an **enemy**, that is, opposing an enemy in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Suppose your people Israel are defeated in front of an enemy] or [Suppose your people Israel are defeated as they fight against an enemy]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:33 (#5)

בָּהִנָּגֵף עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי אוֹיֵב

“When your people Israel are struck to the face of an enemy”

The expression **are struck** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Suppose an enemy defeats your people Israel as they fight against them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:33 (#8)

וְהִתְפַּלְלוּ וְהִתְחַנְּנוּ

“and they pray and they supplicate”

Together, the words **pray** and **supplicate** expresses a single idea. The word **supplicate** tells what the people would be doing as they **pray**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning

in a different way. Alternate translation: [and they pray for help]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:33 (#9)

אֵלֶיךָ בַּבַּיִת הַזֶּה

“toward you in this house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:29. Alternate translation: [toward this temple as a place where you are present]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 8:34 (#1)

וְסָלַחְתָּ & וְהֲשֵׁבֹתָם

“and may you forgive & and bring them back”

The pronoun **them** refers to any Israelites an enemy may have captured and taken prisoner. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and bring back any prisoners whom the enemy has captured]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:35 (#1)

בְּהֵעָצֵר שָׁמַיִם וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה מָטָר כִּֽי־יֶחֶטְאוּ־לָךְ

“When the heavens are restrained and there is no rain because they have sinned against you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:31. Alternate translation: [If the heavens are restrained and there is no rain because they have sinned against you] or [Suppose the heavens are restrained and there is no rain because they have sinned against you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Kings 8:35 (#3)

בְּהֵעָצֵר שָׁמַיִם וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה מָטָר כִּֽי־יֶחֶטְאוּ־לָךְ

“When the heavens are restrained and there is no rain because they have sinned against you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Suppose your people Israel sin against you and, as a result, the heavens are restrained and there is no rain]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:35 (#4)

בְּהֵעָצֵר שָׁמַיִם וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה מָטָר

“When the heavens are restrained and there is no rain”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Suppose it does not rain for a long time]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:35 (#2)

בְּהֵעָצֵר שָׁמַיִם וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה מָטָר כִּֽי־יֶחֶטְאוּ־לָךְ

“When the heavens are restrained and there is no rain because they have sinned against you”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelite people. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Suppose the heavens are restrained and there is no rain because your people Israel have sinned against you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:35 (#6)

וּמֵחַטָּאתָם יְשׁוּבֻן

“and they turn back from their sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:33. Alternate translation: [and they repent of their sin] or [and they stop sinning]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:35 (#5)

וְהִתְפַּלְלוּ אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה וְהוֹדּוּ אֶת־שְׁמֶךָ וּמֵחַטָּאתָם יְשׁוּבֻן כִּֽי־תְעַנֵּם

“and they pray toward this place and they confess your name and they turn back from their sin because you have afflicted them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and, because you have afflicted them, they pray toward this place and they confess your name and they turn back from their sin]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:36 (#4)

אֶת־הַדֶּרֶךְ הַטּוֹבָה אֲשֶׁר יֵלְכוּ־בָהּ

“the good way in which they should walk”

Solomon is speaking of how a person lives as if that were a path or **way** on which they were walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the right manner in which they should conduct themselves]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:36 (#5)

לְנַחֲלָה

“for an inheritance”

Solomon is using the term **inheritance** to mean a lasting possession passed down from one generation to another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated the similar expression in Joshua 11:23. Alternate translation: [as a lasting possession]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:36 (#1)

וְסָלַחְתָּ לְחַטַּאת עֲבָדֶיךָ וְעַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי תוֹרֵם אֶת־הַדֶּרֶךְ הַטּוֹבָה אֲשֶׁר יֵלְכוּ־בָהּ

“and may you forgive the sin of your servants and your people Israel, for you teach the good way in which they should walk”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since you will have taught the good way in which they should walk, may you forgive the sin of your servants and your people Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:36 (#2)

עֲבָדֶיךָ וְעַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“your servants and your people Israel”

The phrase **your servants and your people Israel** expresses a single idea. The word **servants** defines and describes who **your people Israel** are. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [your servants, the people of Israel]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:36 (#3)

כִּי תוֹרֵם

“for you teach”

While Solomon may be making a general statement about how Yahweh always teaches **the good way** in which people should live, in context, he seems to be giving a reason why Yahweh should forgive the Israelites if this possible condition occurs. In that case, he would actually be referring to a recent past event viewed from a future perspective. Your language may have a verb form that you could use to indicate this. Alternate translation: [since you will have taught]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 8:37 (#1)

שִׁדָּפוֹן

“blight”

A **blight** is a kind of plant disease that damages or destroys crops. If your readers would not be familiar with what a blight is, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [plant disease] or [crop disease]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 8:37 (#6)

בְּאֶרֶץ שְׁעָרָיו

“in the land of his gates”

Here, the **gates** of a city represent the city itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the place where his city is located] or [by besieging his city]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:37 (#2)

יֵרָקוֹן

“mildew”

A **mildew** is a kind of fungal disease that damages crops. If your readers would not be familiar with what a mildew is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [fungus] or [crop disease]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 8:37 (#7)

כָּל־נֶגַע כָּל־מַחֲלָה

“any plague, any sickness”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if there is any plague or any sickness]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:37 (#3)

חָסִיל

“grasshopper”

This term, like the preceding term **locust**, refers to some kind of insect that devours crops. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [grasshopper]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:37 (#5)

כִּֽי־יָצַר־לוֹ אֹיְבֹו

“if his enemy makes {it} narrow to him”

Solomon is using **makes it narrow to him** as a common expression of his culture to mean “puts him in a very dangerous situation.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 28:15. Alternate translation: [if someone’s enemy puts him in a very dangerous situation]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:37 (#4)

כִּֽי־יָצַר־לוֹ אֹיְבֹו

“if his enemy makes {it} narrow to him”

The pronoun **his** refers to any Israelite whose city is under siege, while **it** refers to the city or land being besieged. The pronoun **him** also refers to the same Israelite. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [if someone’s enemy makes it narrow to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:38 (#2)

כָּל־תְּפִלָּה כָל־תְּחִנָּה אֲשֶׁשֶׁר תִּהְיֶה֙ לְכָל־הָאָדָ֔ם לְכֹל֙ עַמְּךָ֔
יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֵדְע֑וּן אִ֚ישׁ נֶ֣גַע לְבָבֹ֔ו וּפָרַ֥שׂ כַּפָּ֖יו אֶל־הַבַּ֥יִת הַזֶּֽה

“any prayer, any supplication that is to any man, to any of your people Israel who know, a man the plague of his heart, and he spreads out his palms toward this house”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **prayer** and **supplication** with the information that a person would **spread out his palms** to pray. Alternate translation: [and if any man, any of your people Israel, who knows, a man the plague of his heart, spreads out his palms toward this house to make any prayer, any supplication]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 8:38 (#4)

לְכָל־הָאָדָ֔ם לְכֹל֙ עַמְּךָ֔ יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“to any man, to any of your people Israel”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [to any Israelite person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 8:38 (#5)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר יֵדְע֑וּן אִ֚ישׁ נֶ֣גַע לְבָבֹ֔ו

“who know, a man the plague of his heart”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s emotions and awareness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [an individual who is painfully aware that you are plaguing him]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:38 (#6)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר יֵדְע֑וּן אִ֚ישׁ נֶ֣גַע לְבָבֹ֔ו

“who know, a man the plague of his heart”

In this context, the term **plague** does not describe a disease that affects a whole community of people. Instead, it has the sense of an affliction by which God seeks to correct a person who has been doing wrong. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate trans-

lation: [an individual who is painfully aware that you are chastising him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:38 (#1)

כָּל־תְּפִלָּ֣ה כָּל־תְּחִנָּ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּֽהְיֶ֖ה לְכָל־הָאָדָ֑ם לְכֹ֣ל

“any prayer, any supplication that is to any man, to any of”

In this verse, Solomon is introducing more of the first part of a possible condition, which he began introducing with the term “If” in the previous verse. He is asking Yahweh to do the things he describes in the next verse if this condition happens. Use a natural form in your language for introducing more of a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [and if any prayer, any supplication that is to any man]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Kings 8:38 (#3)

כָּל־תְּפִלָּ֣ה כָּל־תְּחִנָּ֔ה

“any prayer, any supplication”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:33. Alternate translation: [any prayer for help]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:38 (#7)

וּפָרַ֥שׂ כַּפָּ֖יו אֶל־הַבַּ֥יִת הַזֶּֽה

“and he spreads out his palms toward this house”

See whether you decided to indicate the significance of this action in the text of your translation in 8:22. If you did, you may or may not wish to indicate it again here.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 8:39 (#6)

וְעָשִׂ֣יתָ & תֵּדַ֔ע

“and may & act & you, you know”

Solomon is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you know** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize the contrast between Yahweh, who knows every person’s motives, and people, who do not. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [you are the one who knows]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:39 (#4)

אֶת־לְבָבֹ֑ו & אֶת־לְבַ֖ב

“his heart & the heart of”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s motives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his motives ... the motives of]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:39 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:39 (#1)

וְעָשִׂ֣יתָ וְנָתַתָּ֣ לְאִ֣ישׁ כְּכָל־דְּרָכָ֗יו & אֶת־לְבָבֹו֙ כִּי־אַתָּ֣ה יָדַ֔עְתָּ

“and may you act and give to a man according to all of his ways, for you know his heart & you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since you know a man’s heart, may you act and give to him according to all of his ways]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:39 (#7)

כָּל־בְּנֵ֖י הָאָדָֽם

“all of the sons of man”

Here, the masculine term **sons of man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [every human being]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 8:39 (#2)

וְעָשִׂ֣יתָ וְנָתַתָּ֣ & אַתָּ֣ה יָדַ֔עְתָּ

“and may you act and give & you know & you”

The phrase **act and give** expresses a single idea. The word **act** tells in what way Solomon wants Yahweh to **give**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and may you actively give]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:39 (#3)

דְּרָכָ֔יו

“his ways”

Solomon is speaking of how a person conducts himself in various circumstances as if that were a series of **ways** or paths that the person was walking along. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his actions] or [his conduct]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:40 (#1)

הַיָּמִ֑ים

“the days”

Solomon is using the term **days** to represent time, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:40 (#2)

הֵ֣ם חַיִּ֗ים עַל־פְּנֵי֙ הָאֲדָמָ֔ה

“they {are} alive on the face of the land”

Solomon is using the term **face** to mean the surface of the **land**. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they are walking around on this land] or [they are alive on earth]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:41 (#1)

וּבָ֣א

“and he comes”

Solomon is introducing the first part of a possible condition. He is asking Yahweh to do the things he describes in 8:43 if this condition happens. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [suppose he comes]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Kings 8:41 (#2)

שְׁמֶ֑ךָ

“your name”

Solomon is using Yahweh’s **name** to represent his reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language, here and in verses 42 and 43. Alternate translation: [your reputation]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:42 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:42 (#2)

יִשְׁמְעוּן֙ & וּבָ֣א

“they will hear & and he will come”

The pronoun **they** refers to foreigners in general, while the pronoun **he** refers to an individual foreigner. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [foreigners will hear & and an individual foreigner will come]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:42 (#3)

וְאֶת־יָדְךָ֣ הַחֲזָקָ֔ה וּזְרֹעֲךָ֖ הַנְּטוּיָ֑ה

“and your mighty hand and your outstretched arm”

The expressions **mighty hand** and **outstretched arm** mean similar things. Both the **hand** and the **arm** represent the power that Yahweh has used to do great things. Solomon is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. If you have already translated the book of Deuteronomy, see how you translated the similar expression in Deuteronomy 4:34 and its several other occurrences in that book. Alternate translation: [and the very powerful things you have done]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:42 (#4)

וּזְרֹעֲךָ הַנְּטוּיָה

“and your outstretched arm”

The term **outstretched** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, if you choose to retain the image, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the arm that you have stretched out]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:43 (#2)

שִׁמְךָ נִקְרָא עַל־הַבַּיִת הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר בָּנִיתִי

“your name has been called over this house that I have built”

Solomon is using **your name has been called over this house** as a common expression of his culture to mean “this house belongs to you” or “you are present in this house.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as for this temple that I have built, your name is on it] or [this is indeed the temple that belongs to you and in which you are present]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:43 (#1)

אַתָּה תִּשְׁמַע

“you, may you hear”

This verse introduces the consequence of the condition proposed in the previous verse. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the consequence of this possible condition. Alternate translation: [then you, may you hear]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Kings 8:44 (#2)

דֶּרֶךְ

“in} the way of”

By **in the way of**, Solomon means in the direction of. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the direction of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:44 (#1)

בַּדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר תִּשְׁלָחֵם & אֶל

“by the way that you send them & to”

Solomon is speaking as if Yahweh would actually **send** the Israelite army out in a specific direction or **way**. He means that Yahweh would direct them to fight a specific enemy at a specific time and the Israelites would obey him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in obedience to you]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:45 (#1)

אֶת־תְּפִלָּתָם וְאֶת־תְּחִנָּתָם

“their prayer and their supplication”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:33. Alternate translation: [their prayer for help]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 8:45 (#2)

וְעָשִׂיתָ מִשְׁפָּטָם

“and may you do their justice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Solomon is appealing to Yahweh to judge the situation of these soldiers justly, to declare them justified in their cause (since they are fighting at his command), and to act on that declaration by giving them victory. Alternate translation: [and may you do what is just for them] or [and may you give them victory]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 8:46 (#3)

כִּי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:46 (#2)

כִּי אֵין אָדָם אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יֶחֱטָא

“for {there is} no man who does not sin”

Solomon is making this statement as background information to this part of his prayer. In your translation,

introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 8:46 (#6)

וְשָׁבְב֥וּם

“and they take them captive”

The pronoun **they** refers to the enemies Solomon has been describing. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the enemy soldiers take them captive]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:46 (#1)

יֶֽחֶטְא֣וּ

“they sin”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelites, whom Solomon calls “your people” in 8:44. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [your people sin]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:46 (#4)

וּנְתַתָּ֖ם לִפְנֵ֣י אוֹיֵ֑ב

“and you give them to the face of an enemy”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:33. Alternate translation: [and you give them in front of an enemy] or [and you give them as they fight against an enemy]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:46 (#7)

וְשָׁבְב֥וּם שֹׁבֵיהֶ֖ם

“and they take them captive {as} their captives”

Solomon is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and they capture them] or [and they take them prisoner]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 8:46 (#5)

וּנְתַתָּ֖ם לִפְנֵ֣י אוֹיֵ֑ב

“and you give them to the face of an enemy”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and you give them over to defeat as they fight against an enemy] or [and you allow an enemy to defeat them]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:46 (#8)

רָחוֹקָ֖ה אוֹ֥ קְרוֹבָֽה

“distant or near”

Solomon is referring to all possible locations by naming two extremes, **distant** and **near**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [wherever that may be]

See: Merism

1 Kings 8:47 (#1)

וְהֵשִׁ֣יבוּ֮ אֶל־לִבָּם֒

“and they bring back to their heart”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s thoughts and understanding. Solomon is speaking of the exiled people becoming aware of their situation as if they were bringing something **back to their heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they recall]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:47 (#2)

וְהֵשִׁ֣יבוּ֮ אֶל־לִבָּם֒

“and they bring back to their heart”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context in to Deuteronomy 30:1, to which Solomon is alluding here, if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they recall your warning that exile would be the punishment for disobedience]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:47 (#3)

בָּאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֣ר נִשְׁבּוּ־שָׁ֔ם וְשָׁ֣בוּ ׀ וְהִתְחַנְּנ֣וּ אֵלֶ֗יךָ בְּאֶ֙רֶץ֙ שֹׁבֵיהֶ֔ם

“in the land where they have been taken captive there, and they turn back and supplicate to you in the land of their captors”

It might seem that saying **where** and **there** and repeating **in the land** would be to convey extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten this. Alternate translation: [in the land where they have been taken captive, and they turn back and supplicate to you there]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:47 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבּוּ־שָׁם

“where they have been taken captive there”

The expression **have been taken captive** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to which their enemies have taken them captive]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:47 (#5)

וְשָׁבוּ

“and they turn back”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:33. Alternate translation: [and they repent]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:47 (#6)

לֵאמֹר חָטָאנוּ וְהֶעֱוִינוּ רָשָׁעְנוּ

“saying, ‘We have sinned and done iniquity, we have acted wickedly”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [saying that they have sinned and done iniquity, that they have acted wickedly]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 8:47 (#7)

חָטָאנוּ וְהֶעֱוִינוּ רָשָׁעְנוּ

“We have sinned and done iniquity, we have acted wickedly”

The expressions **sinned**, **done iniquity**, and **acted wickedly** mean similar things. The people are using these expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [We have committed many very serious sins]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:48 (#1)

וְשָׁבוּ אֵלֶיךָ

“and they return to you”

Here, Solomon is speaking of the Israelites as if they had literally been walking away from God but would then physically **return** to him. He means that they would acknowledge him again as their God and begin to obey him once more. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they acknowledge you again]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:48 (#2)

בְּכָל־לְבָבָם וּבְכָל־נַפְשָׁם

“with all of their heart and with all of their soul”

Solomon is referring to all of a person by naming two major components of a person, his **heart** and his **soul**. These represent overlapping aspects of the inner life of a person, including a person’s thoughts, feelings, desires, and intentions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See how you translated the same expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [with their entire beings]

See: Merism

1 Kings 8:48 (#3)

דֶּרֶךְ

“in} the way of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:44. Alternate translation: [in the direction of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:48 (#4)

הָעִיר

“the city”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context

if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [in the direction of the city]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:49 (#1)

וְעָשִׂיתָ מִשְׁפָּטָם

“and may you do their justice”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:45. Alternate translation: [and may you do what is just for them] or [and may you bring them back from exile]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 8:50 (#2)

וּנְתַתָּם לְרַחֲמִים לִפְנֵי שֹׁבֵיהֶם

“And may you give them compassion to the face of their captors”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of their captors, where their captors can see them. So it means “in the regard of” their captors. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And may you give them compassion in the regard of their captors] or [And may you cause their captors to feel mercifully toward them]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:50 (#3)

וְרִחֲמוּם

“and may they have compassion on them”

By **may they have compassion on them**, Solomon means that the captors would show mercy to the Israelites by allowing them to return to their homeland. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and may they act mercifully toward them] or [and may they allow them to return to their land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:50 (#1)

פִּשְׁעֵיהֶם אֲשֶׁר פָּשְׁעוּ־בָךְ

“their transgressions that they have transgressed against you”

Solomon is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [the transgressions that they have committed against you]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 8:51 (#2)

הֵם

“they”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:51 (#4)

מִמִּצְרַיִם מִתּוֹךְ כּוּר הַבַּרְזֶל

“from Egypt, from the midst of the furnace of iron”

Here, **furnace of iron** describes a furnace that is characterized by the working or smelting of iron. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from Egypt, from the midst of that very hot furnace in which people melt iron]

See: Possession

1 Kings 8:51 (#3)

עַמְּךָ וְנַחֲלָתֶךָ

“are} your people and your inheritance”

Solomon is speaking of the people of Israel as if they were something that Yahweh had inherited as a lasting possession. He is referring to the Israelites as the people who belong to Yahweh perpetually. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 10:1. Alternate translation: [your people who belong to you perpetually]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:51 (#5)

מִמִּצְרַיִם מִתּוֹךְ כּוּר הַבַּרְזֶל

“from Egypt, from the midst of the furnace of iron”

Solomon is alluding to Deuteronomy 4:20, where Moses calls Egypt a “furnace of iron” to represent that the Israelites suffered greatly there, as if they had been iron melting inside such a very hot furnace. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from Egypt, where the Egyptians severely oppressed you]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:51 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces the reason why Solomon feels he can ask Yahweh to respond to all the different kinds of prayers he has described. This is the beginning of the conclusion to the prayer. This conclusion continues through verse 53. If the connection between what Solomon says here and what he has said previously is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word or phrase to show how the relationship. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 8:52 (#4)

לִֽהְיוֹת֩ עֵינֶ֨יךָ פְתֻחוֹת֜ אֶל

“for your eyes to be opened to”

Solomon is speaking of God’s awareness and attention as if God’s **eyes** were actually opened rather than closed. He means that he wants God to pay attention to the prayers of the Israelites. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and so may you pay attention to]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:52 (#3)

לִֽהְיוֹת֩ עֵינֶ֨יךָ פְתֻחוֹת֜ אֶל

“for your eyes to be opened to”

Here, **eyes** represents God’s attention and awareness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [so may you look at] or [so you may regard]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:52 (#1)

לִֽהְיוֹת֩ עֵינֶ֨יךָ פְתֻחוֹת֜

“for your eyes to be opened”

In this verse, Solomon is describing what he believes should follow as a result of what he described in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [so may your eyes be opened]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:52 (#2)

לִֽהְיוֹת֩ עֵינֶ֨יךָ פְתֻחוֹת֜ אֶל

“for your eyes to be opened to”

The expression **to be opened** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so may you open your eyes to]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:53 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבַּ֗רְתָּ בְּיַד֙ ׀ מֹשֶׁ֣ה עַבְדֶּ֔ךָ

“just as you spoke by the hand of Moses your servant”

Here, **hand** represents the agency of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [just as you spoke through the agency of Moses your servant] or [just as you told Moses your servant to tell the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:53 (#1)

אַתָּ֣ה הִבְדַּלְתָּ֔ם

“you, you separated them”

Solomon is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you separated** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the personal role of Yahweh in separating the Israelites from all the other **peoples of the earth**. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [you personally separated them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:53 (#2)

לְנַחֲלָ֑ה

“as an inheritance”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:51. Alternate translation: [so that they would belong to you perpetually]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:54 (#1)

מִלִּפְנֵי

“from to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the altar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:54 (#3)

מִכְּרֹעַ עַל־בִּרְכָּיו

“from kneeling on his knees”

It might seem that the expression **from kneeling on his knees** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [from kneeling down]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:54 (#2)

מִכְּרֹעַ עַל־בִּרְכָּיו וְכַפָּיו פְּרֻשׂוֹת הַשָּׁמָיִם

“from kneeling on his knees with his palms spread out {toward} the heavens”

See whether you indicated the symbolic significance of what Solomon had been doing when you translated the similar expression in 8:22.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 8:56 (#1)

בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה

“Blessed {be} Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:48. Alternate translation: [May people bless Yahweh] or [May people praise Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 8:56 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר בְּיַד מֹשֶׁה עַבְדּוֹ

“that he spoke by the hand of Moses his servant”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [that he spoke through the agency of Moses his servant] or [that he told Moses his servant to tell the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:56 (#2)

לֹא־נָפַל דָּבָר אֶחָד מִכֹּל דְּבָרוֹ הַטּוֹב אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר

“One word has not fallen from all of his good word that he spoke”

Solomon is using the term **word** to represent what God said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Not one thing has fallen from all of the good things he said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:56 (#3)

לֹא־נָפַל דָּבָר אֶחָד מִכֹּל דְּבָרוֹ הַטּוֹב אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר

“One word has not fallen from all of his good word that he spoke”

Solomon is speaking as if a **word** were a physical object that could **fall** to the ground and be lost or ruined. He means that not a single word that Yahweh **spoke** has failed to come true. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 3:19. Alternate translation: [Every single thing has come true of all the good things he said]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:57 (#1)

יְהִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ עִמָּנוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר הָיָה עִם־אֲבֹתֵינוּ

“May Yahweh our God be with us, just as he was with our fathers”

Solomon is using a common expression of his culture to express his desire that Yahweh would help the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 3:19. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [May Yahweh our God help us, just as he helped our ancestors]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:57 (#3)

אַל־יַעַזְבֵנוּ וְאַל־יִטְּשֵׁנוּ

“May he not forsake us and may he not abandon us”

These two phrases **May he not forsake us** and **may he not abandon us** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [May he never forsake us at all]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 8:57 (#2)

אַל־יַעַזְבֵנוּ וְאַל־יִטְּשֵׁנוּ

“May he not forsake us and may he not abandon us”

The expressions **May he not forsake** and **may he not abandon** are double negatives, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative words **forsake** and **abandon**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use positive expressions to translate them. Alternate translation: [May he always cherish us and may he always protect us]

See: Double Negatives

1 Kings 8:58 (#2)

לְהַטּוֹת לְבָבֵנוּ אֵלָיו

“may he stretch out our heart to him”

Solomon is speaking as if a person’s **heart** were something that Yahweh could **stretch out** toward himself. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated the similar expression in Joshua 24:23. Alternate translation: [may he make us completely devoted to him]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:58 (#3)

מִצְוֹתָיו וְחֻקָּיו֙ וּמִשְׁפָּטָ֔יו

“his commandments and his statutes and his judgments”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [all of his commandments]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:58 (#1)

לְהַטּוֹת לְבָבֵנוּ אֵלָיו

“may he stretch out our heart to him”

In this verse, the word **heart** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Israelites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “heart.” Alternate translation: [may he stretch out our hearts to him]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 8:59 (#2)

דְּבָרַ֣י אֵ֔אֶלֶּה

“these my words”

Solomon is using the term **words** to represent the things that he has said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these things that I have said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:59 (#5)

לַעֲשֹׂות ׀ מִשְׁפַּ֣ט עַבְדּ֗וֹ וּמִשְׁפַּ֤ט עַמּוֹ֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“to do the justice of his servant and the justice of his people Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:45. Alternate translation: [so that he will do what is just for his servant and what is just for his people Israel]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 8:59 (#1)

וְיִהְי֗וּ דְּבָרַ֤י אֵ֨אֶלֶּה֙ קְרֹבִ֔ים אֶל־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֑ינוּ &

“And may these my words & be near to Yahweh our God”

Solomon is speaking of his words as if they could actually be **near to** Yahweh, meaning that Yahweh would remember and consider them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And may Yahweh our God remember these my words]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:59 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:59 (#4)

יוֹמָמָם וְלַיְלָה

“by day and {by} night”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:29. Alternate translation: [all the time]

See: Merism

1 Kings 8:59 (#6)

דְּבַר־יוֹם בְּיוֹמוֹ

“the matter of a day in its day”

Solomon is using **the matter of a day in its day** as a common expression of his culture to mean “as each day requires” or “according to daily needs.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as each day requires] or [according to our daily needs]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:60 (#1)

יְהוָה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים

“Yahweh, he {is} God”

Solomon is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the name **Yahweh** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize the contrast between Yahweh, who is the only true God, and the so-called gods of the other **peoples of the earth**, which are not gods at all. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the expression “he, he cursed” in 2:8, which similarly uses an explicit pronoun to draw a contrast. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is the only true God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 8:61 (#1)

וְהְיֶה לְבַבְכֶם שְׁלֵם עִם יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ

“And may your heart be complete with Yahweh our God”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s commitment, loyalty, and devotion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And may you be completely devoted to Yahweh our God]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:61 (#2)

לְבַבְכֶם

“your heart”

The word **your** is plural here because Solomon is addressing the crowd of Israelites, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 8:61 (#4)

לָלֶכֶת & וְלִשְׁמֹר מִצְוֹתָיו

“to walk in his statutes and to keep his commandments”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [to live obediently according to all of his commandments]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 8:61 (#3)

לְבַבְכֶם

“your heart”

In this verse, the word **heart** is singular in form, but it refers to all the people of Israel as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “heart.” Alternate translation: [your hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 8:61 (#5)

כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“as this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [as is the case right now]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 8:62 (#3)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:62 (#1)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and all of Israel”

The author says **all of Israel** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [and all of the Israelites who were present]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 8:62 (#2)

זֹבְחִים זָבַח

“were sacrificing sacrifices”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [were offering sacrifices]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 8:63 (#2)

וַיִּזְבַּח שְׁלֹמֹה אֵת זֶבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים

“And Solomon sacrificed a sacrifice of peace offerings”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And Solomon offered a sacrifice of peace offerings]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 8:63 (#3)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:63 (#1)

וַיִּזְבַּח שְׁלֹמֹה אֵת זֶבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים אֲשֶׁר זָבַח לַיהוָה

“And Solomon sacrificed a sacrifice of peace offerings that he sacrificed to Yahweh”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [And Solomon sacrificed a sacrifice of peace offerings to Yahweh]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:64 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא קִדַּשׁ הַמֶּלֶךְ אֶת־תּוֹךְ הֶחָצֵר אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵי בֵּית־יְהוָה כִּי־עָשָׂה שָׁם אֶת־הָעֹלָה וְאֶת־הַמִּנְחָה וְאֵת חֶלְבֵי הַשְּׁלָמִים כִּי־מִזְבַּח הַנְּחֹשֶׁת אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵי יְהוָה קָטֹן מֵהָכִיל אֶת־הָעֹלָה וְאֶת־הַמִּנְחָה וְאֵת חֶלְבֵי הַשְּׁלָמִים

“On that day the king consecrated the middle of the courtyard that was to the face of the house of Yahweh, so that there he made the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat of the peace offerings, for the altar of bronze that {was} to the face of Yahweh was small from the containing of the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat of the peace offerings”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [On that day, since the altar of bronze that was to the face of Yahweh was too small to contain the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat of the peace offerings, the king consecrated the middle of the courtyard that was to the face of the house of Yahweh, so that there he made the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat of the peace offerings]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 8:64 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“was to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Yahweh’s temple. If it would be helpful in your lan-

guage, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:64 (#3)

אֶת־הָעֹלָה֙ וְאֶת־הַמִּנְחָ֔ה

“the burnt offering and the grain offering”

In this verse, the terms **the burnt offering** and **the grain offering** are singular in form, but they refer to all the burnt offerings and grain offerings as groups. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural forms of these terms. Alternate translation: [the burnt offerings and the grain offerings]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 8:64 (#4)

מִזְבַּ֣ח הַנְּחֹשֶׁ֔ת אֲשֶׁ֖ר לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“the altar of bronze that {was} to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of Yahweh** represents being in front of Yahweh’s temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the altar of bronze that was in front of Yahweh’s temple]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:64 (#5)

קָטֹ֗ן מֵהָכִ֤יל אֶת־הָעֹלָה֙ וְאֶת־הַמִּנְחָ֔ה וְאֵ֖את חֶלְבֵ֣י הַשְּׁלָמִֽים

“was small from the containing of the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat of the peace offerings”

Since the author lists all of these offerings earlier in the verse, it might seem that repeating the whole list here would be to convey extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could refer to the offerings with a brief phrase. Alternate translation: [was too small to contain all those offerings]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 8:65 (#1)

אֶת־הֶחָ֔ג

“the feast”

By **the feast**, the author means the Festival of Booths (also known as the Festival of Shelters or Tabernacles). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the Feast of Booths]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 8:65 (#4)

מִלְּבוֹא֙ חֲמָ֔ת ׀ עַד־נַ֖חַל מִצְרַ֑יִם

“from Lebo Hamath to the wadi of Egypt”

The author is referring to all of Israel’s territory by naming two extremes, **Lebo Hamath** (the northern boundary) and **the wadi of Egypt** (the southern boundary). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from throughout the territory of Israel]

See: Merism

1 Kings 8:65 (#3)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֥ל עִמּ֛וֹ

“and all of Israel with him”

The author is saying **all of Israel with him** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and all of the Israelites who were present observed the feast with him]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 8:65 (#5)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 8:65 (#6)

שִׁבְעַ֥ת יָמִ֖ים וְשִׁבְעַ֣ת יָמִ֑ים אַרְבָּעָ֥ה עָשָׂ֖ר יֽוֹם

“seven days and seven days, fourteen days”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [They had celebrated the dedication of the temple for seven days, and then they celebrated the Feast of Booths for seven days, for a total of fourteen days of celebration]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:65 (#2)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֥ל עִמּ֖וֹ

“and all of Israel with him”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and all of Israel observed the feast with him]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 8:66 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁמִינִ֔י

“On the eighth day”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the eighth**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [On day eight]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 8:66 (#4)

שְׂמֵחִים֙ וְטֹ֣בֵי לֵ֔ב

“rejoicing and good of heart”

Here, the **heart** represents people’s feelings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [rejoicing and feeling happy]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 8:66 (#5)

שְׂמֵחִים֙ וְטֹ֣בֵי לֵ֔ב

“rejoicing and good of heart”

The expressions **rejoicing** and **good of heart** mean similar things. The author is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [rejoicing greatly]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 8:66 (#3)

לְאָהֳלֵיהֶ֑ם

“to their tents”

The author is using one kind of home in which people of this culture lived, **tents**, to represent homes in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to their homes]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 8:66 (#6)

הַטּוֹבָ֔ה

“the good”

The author is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the good things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 8:66 (#2)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁמִינִ֔י

“On the eighth day”

The author assumes that readers will know that **the eighth day** refers to the day after the seven-day Feast of Booths ended. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [On the day after the Feast of Booths ended]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues to describe Solomon’s reign as king of Israel.

1. Yahweh appears to Solomon in a dream for a second time, promising blessings for obedience but warning of punishment for disobedience. (9:1–9)
2. Solomon gives King Hiram 20 cities to thank him for his help. (9:10–14)
3. The author describes Solomon’s system of forced labor. (9:15–24)
4. Solomon makes the temple the central location for Israelite worship (9:26)
5. Solomon builds and sails a fleet with Hiram’s help (9:26–27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Blessings for obedience, punishments for disobedience
After the dedication of the temple, Yahweh appeared to Solomon a second time. He repeated the covenant promises he had made to David. Yahweh promised to establish Solomon's throne forever if he and his descendants remained faithful and obedient to him. However, he also warned of severe consequences if they became devoted to other gods instead and worshiped them. This divine warning highlights a central theme of the Old Testament: there would be blessings for obedience, but there would be severe punishment for disobedience, especially for disobedience in the form of living in the way that followers of foreign gods lived. The nation's well-being was directly linked to the fidelity of the king and people to Yahweh. This covenantal relationship provides the background to the events that unfold later in the book of 1 Kings and in the subsequent history of Israel.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"serve other gods and bow down to them"
In 9:6, Yahweh warns Solomon that his descendants who become kings must not "serve other gods and bow down to them." When applied to "other gods," the term "serve" refers to honoring them by living as their followers did, building shrines for them, and generally following religious practices. To "bow down" to these gods (physically bowing to an idol that represented them in a shrine or temple) was a symbolic action of surrender to them as one's lord. It represented a definitive further step, beyond the idea of "serving" or honoring them. This would provoke Yahweh's severe judgment, as he describes in 9:7–9. Later in the book, we hear how King Ahab of Israel took this further definitive step. The author reports in 16:31 that "he went and served Baal, and he bowed down to him." This leads the author to say that Ahab was worse than any other king before him. Because the difference between "serve" and "bow down" has this significance, we recommend that you do not combine these two terms, even if you sometimes combine similar terms in your translation. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain in the text of your translation or in a footnote the significance of bowing down. For example, you might translate "serve and bow down to other gods" as "honor other gods and ultimately commit yourself to them by bowing down to them."

1 Kings 9:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי׀

"And it happened"

See how you translated the phrase "And it happened" in 2:39, where it similarly introduces a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 9:1 (#3)

אֶת־בֵּית־יְהוָה

"the house of Yahweh"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [the temple of]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:1 (#5)

וְאֵת֨ כָּל־חֵ֤שֶׁק שְׁלֹמֹה֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר חָפֵ֔ץ לַֽעֲשׂ֖וֹת

"and all of the desire of Solomon that he delighted to do"

The author is using Solomon's **desire** to build further structures to represent those structures themselves. (He describes them in 9:15 and, with a further reference to desire, in 9:17–19.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all of the other structures that Solomon delighted to build]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:1 (#4)

בְּבֵ֥ית הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

"the house of the king"

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:1. Alternate translation: [his royal palace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:1 (#2)

כְּכַלּ֣וֹת שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה לִבְנ֖וֹת

"when Solomon finished building"

The author is using one person who was involved, Solomon, to mean everyone who was involved in building these structures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, as the UST does. See how you translated similar expressions throughout chapters 5, 6, and 7. Alternate translation: [when Solomon's workers finished building]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 9:2 (#1)

שֵׁנִֽית

“a second time”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **second**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [again] or [once more]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 9:3 (#5)

וְהָי֥וּ עֵינַ֛י וְלִבִּ֖י שָׁ֑ם כָּל־הַיָּמִֽים

“And my eyes and my heart will be there all of the days”

Yahweh is responding to Solomon’s request in 8:29 “that your eyes may be opened to this house.” Solomon was speaking as if he wanted Yahweh always to be looking at the temple, but he meant that he wanted Yahweh always to be listening to the prayers that people offered toward the temple. Yahweh is saying that he will do this and, in addition, he will always care about the temple, the worship in it, and the prayers that people pray toward it. Yahweh is using his **heart** to represent his feelings and commitment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will always listen to the prayers that people pray toward the temple, and it will always be precious to me]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:3 (#6)

כָּל־הַיָּמִֽים

“all of the days”

Yahweh is using the term **days** to refer to time, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:3 (#1)

שָׁמַ֣עְתִּי

“I have heard”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [I have answered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:3 (#4)

לְשׂ֤וּם־שְׁמִי֙ שָׁ֔ם

“to put my name there”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2 and the similar expressions throughout chapter 8. Alternate translation: [for it to be a place where people will worship me] or [for it to be a place where my reputation will be made known]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:3 (#3)

לְפָנָֽי׃

“to my face”

Here, **to my face** represents “in my presence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in my presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:3 (#2)

וְאֶת־תְּחִנָּתְךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֥ר הִתְחַנַּ֖נְתָּה

“and your supplication that you supplicated”

Yahweh is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and the supplication that you made]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 9:4 (#1)

וְאַתָּ֕ה אִם־תֵּלֵ֥ךְ

“And you, if you walk”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you walk** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Solomon, for his part (just as his father had done for his own part), is to live in the way that he describes. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [And if you, for your part, walk] or [And if you personally walk]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 9:4 (#3)

חֻקַּקַי וּמִשְׁפָּטַי תִּשְׁמֹר

“if} you keep my statutes & my judgments”

The terms **statutes** and **judgments** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [if you obey all of my commandments]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 9:4 (#2)

אִם־תֵּלֵךְ לְפָנַי כַּאֲשֶׁר הָלַךְ דָּוִד אָבִיךָ בְּתָם־לֵבָב וּבְיֹשֶׁר

“if you walk to my face just as David your father walked, in integrity of heart and in uprightness”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 3:6, where Solomon says to Yahweh about his father David, “he walked to your face in faithfulness and in righteousness and in uprightness of heart.” Alternate translation: [if you conduct yourself in my presence just as David your father conducted himself, with integrity in your motives and intentions and with upright actions]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:5 (#1)

וַהֲקִמֹתִי אֶת־כִּסֵּא מַמְלַכְתְּךָ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“then I will raise up the throne of your kingdom over Israel”

Yahweh is speaking as if he would physically **raise up** the **throne** of Solomon to a high position above Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express his meaning using an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 3:10. Alternate translation: [then I will establish your rule over the kingdom of Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:5 (#3)

לֹא־יִכָּרֵת לְךָ אִישׁ מֵעַל כִּסֵּא יִשְׂרָאֵל

“A man to you will not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel”

See how you translated this same sentence in 3:4. Alternate translation: [One of your descendants will always be the king of Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:5 (#2)

אָבִיךָ לֵאמֹר לֹא־יִכָּרֵת לְךָ אִישׁ מֵעַל כִּסֵּא יִשְׂרָאֵל

“your father, saying, ‘A man to you will not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [your father when I told him that a man to him would not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 9:6 (#1)

אִם־שׁוֹב תָּשֻׁבוּן אַתֶּם וּבְנֵיכֶם מֵאַחֲרָי

“If turning, you turn, you or your sons, from after me”

Yahweh is speaking as if Solomon or his descendants would be walking behind him but then might **turn** away to walk in a different direction. He means that they would stop living in the manner in which he wants people to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If you or your sons ever stop following me] or [If you or your sons ever stop being devoted to me as your God]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:6 (#7)

וַעֲבַדְתֶּם אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים וְהִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתֶם לָהֶם

“and serve other gods and prostrate yourselves to them”

When applied to “other gods,” the term “serve” refers to honoring them by living as their followers did, building shrines for them, and following religious practices such as praying to them and offering sacrifices to them. Bowing down to these gods (physically bowing to an idol that represented them in a shrine or temple) was a symbolic action of surrender to them as one’s lord. It represented a definitive further step, beyond the idea of “serving” or honoring them, that would provoke Yahweh’s judgment, as he describes in the following verses. So we recommend that you do not combine these two phrases in your translation. While their meaning is similar, there is a significant difference between them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain in the text of your translation or in a footnote the significance of bowing down. Alternate translation: [and honor other gods and ulti-

mately commit yourself to them by bowing down to them]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 9:6 (#4)

לִפְנֵיכֶם

“to your faces”

Here, **to your faces** means “in front of you.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I have set in front of you]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:6 (#2)

אִם־שׁוֹב תְּשֻׁבוּן

“If turning, you turn”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **turn** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [If you ever turn]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 9:6 (#3)

תְּשֻׁבוּן אַתֶּם & וְלֹא תִשְׁמְרוּ & לִפְנֵיכֶם וַהֲלַכְתֶּם

“you turn, you & and you do not keep & to your faces, and you go”

The word **you** is singular in the first two instances because Yahweh is using it to refer to Solomon. The words **you** and **your** (and the implied “you” in the verbs **serve** and **bow down**) are plural in the rest of the verse because Yahweh is using them to refer to Solomon and his **sons**. Use the appropriate singular and plural forms in each case in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 9:6 (#6)

וַהֲלַכְתֶּם וַעֲבַדְתֶּם אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“and you go and serve other gods”

In describing this possible condition, Yahweh is not envisioning that Solomon or later kings would **go** somewhere in order to **serve other gods and bow down to them**. He is using the term **go** to mean that a king might resolve to do these things and take action to do them (leading his Israelite subjects to do the same). Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 7:3. Alternate translation: [and you decide to serve other gods and bow down to them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:6 (#5)

לִפְנֵיכֶם

“to your faces”

Yahweh is speaking as if his commandments and statutes were objects that he had physically placed in front of the Israelites where they could see them. He means that he has given them these laws to obey. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have told you to obey]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:7 (#6)

וְהָיָה יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמָשָׁל וְלִשְׁנִינָה בְּכָל־הָעַמִּים

“and Israel will be for a proverb and for a taunt among all of the peoples”

The word translated as **proverb** indicates in this context that people would use the specific case of Israel as a reference point for a general observation. The word translated as **taunt** means that people would use a comparison with what happened to Israel to mock or ridicule others who suffered a similar fate. So while the meaning of these terms is similar, there is a significant difference between them, and we recommend that you do not combine them into a single term or phrase in your translation. The UST models one way to show their different meanings.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:7 (#1)

וְהִכְרַתִּתִי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי לָהֶם

“then I will cut off Israel from upon the face of the ground that I have given to them”

See how you translated the term “face” in 8:40. Alternate translation: [then I will cut off Israel from upon the surface of the ground that I have given to them]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 9:7 (#2)

וְהִכְרַתִּתִי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי לָהֶם

“then I will cut off Israel from upon the face of the ground that I have given to them”

See how you translated the term “Israel” in 4:20. Alternate translation: [then I will cut off the Israelites from upon the surface of the ground that I have given to them]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:7 (#4)

אֲשַׁלַּח מֵעַל פָּנָי

“I will send away from before my face”

Here, **before my face** represents “in front of me.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will send away from in front of me]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:7 (#5)

אֲשַׁלַּח מֵעַל פָּנָי

“I will send away from before my face”

Yahweh is speaking as if the temple were actually a person whom he could **send away** with a command. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will destroy so that it no longer exists]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:7 (#3)

וְהִכְרַתִּתִי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי לָהֶם

“then I will cut off Israel from upon the face of the ground that I have given to them”

Yahweh is speaking as if he were actually going to **cut off** the Israelites **from ... the ground**, as if they were a plant that he would remove from the ground with a sharp tool. He means that he will remove the Israelites from the land so that they will no longer live in it. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then I will remove the Israelites so that they will no longer live in the land that I have given to them]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:8 (#3)

וְשָׁרָק

“and will hiss”

To **hiss** was to make a sound like a snake by forcing breath through one’s teeth. In this culture, hissing was a way of expressing derision and contempt, like booing or whistling in some modern cultures. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and will hiss in derision]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 9:8 (#1)

וְהַבַּיִת הַזֶּה יִהְיֶה עֶלְיוֹן

“And this house {that} is exalted”

This could mean: (1) that the author is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 7:21 includes the word “which.” You could supply it in your translation if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And this temple, which is exalted] or [And although this temple is now exalted] or (2) that the author is saying that the temple will be **exalted** in the sense of lifted up or heaped up as a ruin. Alternate translation: [And this temple will become a heap of ruins]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 9:8 (#4)

וְאָמְרוּ עַל־מָּה עָשָׂה יְהוָה כָּכָה לָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת וְלַבַּיִת הַזֶּה

“And they will say, ‘Why did Yahweh do thus to this land and to this house”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And they will ask why Yahweh did this to this land and to this temple]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 9:8 (#2)

כָּל־עֹבֵר עָלָיו יִשֹּׁם וְשָׁרָק

“everyone passing by it will be appalled and will hiss”

The expression **will be astonished** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate trans-

lation: [what has happened to it will astonish everyone passing by it, and they will hiss]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 9:8 (#5)

וְאָמְרוּ

“And they will say”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense here, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people will ask]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 9:9 (#5)

וַיַּחֲזִיקוּ בֵּאלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“and they held onto other gods”

The people Yahweh is envisioning are speaking here as if the Israelites were physically holding onto **other gods** with their hands. They mean that they became devoted to or loyal to these gods. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they embraced other gods] or [and they became loyal to other gods]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:9 (#6)

וישתחו לָהֶם וַיַּעַבְדֵם

“and prostrated themselves to them and served them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **served them** before the information about **bowed down to them**, as in 9:6. Alternate translation: [and served them and bowed down to them]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 9:9 (#7)

הֵבִיא יְהוָה עֲלֵיהֶם אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה הַזֹּאת

“Yahweh brought upon them all of this harm”

The author is speaking here as if Yahweh had actually **brought** harm to the people, as if he had carried it over and set it down upon them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh caused all of this harm to happen to them]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:9 (#1)

וְאָמְרוּ עַל־אֲשֶׁר

“And they will say, ‘Because”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And they will say that it was because]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 9:9 (#4)

אֶת־אֲבֹתָם

“their fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [their ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:9 (#2)

וְאָמְרוּ

“And they will say”

The author is continuing to use the pronoun **they** in a general sense. Alternate translation: [And others will answer]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 9:9 (#3)

עַל־אֲשֶׁר

“Because”

The people are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh did this because]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 9:10 (#1)

אֶת־בֵּית יְהוָה וְאֶת־בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ

“the house of Yahweh and the house of the king”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:1. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh and his royal palace]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:11 (#1)

לְכָל־חֶפְצוֹ

“according to all of his delight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **delight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in keeping with everything he wanted]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 9:12 (#1)

וְלֹא יָשְׁרוּ בְּעֵינָיו

“but they were not right in his eyes”

The author is using **they were not right in his eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “they were not acceptable in his judgment” or “they were not satisfactory in his opinion.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but in his judgment, they were not an appropriate gift]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 9:13 (#5)

עַד־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:8. Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:13 (#1)

מָה הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר־נָתַתָּה לִּי אָחִי

“What are these cities that you have given to me, my brother”

Hiram was using the question form to express his dissatisfaction with the cities that Solomon had given him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I do not like these cities that you have given to me, my brother!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 9:13 (#2)

אָחִי

“my brother”

Hiram is speaking here as if he and Solomon were actually **brothers**. Hiram means that he and Solomon are allies or fellow kings who have a close relationship. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my fellow king] or [my ally]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:13 (#3)

כָּבֻל

“Cabul”

It is no longer clear what the term **Cabul** means. Some interpreters suggest that the context indicates that it means “worthless” or “good for nothing.” But since this is uncertain, we recommend that you simply use the name in your translation without explaining its meaning, and that you let readers infer the meaning from the context.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 9:13 (#4)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and that is still their name to this day]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 9:14 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח חִירָם לַמֶּלֶךְ מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים כִּכַּר זָהָב

“Now Hiram had sent to the king 120 kikkars of gold”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand how much Hiram had done for Solomon and why he was therefore so disappointed to receive what he felt was a paltry acknowledgement of his contributions. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 9:14 (#2)

מֵאָ֥ה וְעֶשְׂרִ֖ים כִּכַּ֥ר זָהָֽב

“120 kikkars of gold”

These 120 **kikkars of gold** weighed a total of about 4,000 kilograms or about 9,000 pounds. In your translation, you could use the ancient measurement and spell the word “kikkar” the way it sounds in your language. You could also use the metric measurement given in the UST or use the measurement that your language and culture customarily use. Alternatively, you could use the ancient measurement and put a modern measurement in parentheses in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 9:15 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַמִּלּ֔וֹא

“and the Millo”

The word **Millo** is the name of a place. It was likely a raised platform or landfill that formed part of Jerusalem’s fortifications. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated this name in 2 Samuel 5:9.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 9:15 (#2)

הַמַּ֣ס אֲשֶׁר־הֶעֱלָ֔ה ׀ הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹֽה

“the forced labor that King Solomon brought up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:13. Alternate translation: [the levy that King Solomon raised] or [the work force that King Solomon called up]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 9:15 (#1)

וְזֶ֣ה דְּבַר

“Now this is the matter of”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new topic related to the reign of Solomon, which he has been describing in the course of the story he is telling about the kings of Israel. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new topic.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 9:16 (#4)

שִׁלַּ֣חַ לִבְתּ֔וֹ אֵ֖שֶׁת שְׁלֹמֹֽה

“as} a dowry to his daughter, the wife of Solomon”

A **dowry** is a payment or transfer of money, property, or valuable goods by a woman’s family to her new husband or his family at the time of their marriage. Typically in the biblical culture, a man would instead pay a bride-price to the woman’s family. But some men, especially rulers such as Pharaoh, gave property or territory to their daughters when they were married. If your readers would not be familiar with what a dowry is, you could explain it in your translation with a general term or a descriptive phrase. Alternate translation: [as a gift to his daughter on the occasion of her marriage to Solomon]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 9:16 (#2)

וַיִּשְׂרְפָ֥הּ בָּאֵ֖שׁ

“and he had burned it with fire”

It might seem that the expression **burned it with fire** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and he had burned it down]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 9:16 (#3)

הַֽכְּנַעֲנִ֗י הַיֹּשֵׁ֥ב בָּעִ֛יר

“the Canaanite, the dweller of the city”

The author is not referring to a specific **Canaanite**. He means all of the Canaanites who lived in Gezer. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Canaanites who lived in that city]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 9:16 (#1)

עָלְתָ֔ה

“had gone up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [had gone]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 9:18 (#1)

בָּאָֽרֶץ

“in the land”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **the land**, he means the land of Judah. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the land of Judah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:19 (#1)

וְאֵת ׀ חֵ֣שֶׁק שְׁלֹמֹ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֤ר חָשַׁק֙ לִבְנ֔וֹת

“and the desire of Solomon, whatever he desired to build”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:1. Alternate translation: [and all of the other structures that Solomon desired to build]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:19 (#2)

וּבְכֹ֖ל אֶ֥רֶץ מֶמְשַׁלְתּֽוֹ

“and in all of the land of his dominion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dominion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and in the entire territory that he ruled]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 9:20 (#2)

הָאֱמֹרִ֣י הַֽחִתִּ֔י הַפְּרִזִּי֙ הַֽחִוִּ֔י וְהַיְבוּסִֽי

“the Amorite, the Hittite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Amorite** or to specific members of any of these other people groups. He means those people groups in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 9:20 (#1)

הַנּוֹתָ֖ר

“being left”

The expression **the ones being left** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones remaining]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 9:20 (#3)

מִבְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“from the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 9:21 (#6)

עַ֚ד הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה

“to this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:8. Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:21 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־יָכְל֗וּ בְּנֵי֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל לְהַחֲרִימָ֖ם

“whom the sons of Israel were not able to devote them”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [whom the sons of Israel were not able to devote]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 9:21 (#3)

לְהַחֲרִימָ֖ם

“to devote them”

The word that the ULT translates as **devote** describes the cultural practice of giving something over to Yahweh so that humans will no longer be able to use it. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated this term in its frequent occurrences there. In this context, the term means to “destroy completely.” Alternate translation: [to destroy completely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:21 (#4)

וַיַּעַ֥לֵם שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה לְמַס־עֹבֵ֑ד

“Solomon brought them up for the forced labor of working”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:13. Alternate translation: [Solomon called them up as a work force]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 9:21 (#1)

בְּנֵיהֶם

“their sons”

The masculine term **sons** has a generic sense here that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [their descendants]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 9:21 (#5)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they still serve as forced labor to this day]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 9:22 (#1)

עָבֶד & וַעֲבָדָיו

“a servant & and his servants”

In the first instance, the term **servant** describes in this context a forced laborer. In the second instance, the term **servants** refers to royal officials, as in 1:2 and often elsewhere in this book. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [a forced laborer ... his royal officials]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:23 (#1)

אֵאֵלֶּה ׀ שָׂרֵי הַנִּצָּבִים אֲשֶׁר עַל־הַמְּלָאכָה לִשְׁלֹמֹה חֲמִשִּׁשִּׁים וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת הָרֹדְדִים בָּעָם הָעֹשִׂים בַּמְּלָאכָה

“These {were} the commanders of the deputies who {were} over the work for Solomon, 550, ruling over the people doing the work”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that there were **550** commanders before the information about what the commanders did. Alternate translation: [There were 550 commanders of the deputies who were over the work for Solomon, the ones ruling over the people doing the work]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 9:25 (#3)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“which {was} to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:64. Alternate translation: [which was in front of Yahweh’s temple]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 9:25 (#1)

וְהֶעֱלָה שְׁלֹמֹה & עֹלוֹת וּשְׁלָמִים עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ אֲשֶׁשֶׁר בָּנָה לַיהוָה וְהַקְטֵיר אִתּוֹ אֲשֶׁשֶׁר לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“And & Solomon offered burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar that he had built for Yahweh, and he burned incense with it, which {was} to the face of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **incense** with the information about the **burnt offerings and peace offerings**. Alternate translation: [Solomon offered burnt offerings and peace offerings, and he burned incense with it on the altar that he had built for Yahweh, which was to the face of Yahweh]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 9:25 (#2)

אִתּוֹ

“with it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the offerings that Solomon made. It may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [with them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 9:25 (#4)

וְשִׁלֵּם אֶת־הַבָּיִת

“And he completed the house”

The term translated as **completed** here is different from the term translated as “finished” in 9:1. The author is not restating that Solomon had finished building the temple, even though he is concluding this account of Solomon’s building projects, and he

often concludes an account with a review statement. Instead, he means that by offering these sacrifices on the occasions of Israel's three great annual feasts, Solomon made the Jerusalem temple the center of Israel's worship. The Israelites no longer worshiped at the high places, as the author notes in 3:2 that they had been doing previously. If your language has different words for "finished" and "completed" that would convey these different senses, it would be appropriate to use them in your translation.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 9:26 (#1)

עַל־שְׂפַ֥ת

"on the lip of"

The author is using the term **lip** to mean the shore of the **Sea of Reeds**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the shore of]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 9:27 (#1)

אַנְשֵׁ֥י אֳנִיּ֖וֹת

"men of ships"

The author is using this possessive form to describe **men** who had expertise in sailing **ships**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [sailors]

See: Possession

1 Kings 9:28 (#2)

אַרְבַּע־מֵא֣וֹת וְעֶשְׂרִ֔ים כִּכָּ֖ר

"420 kikkars"

See how you decided to represent the expression "120 kikkars" in 9:14.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 9:28 (#1)

וַיָּבֹֽאוּ

"And they came"

In a context such as this, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [And they went]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues to describe Solomon's reign as king of Israel. The author celebrates his wisdom, riches, and worldwide fame and trading operations. However, at the end of the chapter, the author begins to show how Solomon disobeyed Yahweh at the end of his reign. Solomon sent agents to Egypt to buy horses there, even though this was forbidden in Deuteronomy 17:16. The next chapter will further describe how Solomon disobeyed Yahweh and brought great trouble on Israel.

1. The Queen of Sheba visits Solomon (10:1–13)
2. Solomon's great wealth and wisdom (10:14–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Queen of Sheba

The Queen of Sheba's visit to King Solomon highlights his wealth and wisdom. Having learned of Solomon's reputation, the Queen undertakes a long journey (probably from modern-day Yemen) to see whether he can answer some difficult questions that trouble her. Her visit shows how far his reputation, and with it the reputation of Yahweh, had spread. The Queen is so impressed by Solomon's wisdom and wealth and by the splendor of his kingdom that she praises Yahweh. Her acknowledgment of Yahweh's favor to Solomon and Israel brings glory to him and confirms the blessings that he promised to the Davidic line. This story underscores the global recognition of God's blessing on Israel through Solomon's reign, and it serves as a significant indication of his kingdom's influence.

Sources of Solomon's wealth

Solomon's kingdom was strategically located at the crossroads of major trade routes, including those running through the Arabian Peninsula and up from Egypt. This gave him control over the movement of goods, including gold, spices, and other valuable commodities. He could therefore charge taxes, tolls, and duties. The author describes in 10:15 how Solomon derived such income from "men of the searchers," that is, men who traveled to distant lands to find goods for trade, and from "traders," that is, local merchants who bought goods from traveling merchants and sold them within the country. He also describes how Solomon received income from the "kings of the Arab." That phrase seems to refer to rulers of independent or semi-independent Arabian kingdoms located to the south and east of Israel. These kings apparently made gifts to Solomon from time to time in exchange for peaceful trade relations and as a sign of submission to his

superior military and economic power. The 666 talents of gold that the author mentions in the previous verse might have been a fixed, yearly tax or tribute from Solomon's main vassal states, while the gold from the Arabian kings came as gifts or offerings for trade access. The gifts from the Queen of Sheba, for example, would have been a significant, yet one-time, contribution to Solomon's wealth, separate from his yearly tribute.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Ancient measurements of weight
In several places in this chapter, the author describes a weight of gold or silver using an ancient measurement such as the kikkar, mina, or shekel. In your translation, you could use the ancient measurement and spell these words the way they sound in your language. Alternatively, you could use the metric measurement given in the UST, or you could use the measurement that your language and culture customarily use. You could also use the ancient measurement and put a modern measurement in parentheses in the text or in a footnote. (See: Biblical Weight)

1 Kings 10:1 (#1)

לְשֵׁ֖שֵׁם יְהוָ֑ה

"regarding the name of Yahweh"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:47. Alternate translation: [the character of Yahweh] or [the reputation of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:2 (#1)

אֵ֚את כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָיָ֔ה עִם־לִבָּ֖הּ

"all that was with her heart"

Here, the **heart** represents a person's thoughts and feelings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all that was on her mind] or [everything she wanted to ask about]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 10:3 (#1)

וַיַּגֶּד־לָ֥הּ שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה אֶת־כָּל־דְּבָרֶ֑יהָ לֹא־הָיָ֥ה דָבָר֙ נֶעְלָ֣ם מִן־הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹֽא־הִגִּ֖יד לָֽהּ

"And Solomon declared to her all of her matters. No matter was hidden from the king that he did not declare to her"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [And Solomon was able to find the answer to every one of her questions and explain it to her]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 10:3 (#2)

לֹֽא־הָיָ֥ה דָבָר֙ נֶעְלָ֣ם מִן־הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ

"No matter was hidden from the king"

Here the author is speaking as if the kind of **matter** that the Queen was asking about were an object that could be **hidden**. He means that there was no question that Solomon could not answer. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [There was no question whose answer the king could not find] or [There was nothing that the king was not able to understand]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 10:4 (#1)

וַתֵּ֣רֶא & אֵ֔את כָּל־חָכְמַ֖ת שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה וְהַבַּ֖יִת אֲשֶׁ֥ר בָּנָֽה

"And & saw all of the wisdom of Solomon and the house that he had built"

The author is speaking as if the Queen actually **saw** the **wisdom** that Solomon had. He means that she recognized or perceived Solomon's wisdom by observing his actions, decisions, and responses. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [recognized all of the wisdom of Solomon, and she saw the house that he had built]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 10:4 (#2)

וְהַבַּ֖יִת

"and the house"

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:1. Alternate translation: [the palace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:5 (#2)

בֵּ֥ית יְהוָ֖ה

“at} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [at the temple of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:5 (#3)

וְלֹא־הָיָה בָהּ עֹוד רוּחַ

“And no more breath was in her”

The author is using **no more breath was in her** as a common expression of his culture to mean “she was utterly amazed” or “she was completely overwhelmed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it took her breath away] or [And she was totally amazed]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:5 (#1)

וּמַעֲמַד משרתיו וּמַלְבֻּשֵׁיהֶם וּמַשְׁקָיו

“and the service of his attendants and their apparel and his cupbearers”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **cupbearers** with the information about the **attendants**, since the term **apparel** applies to both groups. Alternate translation: [and the service of his attendants and his cupbearers and their apparel]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 10:6 (#1)

הַדָּבָר

“The word”

Here, **the word** represents what the queen had heard people say about Solomon by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [The report]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:6 (#2)

עַל־דְּבָרֶיךָ וְעַל־חָכְמָתֶךָ

“about your words and about your wisdom”

This could mean: (1) that the Queen of Sheba is using the terms **words** and **wisdom** together to express a single idea. She would be using the term **words** to tell in what way Solomon communicated his **wisdom**. Alternate translation: [about the wise things you say] or [about how wisely you explain things] or (2) that the Queen of Sheba is expressing two different ideas. She would be saying that everything she heard both about Solomon’s achievements and about his **wisdom** was true. In this case, the term translated as **words** would have the sense of [matters,] as in 10:3. Alternate translation: [about your achievements and about your wisdom]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 10:7 (#2)

וַתִּרְאֶינָה עֵינָי

“and my eyes saw”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and my eyes saw the splendor of your kingdom] or [and I saw the splendor of your kingdom with my own eyes]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:7 (#4)

לֹא־הֻגַּד־לִי הַחֵצִי

“the half had not been declared to me”

The expression **had not been declared** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people had not declared the half to me]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:7 (#5)

לֹא־הֻגַּד־לִי הַחֵצִי

“the half had not been declared to me”

The queen is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the half of the extent of your wisdom and prosperity had not been declared to me]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:7 (#7)

הוֹסַפְתָּ חָכְמָה֙ וְטוּב֔וֹב אֶל־הַשְּׁמוּעָ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁמָ֖עְתִּי

“You have added wisdom and goodness to the report that I heard”

The queen is using **added wisdom and goodness to the report** as a common expression of her culture to mean that the splendor of Solomon’s kingdom “greatly exceeded the report” or “surpassed what was reported.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your wisdom and goodness greatly exceed the report that I heard about them]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:7 (#1)

וַתִּרְאֶ֣ינָה עֵינָ֔י

“and my eyes saw”

The queen of Sheba is using one part of herself, her **eyes**, to mean all of her in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I saw with my own eyes] or [and I saw in person]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 10:7 (#3)

וְהִנֵּ֑ה

“and behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [and let me tell you]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 10:7 (#6)

הַחֵצִ֖י

“the half”

A **half** means one part out of two equal parts.

See: Fractions

1 Kings 10:7 (#8)

וְטוּב֔וֹב

“and goodness”

This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [and prosperity] or (2) Alternate translation: [and virtue]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:8 (#2)

אֲנָשֶׁ֑יךָ

“your men”

Here the masculine term **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [your people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 10:8 (#4)

לְפָנֶ֖יךָ

“to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents being in Solomon’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:8 (#1)

אַשְׁרֵ֣י אֲנָשֶׁ֑יךָ אַשְׁרֵ֣י עֲבָדֶ֗יךָ אֵ֚לֶּה הָעֹמְדִ֣ים לְפָנֶ֔יךָ תָּמִ֖יד הַשֹּׁמְעִ֥ים אֶת־חָכְמָתֶֽךָ

“The happiness of your men! The happiness of these servants of yours, the ones standing to your face continually, the ones hearing your wisdom”

The Queen of Sheba is using phrases that express a strong feeling of admiration. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what the Queen of Sheba was feeling, or you could say what made her so impressed. Alternate translation: [How happy your men must be! How happy these servants of yours must be who stand to your face continually and hear your wisdom] or [I admire the wisdom that must make your men and the servants who stand to your face happy when they hear it!]

See: Exclamations

1 Kings 10:8 (#3)

הָעֹמְדִ֣ים לְפָנֶ֔יךָ תָּמִ֖יד הַשֹּׁמְעִ֥ים אֶת־חָכְמָתֶֽךָ

“the ones standing to your face continually, the ones hearing your wisdom”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that these things happen **continually** before the information that Solomon’s servants are **hearing** his **wisdom** and **standing** to his

face. Alternate translation: [who continually stand to your face and hear your wisdom]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 10:9 (#2)

לְתִתְּךָ עַל־כִּסֵּא יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to put you on the throne of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:20. Alternate translation: [to make you the king of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:9 (#1)

יְהִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בָּרוּךְ

“May Yahweh your God be blessed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:48. Alternate translation: [May people bless Yahweh your God] or [May people praise Yahweh your God]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:9 (#3)

לַעֲשׂוֹת מִשְׁפָּט וּצְדָקָה

“to do justice and righteousness”

The phrase **justice and righteousness** expresses a single idea. The word **righteousness** tells in what way Solomon executed **justice**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [to judge righteously]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 10:10 (#1)

מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים ׀ כִּכַּר

“120 kikkars of”

See how you decided to represent the expression “120 kikkars” in 9:14.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 10:11 (#1)

וְגַם־ אֳנִיֹּת חִירָם

“And also the fleet of Hiram”

Here and in the next verse, the author is providing background information about further valuable products that were imported to Jerusalem during the reign of Solomon. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 10:11 (#2)

עֲצֵי אַלְמֻגִּים

“wood of almug”

The phrase **wood of almug** describes a kind of valuable, fragrant wood that most interpreters identify with red sandalwood. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of wood, you could use a general term in your translation. Alternate translation: [valuable wood] or [fragrant wood]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 10:12 (#6)

וְלֹא נִרְאָה

“and has not been seen”

The expression **has not been seen** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no one has seen so much of it]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:12 (#7)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:8. Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:12 (#3)

מְסִלָּה

“a support”

The word translated as **support** occurs only here in the Old Testament. The parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 9:11 has a term that means “stairs,” “stairways,” or “steps.” But since wooden steps would wear out quickly, one possibility is that the term describes a baluster, an ornamental wooden shaft or spindle used in decorative railings for stairways and balconies. Since many of these items seem to be in view, the author could be describing wooden balustrades or railings that Solomon had his workers make for the temple and for his palace. You could indicate this

explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. However, since the meaning is not entirely certain, you could also use a general expression, as the UST does. Alternate translation: [balustrades] or [decorative railings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:12 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַשׂ הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙

“And the king made”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:1. Alternate translation: [And the king had his craftsmen make]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 10:12 (#2)

מִסְעָ֔ד

“a support”

In this verse, the word **support** is singular in form, but in context it seems to refer to a number of such items. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a plural form in your translation. Alternate translation: [supports]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 10:12 (#5)

לֹ֣א בָ֗א כֵּ֚ן עֲצֵ֣י אַלְמֻגִּ֔ים

“Such wood of almug had not come”

The author is speaking of **wood** as if it were a living thing that could come on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [No one had brought so much wood of almug before]

See: Personification

1 Kings 10:12 (#4)

לֹ֣א בָ֗א כֵּ֚ן עֲצֵ֣י אַלְמֻגִּ֔ים

“Such wood of almug had not come”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Such wood of almug had not come for abundance]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:13 (#1)

אֶת־כָּל־חֶפְצָהּ֙

“all of her desire”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:11. Alternate translation: [everything she wanted]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 10:13 (#2)

כְּיַ֣ד הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“according to the hand of King Solomon”

Since the author has already mentioned King Solomon by name earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [according to his own hand]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 10:13 (#3)

כְּיַ֣ד הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“according to the hand of King Solomon”

Here, **hand** represents the power and resources of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [freely from his own wealth]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:13 (#4)

וַתֵּ֥פֶן וַתֵּ֖לֶךְ

“And she turned and went”

The phrase **turned and went** expresses a single idea. The word **turned** tells in what way the Queen **went**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And she went back]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 10:14 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־בָּ֥א לִשְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

“that came to Solomon”

The author is speaking of **gold** as if it were a living thing that could come to a person on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that people brought to Solomon]

See: Personification

1 Kings 10:14 (#2)

שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שִׁשִּׁים וְשֵׁשׁ כִּכַּר זָהָב

“666 kikkars of gold”

See how you decided to represent the similar expression “120 kikkars” in 9:14.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 10:15 (#3)

מֵאַנְשֵׁי הַתָּרִֽים

“from the men of the searchers”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the group of people that this phrase describes and of the other groups that the author mentions here. Alternate translation: [from men who traveled in search of goods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:15 (#4)

וְכָל־מַלְכֵי הָעֲרֶב

“and all of the kings of the Arab”

In this verse, the word **Arab** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Arabian people groups that often gave gifts to Solomon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that would indicate this. Alternate translation: [and all of the kings of the Arabs] or [and all of the Arabian kings]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 10:15 (#2)

מֵאַנְשֵׁי הַתָּרִֽים

“from the men of the searchers”

The author is using this possessive form to mean men who searched or men whose job it was to search. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from the men who were searchers]

See: Possession

1 Kings 10:15 (#1)

לְבַדְּ֣ מֵאַנְשֵׁי הַתָּרִֽים

“apart from the men of the searchers”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. See the discussion of the sources of Solomon’s wealth in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [apart from the gold he received through taxes, duties, and tolls from the men of the searchers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:15 (#5)

וְכָל־מַלְכֵי הָעֲרֶב

“and all of the kings of the Arab”

The author says **all of the kings of the Arab** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and kings throughout Arabia]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 10:15 (#6)

וּפַחֲוֹת הָאָֽרֶץ

“and the governors of the land”

The word translated as **governors** seems to refer to the same officials whom the author calls “deputies” in chapter 4. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the same term here that you used there. Alternate translation: [and the deputies who governed the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:16 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הַמֶּ֠לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹ֨ה מָאתַ֤יִם צִנָּ֙ה זָהָ֔ב שָׁחָ֖וּט

“And King Solomon made 200 beaten-gold large shields”

The expression **beaten-gold shields** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And King Solomon had his workers make 200 large shields by beating out gold]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:16 (#4)

שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת זָהָ֖ב יַעֲלֶ֣ה עַל־הַצִּנָּ֑ה הָאֶֽחָת

“he brought up 600 gold onto one large shield”

The author is using **600 gold went up onto one large shield** as a common expression of his culture to mean “600 shekels of gold were used to make each large shield.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [600 shekels of gold went into making each large shield] or [each large shield contained 600 shekels of gold]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:16 (#5)

שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת זָהָב

“600 gold”

These 600 shekels of **gold** would have weighed nearly seven kilograms or about 15 pounds. In your translation, you could use the ancient measurement and spell the word “shekel” the way it sounds in your language. You could also use the metric measurement given in the UST or the measurement that your language and culture customarily use. Alternatively, you could use the ancient measurement and put a modern measurement in parentheses in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 10:16 (#2)

צִנָּנָה

“large shields”

The term translated as **large shields** here is different from the term translated as “shields” in the next verse. The difference in the amount of gold used for each kind of shield suggests that the ones in the next verse were probably about the size that a warrior would carry on his arm, while the ones here may have been large enough to shield a warrior’s entire body. If your language has different terms for shields of these types, it would be appropriate to use those terms in your translation.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:16 (#3)

שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת זָהָב יַעֲלֶה עַל־הַצִּנָּנָה הָאֶחָת

“he brought up 600 gold onto one large shield”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 18:11. Alternate translation: [600 shekels of gold went up onto one large shield]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:17 (#3)

שְׁלֹשֶׁת מָנִים זָהָב

“three gold minas”

These **three gold minas** would have weighed about one and a half kilograms or a little over three pounds. See how you decided to express the weight of 600 gold shekels that the author describes in the previous verse.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 10:17 (#1)

וּשְׁלֹשׁ־מֵאוֹת מָגִנִּים זָהָב שָׁחוּט

“and 300 beaten-gold shields”

The expression **beaten-gold shields** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he had his workers make 300 shields by beating out gold]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:17 (#2)

שְׁלֹשֶׁת מָנִים זָהָב יַעֲלֶה עַל־הַמָּגֵן הָאֶחָת

“he brought up three gold minas onto one shield”

See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [three minas of gold went into making each shield] or [each shield contained three minas of gold]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:18 (#1)

זָהָב מוּפָז

“with} refined gold”

The expression **refined gold** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [with gold that workers had refined] or [with very pure gold]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:19 (#1)

וְרֹאשׁ־עֶגֶל לַכִּסֵּה מֵאֲחֳרָיו

“and a round head {was} to the throne from behind it”

The author is using the term **head** to mean the top of the **throne**. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the back of the throne had a rounded top]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:19 (#2)

וְיָדֹת

“And hands”

The author is using the term **hands** to mean the part of a chair on which someone sitting in the chair would rest his arms. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And arms] or [And armrests]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:19 (#3)

מִזֶּה וּמִזֶּה אֶל־מְקֹם הַשָּׁשֶׁבֶת

“were} from this and from this to the place of the seat”

The author is using **from this side and from that side** as a common expression of his culture to mean “on both sides.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [were on both sides of the seat]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:19 (#4)

אֲרָיוֹת

“lions”

The implication is that these were carved or sculpted statues, not living animals. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [statues of lions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:20 (#1)

מִזֶּה וּמִזֶּה

“from this side and from that side”

The author is using **from this side and from that side** as a common expression of his culture to mean “on both sides” or “on each side.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one on each side of each step]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:20 (#2)

לֹא־נַעֲשָׂתָה כֵּכֶן

“It had not been done thus”

The expression **It was not made** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one made any throne like this]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:21 (#2)

לֹא נֶחְשָׁבָה & לִמְאוּמָה

“It was not reckoned as anything”

The expression **was not reckoned** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People did not reckon it as anything] or [People did not consider it to have any value]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:21 (#3)

בִּימֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“in the days of Solomon”

The author is using the term **days** to mean a specific period of time, since time consists of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during the reign of Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:21 (#1)

וְכֹל כְּלֵי בֵּית־יַעַר הַלְּבָנוֹן זָהָב סָגוּר

“and all of the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were beaten gold”

The expression **were beaten gold** uses a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate trans-

lation: [and craftsmen had made all of the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon by beating out gold]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 10:22 (#2)

אֳנִ֣י תַרְשִׁ֔ישׁ

“a fleet of Tarshish”

The author seems to be using the name **Tarshish**, most likely a place in southern Spain, at the west end of the Mediterranean Sea, to indicate that this was a **fleet** of long-range, ocean-going ships that stopped at ports all around the Mediterranean Sea. The three-year length of each voyage supports this understanding. (Furthermore, the author’s statement in 22:48 that “Jehoshaphat made ships of Tarshish to go to Ophir” supports the idea that this phrase describes the size and range of such ships rather than their destination. Several different locations have been suggested for Ophir, but all would have been reached through the Arabian Sea, and thus by ships sailing in a different direction from Tarshish.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language here. Alternate translation: [a fleet of long-range ships]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:22 (#4)

אַחַ֥ת לְשָׁלֹ֖שׁ שָׁנִ֑ים

“One in three years”

The author is using **One in three years** as a common expression of his culture to mean “once every three years.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Once every three years]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:22 (#1)

כִּי֩

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces a further explanation. Alternate translation: [There was so much gold and silver because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 10:22 (#3)

בַּיָּ֛ם

“on the sea”

By **on the sea**, the author means on the Mediterranean Sea. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. If so, you may wish to use the name that the ancient Hebrews used for that sea. Alternate translation: [on the Mediterranean Sea] or [on the Great Sea]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 10:22 (#5)

שֶׁנְהַבִּ֥ים

“elephant tusks”

An **elephant** is a very large land mammal. The term **tusks** describes the two long, protruding teeth that elephants have. These consist of ivory, a beautiful and valuable substance. If your readers would not be familiar with what **elephant tusks** are, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [ivory]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 10:22 (#6)

וְקֹפִ֖ים

“and apes”

The term **apes** describes a kind of primate, an animal that is like a monkey but larger. If your readers would not be familiar with what an ape is, you could use the name of a similar animal that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and large monkeys]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 10:22 (#7)

וְקֹפִ֖ים

“and apes”

The term **peacocks** describes a kind of bird with large, colorful tail feathers. If your readers would not be familiar with what a peacock is, you could use the name of a similar bird that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [colorful birds] or [exotic birds]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 10:23 (#1)

מִכֹּ֖ל מַלְכֵ֥י הָאָֽרֶץ

“than all of the kings of the earth”

The author says **all of the kings of the earth** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [any other king who was ruling at that time]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 10:24 (#3)

לִשְׁמֹעַ֙ אֶת־חָכְמָתֹ֔ו אֲשֶׁר־נָתַ֥ן אֱלֹהִ֖ים בִּלְבֹּֽו

“to hear his wisdom, which God had put in his heart”

The author is speaking as if wisdom were an object that God could have placed in Solomon’s **heart**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to hear the wisdom that God had given him in his mind]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 10:24 (#2)

וְכָל־הָאָ֗רֶץ מְבַקְשִׁ֛ים אֶת־פְּנֵ֥י שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

“And all of the earth was seeking the face of Solomon”

Here, **the face of Solomon** represents being in Solomon’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And people from throughout the earth wanted to come into the presence of Solomon] or [And people from throughout the earth wanted to have an audience with Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 10:24 (#4)

לִשְׁמֹעַ֙ אֶת־חָכְמָתֹ֔ו אֲשֶׁר־נָתַ֥ן אֱלֹהִ֖ים בִּלְבֹּֽו

“to hear his wisdom, which God had put in his heart”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to hear the wise things he said, which God had put in his heart] or [to hear the wise things he said, which God had enabled him to understand]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 10:24 (#1)

וְכָל־הָאָ֗רֶץ מְבַקְשִׁ֛ים אֶת־פְּנֵ֥י שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

“And all of the earth was seeking the face of Solomon”

The author says **all of the earth** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And people from throughout the earth were seeking the face of Solomon]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 10:25 (#3)

דְּבַר־שָׁנָ֥ה בְשָׁנָ֖ה

“a matter of year by year”

The author is using **year by year** as a common expression of his culture to mean “continually” or “every year without exception.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and this happened year after year] or [and people did this continually]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:25 (#1)

וְהֵ֣בִ֔יאוּ אִ֖ישׁ מִנְחָתֹֽו

“And they were bringing, a man his gift”

The author is using **a man his gift** as a common expression of the culture to mean “each man brought his own gift” or “every person brought a gift.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And each man brought Solomon a gift]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:25 (#2)

וְהֵ֣בִ֔יאוּ אִ֖ישׁ מִנְחָתֹֽו

“And they were bringing, a man his gift”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [And each person brought Solomon a gift]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 10:26 (#1)

וְעִם־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“and with the king”

Since the phrase **the king** refers to Solomon, who is the subject of this sentence (represented by the pronoun **he**), it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and with him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 10:27 (#2)

וַיִּתֵּ֤ן הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ אֶת־הַכֶּ֔סֶף בִּירוּשָׁלַ֖͏ִם כָּאֲבָנִ֑ים

“And the king made silver in Jerusalem like stones”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And the king made silver in Jerusalem to be like stones for abundance]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:27 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּ֤ן הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ אֶת־הַכֶּ֔סֶף בִּירוּשָׁלַ֖͏ִם כָּאֲבָנִ֑ים וְאֶ֨ת הָאֲרָזִ֜ים נָתַ֗ן כַּשִּׁקְמִ֛ים אֲשֶׁר־בַּשְּׁפֵלָ֖ה לָרֹֽב

“And the king made silver in Jerusalem like stones, and he made cedars like the sycamores that {are} in the Shephelah for abundance”

The author is making overstatements for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 10:27 (#3)

בַּשְּׁפֵלָֽה

“are} in the Shephelah”

The word **Shephelah** is the name of a place within the territory of the tribe of Judah, the foothills between the highlands and the coastal plain. Alternate translation: [the Judean foothills]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 10:28 (#1)

וּמִקְוֵ֣ה

“and from Kue”

The word **Kue** is the name of a place. Most interpreters identify it with Cilicia, a region in what is now the nation of Turkey.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 10:28 (#2)

בְּמְחִֽיר

“for a price”

The author is using **for a price** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Solomon’s traders would buy these horses at whatever price was current at the time. (It appears that while the prices in Egypt were relatively fixed, as the next verse indicates, the prices in Kue fluctuated.) If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the going price] or [at the market price]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 10:29 (#1)

וַתַּ֤עַל וַתֵּצֵא֙ מֶרְכָּבָ֔ה מִמִּצְרַ֖יִם

“And a chariot came up and went out from Egypt”

The author is speaking of a **chariot** as if it were a living thing that **came up and went out** from a place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a chariot could be imported from Egypt]

See: Personification

1 Kings 10:29 (#2)

בְּשֵׁ֣שׁ מֵא֗וֹת כֶּ֚סֶף וְסוּס֙ בַּחֲמִשִּׁ֣ים וּמֵאָ֔ה

“for 600 silver, and a horse for 150”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [for 600 silver shekels, and a horse could be imported from Egypt for 150 silver shekels]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 10:29 (#5)

יֹֽצְאִ֑ו

“they brought out”

The pronoun **they** refers to Solomon’s agents or traders. It may be helpful to clarify this for your read-

ers. Alternate translation: [Solomon's traders brought out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 10:29 (#3)

בְּשֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת כֶּסֶף & בַּחֲמִשִּׁים וּמֵאָה

"for 600 silver & for 150"

See how you translated the expression "600 gold" in 10:16. You can express the weight of these **silver** shekels in the same way.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 10:29 (#4)

בְּיָדָם

"by their hand"

Here, **hand** represents the agency of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by their agency]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings - Chapter 11 Introduction

This chapter concludes the description of Solomon's reign as king of Israel. The author describes how Solomon built shrines to foreign gods in Jerusalem so that his wives could worship there. This made Yahweh so angry that he made some of Solomon's enemies powerful enough to resist him. Yahweh also sent a prophet to a man named Jeroboam, one of Solomon's officials, to tell him that he would become the king of ten of the Israelite tribes`.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Further phrases that the author uses to conclude accounts of kings' reigns

In 11:41–43, the author uses the same phrases to describe the end of Solomon's reign that he used to describe the end of David's reign in 2:10–11. He says for how many years Solomon ruled as king and describes his death and burial. However, he begins by making an additional statement, that further details of Solomon's reign are "written in the book of the matters of Solomon." This is the first instance of this kind of reference to another book for further details, but after this the author will make such a reference regularly as he concludes the account of the reign of a king. So that your readers will appreciate the role of this reference, be careful to translate it consistently in each of its occurrences.

Long quotation within quotation

The prophet Ahijah speaks a long message from Yahweh to Jeroboam in 11:31–39. Most of it is a quotation within a quotation. The author quotes what Ahijah said, and Ahijah quotes what Yahweh told him to say. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. For example, Ahijah begins in 11:31 by telling Jeroboam, "For thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, 'Behold me, tearing the kingdom from the hand of Solomon and I will give ten tribes to you." You could translate this as, "For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says that he is about to tear the kingdom from the hand of Solomon and give ten tribes to you." You can continue to translate the message that way in subsequent verses. For example, in 11:32, Ahijah continues, "But one tribe will be to him for the sake of my servant David and for the sake of Jerusalem, the city upon which I have chosen from all of the tribes of Israel." You could translate that as, "But he says that one tribe will be to him for the sake of his servant David and for the sake of Jerusalem, the city upon which he has chosen from all of the tribes of Israel." (See: Quotes within Quotes)

If Jeroboam was to rule ten of the twelve Israelite tribes, how was only one tribe left for David's descendants to rule?

In 11:30–32, the prophet Ahijah tears his robe in twelve pieces and tells Jeroboam to take ten of them. Ahijah explains that this shows that Yahweh will make Jeroboam the king of ten of the Israelite tribes. He says further that one tribe will remain for David's descendants to rule. But that leaves one tribe to be accounted for. The explanation is that Yahweh, speaking through Ahijah, assumes that Jeroboam will understand that by "one tribe," he means the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin. The author was able to assume that readers would understand this as well, so he does not explain it in the text. As the story. later shows (in 12:21), Judah and Benjamin had become closely aligned. Jerusalem was on the border between those two tribes, with much of the city in the territory of Benjamin. The Benjaminites could easily come to the worship in the temple. So by this time, Judah and Benjamin had come to be considered as one tribe. Since modern readers generally do not have this information, it may be helpful to indicate this explicitly in your translation. Notes will suggest possible ways to do that in various contexts. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

1 Kings 11:1 (#1)

וְאֶת־בַּת־פַּרְעֹה

“and the daughter of Pharaoh”

The **daughter of Pharaoh** herself was one of these **foreign women**. Your language may have a connecting word or phrase that you could use to indicate this. Alternate translation: [in addition to the daughter of Pharaoh]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 11:2 (#4)

יַטּוּ אֶת־לְבַבְכֶם אַחֲרֵי אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“they will stretch out your heart after their gods”

To translate this expression and the similar ones in verses 3, 4, and 9, see how you translated the similar expression “may he stretch out our heart to him” in 8:58. Alternate translation: [they will make you become devoted to their gods]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:2 (#5)

אֶת־לְבַבְכֶם

“your heart”

In this verse, the word **heart** is singular in form, but it refers to all the Israelites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, if you decide to retain this image in your translation, you could use the plural form of “heart.” Alternate translation: [your hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 11:2 (#6)

בָּהֶם דָּבַק שְׁלֹמֹה לְאַהֲבָה

“Solomon clung to them in love”

The author is speaking of Solomon’s romantic attachment to these foreign women as if he had physically **clung** to them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Solomon loved them and became attached to them] or [Solomon loved them and insisted on marrying them]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 11:2 (#1)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:2 (#3)

לֹא־תָבֹאוּ בָהֶם וְהֵמָּה לֹא יָבֹאוּ בָכֶם

“You must not enter into them, and they must not enter into you”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You must not intermarry with the people of those groups]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 11:2 (#2)

לֹא־תָבֹאוּ בָהֶם וְהֵמָּה לֹא יָבֹאוּ בָכֶם

“You must not enter into them, and they must not enter into you”

Yahweh was using **enter into** as a common expression of his culture to mean “intermarry.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You must not intermarry with them, and they must not intermarry with you]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:3 (#2)

וַיַּטּוּ נָשָׁיו אֶת־לִבּוֹ

“And his wives stretched out his heart”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. The usual full expression occurs in verse 2. Alternate translation: [And his wives stretched out his heart after their gods] or [And his wives caused him to become devoted to their gods]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:3 (#1)

וַיְהִי־לוֹ נָשִׁים שָׂרוֹת שְׁבַע מֵאוֹת

“And to him were 700 wives, princesses”

The author is using the expression **wives, princesses** to introduce these wives of Solomon as new partici-

pants in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And he had 700 wives who were princesses] or [And he had 700 wives whom he had married to make alliances with their fathers, who were kings]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:4 (#2)

וְלֹא־הָיָ֤ה לְבָבְוֹ֙ שָׁלֵ֔ם עִם־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהָ֑יו כִּלְבַב֙ דָּוִ֣יד אָבִ֔יו

“And his heart was not complete with Yahweh his God like the heart of David his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:61. Alternate translation: [And he was not completely devoted to Yahweh his God as David his father had been]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:4 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 8:10, where it similarly introduces a new development.

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:5 (#1)

וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה֙ אַחֲרֵ֣י עַשְׁתֹּ֔רֶת & וְאַחֲרֵ֖י מִלְכֹּ֥ם

“And Solomon went after Ashtoreth & and after Milcom”

The author is using **went after** as a common expression of the culture to mean “worshiped.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Solomon worshiped Ashtoreth ... and Milcom]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:5 (#2)

שִׁקֻּ֥ץ עַמֹּנִֽים

“the abomination of the Ammonites”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way, here and in verse 7. Alternate translation: [the abominable god of the Ammonites] or [the detestable god of the Ammonites]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 11:6 (#3)

וְלֹ֣א מִלֵּ֔א אַחֲרֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“and he was not full after Yahweh”

The author is using this common expression of his culture to mean that Solomon was not completely devoted and obedient to Yahweh. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated the similar expression in Joshua 14:8. Alternate translation: [and he did not follow Yahweh fully] or [and he did not obey Yahweh completely]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 11:6 (#1)

הָרַ֥ע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:6 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:7 (#3)

וּלְמֹ֣לֶךְ

“and for Molech”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he built a high place for Molech]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:7 (#2)

עַל־פְּנֵ֖י יְרוּשָׁלִָֽם

“is} on the face of Jerusalem”

Here, **on the face of Jerusalem** represents being in front of or opposite Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [opposite Jerusalem]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:7 (#1)

אָז֩ יִבְנֶ֨ה שְׁלֹמֹ֜ה

“Then Solomon built”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:1. Alternate translation: [Then Solomon had his workers build]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 11:8 (#1)

נָשָׁ֣יו הַנָּכְרִיּ֗וֹת מַקְטִירוֹת֙ וּמְזַבְּח֣וֹת לֵאלֹהֵיהֶֽן

“his foreign wives burning incense and sacrificing to their gods”

The verbs **burning** and **sacrificing** are feminine plural, so the author means that it was Solomon’s wives, not Solomon himself, who were doing these things. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [his foreign wives, who were burning incense and sacrificing to their gods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:9 (#1)

וַיִּתְאַנַּ֖ף יְהוָ֑ה בִּשְׁלֹמֹ֔ה כִּי־נָטְתָ֣ה לְבָבֹ֔ו מֵעִ֖ם יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל הַנִּרְאָ֥ה אֵלָ֖יו פַּעֲמָֽיִם

“And Yahweh became angry with Solomon, for his heart had stretched away from with Yahweh, the God of Israel, the one having appeared to him two times”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Solomon’s heart had stretched away from with Yahweh, the God of Israel, the one having appeared to him two times, Yahweh became angry with him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 11:9 (#2)

נָטְתָ֣ה לְבָבֹ֔ו מֵעִ֖ם יְהוָ֣ה

“his heart had stretched away from with Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:2. Alternate translation: [he had become devoted to gods other than Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:10 (#1)

לְבִלְתִּי־לֶ֖כֶת אַחֲרֵ֣י אֱלֹהִ֑ים אֲחֵרִ֔ים

“not to go after other gods”

The author is using **go after other gods** as a common expression of his culture to mean “worship other gods.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [not to follow other gods] or [not to worship other gods]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:11 (#2)

בְּרִיתִ֥י וְחֻקֹּתַ֖י

“my covenant and my statutes”

The phrase **my covenant and my statutes** expresses a single idea. The word **covenant** tells what kind of **statutes** these are. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [the statutes of my covenant] or [my covenantal statutes]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 11:11 (#1)

הָיְתָ֥ה־זֹּ֖את עִמָּ֑ךְ

“this is with you”

Yahweh is using **this is with you** as a common expression of his culture to mean “you have done this.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you have done this]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:11 (#3)

קָרֹ֣עַ אֶקְרַ֔ע אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָ֖ה מֵעָלָ֑יִךְ

“tearing, I will tear the kingdom away from you”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **tear** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I will certainly tear the kingdom away from you]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 11:11 (#4)

קָרֹ֣עַ אֶקְרַ֗ע אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָה֙ מֵעָלָ֔יִךְ

“tearing, I will tear the kingdom away from you”

Yahweh is speaking as if taking the kingdom from Solomon were actually **tearing** it away from him. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next two verses. Alternate translation: [I will certainly take the kingdom away from you]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:12 (#1)

בְּיָמֶ֖יךָ לֹ֣א אֶעֱשֶׂ֑נָּה לְמַ֨עַן֙ דָּוִ֣ד אָבִ֔יךָ

“I will not do it in your days, for the sake of David your father”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [for the sake of David your father, I will not do it in your days]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 11:12 (#2)

בְּיָמֶ֖יךָ

“in your days”

Yahweh is using the term **days** to represents a period of time, specifically the lifetime of Solomon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during your lifetime]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:12 (#3)

מִיַּ֥ד בִּנְךָ֖

“From the hand of your son”

Here, **hand** represents the power or authority of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [From the authority of your son]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:13 (#1)

שֵׁ֣בֶט אֶחָ֔ד אֶתֵּ֖ן לִבְנֶ֑ךָ

“I will give one tribe to your son”

Yahweh is speaking as if a **tribe** were an object that he could actually **give** to Solomon’s son. He means that he will allow Solomon’s son to continue ruling over one tribe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will allow your son to continue ruling one tribe]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:13 (#2)

שֵׁ֣בֶט אֶחָ֔ד

“one tribe”

Yahweh assumes that Solomon will understand that by **one tribe**, he means the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin. See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how Judah and Benjamin came to be considered one tribe. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation here and in verses 32 and 36 if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:14 (#1)

וַיָּ֧קֶם יְהוָ֛ה שָׂטָ֖ן לִשְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“And Yahweh raised up an adversary against Solomon”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh had physically **raised up** this **adversary**, that is, as if he had lifted him up into the air or to an elevated location. In contexts such as this, this expression describes making a person powerful or giving a person a powerful position. To translate this expression here and in verse 23, see how you represented the same image in 9:5. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh made someone a powerful adversary of Solomon]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:14 (#2)

אֵ֚ת הֲדַ֣ד הָאֲדֹמִ֔י מִזֶּ֖רַע הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ הֽוּא בֶּאֱדֹֽום

“Hadad the Edomite. He {was} from the seed of the king in Edom”

The author is introducing **Hadad the Edomite** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [There was a man named Hadad the Edomite. He was from the seed of the king in Edom]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 11:14 (#3)

מִזֶּ֖רַע הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ הוּא֙ בֶּאֱדֹֽום

“He {was} from the seed of the king in Edom”

The author is speaking of Hadad as if he had actually grown from **the seed of the king**, as if a person were a plant that grew from a seed. He means that Hadad was a descendant of the king of Edom. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He was a descendant of the king of Edom]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:15 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“Now it had happened”

The author is providing background information about **when David was in Edom** to help readers understand how Hadad became an adversary to Solomon. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 11:15 (#3)

אֶת־הַחֲלָלִ֔ים

“the slain”

The author is using the adjective **slain** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the Israelite soldiers whom the Edomites had slain]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 11:15 (#4)

וַיַּ֥ךְ

“that he had struck”

See the discussion of the term “struck” in the introduction to 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [that he had killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:15 (#5)

וַיַּ֥ךְ

“that he had struck”

The author says that Joab had **struck** or killed every male in Edom as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [that he had tried hard to kill]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 11:15 (#2)

בַּעֲלֹ֤ות יוֹאָב֙ שַׂ֣ר הַצָּבָ֔א

“when Joab, the commander of the army, had gone up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [when Joab, the commander of the army, had gone]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 11:16 (#4)

כָּל־זָכָ֖ר בֶּאֱדֹֽום

“every male in Edom”

The author says **every male in Edom** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [every Edomite male they could capture]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 11:16 (#2)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“and all of Israel”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to 1 Kings of how the author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its people. Here the author is using the name **Israel** to represent the army of that nation. Alternate translation: [and the entire Israelite army]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:16 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but a further explanation. Alternate translation: [Specifically]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 11:16 (#3)

הִכְרִ֥ית

“he had cut off”

The author is speaking as if Joab had actually **cut off** the Edomite males, as if they had been plants that he and his soldiers had removed from the ground with a sharp tool. He means that Joab and his soldiers killed them. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:7. Alternate translation: [he and his soldiers had killed]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:17 (#1)

וַיִּבְרַ֣ח אֲדַ֗ד הוּא֙ וַאֲנָשִׁ֣ים אֲדֹמִיִּ֔ים מֵעַבְדֵ֖י אָבִ֑יו אִתּ֥וֹ לָבֹ֖וא מִצְרָ֑יִם

“But Adad fled, he and Edomite men from the servants of his father with him, to enter Egypt”

Since Hadad was a **little boy** at this time, it is not likely that he fled on his own. It appears that these **men from the servants of his father** conducted him to safety. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:17 (#2)

אֲדַ֗ד

“Adad”

Adad is a variant spelling of the name **Hadad**. The author may be giving his name in the form in which the people he encountered in the places described in the next verse would have said it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the name “Hadad” here.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 11:18 (#2)

וַיִּתֶּן־לוֹ֙ בַּ֔יִת

“And he gave a house to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Pharaoh, while the pronoun **him** refers to Hadad. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Pharaoh gave a house to Hadad]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 11:18 (#3)

וְלֶ֖חֶם

“and & bread”

The author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 11:18 (#1)

וַיָּקֻ֣מוּ מִמִּדְיָ֗ן וַיָּבֹ֙אוּ֙ פָּארָ֔ן

“And they arose from Midian and entered Paran”

The author does not mean that the journey of Hadad and his escorts began in **Midian**. He assumes that readers will understand that first they fled from Edom to nearby Midian. From there, they undertook the difficult and dangerous journey through the wilderness of **Paran** to **Egypt**. So the term **arose** here has the sense of “took action,” as in 2:40. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:19 (#1)

וַיִּמְצָ֤א הֲדַד֙ חֵ֣ן בְּעֵינֵ֔י פַּרְעֹ֖ה מְאֹ֑ד

“And Hadad found much favor in the eyes of Pharaoh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [And Pharaoh regarded Hadad very favorably] or [And Pharaoh was very pleased with Hadad]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:19 (#2)

אֶת־אֲחוֹת֙ אִשְׁתּ֣וֹ

“the sister of his wife”

Your language may have its own term or expression for the relationship that the author describes here with the phrase **the sister of his wife**. Alternate translation: [his sister-in-law]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 11:20 (#1)

וַתִּגְמְלֶ֥הוּ תַחְפְּנֵ֛ס בְּתוֹךְ־בֵּ֥ית פַּרְעֹֽה

“and Tahpenes weaned him in the midst of the house of Pharaoh”

Nursing Genubath until he was **weaned** was a symbolic action by which Tahpenes showed that she was accepting him as her own child and giving him full status in Pharaoh’s household. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and Tahpenes nursed him until he was weaned in order to show that she accepted him as her own child and a member of Pharaoh’s household]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 11:21 (#2)

שַׁלְּחֵ֣נִי

“Send me away”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please allow me to leave]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 11:21 (#1)

שָׁכַ֤ב דָּוִד֙ עִם־אֲבֹתָ֔יו

“David had lain down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [That David had passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 11:22 (#2)

וְהִנְּךָ֣ מְבַקֵּ֔שׁ לָלֶ֖כֶת

“that behold you, seeking to go”

Pharaoh is using **behold you** as a common expression of his culture that indicates that someone is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “behold me, saying” in 5:5. Alternate translation: [that I see that you are about to try to go]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:22 (#1)

כִּ֣י מָה־אַתָּ֤ה חָסֵר֙ עִמָּ֔י וְהִנְּךָ֣ מְבַקֵּ֔שׁ לָלֶ֖כֶת אֶל־אַרְצֶ֑ךָ וַיֹּ֖אמֶר לֹ֥א׃

“But what {are} you lacking with me, that behold you, seeking to go to your land?” And he said, “Nothing”

Pharaoh is using the question form to suggest a reason why Hadad should not leave Egypt. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Since Hadad, as part of a courteous exchange, answers Pharaoh’s question, even though he is not really asking for information, you could translate Hadad’s answer as a statement rather than as a response. Alternate translation: [I do not understand why you are seeking to go to your land, since you lack nothing with me.” And he said, “I do not lack anything here]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 11:22 (#4)

שַׁלֵּ֥חַ תְּשַׁלְּחֵ֖נִי

“sending, may you send me away”

Hadad is repeating forms of the verb **send** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [please do send me away] or [please do allow me to leave]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 11:22 (#5)

שַׁלֵּ֥חַ תְּשַׁלְּחֵ֖נִי

“sending, may you send me away”

The author indicates in 11:25 that Hadad did “harm” to Solomon, but here he ends his specific account of how Hadad became an “adversary” to Solomon without describing how Hadad returned to Edom and fomented a rebellion. The author assumes that his readers already know how he did that. You could include some indication of this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:22 (#3)

לֹּֽא

“Nothing”

Hadad is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I lack nothing]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:23 (#1)

שָׂטָ֑ן

“an adversary”

By **an adversary**, the author means another adversary in addition to Hadad, whom he has just described. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [another adversary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:23 (#3)

אֶת־רְזֹ֣ן בֶּן־אֶלְיָדָ֗ע אֲשֶׁ֤ר בָּרַח֙ מֵאֵ֣ת הַדַּדְעֶ֔זֶר מֶ֖לֶךְ־צוֹבָ֑ה אֲדֹנָֽיו

“Rezon, the son of Eliada, who had fled from Hadadezer, the king of Zobah, his master”

The author is introducing **Rezon** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [There was a man named Rezon, the son of Eliada, who had fled from Hadadezer, the king of Zobah, his master]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 11:23 (#2)

לֽוֹ׃

“against him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Solomon. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [against Solomon]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 11:24 (#3)

בְּדַמֶּ֑שֶׂק

“in Damascus”

Since the author has already named **Damascus** earlier in the sentence, it might seem that the expression **in Damascus** here contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [there]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 11:24 (#1)

וַיִּקַּבְּצֵ֥ן עָלָ֛יו אֲנָשִׁ֖ים וַיְהִ֣י שַׂר־גְּדוּד֒ בַּהֲרֹ֣ג דָּוִ֔ד אוֹתָ֑ם

“And he gathered men to himself, and he became the commander of a raiding band when David killed them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **when David killed them** before the information that **he gathered men to himself**. Alternate translation: [For when David killed them, he gathered men to himself, and he became the commander of a raiding band]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 11:24 (#2)

בַּהֲרֹ֣ג דָּוִ֔ד אוֹתָ֑ם

“when David killed them”

The author assumes that readers will know that the phrase **when David killed them** refers to David’s defeat of Hadadezer and his army, as recorded in 2 Samuel 8:3–5. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [when David defeated Hadadezer and killed many of his other soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:25 (#2)

וְאֶת־הָרָעָ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֲדָ֑ד

“and the harm that Hadad {did”

If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word or phrase to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [in addition to the harm that Hadad did]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 11:25 (#1)

כָּל־יְמֵ֥י שְׁלֹמֹ֖ה

“all of the days of Solomon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:21. Alternate translation: [for the rest of the reign of Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:26 (#2)

וַיָּ֥רֶם יָ֖ד בַּמֶּֽלֶךְ

“and he raised a hand against the king”

The author is using **raised a hand against** as a common expression of his culture to mean “rebelled against.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next verse. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 18:28. Alternate translation: [and he rebelled against the king]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:26 (#1)

וְיָרָבְעָם֙ בֶּן־נְבָ֣ט אֶפְרָתִ֔י מִן־הַצְּרֵדָ֖ה וְשֵׁ֣ם אִמּ֑וֹ צְרוּעָ֣ה אִשָּׁ֔ה אַלְמָנָ֖ה עָבַ֥ד לִשְׁלֹמֹֽה

“And Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, an Ephrathite from Zeredah, and the name of his mother {was} Zeruah, a woman, a widow, {was} a servant of Solomon”

The author is introducing **Jeroboam** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now Solomon had an official, a certain man named Jeroboam, whose father Nebat, an Ephrathite from Zeredah, had died, leaving his mother Zeruah a widow]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 11:27 (#1)

וְזֶ֖ה הַדָּבָ֑ר אֲשֶׁר־הֵרִ֥ים יָ֖ד בַּמֶּֽלֶךְ

“Now this {was} the matter {by} which he raised a hand against the king”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. He is specifically describing how Jeroboam came to have the position in which he “went out from Jerusalem,” as he describes in 11:29. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 11:28 (#3)

בֵּ֖בֵית יוֹסֵֽף

“the house of Joseph”

The author is using the image of a **house** to refer to the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh, who were descended from Joseph’s two sons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:28 (#1)

וְהָאִ֣ישׁ יָרָבְעָ֔ם גִּבּ֥וֹר חָ֖יִל

“And the man Jeroboam {was} mighty of strength”

While in many biblical contexts the expression “mighty of strength” describes a soldier who can fight powerfully and effectively, the expression can also describe someone who is very capable. That is the meaning here. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jeroboam was a very capable person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:28 (#2)

כִּֽי־עֹשֵׂ֥ה מְלָאכָ֖ה הֽוּא

“that he was a doer of work”

The author is using **a doer of work** as a common expression of his culture to mean “someone who gets work done well.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that he got work done] or [that he was industrious]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:29 (#3)

בַּשָּׂדֶֽה

“in the field”

The author is using the term **field** to mean an open place outside of the city where no one else could see or hear them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the open country]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:29 (#2)

וְהוּא מִתְכַּסֶּהוּ בְּשַׂלְמָה חֲדָשָׁה

“And he was covering himself with a new cloak”

The pronoun **he** refers to Ahijah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Ahijah was wearing a new cloak]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 11:29 (#1)

וַיִּמְצָאֵם אֹתוֹ אֲחִיָּהוּ הַשִּׁילֹנִי הַנָּבִיא

“and the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him”

If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 9:11. Alternate translation: [and the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite met him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:31 (#1)

כִּכֹה אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הִנֵּנִי קֹרֵעַ אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָה מִיַּד שְׁלֹמֹה וְנָתַתִּי לְךָ אֵת עֲשָׂרָה הַשְּׁבָטִים

“For thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, ‘Behold me, tearing the kingdom from the hand of Solomon, and I will give ten tribes to you”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how you can translate Yahweh’s message to Jeroboam in verses 31–39 in such a way that there will not be a quotation within a quotation.

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 11:31 (#3)

הִנֵּנִי קֹרֵעַ

“Behold me, tearing”

See how you translated the term “tear” in 11:11. Alternate translation: [I am about to take]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:31 (#4)

מִיַּד שְׁלֹמֹה

“from the hand of Solomon”

Here, **hand** represents the power and control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly, and in verses 34 and 35. Alternate translation: [from the control of Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:31 (#2)

הִנֵּנִי קֹרֵעַ

“Behold me, tearing”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [I am about to tear]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:32 (#2)

מִכֹּל שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from all of the tribes of Israel”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [from all of the cities in the territories of all of tribes of Israel]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:32 (#1)

וְהַשֵּׁבֶט הָאֶחָד יִהְיֶה־לּוֹ

“But one tribe will be to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:13. Alternate translation: [But I will allow his family to continue ruling one tribe]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:33 (#2)

עֲזָבֻנִי

“they have forsaken me”

The pronoun **they** refers to Solomon and the Israelites. The implication is that Solomon influenced many Israelites to worship foreign gods. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Solomon has led the Israelites to forsake me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 11:33 (#3)

לַעֲשׂוֹת הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינַי וְחֻקֹּתַי וּמִשְׁפָּטַי

“to do right in my eyes, or my statutes or my judgments”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate

translation: [to do right in my eyes, or to obey my statutes or my judgments]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:33 (#4)

וְחֻקֹּתַי וּמִשְׁפָּטַי

“or my statutes or my judgments”

The terms **statutes** and **judgments** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [or to obey my instructions carefully]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 11:33 (#8)

כְּדָוִד אָבִיו

“like David his father”

The pronoun **his** refers to Solomon. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [like David, Solomon’s father]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 11:33 (#1)

יַעַן ׀ אֲשֶׁר

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces a further explanation. See how you translated this word in 10:22. Alternate translation: [I am going to take most of the kingdom away from Solomon because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 11:33 (#5)

וְלֹא־הָלְכוּ בִדְרָכַי

“And they do not walk in my ways”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [And they do not live as I want people to live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:33 (#6)

הַיָּשָׁר

“right”

Yahweh is using the adjective **right** as a noun to mean things that are right. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [things that are right]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 11:33 (#7)

בְּעֵינַי

“in my eyes”

Yahweh is using **in my eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in my judgment” or “in my opinion.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in my judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:34 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר שָׁמַר מִצְוֹתַי וְחֻקֹּתָי

“who kept my commandments and my statutes”

The terms **commandments** and **statutes** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [who carefully did what I commanded]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 11:36 (#1)

נֵר

“a lamp”

Yahweh is using the image of a **lamp** to mean a continuing presence, just as the lamp that was kept burning in the sanctuary represented Yahweh’s continuing presence there. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a continuing presence in the person of a successor]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:36 (#3)

לְפָנָי

“to my face”

Here, Yahweh’s **face** represents his presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in my presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:36 (#2)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

Yahweh is using the term **days** to refer to time in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the time] or [always]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:36 (#4)

לְשַׂשֵּׂם שְׁמִי שָׁם

“to put my name there”

See how you translated the same expression in 9:3. Alternate translation: [as a place where people will worship me] or [to be a place where my reputation will be made known]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:37 (#1)

וְאֹתְךָ אֶקָּח וּמָלַכְתָּ בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־תְּאַוֶּה נַפְשֶׁךָ וְהָיִיתָ מֶלֶךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And I will take you, and you will reign over all that your soul desires, and you will be king over Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that Jeroboam **will be king over Israel** before the information that he **will reign over all that** his **soul desires**. Alternate translation: [And I will take you and make you king over Israel, and you will reign over all that your soul desires]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 11:37 (#3)

בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־תְּאַוֶּה נַפְשֶׁךָ

“over all that your soul desires”

Here Yahweh is using one part of Jeroboam, his **soul**, to mean all of him in the act of desiring to reign. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everything that you want to reign over]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 11:37 (#2)

וְאֹתְךָ אֶקָּח

“And I will take you”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And I will take you from your current position]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 11:38 (#1)

אִם־תִּשְׁמַע

“if you hear”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [if you obey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:38 (#5)

לִשְׁמֹר חֻקּוֹתַי וּמִצְוֹתַי

“to keep my statutes and my commandments”

The terms **statutes** and **commandments** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to obey my commandments carefully]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 11:38 (#6)

וְהָיִיתִי עִמָּךְ

“then I will be with you”

Yahweh is using **I will be with you** as a common expression of this culture to mean “I will help you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 3:19. Alternate translation: [I will help you]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:38 (#2)

וְהָלַכְתָּ בִּדְרָכַי

“and you walk in my ways”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [and you live as I want people to live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:38 (#3)

הַיָּשָׁר

“right”

Yahweh is using the adjective **right** as a noun to mean things that are right. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [things that are right]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 11:38 (#4)

בְּעֵינָי

“in my eyes”

Yahweh is using **in my eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in my judgment” or “in my opinion.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in my judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 11:38 (#8)

וּבָנִיתִי לְךָ בֵּית־נֶאֱמָן כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּנִיתִי לְדָוִד

“and I will build for you an established house, just as I built for David”

Yahweh is speaking of establishing a dynasty as if it were actually a **house** that he would **build**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 7:26. Alternate translation: [and I will establish a royal dynasty for you, just as I did for David]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:38 (#7)

וּבָנִיתִי לְךָ בֵּית־נֶאֱמָן כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּנִיתִי לְדָוִד

“and I will build for you an established house, just as I built for David”

The term **established** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will build a house for you and establish it, just as I did for David]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 11:39 (#2)

לְמַעַן זֹאת

“on account of this”

By **on account of this**, God means on account of Solomon’s disobedience and idolatry that he has described earlier. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because Solomon has forsaken me and worshiped other gods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:39 (#3)

אַךְ לֹא כָל־הַיָּמִים

“only not all of the days”

Here, **days** represents time or duration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but not for all time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:39 (#1)

אֶת־זֶרַע דָּוִד

“the seed of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:14. Alternate translation: [the descendants of David] or [David’s successors in his dynasty]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 11:40 (#2)

וַיָּקָם יָרָבְעָם

“But Jeroboam arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:40. Alternate translation: [But Jeroboam took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:40 (#1)

וַיְבַקֵּשׁ שְׁלֹמֹה לְהָמִית אֶת־יָרָבְעָם

“And Solomon sought to kill Jeroboam”

The implication is that Solomon learned about Yahweh’s promise to make Jeroboam the king of ten tribes of Israel. You could include this information if

that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Solomon learned of this and sought to kill Jeroboam]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 11:41 (#4)

וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה

“and all that he did”

The author is saying **all that he did** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [other significant things that he did]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 11:41 (#5)

סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“the book of the matters of Solomon”

Decide how you will represent in your translation the name of this book and similar books that the author refers readers to for further information about various kings. Alternate translation: [the royal annals of Solomon] or [the Chronicles of Solomon]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 11:41 (#2)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְחָכְמָתוֹ הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתֻבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“Now the rest of the matters of Solomon and all that he did and his wisdom, {are} they not written in the book of the matters of Solomon”

The author is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Now the rest of the matters of Solomon and all that he did and his wisdom are written in the book of the matters of Solomon.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 11:41 (#3)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְחָכְמָתוֹ הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתֻבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“Now the rest of the matters of Solomon and all that he did and his wisdom, {are} they not written in the book of the matters of Solomon”

The expression **are they not written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Solomon and all that he did and his wisdom in the book of the matters of Solomon.]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 11:41 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְחָכְמָתוֹ הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתֻבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“Now the rest of the matters of Solomon and all that he did and his wisdom, {are} they not written in the book of the matters of Solomon”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is using the phrases he regularly uses to conclude the account of a king’s reign. See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter, and see how you translated the phrases in 2:10–11 that are similar to the ones in verses 42 and 43 here.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 11:42 (#1)

וְהַיָּמִים & אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה

“And the days & were 40 years”

Here, **days** represents the length of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the time … was 40 years]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 11:43 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב שְׁלֹמֹהׂ עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Solomon lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:10. Alternate translation: [And Solomon passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 11:43 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“and he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that

is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter tells how the kingdom of David and Solomon was split into two kingdoms, Israel in the north and Judah in the south.

1. The Israelites revolt against Rehoboam (12:1–19)
2. Jeroboam becomes the king of the northern tribes (12:20–33)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Israel splits

God's warning to Solomon came true. In spite of his famous wealth, Solomon had over-taxed his own people and forced them to work too hard. When the people requested that his son Rehoboam, who succeeded him as king, reduce taxes and forced labor, he replied that he would be even harsher than his father. This caused the ten northern tribes to revolt and appoint Jeroboam as their king. These northern tribes became the kingdom of Israel. Only the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin remained loyal to Rehoboam. They became the kingdom of Judah.

Jeroboam introduces idol worship

Jeroboam was afraid that if the people continued to go to Jerusalem to worship in the temple, they would want to return to Rehoboam as their king. So he made shrines in the north and south of his kingdom with golden statutes of calves for the people to worship. This eventually caused the destruction of his whole family. The kingdom of Israel continued worshiping those idols until they were taken captive by the Assyrians.

Why did Rehoboam send Adoram out?

The author describes in 12:18 how, after the Israelites rejected Rehoboam as their king, he sent Adoram, his officer in charge of forced labor, to speak with them. The Israelites responded by stoning Adoram to death. Rehoboam then had to flee to Jerusalem in his chariot to save his own life. It may seem that Rehoboam should have anticipated this outcome and not sent Adoram to speak with the people. This shows that he truly did have bad judgment because he was relying on his younger, inexperienced friends instead of the older men who had attended his father Solomon and heard his wisdom. Sending Adoram to the people signaled Rehoboam's intent to continue and enforce the harsh labor policies established under his father Solomon, which the people deeply resented. Rather than seeking dialogue or reconciliation, Rehoboam acted out of arrogance or misjudgment, believing wrongly that a show of authority through his officer would quell resistance.

1 Kings 12:1 (#2)

כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"all of Israel"

The author says **all of Israel** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [representatives of the Israelite tribes]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 12:1 (#1)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ רְחַבְעָ֔ם שְׁכֶ֖מָה כִּֽי־שְׁכֶ֣ם בָּ֔אוּ כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל לְהַמְלִ֥יךְ אֹתֽוֹ

"And Rehoboam went {to} Shechem, for all of Israel had come {to} Shechem to make him reign"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since all of Israel had come to Shechem to make him reign, Rehoboam went to Shechem]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 12:2 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

"And it happened"

See how you translated the phrase "And it happened" in 2:39, where it similarly introduces a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 12:2 (#2)

וְהוּא֙ עוֹדֶ֣נּוּ בְמִצְרַ֔יִם

"now he, he {was} still in Egypt"

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the expression **he {was} still** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to introduce background information. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for this same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing that the author is introducing background

information. Alternate translation: [now as for him, he was still in Egypt]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:2 (#3)

מִפְּנֵי הַמֶּמֶלֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה

“from the face of King Solomon”

The author is using one part of Solomon, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of trying to kill Jeroboam. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 18:11. Alternate translation: [from Solomon, who had tried to kill him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 12:3 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ

“that they sent”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that they sent messengers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:3 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 12:4 (#3)

עַתָּתָּה הָקֵל מֵעֲבֹדַת אָבִיךָ הַקָּשָׁה וּמֵעֻלּוֹ הַכָּבֵד אֲשֶׁר־נָתַתָּן עָלֵינוּ

“now make {it} lighter than the hard service of your father and than his heavy yoke that he put on us”

The terms **hard service** and **heavy yoke** mean similar things. The people are using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [now make it lighter than the heavy yoke that your father put on us as a hard master] or [now let us work less hard than we did when we were serving your father]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 12:4 (#2)

וְאַתָּתָּה עַתָּתָּה הָקֵל

“But you, now make {it} lighter”

Jeroboam and the Israelite leaders are stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the imperative verb translated as **make ... lighter** already includes this meaning. They are doing that in order to emphasize a contrast between what Solomon did and what they want Rehoboam to do. See how you translated the expression “he, he cursed” in 2:8, which similarly emphasizes a contrast. Alternate translation: [But for your part, now make it lighter]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:4 (#1)

אָבִיךָ הִקְשָׁה אֶת־עֻלֵּנוּ וְאַתָּתָּה עַתָּתָּה הָקֵל מֵעֲבֹדַת אָבִיךָ הַקָּשָׁה וּמֵעֻלּוֹ הַכָּבֵד אֲשֶׁר־נָתַתָּן עָלֵינוּ

“Your father made our yoke hard. But you, now make {it} lighter than the hard service of your father and than his heavy yoke that he put on us”

The Israelites are speaking as if the labor that Solomon required of them were actually a **yoke** that he had put on them. They mean that Solomon’s requirements were difficult and burdensome. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your father made us work very hard. But you, now make us work less hard than we did when we were serving your father, who made us work so hard]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:5 (#1)

לְכוּ עַד שְׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים

“Go until three days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:18. Alternate translation: [Go away until the day after tomorrow]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:6 (#1)

הַזְּקֵנִים

“the elders”

Here, as in verses 8 and 13, the term **elders** describes older men, as opposed to the “young men” whom the author describes in verses 8 and 10. It may be helpful

to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the older men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:6 (#2)

אֶת־פְּנֵי֙ שְׁלֹמֹ֣ה

“to the face of Solomon”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Solomon in order to be ready to serve him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Solomon] or [as attendants to Solomon]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:6 (#3)

אֵ֚יךְ אַתֶּ֣ם נוֹעָצִ֔ים לְהָשִׁ֥יב אֶת־הָעָ֖ם־הַזֶּ֥ה דָּבָֽר

“How are you advising to answer this people {with} a word”

Here, **word** represents what Rehoboam would say by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What would you advise me to say to answer these people]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:7 (#1)

הַיּ֔וֹם

“today”

The elders are using the term **today** to refer to a specific occasion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in this instance] or [on this occasion]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:7 (#2)

תִּֽהְיֶה־עֶ֥בֶד לָעָ֖ם הַזֶּ֑ה וְעָבַדְתָּ֣ם

“you will be a servant to this people and serve them”

The elders are speaking as if Rehoboam should actually be a **servant** and **serve** the people. They mean that Rehoboam should have a humble attitude toward them and be willing to let them say what he should do in this instance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will have a humble attitude toward this people and let them say what you should do]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:7 (#3)

וַעֲנִיתָ֣ם וְדִבַּרְתָּ֔ אֲלֵיהֶ֖ם דְּבָרִ֣ים טוֹבִ֑ים

“and you answer them and speak good words to them”

The phrase **answer them and speak good words** expresses a single idea. The phrase **speak good words** tells in what way Rehoboam should **answer** the people. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and you speak good words in answer to them] or [and you answer them kindly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 12:7 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֖ים

“all of the days”

Here, **all of the days** represents “all the time” or “for as long as you reign.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time] or [for as long as you reign]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:8 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר הָעֹמְדִ֖ים לְפָנָֽיו

“who were standing to his face”

Here, **to his face** represents being in Rehoboam’s presence, in this context, to serve him as advisors. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [who were standing in his presence] or [who were serving as his advisors]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:8 (#1)

אֶת־עֲצַ֣ת הַזְּקֵנִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר יְעָצֻ֑הוּ

“the counsel of the elders that they had counseled him”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [the counsel that the elders had given him]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 12:9 (#3)

לֵאמֹ֗ר הָקֵ֤ל מִן־הָעֹל֙ אֲשֶׁר־נָתַ֣ן אָבִ֔יךָ עָלֵ֖ינוּ

“saying, ‘Make lighter than the yoke that your father put on us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and asked me to make their yoke lighter now than the yoke that my father put on them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 12:9 (#1)

מָ֣ה אַתֶּ֗ם נוֹעָצִים֙ וְנָשִׁ֣יב דָּבָ֔ר

“How are you advising that we should return a word”

Here, **word** represents what Rehoboam and his young advisors would say by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What are you advising that we should say in response to]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:9 (#2)

וְנָשִׁ֣יב

“that we should return”

By **we**, Rehoboam means to include both himself and the young men whom he is consulting, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Kings 12:9 (#4)

הָקֵ֤ל

“Make lighter”

The people are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Make our yoke lighter now]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:9 (#5)

עָלֵ֔ינוּ

“on us”

The Israelite leaders were using the pronoun **us** to refer to themselves but not to Rehoboam, so use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Kings 12:10 (#1)

כֹּֽה־תֹאמַ֞ר לָעָ֣ם הַזֶּ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֨ר דִּבְּר֤וּ אֵלֶ֙יךָ֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר אָבִ֖יךָ הִכְבִּ֣יד אֶת־עֻלֵּ֑נוּ וְאַתָּ֣ה הָקֶ֤ל מֵעָלֵ֙ינוּ֙

“Thus you shall say to this people who spoke to you, saying, ‘Your father made our yoke heavy, but you, make light from upon us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Thus you shall say to this people who spoke to you and told you that your father had made their yoke heavy but you, you should make light from upon them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 12:10 (#2)

אָבִ֣יךָ הִכְבִּ֔יד אֶת־עֻלֵּ֖נוּ וְאַתָּ֣ה הָקֶ֤ל מֵעָלֵ֙ינוּ֙

“Your father made our yoke heavy, but you, make light from upon us”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [Your father made us work very hard, but you, make us work less hard]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:10 (#3)

הָקֶ֤ל מֵעָלֵ֙ינוּ֙

“make light from upon us”

The people were stating the pronoun **you** explicitly in order to draw a contrast between what Solomon had done and what they wanted Rehoboam to do. See how you translated the similar expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [but for your part, make light from upon us] or [but for your part, make us work less hard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:10 (#4)

כֹּ֚ה תְּדַבֵּ֣ר אֲלֵיהֶ֔ם קָטָנִ֖י עָבָ֣ה מָתְנֵ֑י אָבִֽי

“Thus you shall speak to them, ‘My little finger {is} thicker than the loins of my father”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a

quotation. Alternate translation: [You should tell them that your little finger is thicker than the loins of your father]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 12:10 (#5)

קָטַנְּנִי עָבְתָה מִמָּתְנֵי אָבִי

“My little finger {is} thicker than the loins of my father”

Here, Rehoboam is speaking as if his **little finger** were actually **thicker** than his father’s **loins** (his hips, the widest part of his body). He means that he has much greater power and authority than his father did. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have much greater power and authority than my father did]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:11 (#2)

אָבִי֙ הֶעְמִ֣יס עֲלֵיכֶ֔ם עֹ֖ל כָּבֵ֑ד וַאֲנִ֗י אוֹסִ֛יף עַל־עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם

“my father loaded a heavy yoke on you, but I, I will add to your yoke”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [my father made you work hard, but I, I will make you work even harder]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:11 (#4)

בָּעֲקָרְבִּים

“with scorpions”

The young men want Rehoboam to use the term **scorpions** within an image to mean that he would discipline the Israelites more severely than his father did. If you decide to retain the image in your translation, you could show what this term means. The term **scorpions** could be: (1) the name of whips that had cutting objects in their ends such as iron points, hooks, or thorns. Alternate translation: [with barbed whips] or (2) a reference to actual scorpions, insects that have very painful stingers in their tails. Alternate translation: [by having scorpions sting you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:11 (#1)

וְעַתָּה֙

“And now”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 12:11 (#3)

וַאֲנִי֙ אוֹסִ֣יף עַל־עֲלֵיכֶ֔ם & וַאֲנִ֗י אֲיַסֵּ֛ר אֶתְכֶ֖ם בָּעֲקָרְבִּֽים

“but I, I will add to your yoke & but I, I will discipline you with scorpions”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [but for my part, I will add to your yoke … but for my part, I will discipline you with scorpions] or [but for my part, I will make you work even harder … but for my part, I will discipline you even more severely]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:12 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁלִשִׁ֔י & בַּיּ֖וֹם הַשְּׁלִשִֽׁי

“on the third day & on the third day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:5. Alternate translation: [two days after their first meeting with him … the day after tomorrow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:13 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַן הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ קָשָׁ֔ה וַיַּעֲזֹ֖ב אֶת־עֲצַ֣ת הַזְּקֵנִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר יְעָצֻֽהוּ

“And the king answered the people harshly, and he forsook the counsel of the elders that they had counseled him”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [And the king forsook the counsel of the elders that they had counseled him, and he answered the people harshly]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 12:13 (#2)

אֶת־עֲצַ֣ת הַזְּקֵנִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר יְעָצֻֽהוּ

“the counsel of the elders that they had counseled him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:8. Alternate translation: [the counsel that the elders had given him]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 12:14 (#1)

אָבִי֙ הִכְבִּ֣יד אֶת־עֻלְּכֶ֔ם וַאֲנִ֖י אֹסִ֣יף עַל־עֻלְּכֶ֑ם אָבִ֤י יִסַּר֙ אֶתְכֶ֣ם בַּשּׁוֹטִ֔ים וַאֲנִ֖י אֲיַסֵּ֥ר אֶתְכֶ֖ם בָּעַקְרַבִּֽים

“My father made your yoke heavy, but I, I will add to your yoke. My father disciplined you with whips, but I, I will discipline you with scorpions”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:11. Alternate translation: [My father made you work hard, but for my part, I will make you work even harder. My father disciplined you severely, but for my part, I will discipline you even more severely]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:15 (#1)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַ֥ע הַמֶּ֛לֶךְ אֶל־הָעָ֖ם

“And the king did not listen to the people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And the king did not agree to do what the people had requested]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:15 (#5)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:15 (#2)

סִבָּה

“the turn”

The author is saying **the turn** as a common expression of his culture to mean “this turn of events” or “this occurrence.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this turn of events] or [this occurrence]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:15 (#3)

לְמַעַן֙ הָקִ֣ים אֶת־דְּבָר֔וֹ

“so that he might raise up his word”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [so that he might make happen the things that he said]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:15 (#4)

דִּבֶּ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה

“Yahweh had spoken”

Since the author has already used the name Yahweh earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [he had spoken]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:16 (#1)

כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“all of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:1. Alternate translation: [the representatives of the Israelite tribes]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 12:16 (#7)

מַה־לָּ֥נוּ חֵ֖לֶק בְּדָוִ֑ד

“What portion {is} to us in David”

The people are using the question form **What portion is to us in David?** to emphasize that they have no share or inheritance with David’s dynasty. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [We have no portion in David!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 12:16 (#9)

לְאֹהָלֶ֖יךָ & לְאֹהָלָֽיו

“To your tents & to its tents”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:66. Alternate translation: [To your homes … to their homes]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 12:16 (#2)

לֹא־שָׁמַ֥ע & אֲלֵיהֶ֖ם

“had not listened to them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [would not agree to do what they had asked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:16 (#6)

מַה־לָּנוּ֩ חֵ֨לֶק בְּדָוִ֜ד וְלֹא־נַחֲלָ֣ה בְּבֶן־יִשַׁ֗י

“What portion {is} to us in David? And no inheritance in the son of Jesse”

The Israelite leaders are speaking as if David were actually land or property of which the Israelites could have a **portion** that they would receive as an **inheritance**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [We want nothing to do with the kingdom of David son of Jesse]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:16 (#12)

דָּוִ֑ד

“David”

Here, **David** represents the royal dynasty of David, in which Rehoboam is the current king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Rehoboam] or [you descendant of David]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:16 (#3)

וַיָּשִׁ֧בוּ הָעָ֛ם אֶת־הַמֶּ֥לֶךְ דָּבָ֖ר

“and the people answered the king {with} a word”

Here, **a word** represents what the people said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the people spoke in response to the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:16 (#8)

וְלֹא־נַחֲלָ֖ה בְּבֶן־יִשַׁ֑י

“And no inheritance in the son of Jesse”

The people are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And we have no inheritance in the son of Jesse]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:16 (#10)

לְאׇהָלֶ֔יךָ

“To your tents”

The people are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Return to your tents] or [Return to your homes]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:16 (#11)

רְאֵ֣ה בֵיתְךָ֔

“see your house”

The people are using **see your house** as a common expression of their culture to mean “take care of your own affairs” or “rule only your own tribe.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [see to your own house] or [be the king of your own tribe]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:16 (#4)

מַה־לָּנוּ֩ חֵ֨לֶק בְּדָוִ֜ד וְלֹא־נַחֲלָ֣ה בְּבֶן־יִשַׁ֗י

“What portion {is} to us in David? And no inheritance in the son of Jesse”

Here, **David** represents a kingdom ruled by descendants of David, and **the son of Jesse** represents the dynasty of Jesse’s son. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [What portion is to us in a kingdom ruled by descendants of David? And no inheritance in the dynasty of the son of Jesse]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:16 (#5)

מַה־לָּנוּ֩ חֵ֨לֶק בְּדָוִ֜ד וְלֹא־נַחֲלָ֣ה בְּבֶן־יִשַׁ֗י

“What portion {is} to us in David? And no inheritance in the son of Jesse”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine

them and express the emphasis in another way. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 20:1. Alternate translation: [We will inherit no portion of the kingdom of David, the son of Jesse]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 12:17 (#4)

בְּעָרֵי יְהוּדָֽה

“in the cities of Judah”

Here, **the cities of Judah** represents the territory of the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [within the territory of the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:17 (#1)

וּבְנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל הַיֹּשְׁבִים֙ בְּעָרֵ֣י יְהוּדָ֔ה וַיִּמְלֹ֥ךְ עֲלֵיהֶ֖ם רְחַבְעָֽם

“But the sons of Israel dwelling in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them”

As background information, the author is describing what happened as a result of this event even before he has finished telling the story of the event. He is doing that in order to clarify that the term “Israel” in the previous verse, meaning the Israelite people, does not include the members of the tribe of Judah. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 12:17 (#2)

וּבְנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“But the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [But the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:17 (#3)

בְּעָרֵי יְהוּדָֽה

“in the cities of Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:13. Alternate translation: [the cities of Judah and Benjamin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:18 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֤ח הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ רְחַבְעָ֔ם אֶת־אֲדֹרָ֖ם אֲשֶׁ֣ר עַל־הַמַּ֑ס

“And King Rehoboam sent Adoram, who {was} over the forced labor”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And King Rehoboam sent Adoram, who was over the forced labor, to reassert his authority]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:18 (#3)

וַיִּרְגְּמ֥וּ כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל בּ֖וֹ אֶ֣בֶן

“but all of Israel stoned him {with} stone”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [but all of Israel violently stoned him]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 12:18 (#5)

וְהַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ רְחַבְעָ֔ם הִתְאַמֵּ֖ץ

“And King Rehoboam strengthened himself”

The author is using **strengthened himself** as a common expression of the culture to mean “summoned all his strength” or “made a desperate effort.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And King Rehoboam made a desperate effort]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:18 (#2)

אֶת־אֲדֹרָ֑ם

“Adoram”

Adoram seems to be a variant spelling of the name “Adoniram,” whom the author says similarly in 5:14 was “over the forced labor” during the reign of Solomon. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the name “Adoniram” here.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 12:18 (#4)

כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of Israel”

The author says **all of Israel** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [the Israelites who had come to Shechem]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 12:19 (#2)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:8. Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:19 (#1)

בְּבֵית דָּוִד

“against the house of David”

To translate this expression and in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [against the dynasty of David]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:20 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ

“that they sent”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:3. Alternate translation: [that they sent messengers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:20 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 8:10, where it similarly introduces a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 12:20 (#3)

לֹא הָיָה אַחֲרֵי בֵית־דָּוִד זוּלָתִי שֵׁבֶט־יְהוּדָה לְבַדּוֹ

“One was not after the house of David except the tribe of Judah by itself”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [Only the tribe of Judah by itself was after the house of David]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Kings 12:20 (#4)

לֹא הָיָה

“One was not”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [One tribe was not] or [No tribe was]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:20 (#5)

לֹא הָיָה אַחֲרֵי בֵית־דָּוִד

“One was not after the house of David”

The author is using **was after the house of David** as a common expression of his culture to mean “was loyal to the house of David” or “remained subject to the house of David.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One was not loyal to the house of David] or [One did not remain subject to the house of David]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:20 (#6)

שֵׁבֶט־יְהוּדָה

“the tribe of Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:13. Alternate translation: [the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:21 (#2)

בֵּית יְהוּדָה וְאֶת־שִׁשֶּׁבֶט בִּנְיָמִן & בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the house of Judah and the tribe of Benjamin & the house of Israel”

The author is using the term **house** to mean "army." If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the army of the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin ... the army of the northern Israelite tribes]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:21 (#1)

וּיבֹא רְחַבְעָם֮ & לִרְחַבְעָם בֶּן־שְׁלֹמֹה

"And Rehoboam entered & to Rehoboam, the son of Solomon"

Since the author uses the name **Rehoboam** at the start of this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun at the end of the sentence. If you decide to do that, you could give the full form of his name at the beginning of the sentence. Alternate translation: [And Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, entered ... to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:21 (#3)

בָּחוּר עֹשֵׂי מִלְחָמָה

"chosen makers of war"

The term **chosen** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [makers of war whom he chose]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 12:21 (#4)

עֹשֵׂי מִלְחָמָה

"makers of war"

The author is using the possessive form to describe men who are characterized by their ability to make war. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [warriors]

See: Possession

1 Kings 12:22 (#2)

אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִים

"the man of God"

The author is using this possessive form to describe a **man** who was characterized by having a special mission from **God**, specifically, to be a prophet. (The author does not mean "a godly man," although true prophets also were godly people.) If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the prophet]

See: Possession

1 Kings 12:22 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ דְּבַר־הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים אֶל־שְׁמַעְיָ֖ה

"But the word of God was to Shemaiah"

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [But God spoke a message to Shemaiah]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:23 (#3)

וְיֶתֶר הָעָם

"and the rest of the people"

By **the rest of the people**, the author means the people of Rehoboam's kingdom who were not warriors. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the civilian population]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:23 (#2)

בֵּבֵ֣ית

"the house of"

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:21. Alternate translation: [the soldiers of] or [the army of]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:23 (#1)

מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה

"the king of Judah"

Since **king of Judah** was an actual title that Rehoboam and his successors held, it would not be appropriate to translate it as "king of the united tribe of Judah and Benjamin," even if you have been representing the term "Judah" that way elsewhere in your translation.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 12:23–24 (#1)

אֱמֹ֗ר אֶל־רְחַבְעָם֙ בֶּן־שְׁלֹמֹ֣ה׀ מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה וְאֶל־כָּל־בֵּ֥בֵית יְהוּדָ֖ה
וּבִנְיָמִ֑ין וְיֶתֶר֙ הָעָ֔ם לֵאמֹ֖ר׃ כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֔ר יְהוָ֖ה לֹא־תַעֲל֣וּ׀

וְלֹא־תִלָּחֲמוּן עִם־אֲחֵיכֶם בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל שׁוּבוּ אִישׁ לְבֵיתוֹ כִּי מֵאִתִּי נִהְיָה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“Speak to Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, the king of Judah, and to all of the house of Judah and Benjamin and the rest of the people, saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “You shall not go up and you shall not fight with your brothers, the sons of Israel. Return, a man to his house, for this thing has been from with me”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [Speak to Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, the king of Judah, and to all of the house of Judah and Benjamin and the rest of the people and tell them that I say that they should not go up and fight with their brothers, the sons of Israel. Instead, a man should return to his house, for this thing has been from with me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 12:24 (#1)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה לֹא־תַעֲלוּ֙ וְלֹא־תִלָּחֲמוּן עִם־אֲחֵיכֶם בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל שׁוּבוּ אִישׁ לְבֵיתוֹ כִּי מֵאִתִּי נִהְיָה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“Thus says Yahweh, “You shall not go up and you shall not fight with your brothers, the sons of Israel. Return, a man to his house, for this thing has been from with me”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Yahweh said to Shemaiah (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. At the start of this verse, Yahweh is speaking directly to Shemaiah (level 2). Yahweh then tells Shemaiah what he wants him to say to Rehoboam and the people with him (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 12:24 (#5)

אֶת־דְּבַר֙ יְהוָ֔ה & כִּדְבַ֖ר יְהוָ֑ה

“the word of Yahweh & according to the word of Yahweh”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh had said to them ... just as Yahweh had told them to do]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:24 (#4)

שׁוּבוּ אִישׁ לְבֵיתוֹ

“Return, a man to his house”

Yahweh is using **a man to his house** as a common expression of this culture to mean that the soldiers should not continue this military campaign. Instead, each one should go back to his home and family. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression “a man to his tent” in 2 Samuel 18:17, which similarly refers to a cessation of military activities. Alternate translation: [Each of you, leave the army and return home]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 12:24 (#2)

לֹא־תַעֲלוּ֙

“You shall not go up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Yahweh is speaking of travel to a higher elevation, specifically, from Judah to “Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim,” which Jeroboam made his capital, as the author explains in the next verse. Alternate translation: [You shall not go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 12:24 (#3)

אֲחֵיכֶם

“your brothers”

Yahweh is speaking as if the people of the northern tribes were actually **brothers** to the people of Judah. He means that they are all descendants of the same ancestor, Jacob. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:24 (#6)

וַיָּשֻׁ֖בוּ לָלֶ֑כֶת

“and they returned to go”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to

be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they returned from the military campaign in order to go home]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:25 (#2)

וַיִּבֶן יָרָבְעָם אֶת־שְׁכֶם & וַיֵּשֶׁב פְּנוּאֵלָה

“And Jeroboam built Shechem & and he built Penuel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [And Jeroboam had his workers fortify Shechem ... and he had his workers fortify Penuel]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 12:25 (#1)

וַיִּבֶן יָרָבְעָם אֶת־שְׁכֶם & וַיֵּשֶׁב פְּנוּאֵלָה

“And Jeroboam built Shechem & and he built Penuel”

The implication is that Jeroboam **built** fortifications around these cities to strengthen them as military and administrative centers for his new kingdom. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jeroboam built up Shechem ... and he built up Penuel] or [And Jeroboam fortified Shechem ... and he fortified Penuel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:26 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר יָרָבְעָם בְּלִבּוֹ

“And Jeroboam said in his heart”

The author is using Jeroboam’s **heart** to represent his thoughts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Jeroboam thought]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:26 (#2)

תָּשׁוּב הַמַּמְלָכָה לְבֵית דָּוִד

“the kingdom will return to the house of David”

Jeroboam is speaking of his **kingdom**, the Israelite tribes that he rules, as if it were a living thing that could **return** to David’s descendants and become their subject again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the house of David will rule the kingdom once again]

See: Personification

1 Kings 12:26 (#3)

לְבֵית דָּוִד

“to the house of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [to the dynasty of David]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:27 (#1)

יַעֲלֶה ׀ הָעָם הַזֶּה

“this people goes up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [this people goes]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 12:27 (#5)

רְחַבְעָם מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

“Rehoboam, the king of Judah”

Since Jeroboam has already used the name and title **Rehoboam, the king of Judah** earlier in this verse, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:27 (#3)

וְשָׁב לֵבָב הָעָם הַזֶּה אֶל־אֲדֹנֵיהֶם

“then the heart of this people will return to their master”

Jeroboam is using the **heart** of the people to represent their feelings, specifically their feelings of loyalty. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then this people will become loyal once again to their master]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:27 (#2)

בְּבֵית־יְהוָה

“in the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:27 (#4)

וְשָׁשֲׁבוּ אֶל

“and they will return to”

Jeroboam is speaking as if the people would actually **return** physically to where Rehoboam was. He means that they will become subjects of Rehoboam again and obey him as their king. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will agree to be subjects once again of]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:28 (#2)

הִנֵּה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Behold your gods”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Here are your gods]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:28 (#4)

הֶעֱלֵוךָ

“brought you up”

Jeroboam is using the current generation of Israelites, addressing them as **you**, to represent the Israelite people and specifically the earlier generation of them whom Yahweh rescued from slavery in Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [brought our ancestors up] or [brought us Israelite people up]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:28 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם

“And he said to them”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jeroboam, and the pronoun **them** refers to the people who were his subjects. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And he said to his subjects]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 12:28 (#3)

הִנֵּה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Behold your gods”

By **your gods**, Jeroboam means that these golden calves represent the God of Israel who brought the people out of Egypt. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [These represent your God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:29 (#1)

אֶת־הָאֶחָד & הָאֶחָד

“one & one”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one of the calves ... the other one]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 12:30 (#1)

וַיְהִי הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה לְחַטָּאת

“And this thing became a sin”

The author is using the term **sin** to mean “an occasion for sin” or “something that caused the people to sin.” You could indicate that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And this thing became an occasion for sin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 12:30 (#2)

לִפְנֵי הָאֶחָד עַד־דָּן

“to the face of the one as far as Dan”

Here, **to the face of** represents being “in the presence of.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [as far as Dan to be in the presence of the one] or [as far as Dan to where one of them was]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 12:31 (#2)

מִקְצוֹת הָעָם

“from the extremities of the people”

The author is using the term **extremities** to mean everything between the outer limits of the Israelite population, that is, the entire population. If it would

be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Judges, see how you translated the similar expression "from the borders" in Judges 18:2. Alternate translation: [men throughout the Israelite population]

See: Merism

1 Kings 12:31 (#1)

אֶת־בֵּ֣ית בָּמ֔וֹת

"a house of high places"

In this verse, the word **house** is singular in form, but it refers to as a group to all of the "houses" or shrines that Jeroboam eventually built on **high places** or hill-tops throughout his kingdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of "house," or you could express the meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [houses of high places] or [shrines for worship on high places]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 12:31 (#3)

מִבְּנֵ֥י לֵוִֽי

"from the sons of Levi"

The author is speaking as if the descendants of **Levi** were actually his **sons**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Levi] or [the tribe of Levi]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 12:32 (#1)

בַּחֹ֨דֶשׁ הַשְּׁמִינִ֜י בַּחֲמִשָּׁה־עָשָׂר֣ יֹ֗ום ׀ לַחֹ֨דֶשׁ

"in the eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the month"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **eighth** or **fifteenth**, you could represent those numbers in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [on day fifteen of month eight]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 12:32 (#2)

בַּחֹ֨דֶשׁ הַשְּׁמִינִ֜י

"in the eighth month"

This **eighth month** of the Hebrew calendar occurred during the rainy season, when people plowed their fields and sowed seed. It is during the last part of October and the first part of November on Western calendars. You could convert the Hebrew day and month into an approximate date on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the date will be different every year, and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may just want to give the number of the day and the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar and say in a footnote approximately what time of year that is on your calendar.

See: Hebrew Months

1 Kings - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the story of how the kingdom of David and Solomon was split into two kingdoms, Israel in the north and Judah in the south. It focuses on how Yahweh sent a "man of God" from Judah to the altar at Bethel in Israel to tell Jeroboam that because he had made calf idols, Yahweh would destroy his royal dynasty.

1. A man of God warns Jeroboam (13:1–10)
2. An older prophet deceives the man into disobeying Yahweh, and a lion kills him (13:11–24)
3. The older prophet buries the man and asks to be buried with him when he dies (13:25–32)
4. Jeroboam ignores the man's warning (13:33–34)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did the older prophet in Bethel deceive the man of God into disobeying Yahweh?

There are several aspects of the story that this chapter tells that are puzzling to readers and interpreters of the Bible. Why did the old prophet want the man of God from Judah to come to his home for a meal? When the man of God refused, why did the prophet lie to him to get him to come? And how could Yahweh have then spoken a true prophecy through a man who had just spoken a false prophecy? The answers to these questions are uncertain, but here are some possibilities.

The older prophet may have wanted the man of God from Judah to come to his house for a meal for one of a number of reasons, or perhaps from a mixture of motives. These may have included curiosity, jealousy, a misguided attempt at hospitality, a desire to test the man's genuineness, or a desire to associate with someone who had just powerfully demonstrated God's authority. When the man of God refused, the old prophet lied, pretending that he had gotten a new

message from an angel. He did this possibly out of envy, confusion, or the wish to test the man of God. Nevertheless, Yahweh then spoke a true prophecy through the deceitful old prophet in order to deliver a message of judgment to the disobedient man of God. This demonstrated that God's power and purpose are not dependent on the character of the messenger. It also underscored the seriousness of obeying God's commands above all else.

While these are all possibilities, the story remains puzzling. Since the author does not answer specifically the questions that it raises, we suggest that you do not try to do that in your translation. Translate the story as it has come down to us in the Bible, and allow readers and interpreters to work at understanding it themselves.

Why did the older prophet ask to be buried in the same grave as the man of God?
In 13:31, the older prophet tells his sons, "When I die, then you shall bury me in the grave in which the man of God is buried." Asking to be buried in the same grave as the man of God was a symbolic action by which the old prophet expressed his confidence that what the man had predicted would certainly happen (as he says in the next verse). Specifically, the man of God had said that human bones would be burned on the altar at Bethel (13:2). The old prophet was hoping that when someone collected human bones from graves in the area to burn on the altar, he would spare the bones of the prophet who had predicted this action and any other bones that were also in his grave. As the story continues, the account in 2 Kings 23:16–18 shows that this is just what happened. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"Bread" meaning "food" and "water" meaning "a drink"
In several places in verses 8–23, characters use one kind of food, bread, to mean food in general, and they use one kind of drink, water, to mean drinks in general. If it would be helpful in your language, in all of these instances, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture, or you could state the meaning plainly. (See: Synecdoche)

1 Kings 13:1 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

"And behold"

The author is using the phrase **And behold** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 13:1 (#3)

אִ֣ישׁ אֱלֹהִ֔ים

"a man of God"

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:22. Alternate translation: [a prophet]

See: Possession

1 Kings 13:1 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

"And behold"

The author is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:1 (#4)

בִּדְבַ֣ר יְהוָ֑ה

"by the word of Yahweh"

Here, **word** represents a command that Yahweh gave by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:2 (#8)

הַמְקַטְּרִ֖ים עָלָֽיִךְ

"the ones burning incense on you"

Here, **burning incense** represents offering sacrifices more generally. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones offering unlawful sacrifices on you]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:2 (#4)

כֹּ֚ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה הִנֵּה־בֵ֥ן נוֹלָ֖ד

"Thus says Yahweh, 'Behold, a son will be born"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that behold, a son will be born]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:2 (#7)

אֶת־כֹּהֲנֵי הַבָּמוֹת

“the priests of the high places”

The phrase **the priests of the high places** refers to the entire class of priests that Jeroboam appointed to serve at hilltop shrines, as the author describes in 12:31 and 13:33. In this context, however, it refers specifically to the priests who served at the shrine at Bethel. It may be helpful to clarify that for your readers. Alternate translation: [the priests of this high place]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 13:2 (#9)

וְעַצְמוֹת אָדָם יִשְׂרְפוּ עָלָיִךְ

“And they will burn the bones of a human on you”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific **human**. He means humans in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And they will burn human bones on you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Kings 13:2 (#11)

וְעַצְמוֹת אָדָם יִשְׂרְפוּ עָלָיִךְ

“And they will burn the bones of a human on you”

Burning the bones of a human was a symbolic action by which someone completely desecrated and defiled a sacred place. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And they will completely desecrate you by burning human bones on you]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 13:2 (#1)

וַיִּקְרָא & וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he cried out & and said”

See whether you chose to represent the expression “and said” in your translation in 1:28 and similar contexts.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 13:2 (#2)

בִּדְבַר יְהוָה

“by the word of Yahweh”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh told the prophet to say by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [saying what Yahweh had told him to say]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:2 (#5)

בֵּן נוֹלָד לְבֵית־דָּוִד

“a son will be born to the house of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:27. Alternate translation: [a son will be born among the descendants of David]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:2 (#10)

וְעַצְמוֹת אָדָם יִשְׂרְפוּ עָלָיִךְ

“And they will burn the bones of a human on you”

Yahweh is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people will burn human bones on you] or [And human bones will be burned on you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:2 (#6)

בֵּן נוֹלָד לְבֵית־דָּוִד

“a son will be born to the house of David”

The expression **will be born** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [David will have a male descendant]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 13:2 (#3)

מִזְבֵּחַ מִזְבֵּחַ כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה

“Altar! Altar! Thus says Yahweh”

The man of God is speaking to something that he knows cannot hear him, the **Altar** at Bethel. He is

doing this to communicate to the people who can hear him that Yahweh feels very strongly about how they are disobeying him by worshiping at this altar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if the man of God were telling the people directly what Yahweh has to say about the altar. Alternate translation: [You Israelites who are worshiping at this altar, listen to what Yahweh says about it]

See: Apostrophe

1 Kings 13:3 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר & הַמִּזְבֵּחַ נִקָּרָע וְנִשְׁפַּךְ הַדֶּשֶׁן & עָלָיו

“the altar will be split open, and the ash that {is} on it will be poured out”

The expressions **will be split open** and **will be poured out** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use those forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will split open the altar so that the ash that is on it spills out]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 13:3 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 13:3 (#2)

זֶה הַמּוֹפֵת & דִּבֶּר יְהוָה הִנֵּה הַמִּזְבֵּחַ נִקָּרָע & אֲשֶׁר

“This {is} the sign that Yahweh has spoken, ‘Behold, the altar will be split open”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [This is the sign that Yahweh has spoken. Behold, the altar will be split open]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:3 (#3)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Now listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:4 (#2)

וַיְהִי׃

“And it happened”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 8:10, where it similarly introduces a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 13:4 (#4)

תִּפְשֻׂהוּ

“Seize him”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Seize** is plural here because Jeroboam is giving a command to several of his officials or soldiers who are present. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 13:4 (#3)

וַיִּשְׁלַח יָרָבְעָם אֶת־יָדוֹ מֵעַל הַמִּזְבֵּחַ & יָדוֹ אֲשֶׁר שָׁלַח עָלָיו

“that Jeroboam stretched out his hand from over the altar & his hand that he had stretched out against him”

The author is using **stretched out his hand** as a common expression of the culture to mean “pointed at him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that Jeroboam pointed at him, using his hand that had been over the altar ... the hand that he had used to point at him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 13:4 (#5)

וַתִּיבַשׁ יָדוֹ אֲשֶׁר שָׁלַח עָלָיו

“And his hand that he had stretched out against him dried up”

The author is speaking of the king’s arm as if it were actually a plant that had lost its moisture and become stiff. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And his hand that he had stretched out against him became stiff] or [And the hand with which he was pointing suddenly became immobilized]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:4 (#1)

אֶת־דְּבַר֙ אִ֣ישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר קָרָ֑א

“the word of the man of God that he had cried out”

Here the term **word** represents what the man of God said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what the man of God said when he had cried out]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:4 (#6)

וַתִּיבַ֥שׁ יָד֖וֹ

“And his hand & dried up”

As the context indicates, the author is using Jeroboam’s **hand** to represent his entire arm. Alternate translation: [And his arm]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:5 (#1)

וְהַמִּזְבֵּ֣חַ נִקְרָ֗ע וַיִּשָּׁפֵךְ֙ הַדֶּ֔שֶׁן מִן־הַמִּזְבֵּ֖חַ

“And the altar was split open, and the ash was poured out from the altar”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:3. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh split open the altar so that the ash that was on it spilled out]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 13:5 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר נָתַ֤ן אִישׁ֙ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים בִּדְבַ֖ר יְהוָֽה

“that the man of God had given by the word of Yahweh”

This could mean: (1) that Yahweh had announced this **sign** and the man of God had reported what Yahweh announced. Alternate translation: [that the man of God had told the people that Yahweh had announced] (2) that the man of God gave this sign because Yahweh had commanded him to do that. Alternate translation: [that the man of God had given at the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:6 (#2)

חַל־נָ֞א אֶת־פְּנֵ֣י יְהוָ֗ה & אֶת־פְּנֵי֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“Entreat, please, the face of Yahweh & the face of Yahweh”

Jeroboam is using one part of Yahweh, his **face**, to represent all of him in the act of being entreated. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 13:12. Alternate translation: [Please entreat Yahweh ... Yahweh]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:6 (#3)

וְתָשֹׁ֥ב יָדִ֖י אֵלָ֑י & וַתָּ֣שָׁב יַד־הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אֵלָ֖יו

“that my hand may return to me & and the hand of the king returned to him”

Jeroboam and the author are speaking of his **hand** as if it were a living thing that could **return** to him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that I may be able to pull my hand back ... and the king was able to pull his hand back] or [that I may be able to lower my arm ... and the king was able to lower his arm]

See: Personification

1 Kings 13:6 (#4)

וַתָּ֣שָׁב יַד־הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אֵלָ֖יו וַתְּהִ֥י כְּבָרִאשֹׁנָֽה

“and the hand of the king returned to him, and it became like at the first”

The author is describing one event, the king’s hand being restored, before describing another event that preceded it, the king pulling his hand back. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [and the hand of the king became like at the first, and he was able to pull it back]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 13:6 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַן הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ וַיֹּ֖אמֶר ׀ אֶל־אִ֣ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים

“And the king answered and said to the man of God”

The **king** was not answering something that the **man of God** had said to him. He was responding to the situation. It may be helpful to clarify that for your readers. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 14:28. Alternate translation: [And the king responded to the man of God]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 13:8 (#2)

לֹ֣א אָבֹ֔א עִמָּ֑ךְ

“I would not come with you”

In a context such as this, your language might say “go” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [I would not go with you]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 13:8 (#3)

לֶ֖חֶם & מַ֥יִם

“bread & water”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how, throughout verses 8–23, characters use the words **bread** and **water** to mean “food” and “a beverage.”

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:8 (#1)

בֵּיתֶ֔ךָ

“your house”

The prophet is using one part of Jeroboam’s possessions, his **house** to represent all of his possessions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your possessions]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:9 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I say this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 13:9 (#2)

צִוָּ֥ה אֹתִ֛י בִּדְבַ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה

“he has commanded me by the word of Yahweh”

It may be more natural in your language to use the name of Yahweh as the subject of this sentence and to use a pronoun later in the sentence. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has commanded me by his word]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:9 (#4)

לֵאמֹ֗ר לֹא־תֹאכַל֙ לֶ֔חֶם וְלֹ֥א תִשְׁתֶּה־מַ֖יִם וְלֹ֣א תָשׁ֑וּב בַּדֶּ֥רֶךְ אֲשֶׁ֖ר הָלַ֥כְתָּ

“saying, ‘You shall not eat bread, and you shall not drink water, and you shall not return by the road {by} which you went”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He told me that I should not eat bread, and I should not drink water, and I should not return by the road by which I went]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:9 (#6)

וְלֹ֥א תָשׁ֑וּב בַּדֶּ֥רֶךְ אֲשֶׁ֖ר הָלַ֥כְתָּ

“and you shall not return by the road {by} which you went”

The prophet returning to Judah by a different road seems also to have been a symbolic action. The purpose of this action could have been: (1) so that anyone who had seen him coming who heard about the events at the altar would not recognize him on his return trip and detain him. As a result, he would spend as little time as possible in the northern kingdom, showing further that Yahweh wanted nothing to do with the corrupt worship there. Alternate translation: [and so that no one in that corrupt kingdom detains you on your way home, you shall not return by the road by which you went] or (2) to use the **road** as a symbol of a course of action in life. Taking a different road would have depicted how the people of the northern kingdom should stop worshiping at the shrines at Bethel and Dan and worship at the temple in Jerusalem once again. Alternate translation: [and to show that these people should worship in the Jerusalem temple and not in these shrines, you shall not return by the road by which you went]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 13:9 (#7)

הָלַ֥כְתָּ

“you went”

In a context such as this, your language might say “came” instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [you came]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 13:9 (#3)

כֵּ֣ן ׀ צִוָּ֣ה אֹתִ֗י בִּדְבַ֤ר יְהוָה֙

“thus he has commanded me by the word of Yahweh”

Here, **word** represents what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this is the command that Yahweh has spoken to me]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:9 (#5)

לֹא־תֹאכַל֙ לֶ֔חֶם וְלֹ֥א תִשְׁתֶּה־מָ֖יִם

“You shall not eat bread, and you shall not drink water”

Refusing to accept any hospitality was a symbolic action by which the man of God expressed total separation from the people of the northern kingdom and their religious practices. This clearly signaled Yahweh’s disapproval of the corrupt worship that Jeroboam had introduced. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [To show that I want nothing to do with this corrupt worship, you shall not eat bread, and you shall not drink water]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 13:11 (#1)

וְנָבִ֥יא אֶחָ֛ד זָקֵ֖ן יֹשֵׁ֣ב בְּבֵֽית־אֵ֑ל

“Now an old prophet was dwelling in Bethel”

The author is introducing this **old prophet** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now there was a certain old prophet who lived in Bethel]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 13:11 (#3)

אֵ֚ת־כָּל־הַמַּעֲשֶׂ֣ה אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂ֣ה ׀ אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִ֗ים

“all of the deed that the man of God had done”

In this verse, the word **deed** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the deeds that the man of God did. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a plural form in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [all of the deeds that the man of God had done] or [everything that the man of God had done]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 13:11 (#2)

וַיָּבֹ֥א בְנ֖וֹ וַיְסַפֵּ֑ר

“and his son came, and he recounted”

The author is using one **son**, one person who was involved in this action, to represent everyone who was involved, which the context shows included some of his other sons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his sons came, and one of them recounted]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:11 (#4)

אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֛ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֖ר

“The words that he had spoken”

Here, **words** represents what the prophet said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What he had said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:12 (#1)

וַיִּרְאֵ֣ם בָּנָ֗יו אֶת־הַדֶּ֙רֶךְ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָלַ֔ךְ אִ֖ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים אֲשֶׁר־בָּ֥א מִיהוּדָֽה

“Now his sons had seen the road that the man of God had walked who had come from Judah”

By **his sons had seen the road**, the author means that his sons had watched the man of God leave and had seen which road he took when he departed from Bethel. As a result, they were able to tell this information to their father. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Now his sons had seen the road that the man of God had walked who had come from Judah, so they were able to tell him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 13:13 (#2)

חִבְּשׁ֥וּ לִ֛י הַחֲמֹ֖ר

“Saddle the donkey for me”

The old prophet is using the action of saddling his donkey to represent putting all the necessary equipment on the donkey to prepare it for riding, including a saddle and bridle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from

your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Put the saddle and bridle on the donkey so that I can ride it]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:13 (#1)

חִבְשׁוּ־לִ֣י הַחֲמֹ֔ור וַיַּחְבְּשׁוּ & הַחֲמֹֽור

“Saddle the donkey for me.” And they saddled the donkey”

It becomes clear in 13:27–28 that the old prophet owns more than one donkey. It may be helpful to your readers to clarify that here. Alternate translation: [“Saddle one of my donkeys for me.” And they saddled one of his donkeys]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 13:14 (#1)

אֲנִֽי

“I {am”

The prophet from Judah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yes, I am that man]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 13:17 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I say this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 13:17 (#2)

דָּבָ֣ר אֵלַ֗י בִּדְבַ֤ר יְהוָה֙ לֹֽא־תֹאכַ֣ל לֶ֔חֶם וְלֹֽא־תִשְׁתֶּ֥ה שָׁ֖ם מָ֑יִם לֹֽא־תָשׁ֣וּב לָלֶ֔כֶת בַּדֶּ֥רֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־הָלַ֖כְתָּ בָּֽהּ

“a word {was} to me by the word of Yahweh, ‘You shall not eat bread and you shall not drink water there. You shall not return to go by the road by which you went”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh spoke to me, he commanded me not to eat bread and not to drink water here. He also told me not to return home by the road by which I came]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:17 (#3)

דָּבָ֣ר אֵלַ֗י בִּדְבַ֤ר יְהוָה֙

“a word {was} to me by the word of Yahweh”

Here, the term **word** represents in the first instance a command that Yahweh gave by using words, and it represents in the second instance the words that Yahweh spoke when he gave that command. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh gave me this command when he spoke to me]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:17 (#4)

הָלַ֖כְתָּ

“you went”

In a context such as this, your language might say “came” instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [you came]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 13:18 (#1)

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר לֹ֖ו

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to the old prophet, while the pronoun **him** refers to the man of God from Judah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the old prophet said to the man of God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:18 (#2)

בִּדְבַ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה

“by the word of Yahweh”

Here, **word** represents a command that Yahweh supposedly gave to the angel. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:18 (#3)

לֵאמֹ֔ר הֲשִׁיבֵ֥הוּ אִתְּךָ֖ אֶל־בֵּיתֶ֑ךָ וְיֹאכַ֥ל לֶ֖חֶם וְיִשְׁתְּ֥ מָֽיִם

“saying, ‘Bring him back with you to your house, that he may eat bread and drink water”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and told me to bring you back with me to my house so that you could eat bread and drink water]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:18 (#4)

כִּֽחֲחֵשׁ לוֹ

“He lied to him”

The author is providing background information about the old prophet’s deception to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 13:19 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אכַל לֶ֔חֶם בְּבֵיתוֹ֙ וַיֵּ֣שְׁתְּ מָֽיִם

“and he ate bread in his house and drank water”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the second action (**and drank water**) before the information about the location (**in his house**). Alternate translation: [and he ate bread and drank water in his house]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 13:20 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ דְּבַר־יְהוָ֔ה

“that the word of Yahweh {was”

Here, **word** represents a message that Yahweh gave by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh spoke a message]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:21 (#1)

כֹּֽה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֗ה יַ֚עַן כִּֽי מָרִ֣יתָ

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Because you have disobeyed”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that because you have disobeyed]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:21 (#2)

פִּ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“the mouth of Yahweh”

Here, **mouth of Yahweh** represents what Yahweh said by using his mouth. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh told you to do]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:21 (#3)

וְלֹ֣א שָׁמַ֔רְתָּ אֶת־הַמִּצְוָ֕ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוְּךָ֖ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ

“and you have not kept the command that Yahweh your God commanded you”

Yahweh, speaking through the old prophet, is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [you have not done what Yahweh your God commanded you to do]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 13:22 (#1)

וַתָּ֣שָׁב וַתֹּ֣אכַל לֶ֔חֶם וַתֵּ֣שְׁתְּ מַ֔יִם בַּמָּק֕וֹם אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֛ר אֵלַ֖יִךְ אַל־תֹּ֣אכַל לֶ֔חֶם וְאַל־תֵּ֣שְׁתְּ מָ֔יִם לֹֽא־תָבֹ֥וא נִבְלָתְךָ֖ אֶל־קֶ֥בֶר אֲבֹתָֽיִךְ

“and you have returned and you have eaten bread and you have drunk water in the place {about} which he spoke to you, “You shall not eat bread and you shall not drink water,” your corpse shall not enter into the grave of your fathers”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what the old prophet said to the man of God (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. The old prophet is continuing to quote what Yahweh told him to tell the man of God (level 2). And in the middle of the verse, Yahweh quotes what he told the man of God earlier (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 13:22 (#3)

וְאַל & תָּבֹ֥וא נִבְלָתְךָ֖ אֶל־קֶ֥בֶר אֲבֹתָֽיִךְ

“and & your corpse shall not enter into the grave of your fathers”

Yahweh is speaking of the man's **corpse** as if it were a living thing that could **enter** a place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will not be buried in the same plot as your fathers]

See: Personification

1 Kings 13:22 (#2)

וַתָּשָׁב וַתֹּאכַל לֶחֶם֙ וַתֵּ֣שְׁתְּ מַ֔יִם בַּמָּק֕וֹם אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֖ר אֵלֶ֑יךָ אַל־תֹּאכַל֙ לֶ֣חֶם וְאַל־תֵּ֣שְׁתְּ מָ֔יִם לֹא־תָבֹ֥וא נִבְלָתְךָ֖ אֶל־קֶ֥בֶר אֲבֹתֶֽיךָ

“and you have returned and you have eaten bread and you have drunk water in the place {about} which he spoke to you, “You shall not eat bread and you shall not drink water,” your corpse shall not enter into the grave of your fathers”

If you translated the previous verse so that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you could continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [and because you have returned and you have eaten bread and you have drunk water in the place about which he told you that you were not to eat bread or drink water there, your corpse will not enter into the grave of your fathers]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 13:22 (#4)

אֲבֹתֶֽיךָ

“your fathers”

See how you translated the term “fathers” in 1:21. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:23 (#1)

אַחֲרֵי֙ אָכְל֣וֹ לֶ֔חֶם וְאַחֲרֵ֖י שְׁתוֹתֹ֑ו וַיַּחֲבֹ֥שׁ־לֹ֛ו הַחֲמֹ֖ור

“after his eating bread and after his drinking that he saddled the donkey for him”

The pronouns **his** and **him** refer to the man of God from Judah, while the pronoun **he** refers to the old prophet. (What the author says in the rest of the verse is to clarify this.) It may be helpful to clarify this in your translation for your readers. Alternate translation: [after the man of God had eaten bread and after he had drunk something that the old prophet saddled the donkey for him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:23 (#2)

וַיַּחֲבֹ֥שׁ־לֹ֛ו הַחֲמֹ֖ור

“that he saddled the donkey for him”

The author is using the old prophet, one person who was involved in this action, to represent everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that he told his sons to saddle the donkey for him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:24 (#3)

וְהַחֲמֹ֖ור עֹמֵ֣ד אֶצְלָ֑הּ

“and the donkey was standing beside it”

Here the pronoun **it** refers to the man's **corpse**, not to the **road** or to the **lion**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the donkey was standing beside the corpse]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:24 (#1)

וַיִּמְצָאֵ֥הוּ אַרְיֵ֖ה

“and a lion found him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:29. Alternate translation: [and a lion met him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 13:24 (#4)

וְהָאַרְיֵ֛ה עֹמֵ֥ד אֵצֶ֖ל הַנְּבֵלָֽה

“and the lion was standing beside the corpse”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and so was the lion]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 13:24 (#2)

וַתִּהְיִ֤י נִבְלָתֹו֙ מֻשְׁלֶ֣כֶת בַּדֶּ֔רֶךְ

“And his corpse was thrown on the road”

The expression **was thrown** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And his corpse fell onto the road]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 13:25 (#1)

מֻשְׁלֶכֶת בַּדֶּרֶךְ

“thrown in the road”

The term **thrown** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language, here and in verse 28. Alternate translation: [lying on the road]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 13:26 (#3)

כִּדְבַר יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר־לוֹ

“according to the word of Yahweh that he spoke to him”

Here, **word** represents what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what Yahweh said when he spoke to him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:26 (#2)

וַיִּתְּנֵהוּ יְהוָה לָאַרְיֵה

“And Yahweh gave him to the lion”

The old prophet is speaking as if Yahweh literally **gave** the prophet from Judah to the lion. He means that Yahweh caused or allowed the lion to kill the prophet. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh allowed the lion to kill him] or [And Yahweh sent the lion to attack him]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:26 (#1)

אֶת־פִּי יְהוָה

“the mouth of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:21. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh told him to do]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:27 (#1)

חִבְשׁוּ־לִי אֶת־הַחֲמֹור

“Saddle the donkey for me”

See how you translated the expression “Saddle” in 13:13. Alternate translation: [Put the saddle and bridle on the donkey so that I can ride it]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:27 (#2)

חִבְשׁוּ־לִי אֶת־הַחֲמֹור וַיַּחֲבְשׁוּ

“Saddle the donkey for me.” And they saddled it”

See how you translated the expression “the donkey” in 13:13. Alternate translation: [“Saddle another of my donkeys for me.” And they saddled another one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 13:29 (#1)

וַיָּבֹא אֶל־עִירֹ הַנָּבִיא הַזָּקֵן

“And he entered into the city of the old prophet”

The pronoun **he** refers to the old prophet. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers by putting the description of him at the start of this sentence and using a pronoun later in the sentence. Alternate translation: [And the old prophet entered into his city]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:30 (#1)

וַיַּנַּח אֶת־נִבְלָתֹו בְּקִבְרֹו

“And he laid his corpse in his grave”

The pronoun **he** refers to the old prophet, while the pronoun **his** refers to the man of God from Judah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the old prophet laid the corpse of the man of God in his own grave]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:30 (#3)

הוֹי אָחִי

“Alas, my brother”

The people are speaking to the dead prophet even though they know that he cannot hear them. They are doing this to communicate to the people who can hear them that they feel very strongly about the man’s death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if they were speaking directly to the people who could hear them about how they feel. Alternate translation: [We are very sad that this brother of ours has died]

See: Apostrophe

1 Kings 13:30 (#2)

וַיִּסְפְּדוּ עָלָיו

“And they mourned over him”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people mourned over him] or [And he was mourned as people said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 13:30 (#4)

הֹוי אָחִי

“Alas, my brother”

The people are speaking as if the dead prophet were actually their **brother**. They are using that term to describe a fellow Israelite. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Alas, my kinsman] or [We are very sad that this kinsman of ours has died]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:31 (#1)

וּקְבַרְתֶּם אֹתִי בַּקֶּבֶר אֲשֶׁר אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים קָבוּר בּוֹ אֵצֶל עַצְמֹתָיו הַנִּיחוּ אֶת־עַצְמֹתָי

“then you shall bury me in the grave in which the man of God is buried. Lay my bones beside his bones”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [then you shall bury my bones in this same grave right next to those of the man of God]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 13:31 (#2)

אֵצֶל עַצְמֹתָיו הַנִּיחוּ אֶת־עַצְמֹתָי

“Lay my bones beside his bones”

The old prophet is using the **bones** of people to represent their entire bodies or the remains of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Lay my body beside his remains]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 13:32 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I ask this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 13:32 (#3)

שֹׁמְרוֹן

“Samaria”

Samaria is the name of the city that Omri, a later king of the northern kingdom of Israel, built as his capital several decades after this. People then began using the name of that city to represent this kingdom, and that is what the author is doing here. He is using a name that his readers would recognize in order to convey the old prophet’s meaning. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the name of the kingdom instead. Alternate translation: [the kingdom of Israel]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 13:32 (#4)

הָיֹה יִהְיֶה

“happening, it will happen”

The old prophet is repeating forms of the verb **happen** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [it will certainly happen]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 13:32 (#2)

הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר קָרָא בִּדְבַר יְהוָה

“the word that he cried out by the word of Yahweh”

Here, **the word** represents the message that the prophet proclaimed by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message that he cried out by the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:33 (#5)

יְמַלֵּא אֶת־יָדוֹ

“he would fill his hand”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Jeroboam appointed these men to be priests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Judges, see how you translated the similar expression in Judges 17:5. Alternate translation: [he would appoint him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 13:33 (#1)

אַחַרֹ֣ הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה לֹא־שָׁ֥ב יָרָבְעָ֖ם מִדַּרְכּ֑וֹ הָרָעָ֔ה וַיָּ֖שָׁב

“After this matter Jeroboam did not return from his evil way, but he returned”

In this verse and the next one, the author is describing what happened after this story as a result of the events within the story itself. This signals the end of a story. Use the natural form in your language for expressing the conclusion of a story.

See: End of Story

1 Kings 13:33 (#3)

וַיָּ֖שָׁב וַיַּ֣עַשׂ

“but he returned and made”

The author is using **returned and made** as a common expression of the culture to mean “once again made” or “went back to making.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but he once again made]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 13:33 (#2)

לֹא־שָׁ֥ב יָרָבְעָ֖ם מִדַּרְכּ֑וֹ הָרָעָ֔ה

“Jeroboam did not return from his evil way”

The author is speaking as if Jeroboam had actually been walking along a path in one direction and did not turn around and walk in a different direction. He means that Jeroboam did not stop doing evil things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Jeroboam continued these evil practices]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:33 (#6)

וַיְהִי֙ כֹּהֲנֵ֣י בָמ֔וֹת

“and he became priests of the high places”

Here the author is using the singular pronoun **he** with the plural object **priests**. He means that such a person became one of the priests. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and he became one of the priests of the high places]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Kings 13:33 (#4)

מִקְצ֥וֹת הָעָ֖ם

“from the extremities of the people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:31. Alternate translation: [from throughout the population]

See: Merism

1 Kings 13:34 (#4)

מֵעַ֖ל פְּנֵ֥י הָאֲדָמָֽה

“from upon the face of the ground”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:20. Alternate translation: [from the surface of the earth]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 13:34 (#1)

בֵּ֖ית יָרָבְעָ֑ם

“the house of Jeroboam”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:24. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 13:34 (#2)

וּלְהַכְחִ֥יד וּלְהַשְׁמִֽיד

“both to annihilate and to destroy”

The terms **annihilate** and **destroy** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to destroy completely]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 13:34 (#3)

וּלְהַכְחִ֥יד וּלְהַשְׁמִֽיד

“both to annihilate and to destroy”

In this second part of this sentence, the author is indicating the result of what he describes in the first part of the sentence. Use a word or phrase in your language that will make it clear that this is a description of a result. Alternate translation: [causing it to be completely destroyed] or [leading Yahweh to destroy it completely]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes the story of how the kingdom of David and Solomon was split into two kingdoms, Israel in the north and Judah in the south. It tells what happened during the rest of the reigns of the first king of Israel, Jeroboam, and the first king of Judah, Rehoboam.

1. Ahijah prophesies that Jeroboam’s son will die (14:1–18)
2. Conclusion of the reign of Jeroboam (14:19–20)
3. Rehoboam introduces foreign worship, and his kingdom is diminished (14:21–28)
4. Conclusion of the reign of Rehoboam (14:29–31)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Phrases that the author uses to introduce accounts of kings’ reigns

In 14:21, the author tells how old Rehoboam was when he began to reign as king of Judah. He says who Rehoboam’s father and mother were, how long he reigned, and in what city. This is the first instance in the book of these phrases that the author will use regularly to introduce the account of a king’s reign. So that your readers will appreciate their role, be careful to translate these phrases consistently in each of their occurrences.

Long quotation within quotation

The prophet Ahijah speaks a long message from Yahweh to Jeroboam’s wife in 14:7–16. Most of it is a quotation within a quotation, in which Ahijah tells his wife what to say to him. That long part of the message contains a further quotation of a specific warning in Yahweh’s own words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. For example, Ahijah tells Jeroboam’s wife in 14:7, “Go, say to Jeroboam, ‘Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, “Because I raised you up from the midst of the people and made you a leader over my people Israel ...”’” You could translate this as, “Go and tell Jeroboam that Yahweh, the God of Israel, says that because he raised him up from the midst of the people and made him a leader over his people Israel ....” You can continue to translate the message that way in subsequent verses. For example, in 14:8, Ahijah continues, “and I tore the kingdom away from the house of David and I gave it to you, but you are not like my servant David, who kept my commandments and who walked after me with all of his heart, to do only the right in my eyes.” You could translate that as, “and he tore the kingdom away from the house of David and he gave it to him, but he are not like his servant David, who kept his commandments and who walked after him with all of his heart, to do only the right in his eyes.” (See: Quotes within Quotes)

Was Rehoboam’s son named Abijam or Abijah?

In 14:31, the author describes how Rehoboam’s son succeeded him as king after he died. The author gives Abijam as this son’s name. However, in the parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 12:16, this kings name is given as “Abijah,” and that is what he is called throughout the account of his reign in 2 Chronicles 13. To make clear that this is the same king, some versions use the name Abijam here in 1 Kings as well. However, we do not recommend that you change the name either here or in 2 Chronicles to make the accounts in both books match. The reason for the difference in spelling is not clear, but we recommend that you simply translate the names as they appear in each text and not try to harmonize them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain in a footnote that Abijam of 1 Kings is the same man as Abijah of 2 Chronicles.

1 Kings 14:1 (#1)

בָּעֵ֣ת הַהִ֔יא חָלָ֖ה אֲבִיָּ֑ה בֶּן־יָרָׇבְעָֽם

“At that time Abijah, the son of Jeroboam, became sick”

The author is using the phrase **At that time** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 14:2 (#5)

הִוא־דִּבֶּ֣ר

“He, he spoke”

Jeroboam is stating the pronoun **He** separately, even though the verb translated as **he spoke** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to empha-

size the personal role of Ahijah in having said that Jeroboam would become king. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [He was the one who spoke]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:2 (#4)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:2 (#2)

וְלֹ֣א יֵדְעוּ֮

“so they will not know”

Here Jeroboam is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so no one will know] or [so it will not be known]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:2 (#1)

קוּמִי

“Arise”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [Take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 14:2 (#3)

אֵ֣שֶׁת יָרָבְעָ֔ם

“are} the wife of Jeroboam”

Since Jeroboam is the speaker, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [my wife]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:3 (#1)

בְּיָדֵךְ

“in your hand”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of how the author and characters sometimes use one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of conveying something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 14:3 (#3)

הָהוּא יַגִּ֥יד

“He, he will declare”

Jeroboam is stating the pronoun **He** separately, even though the verb translated as **he will declare** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize the contrast between what he wants his wife to do and what he expects Ahijah to do. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “he, he cursed” in 2:8. Alternate translation: [And for his part, he will declare]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:3 (#2)

וְנִקְדַּדִּ֑ים

“and cakes”

The word translated as **cakes** as a description of a kind of food occurs only here in the Old Testament, so its meaning is not entirely certain. The context suggests that it means some kind of small, baked good. One ancient version adds an explanation that these were a gift for Ahijah’s children. In your translation, you could use the name of a similar food item that your readers would recognize. You could also use a general expression, as the UST does. Alternate translation: [and biscuits] or [and cookies]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 14:4 (#2)

וַאֲחִיָּ֖הוּ לֹא־יָכֹ֣ל לִרְאוֹת֮ כִּֽי־קָ֣מוּ עֵינָ֒יו֒ מִשֵּׁ֖יבוֹ

“Now Ahijah was not able to see, for his eyes had set because of his age”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Now since Ahijah’s eyes had set because of his age, he was not able to see]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 14:4 (#1)

וַאֲחִיָּ֣הוּ לֹא־יָכֹ֔ל לִרְאֹ֖ות כִּ֣י קָ֑מוּ עֵינָ֖יו מִשֵּׁיבֹֽו׃

“Now Ahijah was not able to see, for his eyes had set because of his age”

The author is providing background information about Ahijah’s blindness to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 14:4 (#3)

קָ֑מוּ עֵינָ֖יו

“his eyes had set”

The author is using the phrase **his eyes had set** to describe an eye condition that was most likely cataracts. He means that these cataracts had advanced to the point where Ahijah could no longer use his eyes. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could name this condition explicitly in your translation. You could also use a general expression, as the UST does. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 4:15. Alternate translation: [he had severe cataracts]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 14:5 (#4)

כָּזֹ֣את וְכָזֹ֔את תְּדַבֵּ֖ר אֵלֶ֑יהָ

“Like this and like this you shall speak to her”

Yahweh did not actually say the words **Like this and like this**. The author is using that expression to summarize what Yahweh told Ahijah to say to Jeroboam’s wife. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. You could stop the direct quotation at the end of the previous sentence and begin it again at the start of the next sentence. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see what you decided to do in the case of the same expression in 2 Samuel 17:15. Alternate translation: [Yahweh told Ahijah what to say to Jeroboam’s wife. Then he continued,]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Kings 14:5 (#2)

לִדְרֹ֣שׁ דָּבָ֔ר מֵעִמְּךָ֖

“to seek a word from you”

Here, **word** represents a response from Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to seek an answer from you] or [to ask you a question]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:5 (#3)

כָּזֹ֣את וְכָזֹ֔את תְּדַבֵּ֖ר אֵלֶ֑יהָ וְיִהְיֶ֖ה בְּבֹאָ֥הּ וְהִתְנַכֵּֽרָה׃

“Like this and like this you shall speak to her. And it will happen when she comes that she will be disguising herself”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about Jeroboam’s wife **disguising herself** before the information about what Ahijah should say to her. Alternate translation: [And it will happen when she comes that she will be disguising herself. Like this and like this you shall speak to her]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 14:5 (#1)

אֵ֣שֶׁת יָרׇבְעָ֗ם בָּאָה֙ לִדְרֹ֣שׁ דָּבָ֔ר מֵעִמְּךָ֖ אֶל־בְּנָ֑הּ כִּי־חֹלֶ֣ה הֽוּא׃

“the wife of Jeroboam is coming to seek a word from you about her son, for he is sick”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since the son of the wife of Jeroboam is sick, she is coming to seek a word from you about him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 14:5 (#5)

כָּזֹ֣את וְכָזֹ֔את תְּדַבֵּ֖ר אֵלֶ֑יהָ

“Like this and like this you shall speak to her”

The author is using **Like this and like this** as a common expression of his culture. If you decide to translate everything Yahweh says here as a direct quotation, your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [You shall speak to her in such-and-such a way]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:6 (#2)

לָ֣מָּה זֶּ֔ה אַתְּ֖ מִתְנַכֶּ֣רֶת

“Why is this, you are disguising yourself”

Ahijah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no reason for you to be disguising yourself] or [It is useless for you to disguise yourself]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 14:6 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙

“And it happened”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 8:10, where it similarly introduces a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 14:6 (#3)

וְאָ֣נֹכִ֔י שָׁלֻ֥חַ אֵלַ֖יִךְ קָשֶׁ֑ה

“Now I have been sent to you harshly”

Ahijah is speaking here as if Yahweh had actually sent him to Jeroboam’s wife in a harsh way. He means that Yahweh has given him a harsh message to deliver to her. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Now Yahweh has given me a harsh message to speak to you]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:7 (#1)

לְכִ֣י אִמְרִ֔י לְיָרָבְעָ֖ם כֹּֽה־אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֲרִימֹתִ֔יךָ מִתּ֖וֹךְ הָעָ֑ם וָאֶתֶּנְךָ֞ נָגִ֤יד עַל־עַמִּי֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Go, say to Jeroboam, ‘Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, “Because I raised you up from the midst of the people and made you a leader over my people Israel”

There are three levels of quotation here. At the start, the author is quoting what Ahijah said to Jeroboam’s wife (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. Ahijah then tells her what he wants her to say to Jeroboam (level 2). Within this message, there is a quotation from Yahweh (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 14:7 (#3)

הֲרִימֹתִ֔יךָ

“I raised you up”

Yahweh is speaking as if he had physically **raised up** Jeroboam, that is, as if he had lifted him up into the air or to an elevated location. In contexts such as this, this expression describes making a person powerful or giving a person a powerful position. See how you represented this image in 11:14. Alternate translation: [I brought you to power]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:7 (#2)

לְכִ֣י אִמְרִ֔י לְיָרָבְעָ֖ם כֹּֽה־אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֲרִימֹתִ֔יךָ מִתּ֖וֹךְ הָעָ֑ם וָאֶתֶּנְךָ֞ נָגִ֤יד עַל־עַמִּי֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Go, say to Jeroboam, ‘Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, “Because I raised you up from the midst of the people and made you a leader over my people Israel”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how you can translate Yahweh’s message to Jeroboam’s wife in verses 7–11 in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations. Here is an example of what you might say in this verse. Alternate translation: [Go and tell Jeroboam that Yahweh, the God of Israel, says that because he raised him up from the midst of the people and made him a leader over his people Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 14:8 (#4)

בְּכָל־לְבָבֹ֔ו

“with all of his heart”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:23. Alternate translation: [in complete devotion]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:8 (#3)

וַאֲשֶׁר־הָלַ֥ךְ אַחֲרַ֖י

“and who walked after me”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [and who lived as I want people to live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:8 (#5)

הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינָי

“the right in my eyes”

Yahweh is using the adjective **right** as a noun to mean things that are right. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [things that are right in my eyes]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 14:8 (#2)

מִבֵּית דָּוִד

“from the house of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:19. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of David] or [David’s descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:8 (#6)

הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינָי

“the right in my eyes”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:33. Alternate translation: [things that are right in my judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:8 (#1)

וָאֶקְרַע אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָה

“and I tore the kingdom away”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:11. Alternate translation: [and I took the kingdom away]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:9 (#4)

וְאֹתִי הִשְׁלַכְתָּ אַחֲרֵי גַּוֶּךָ

“and you have thrown me behind your back”

Here Yahweh is using a common expression of this culture to mean that Jeroboam has completely disregarded him. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you have turned your back on me] or [and you have completely disregarded me]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:9 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־הָיוּ לְפָנֶיךָ

“who were to your face”

Yahweh is using the expression **to your face** to mean “before you” or “previous to you.” He is referring specifically to earlier kings of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who ruled Israel before you]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:9 (#3)

אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים וּמַסֵּכוֹת

“other gods and molded images”

The expressions **other gods** and **molded images** together express a single idea. The phrase **molded images** tells in what form Jeroboam made these **other gods**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [molded images of other gods]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 14:9 (#1)

וַתָּתָרַע לַעֲשׂוֹת

“and you have been evil to do”

Together, the verbal phrase **you have been evil** and the infinitive **to do** express a single idea. They indicate that Jeroboam has done what is evil. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and you have done evil]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 14:10 (#3)

וְהִכְרַתִּי לְיָרָבְעָם מַשְׁתִּין בְּקִיר

“and I will cut off from Jeroboam one pissing against a wall”

See how you translated the similar expression “cut off” in 11:16. Alternate translation: [and I will cause someone to kill every one of Jeroboam’s family members who pisses against a wall]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:10 (#6)

וּבָעַרְתִּי֙ אַחֲרֵ֣י בֵּית־יָרָבְעָ֔ם

“And I will burn after the house of Jeroboam”

Yahweh is speaking as if Jeroboam’s family and dynasty were actually a **house** that he would **burn**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will destroy Jeroboam’s descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:10 (#7)

וּבָעַרְתִּי֙ אַחֲרֵ֣י בֵּית־יָרָבְעָ֔ם

“And I will burn after the house of Jeroboam”

In this context, the word **after** adds intensity and completeness to the idea of **burn**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation if you decide to retain the image of burning. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [And I will burn up the house of Jeroboam] or [And I will destroy all of Jeroboam’s descendants]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 14:10 (#1)

הִנְנִ֣י מֵבִ֔יא רָעָ֖ה

“behold me, bringing harm”

Yahweh is using **behold me, bringing** as a common expression of his culture to mean “I am about to bring.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to bring harm]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:10 (#4)

מַשְׁתִּ֥ין בְּקִ֖יר

“one pissing against a wall”

Yahweh is referring to the males in Jeroboam’s household. To emphasize how angry he is at Jeroboam’s serious sins and what severe punishment he deserves, Yahweh is using a vivid expression that might be considered vulgar in some cultures. If it would not be appropriate for your readers if you reproduced this exact expression, you could use an equivalent one that would reflect Yahweh’s anger. You could also use plain language. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 25:22. Alternate translation: [every single one of the men]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:10 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית יָרָבְעָ֔ם

“the house of Jeroboam”

This could mean: (1) the family of Jeroboam. What the author says about this prophecy in 15:29 supports this interpretation. Alternate translation: [the family of Jeroboam] or (2) the dynasty of Jeroboam, as in the similar expression [the house of David] in verse 8. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:10 (#8)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר יְבַעֵ֖ר הַגֹּלָלִ֑ל עַד־תֻּמּ֖וֹ

“just as dung burns until the finishing of it”

The point of this comparison is that just as **dung burns** completely, so Yahweh will completely destroy Jeroboam’s descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as completely as dung burns until the finishing of it]

See: Simile

1 Kings 14:10 (#5)

עָצ֥וּר וְעָזִ֖וב

“one restrained and one set free”

Yahweh is referring to all of Jeroboam’s male descendants by naming the two main categories of them, **one restrained** (legal slaves) and **one set free** (legal free men). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all male descendants] or [every male descendant]

See: Merism

1 Kings 14:11 (#2)

כִּ֣י יְהוָ֔ה דִּבֵּ֖ר

“For Yahweh has spoken”

Ahijah is using this statement to conclude his direct quotation of what Yahweh told him to tell Jeroboam’s wife. In verse 7, he started the quotation by also mentioning that Yahweh had said this. Ahijah begins

and ends the message with these statements in order to mark it as something he has spoken by Yahweh's authority and that will surely happen. In your translation, use a natural way in your language of showing at the end of a quotation that someone has spoken it who has the power and authority to declare it and make it happen.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 14:11 (#1)

בַּשָּׂדֶה

"in the field"

Here, **in the field** represents any place outside of a city or town. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [out in the open]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:12 (#1)

וְאַתָּה קוּם לֵךְ

"Now you, arise, go"

Ahijah is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the imperative verbs translated as **arise** and **go** already include this meaning. He is doing that because, after describing what will happen to all of the males in Jeroboam's family, he is now describing what Jeroboam's wife is to do. See how you translated the similar expression "you, now make" in 12:4, which similarly emphasizes a contrast. Alternate translation: [Now for your part, arise, go] or [And as for you, arise, go]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:12 (#2)

בְּבֹאָה רַגְלַיִךְ הָעִירָה

"When your feet enter the city"

Here the prophet is using one part of Jeroboam's wife, her **feet**, to mean all of her in the act of entering the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When you enter the city] or [As soon as you walk into the city]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 14:13 (#3)

וְזֶה לְבַדּוֹ יָבֹא לִירָבְעָם אֶל־קֶבֶר יַעַן נִמְצָא־בּוֹ דָּבָר טוֹב אֶל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּבֵית יָרָבְעָם

"this {one} alone from Jeroboam will enter into a grave, because a good thing was found in him for Yahweh, the God of Israel, in the house of Jeroboam"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [because a good thing was found in him for Yahweh, the God of Israel, in the house of Jeroboam, this one alone from Jeroboam will enter into a grave]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 14:13 (#4)

נִמְצָא־בּוֹ דָּבָר טוֹב

"a good thing was found in him"

Ahijah is using the term **found** in a way characteristic of his language and culture to mean that this **good thing** could be found, that is, that it could be seen to be present in the life and conduct of Abijah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [there was something good in his life]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:13 (#1)

וְסָפְדוּ־לוֹ כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"And all of Israel will mourn for him"

Ahijah says that **all of Israel** will mourn for Jeroboam's son as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites will mourn greatly for him]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 14:13 (#2)

וְקָבְרוּ אֹתוֹ

"and they will bury him"

Here Ahijah is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will be buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:13 (#5)

בְּבֵית יָרָבְעָם

"in the house of Jeroboam"

Ahijah is speaking of Jeroboam's family as if it were actually a **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in Jeroboam's family] or [among the descendants of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:14 (#1)

וְהֵקִים֤וֹ יְהוָה֙ לֹ֣ו מֶ֔לֶךְ

"And Yahweh by himself will raise up a king"

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:7. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh by himself will bring a king to power]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:14 (#2)

יַכְרִ֥ית אֶת־בֵּֽית יָרָבְעָ֖ם

"will cut off the house of Jeroboam"

Ahijah is speaking as if this king were going to literally **cut off** Jeroboam's family, as if they were a plant, and the king would use a sharp tool to remove them. He means that the king will kill all of Jeroboam's descendants. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will kill all of Jeroboam's family]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:14 (#3)

וְזֶ֖ה הַיֹּ֑ום

"this day"

Ahijah is using the expression **this day** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at this time] or [very soon]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:14 (#4)

וּמֶ֖ה גַּם־עָתָֽה

"But what, even now"

Ahijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But what am I saying, 'will raise up'? This is happening even now]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 14:15 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר יָנ֛וּד הַקָּנֶ֖ה בַּמָּ֑יִם

"just as a reed sways in the waters"

The point of this comparison is that just as a **reed** that **sways in the waters** is unstable and has no firm foundation, so Israel will be unstable and have no secure place to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [so that it will not have a settled place to live, just as a reed sways and ultimately comes loose as the waters of a river tug at it]

See: Simile

1 Kings 14:15 (#7)

לַנָּהָ֔ר

"the River"

By **the River**, Ahijah means the Euphrates River. Alternate translation: [the Euphrates River]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 14:15 (#1)

וְהִכָּ֣ה יְהוָ֔ה אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

"And Yahweh will strike Israel"

Ahijah is speaking of Yahweh's judgment as if Yahweh were going to **strike** Israel physically. This image portrays Yahweh's punishment as a decisive blow. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will decisively punish Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:15 (#5)

לַאֲבֹתֵיהֶ֑ם

"to their fathers"

See how you translated the term "fathers" in 1:21. Alternate translation: [to their ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:15 (#6)

וְזֵרָ֣ם מֵעֵ֣בֶר לַנָּהָ֔ר יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשׂ֔וּ אֶת־אֲשֵׁרֵיהֶ֖ם מַכְעִיסִ֑ים אֶת־יְהוָֽה

"And he will scatter them beyond the River because they made their Asherahs, provoking Yahweh"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because they made their Asherahs, provoking Yahweh, he will scatter them beyond the River]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 14:15 (#2)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר יָנ֛וּד הַקָּנֶ֖ה בַּמָּ֑יִם

“just as a reed sways in the waters”

Ahijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [so that it will sway just as a reed sways in the waters]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 14:15 (#4)

וְנָתַ֣שׁ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“and he will uproot Israel”

Ahijah is speaking of Yahweh removing Israel from the land as if Yahweh were actually going to **uproot** a plant. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will remove Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:16 (#1)

חַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר חָטָ֔א וַאֲשֶׁ֖ר הֶחֱטִ֣יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“the sins of Jeroboam that he sinned and that he caused Israel to sin”

Ahijah is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [the sins that Jeroboam committed and that he caused Israel to commit]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 14:18 (#4)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:18 (#2)

וַיִּסְפְּדוּ־לֹ֖ו כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“and all of Israel mourned for him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:13. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites mourned greatly for him]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 14:18 (#3)

כִּדְבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֖ר דִּבֶּֽר

“according to the word of Yahweh that he had spoken”

Here, **word** represents the message that Yahweh announced through Ahijah by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to the message that Yahweh had spoken]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:18 (#1)

וַיִּקְבְּרֻ֖הוּ אֹתָֽו

“And they buried him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:13. Alternate translation: [And people buried him] or [And he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:19 (#1)

וְיֶ֙תֶר֙ דִּבְרֵ֣י יָרָבְעָ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר נִלְחַ֖ם וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר מָלָ֑ךְ הִנָּ֗ם כְּתוּבִ֛ים עַל־סֵ֥פֶר דִּבְרֵ֖י הַיָּמִ֥ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Jeroboam, how he fought and how he reigned, behold them, written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude the account of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the phrases in 11:41–43 that are similar to the ones in verses 19 and 20 here. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Jeroboam, how he fought and how he reigned, in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 14:20 (#1)

וְהַיָּמִים֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר מָלַ֔ךְ יָרָבְעָ֖ם עֶשְׂרִ֣ים וּשְׁתַּ֑יִם שָׁנָֽה

“And the days that Jeroboam reigned were 22 years”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a period of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the time that Jeroboam reigned was 22 years]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:20 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֣ב עִם־אֲבֹתָ֔יו

“And he lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And he passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 14:21 (#1)

וּרְחַבְעָם֙ בֶּן־שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה מָלַ֖ךְ בִּיהוּדָ֑ה בֶּן־אַרְבָּעִ֨ים וְאַחַ֤ת שָׁנָה֙ רְחַבְעָ֔ם בְּמָלְכ֕וֹ וּשְׁבַ֥ע עֶשְׂרֵ֛ה שָׁנָ֖ה ׀ מָלַ֣ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלַ֗͏ִם הָעִ֡יר אֲשֶׁר־בָּחַ֣ר יְהוָ֣ה לְשׂ֣וּם אֶת־שְׁמ֣וֹ שָׁ֔ם מִכֹּ֖ל שִׁבְטֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל וְשֵׁ֣ם אִמּ֔וֹ נַעֲמָ֖ה הָעַמֳּנִֽית

“Now Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, reigned in Judah. Rehoboam {was} a son of 41 years when he reigned. And he reigned 17 years in Jerusalem, the city where Yahweh had chosen to put his name there from all of the tribes of Israel. And the name of his mother was Naamah the Ammonitess”

In this verse, the author is reintroducing Rehoboam as a participant in the story. He was first introduced briefly in 11:43 as Solomon’s son and successor. The author is now reintroducing him formally as the king of Judah. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation. See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how the author introduces his accounts of the reigns of kings.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 14:21 (#2)

בֶּן־אַרְבָּעִ֨ים וְאַחַ֤ת שָׁנָה֙

“was} a son of 41 years”

The author is using **a son of 41 years** as a common expression of the culture to mean “41 years old.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was 41 years old]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:21 (#5)

מִכֹּ֖ל שִׁבְטֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“from all of the tribes of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:16. Alternate translation: [of all possible locations within the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:21 (#3)

הָעִ֡יר אֲשֶׁר־בָּחַ֣ר יְהוָ֣ה לְשׂ֣וּם אֶת־שְׁמ֣וֹ שָׁ֔ם

“the city where Yahweh had chosen to put his name there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [the city where Yahweh had chosen to put his name]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 14:21 (#4)

לְשׂ֣וּם אֶת־שְׁמ֣וֹ שָׁ֔ם

“to put his name there”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:36. Alternate translation: [as a place where people would worship him] or [as a place where his reputation would be made known]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:22 (#2)

הָרַ֣ע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 14:22 (#1)

יְהוּדָ֔ה

“Judah”

Here, **Judah** represents the people of Judah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Judah]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:22 (#3)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:22 (#4)

בְּחַטֹּאתָם אֲשֶׁר חָטָאוּ

“by their sins that they sinned”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [by the sins that they committed]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 14:23 (#2)

גַּם־הֵמָּה

“they also”

The author is stating the pronoun **they** separately, even though the verb translated as **they built** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that the people of Judah should have known better than to build these **high places and pillars and Asherahs**, since they had Yahweh’s temple and its influence within their territory in Jerusalem. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “you, you know” in 2:5. Alternate translation: [even they, who should have known better]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:23 (#1)

עַל כָּל־גִּבְעָעָה גְּבֹהָה וְתַחַת כָּל־עֵץ רַעֲנָן

“on every high hill and under every green tree”

The author is referring to **every** high hill and **every** green tree as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [on high hills and under green trees throughout their territory]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 14:24 (#1)

קָדֵשׁ הָיֶה בָּאָרֶץ

“a cultic prostitute was in the land”

In this verse, the term **cultic prostitute** is singular in form, but it refers to cultic prostitutes as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a plural form in your translation. Alternate translation: [cultic prostitutes were in the land]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 14:24 (#2)

עָשׂוּ

“They did”

The pronoun **They** refers to the people of Judah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The Judeans did]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 14:24 (#4)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:24 (#3)

מִפְּנֵי

“from the face of”

The author is using **from the face of** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on account of] or [for the sake of]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 14:25 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened that”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 2:39, where it similarly introduces a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 14:25 (#2)

עָלָה & עַל

“came up against”

It might seem that including the word **up** in this phrase would be to state extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [came against] or [attacked]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 14:26 (#1)

בֵּית־יְהוָה & בֵּבֵית הַמֶּלֶךְ

“the house of Yahweh & the house of the king”

The author is speaking here of the temple of Yahweh as if it were a **house** in which he lived. Similarly, he is speaking of the king’s palace as if it were a **house**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “the house of Yahweh and the house of the king” in 9:10. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh ... the palace of the king]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 14:26 (#2)

הַכֹּל & וַיִּקַּח

“And he took everything”

The author says **everything** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And he took everything else of value that he could capture]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 14:27 (#1)

יַד

“the hand of”

Here, **hand** represents the control or custody of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the custody of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:28 (#1)

וְהֶשִׁיבוּם

“and they brought them back”

The author assumes that readers will know that Rehoboam’s servants **brought** these shields **back** to their chamber after he had left the temple. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and once he was gone, they brought them back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 14:29 (#4)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי רְחַבְעָם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה

“Now the rest of the matters of Rehoboam and all that he did”

The terms **the rest of the matters of Rehoboam** and **all that he did** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Now other significant things that Rehoboam did that are not recorded here]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 14:29 (#2)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי רְחַבְעָם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Rehoboam and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:19.

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 14:29 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי רְחַבְעָם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Rehoboam and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude the account of kings' reigns. See how you translated the phrases in 11:41–43 and 14:19–20 that are similar to the ones in verses 29–31 here. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Rehoboam and all that he did in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 14:29 (#3)

וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה

"and all that he did"

The author says **all that he did** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and other significant things that he did]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 14:30 (#1)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

"all of the days"

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the whole time that they both reigned]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 14:31 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב רְחַבְעָם עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

"And Rehoboam lay down with his fathers"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Rehoboam passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 14:31 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

"and he was buried"

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 14:31 (#3)

אֲבִיָּם

"Abijam"

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the name of this king, who is called "Abijah" in the parallel passage in 2 Chronicles. We recommend that you use the name **Abijam** in your translation here and not try to harmonize the name with the form in 2 Chronicles.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter alternately tells the stories of the kings of the two kingdoms into which the kingdom of David and Solomon was split, Israel in the north and Judah in the south.

1. Abijam, king of Judah (15:1–8)
2. Asa, king of Judah (15:9–24)
3. Nadab, king of Israel (15:25–32)
4. Baasha, king of Israel (15:33–34)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Further phrases that the author uses to introduce accounts of kings' reigns

In 15:1–2, the author uses some the same phrases to introduce his account of Abijam's reign that he used to introduce his account of Rehoboam's reign in 14:21. For example, he says for how many years Abijam ruled as king, where he reigned, and who his mother was. However, he begins by making an additional statement, that Abijam began to reign "in year 18 of King Jeroboam." This is the first instance of this kind of reference to a year in the reign of another king, but after this the author will make such a reference regularly as he introduces his accounts of kings' reigns. So that your readers will appreciate the role of this reference, be careful to translate it consistently in each of its occurrences.

1 Kings 15:1 (#3)

אֲבִיָּם

"Abijam"

See the discussion in the introduction to chapter 14 of the form of this name. We recommend that you use the name **Abijam** in your translation here and not try to harmonize it with the form "Abijah" that appears in 2 Chronicles.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 15:1 (#1)

וּבִשְׁנַתשְׁמֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה לַמֶּלֶךְ יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט מָלַךְ אֲבִיָּם עַל־יְהוּדָה

“Now in the year of 18 to King Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, Abijam reigned over Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Abijam** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. Your language may have its own way of introducing participants that you can use in your translation. See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how the author is, for the first time in the book, referring here to a year in the reign of the king of one kingdom in order to identify when the king of another kingdom began to reign.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 15:1 (#2)

וּבִשְׁנַתשְׁמֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה לַמֶּלֶךְ יָרָבְעָם

“Now in the year of 18 to King Jeroboam”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the year of 18**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [Now in the eighteenth year of King Jeroboam]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 15:3 (#1)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ בְּכָל־חַטֹּאות אָבִיו

“And he walked in all of the sins of his father”

See how you translated the similar expression “to walk in his ways” in 2:3. Alternate translation: [And he committed the same sins that his father had committed]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:3 (#3)

וְלֹא־הָיָה לְבָבוֹ שָׁלֵם עִם־יְהוָה אֱלֹהָיו כִּלְבַבָב דָּוִד אָבִיו

“And his heart was not complete with Yahweh his God like the heart of David his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:61. Alternate translation: [And he was not completely devoted to Yahweh his God like David his father]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:3 (#2)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:9. Alternate translation: [when he ruled Israel before him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:3 (#4)

אָבִיו

“his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [his ancestor]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:4 (#2)

לְהָקִים אֶת־בְּנוֹ

“by raising up his son”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:7. Alternate translation: [by bringing his son to power] or [by allowing his son to rule as king]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:4 (#3)

וּלְהַעֲמִיד אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלָ‍ִם

“and by making Jerusalem stand”

The author is speaking of Jerusalem as if it had actually been a building or some other structure that Yahweh could have made **stand**. The author means that Yahweh kept Jerusalem secure. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and by making Jerusalem secure] or [and by protecting Jerusalem]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:4 (#1)

נֵר

“a lamp”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:36. Alternate translation: [a successor]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:5 (#3)

וְלֹא־סָ֠ר מִכֹּ֨ל אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּ֥הוּ

“and he had not turned from all that he had commanded him”

The author is speaking as if David could actually have **turned** from Yahweh’s commands, as if he had been walking in one direction but then turned to walk in a different direction. The author means that David did not disobey Yahweh’s commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he had not disobeyed anything that he had commanded him.]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:5 (#1)

אֶת־הַיָּשָׁ֖ר

“right”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **right**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was right]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 15:5 (#4)

כֹּ֚ל יְמֵ֣י חַיָּ֔יו

“all of the days of his life”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time, the lifetime of David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during his whole lifetime]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:5 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 15:6 (#1)

רְחַבְעָ֖ם

“Rehoboam”

Some ancient manuscripts read “Rehoboam.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “Abijam.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 15:7 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י אֲבִיָּ֔ם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הֲלוֹא־הֵ֑ם כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֚פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֔ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יְהוּדָֽה

“Now the rest of the matters of Abijam and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43, 14:19–20, and 14:29–31. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Abijam and all that he did in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 15:8 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב אֲבִיָּ֖ם עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

“And Abijam lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Abijam passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 15:8 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּרֻ֥הוּ אֹתָ֖ם

“and they buried him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:13. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 15:9 (#1)

וּבִשְׁנַ֣ת עֶשְׂרִ֔ים לְיָרָבְעָ֖ם מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל מָלַ֥ךְ אָסָ֛א מֶ֥לֶךְ יְהוּדָֽה

“Now in the year of 20 to Jeroboam, the king of Israel, Asa reigned {as} the king of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Asa** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 15:9 (#2)

וּבִשְׁנַ֣ת עֶשְׂרִ֔ים לְיָרָבְעָ֖ם

“Now in the year of 20 to Jeroboam”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the year of 20**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [Now in the twentieth year of Jeroboam]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 15:10 (#1)

אִמּוֹ

“his mother”

It is clear from 15:2 that **Maacah** was the mother of Asa’s father, Abijam. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship that you can use here and in verse 13. Alternate translation: [his grandmother]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 15:11 (#1)

הַיָּשָׁר

“right”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **right**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was right]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 15:11 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 15:13 (#1)

מִפְלֶצֶת

“a horror”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **horror**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a horrid image]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 15:13 (#2)

וַיִּכְרֹת אָסָא֙ אֶת־מִפְלַצְתָּתָ֔הּ וַיִּשְׂרֹ֖ף

“And Asa cut down her horror, and he burned {it”

The author is using one person who was involved in this action, **Asa**, to mean everyone who was involved, including Asa’s servants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Asa ordered his servants to cut down her horror and burn it]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 15:14 (#3)

כָּל־יָמָיו

“all of his days”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time, the lifetime of Asa. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [throughout his lifetime]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:14 (#1)

וְהַבָּמוֹת לֹא־סָ֣רוּ

“But they did not remove the high places”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But no one removed the high places] or [But the high places were not removed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 15:14 (#2)

לְבַב־אָסָ֥א הָיָ֛ה שָׁלֵ֖ם עִם־יְהוָ֑ה

“the heart of Asa was complete with Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:61. Alternate translation: [Asa was completely devoted to Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:15 (#1)

בֵּ֖בֵית יְהוָ֑ה

“into} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:1. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:17 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַל בַּעְשָׁא֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל עַל

“And Baasha, the king of Israel, went up against”

See how you translated **went up against** in 14:25. Alternate translation: [And Baasha, the king of Israel, attacked]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 15:17 (#2)

וַיִּבֶן אֶת־הָרָמָה

“and he built Ramah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:25. Alternate translation: [and he built up Ramah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:18 (#5)

וַיִּשְׁלַחֵ֣ם הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ אָסָ֑א

“And King Asa sent them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the silver and gold articles that Asa took from the temple and palace storerooms. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And King Asa sent those articles of silver and gold]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 15:18 (#1)

הַנּוֹתָרִ֔ים ׀ בְּאֹוצְרֹ֖ות בֵּית־יְהוָ֑ה וְאֶת־אֹוצְרֹ֥ות בֵּית־

“remaining in the storerooms of the house of Yahweh and the storerooms of the house of the king”

The author assumes that his listeners will understand that by the term **remaining**, he means all of the silver and gold articles that were in these storerooms after Shishak had taken the greatest treasures from them, as 14:26 describes. This would include the articles that Asa put in the storerooms after Shishak raided them, as 15:15 describes. Express this meaning in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that were then in the storerooms of the house of Yahweh and the storerooms of the house of the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:18 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית מלך

“the house of the king”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:1. Alternate translation: [his royal palace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:18 (#3)

וַיִּתְּנֵ֥ם בְּיַד־עֲבָדָ֖יו

“and he gave them into the hand of his servants”

The author is using one part these servants, their **hand**, to mean all of them in the act of conveying these silver and gold articles. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he gave them to his servants to convey]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 15:18 (#4)

בְּיַד

“into the hand of”

In this verse, the word **hand** is singular in form, but it refers to the hands of all of Asa’s servants. If it would be helpful in your language, if you retain the term “hand,” you could use its plural form. Alternate translation: [the hands of]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 15:19 (#4)

וְיַעֲלֶ֥ה מֵעָלָֽי

“that he may go up from against me”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:17. Alternate translation: [that he may stop attacking me]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 15:19 (#2)

הִנֵּה֙

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:19 (#3)

לֵ֣ךְ הָפֵ֔רָה

“Go, break”

Asa is not telling Ben Hadad to **Go** somewhere. He is encouraging him to do what he is suggesting. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated the similar expression “come” in 1:12. Alternate translation: [Go ahead and break]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:19 (#1)

בְּרִיתׇ֞ בֵּינִ֣י וּבֵינֶ֗ךָ בֵּ֚ין אָבִ֣י וּבֵ֣ין אָבִ֔יךְ

“A covenant between me and between you, between my father and between your father”

Asa is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Let there be a covenant between me and between you, as there was between my father and between your father]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 15:20 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע בֶּן־הֲדַ֖ד אֶל־הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ אָסָ֑א

“And Ben Hadad listened to King Asa”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And Ben Hadad agreed to do what King Asa had requested]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:20 (#2)

וַיַּ֛ךְ

“And he struck”

See the discussion in the introduction to 1 Kings of this sense of the word “struck.” Alternate translation: [And he attacked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:22 (#2)

וְהַמֶּ֣לֶךְ אָסָ֔א הִשְׁמִ֖יעַ אֶת־כָּל־יְהוּדָ֑הׇ

“And King Asa made all of Judah hear”

Here, **all of Judah** represents all the men of Judah who were able to work. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And King Asa required the men of Judah to work]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:22 (#1)

וְהַמֶּ֣לֶךְ אָסָ֔א הִשְׁמִ֖יעַ אֶת־כָּל־יְהוּדָ֑הׇ

“And King Asa made all of Judah hear”

In this context, the sense of the word **hear** is that King Asa required all the people of Judah to participate in the work of dismantling Ramah and using its materials to fortify other cities. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And King Asa made all of Judah obey] or [And King Asa required all of Judah to work]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:23 (#1)

וְיֶ֨תֶר כָּל־דְּבָרֵ֜י אָסָ֗א וְכָל־גְּבוּרָת֤וֹ וְכֹל֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֔ה וְהֶעָרִ֖ים אֲשֶׁ֣ר בָּנָ֑ה הֲלֹא־הֵ֣מָּה כְתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֚פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֔ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יְהוּדָ֑ה

“Now the rest of all of the matters of Asa and all of his might and all that he did and the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel about the rest of all of the matters of Asa and all of his might and all that he did and the cities that he built]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 15:24 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב אָסָ֖א עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

“And Asa lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Asa passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 15:24 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵ֖רׇ

“and he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 15:25 (#1)

וְנָדָב בֶּן־יָרָבְעָם מָלַךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּשְׁנַת שְׁתַּיִם לְאָסָא מֶמֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה וַיִּמְלֹךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁנָתָיִם

“Now Nadab, the son of Jeroboam, reigned over Israel in year two of Asa, the king of Judah. And he reigned over Israel two years”

In this verse, the author is introducing **Nadab** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and 15:9–10.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 15:25 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁתַּיִם

“in year two of”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in year two**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the second year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 15:26 (#4)

וּבְחַטָּאתוֹ אֲשֶׁר הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and in his sin that he caused Israel to sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:16. Alternate translation: [and he continued to commit the sin by which he had led the Israelites to sin]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 15:26 (#1)

הָרַע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 15:26 (#3)

וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ אָבִיו

“And he walked in the way of his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [And he lived as his father had lived]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:26 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 15:27 (#2)

וַיִּקְשֹׁר & בַּעְשָׁא בֶן־אֲחִיָּהוּ לְבֵית יִשָּׂשכָר

“And Baasha, the son of Ahijah, from the house of Issachar, conspired”

The author is introducing **Baasha** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [There was a man named Baasha, the son of Ahijah, from the house of Issachar, and he conspired]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 15:27 (#3)

לְבֵית יִשָּׂשכָר

“from the house of Issachar”

The author is speaking of the tribe of Issachar as if it were actually a **house**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the tribe of Issachar]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:27 (#4)

וַיַּכֵּהוּ בַּעְשָׁא

“and Baasha struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:15. Alternate translation: [and Baasha killed him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 15:27 (#1)

וַיִּקְשֹׁר עָלָיו בַּעְשָׁא בֶן־אֲחִיָּהוּ לְבֵית יִשָּׂשכָר וַיַּכֵּהוּ בַּעְשָׁא בְּגִבְּתוֹן אֲשֶׁר לַפְּלִשְׁתִּים וְנָדָב וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל צָרִרִים עַל־גִּבְּתוֹן

“And Baasha, the son of Ahijah, from the house of Issachar, conspired against him, and Baasha struck him at Gibbethon, which {is} to the Philistines. Now Nadab and all of Israel were besieging against Gibbethon”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that **Nadab and all of Israel were besieging against Gibbethon** before the information that **Baasha ... conspired against** Nadab. Alternate translation: [Now Nadab and all of Israel were besieging against Gibbethon, which is to the Philistines. And Baasha, the son of Ahijah, from the house of Issachar, conspired against him, and Baasha struck him at Gibbethon]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 15:28 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת שָׁלֹשׁ

“in year three of”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in year three**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the third year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 15:28 (#2)

וַיִּמְלֹךְ תַּחְתָּיו

“And he reigned in his place”

The pronoun **he** refers to Baasha, and the pronoun **his** refers to Nadab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Baasha reigned in place of Nadab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 15:29 (#1)

בֵּית יָרָבְעָם

“the house of Jeroboam”

The author is speaking of all the people descended from Jeroboam as **the house of Jeroboam**. He is envisioning them as if they were one household living together. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:29 (#3)

כִּדְבַר יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר

“according to the word of Yahweh that he had spoken”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what Yahweh said when he spoke]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:29 (#4)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:29 (#2)

לֹא־הִשְׁאִיר כָּל־נְשָׁמָה לְיָרָבְעָם עַד־הִשְׁמִדּוֹ

“He did not leave any breathing one to Jeroboam, until he had destroyed him”

The word **until** indicates that what follows gives the result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [He did not leave any breathing one to Jeroboam, and as a result, he destroyed him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 15:30 (#1)

חַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם אֲשֶׁר חָטָא וַאֲשֶׁר הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sins of Jeroboam that he sinned and that he caused Israel to sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:16. Alternate translation: [the sins that Jeroboam committed and caused Israel to commit]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 15:30 (#2)

בְּכַעְסוֹ אֲשֶׁר הִכְעִיס אֶת־יְהוָה

“by his provocation {by} which he provoked Yahweh”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [by which he severely provoked Yahweh]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 15:31 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי נָדָב וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Nadab and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Nadab and all that he did in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 15:32 (#1)

כָּל־יְמֵיהֶם

“all of their days”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time, the time when both of these kings were reigning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the whole time they both reigned]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 15:33 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת שָׁלֹשׁ לְאָסָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מָלַךְ בַּעְשָׁא בֶן־אֲחִיָּה עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתִרְצָה עֶשְׂרִים וְאַרְבַּע שָׁנָה

“In year three of Asa the king of Judah, Baasha, the son of Ahijah, reigned over all of Israel in Tirzah 24 years”

In this verse, the author is reintroducing **Baasha** as a participant in the story, now as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 15:33 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת שָׁלֹשׁ

“In year three of”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in year three**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the third year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 15:34 (#3)

וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ יָרָבְעָם וּבְחַטָּאתוֹ אֲשֶׁר הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And he walked in the way of Jeroboam and in his sin that he caused Israel to sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:26. Alternate translation: [And he lived the way Jeroboam had lived, and he continued to commit the sin by which Jeroboam had led the Israelites to sin]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 15:34 (#1)

הָרַע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 15:34 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues to tell alternately the stories of the kings of the northern kingdom of Israel and the southern kingdom of Judah.

1. Baasha, king of Israel, continued (16:1–7)
2. Elah, king of Israel (16:8–14)
3. Zimri, king of Israel (16:15–20)
4. Omri, king of Israel (16:21–28)
5. Ahab, king of Israel (16:29–34)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why was Yahweh angry with Baasha for killing Nadab (and the rest of Jeroboam’s family) if this fulfilled prophesy?

In 14:7–11, the prophet Ahijah told Jeroboam’s wife that Yahweh would ensure that his whole family would be killed. In 15:27–30, the author describes how Baasha killed all of Jeroboam’s family, and the author says that this happened “according to the word of Yahweh

that he had spoken by the hand of his servant Ahijah the Shilonite." But in 16:1–4, the author describes how Yahweh told the prophet Jehu to tell Baasha that he and his family would be destroyed in the same way because he worshiped idols as Jeroboam had, and the author adds in 16:7 that Yahweh also punished Baasha in this way because he had "struck" or killed Jeroboam and his family. If what Baasha did fulfilled a prophesy from Yahweh, why was Yahweh angry with him for doing it? The explanation seems to be that while Yahweh had said that someone would do this, he had not commissioned Baasha to do it, unlike the way Elisha later sent a prophet to tell Jehu to destroy Ahab and his family for killing the prophets of Yahweh in 2 Kings 9:1–10. Instead, Baasha killed Jeroboam and his family out of his own ambition and desire for power. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in a footnote.

1 Kings 16:1 (#1)

וַיְהִ֥י דְבַר־יְהוָ֖ה אֶל־יֵה֥וּא

"And the word of Yahweh was to Jehu"

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh spoke a message to Jehu]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:2 (#1)

הֲרִימֹתִ֖יךָ

"I raised you"

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:7. Alternate translation: [I brought you to power]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:2 (#2)

מִן־הֶֽעָפָ֑ר

"from the dust"

Yahweh is speaking as if Baasha had literally been in **the dust** when he raised him up to be king. He means that Baasha was in a humble or lowly position. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from a humble situation] or [from a lowly origin]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:2 (#3)

וַתֵּתֵ֣לֶךְ ׀ בְּדַרְכָּ֣ךְ יָרָבְעָ֗ם וַתַּחֲטֵא֙ אֶת־עַמִּ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"but you walked in the way of Jeroboam and caused my people Israel to sin"

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:26. Alternate translation: [but you lived as Jeroboam lived, and you led the Israelites to sin]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:3 (#3)

הִנְנִ֣י מַבְעִ֣יר אַחֲרֵ֣י בַעְשָׁ֔א וְאַחֲרֵ֖י בֵּיתֽוֹ

"behold me, burning after Baasha and after his house"

See how you translated the term "house" in the similar context in 14:10. Alternate translation: [I am going to destroy Baasha and his family]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:3 (#5)

וְנָתַתִּי֙ אֶת־בֵּיתְךָ֔ כְּבֵ֖ית יָרָבְעָ֣ם בֶּן־נְבָֽט

"And I will make your house like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat"

Yahweh is speaking of Baasha's family as if it were **a house**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will make your family like the family of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat.]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:3 (#2)

הִנְנִ֣י מַבְעִ֣יר אַחֲרֵ֣י בַעְשָׁ֔א וְאַחֲרֵ֖י בֵּיתֽוֹ

"behold me, burning after Baasha and after his house"

See how you translated the similar expression "I will burn after the house of Jeroboam" in 14:10. Alternate translation: [I am about to burn up Baasha and his house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:3 (#4)

הִנְנִ֣י מַבְעִ֣יר אַחֲרֵ֣י בַעְשָׁ֔א וְאַחֲרֵ֖י בֵּיתֽוֹ

"behold me, burning after Baasha and after his house"

Yahweh is speaking of **Baasha** in the third person, even though he is addressing him directly. He is doing that because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate

this in the second person. Alternate translation: [I am going to destroy you and your family]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 16:3 (#6)

כְּבֵ֣ית יָרָבְעָ֔ם

“like the house of Jeroboam”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the house of Jeroboam** was completely destroyed, so Baasha’s house (that is, his family) will be completely destroyed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [completely desolate, like the house of Jeroboam] or [completely desolate, like the family of Jeroboam]

See: Simile

1 Kings 16:3 (#1)

הִנְנִ֣י מַבְעִ֗יר אַחֲרֵי֙ בַּעְשָׁ֔א וְאַחֲרֵ֖י בֵּיתֽוֹ

“behold me, burning after Baasha and after his house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [I am about to burn after Baasha and after his house]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:4 (#2)

בַּשָּׂדֶ֖ה

“in the field”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:11. Alternate translation: [out in the open]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:4 (#1)

הַמֵּ֥ת לְבַעְשָׁא֙ & וְהַמֵּ֥ת לוֹ֖

“The one to Baasha dying & and the one to him dying”

Yahweh is speaking of **Baasha** in the third person even though he is addressing him directly. He is doing that because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [the one who belongs to you who dies ... the one who belongs to you who dies]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 16:5 (#1)

וְיֶ֤תֶר דִּבְרֵי֙ בַּעְשָׁ֣א וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֔ה וּגְבוּרָתֹ֖ו הֲלֹא־הֵ֑ם כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֚פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֔ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Baasha and what he did and his might, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Baasha and what he did and his might in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 16:6 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב בַּעְשָׁא֙ עִם־אֲבֹתָ֔יו

“And Baasha lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Baasha passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 16:6 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵ֖ר

“and he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 16:7 (#1)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:7 (#2)

דְּבַר־יְהוָ֥ה הָיָ֛ה

“the word of Yahweh was”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [Yahweh spoke a message]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:7 (#3)

הָרָעָה

“the evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the evil things]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 16:7 (#5)

בְּמַעֲשֵׂה יָדָיו

“with the work of his hands”

The author is using one part of Baasha, his **hands** to represent all of him in doing these **evil** things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by the things he did]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 16:7 (#6)

כְּבֵית יָרָבְעָם

“like the house of Jeroboam”

The author is speaking of the dynasty or royal line of Jeroboam as if it were a **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the kings who were descendants of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:7 (#7)

הִכָּה אֹתוֹ

“he had struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:15. Alternate translation: [he had killed him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:7 (#8)

הִכָּה אֹתוֹ

“he had struck him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Nadab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [he had struck Nadab] or [he had killed Nadab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 16:7 (#4)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:8 (#4)

שְׁנָתָיִם

“two years”

In this culture, people described the length of a king’s reign not by its duration but by the number of different years it included, in whole or in part, in the reign of another king that they were using for reference. In your translation, describe these days as your language and culture naturally would, considering that Elah began to reign during the twenty-sixth year of Asa and was killed during the twenty-seventh year of Asa. Alternate translation: [and he reigned for parts of two years] or [and he reigned for about one year]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:8 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת עֶשְׂרִים וְשֵׁשׁ שָׁנָה לְאָסָא

“In the year of 26, the year to Asa”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the year of 26**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the twenty-sixth year of Asa]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 16:8 (#3)

שְׁנָתָיִם

“two years”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he reigned for two years]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 16:8 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת עֶשְׂרִים וְשֵׁשׁ שָׁנָה לְאָסָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מָלַךְ אֵלָה בֶּן־בַּעְשָׁא עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתִרְצָה שְׁנָתָיִם

“In the year of 26, the year to Asa, the king of Judah, Elah the son of Baasha reigned over Israel in Tirzah, two years”

In this verse, the author is introducing **Elah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 16:9 (#1)

וְהוּא בְתִרְצָה שֹׁתֶה שִׁכּוֹר בֵּית אַרְצָא אֲשֶׁר עַל־הַבַּיִת בְּתִרְצָה

“Now he {was} in Tirzah, drinking drunk {in} the house of Arza, who {was} over the house in Tirzah”

The author is providing background information about where Elah was and what he was doing when Zimri conspired against him. This information helps readers understand how Zimri was able to carry out his plot successfully. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 16:9 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר עַל־הַבַּיִת

“who {was} over the house”

The author is using the phrase **over the house** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in charge of the palace” or “the administrator of the palace.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who was in charge of the palace] or [who was the administrator of the palace]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:9 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר עַל־הַבַּיִת

“who {was} over the house”

See how you translated the term “house” in the similar context in 4:6. Alternate translation: [who was over the palace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:10 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת עֶשְׂרִים וְשֶׁשׁ־בַּע לְאָסָא

“in the year of 27 to Asa”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the year of 27 to Asa**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the twenty-seventh year of Asa]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 16:10 (#1)

וַיַּכֵּהוּ

“and he struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:20. Alternate translation: [and he attacked him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:11 (#2)

הִכָּהוּ

“he struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:15. Alternate translation: [he killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:11 (#3)

בֵּבֵית בַּעְשָׁא

“the house of Baasha”

See how you translated the term “house” in the similar context in 16:3. Alternate translation: [the family of Baasha]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:11 (#4)

מַשְׁתִּתִּין בְּקִקֵּיר וְגֹאֲלָיו וְרֵעֵהוּ

“one pissing against a wall, both his kinsmen and his friend”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:10. Alternate translation: [any male, either among his kinsmen or his friends]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:11 (#1)

כְּשִׁבְתּוֹ עַל־כִּסְאוֹ

“as soon as he sat on his throne”

The author is using Zimri’s **throne** to represent his royal power and authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or

state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as soon as he had seized royal power]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:11 (#5)

וְרֵעֵהוּ

“and his friend”

In this verse, the word **friend** is singular in form, but it refers to all of Baasha’s friends as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “friend.” Alternate translation: [his friends]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 16:12 (#1)

כִּדְבַר יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר

“according to the word of Yahweh that he had spoken”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:29. Alternate translation: [according to what Yahweh said when he spoke]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:12 (#2)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:13 (#1)

אֶל כָּל־חַטֹּאוֹת בַּעְשָׁא וְחַטֹּאוֹת אֵלָה בְנוֹ אֲשֶׁר חָטְאוּ

“concerning all of the sins of Baasha and the sins of Elah his son that they sinned”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [concerning all of the sins that Baasha and his son Elah committed]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 16:13 (#2)

בְּהַבְלֵיהֶם

“with their vapors”

The author is speaking of idols as if they were actually **vapors**. The author is emphasizing how worthless and insubstantial idols are by comparing them to something that quickly disappears. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with their idols]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:14 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי אֵלָה וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Elah and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Elah and all that he did in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 16:15 (#4)

וְהָעָם חֹנִים

“Now the people {were} camping”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the people**, he means the Israelite army. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Now the Israelite army was encamped]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:15 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת עֶשְׂרִים וְשֶׁשׁ שָׁנָה לְאָסָא

“In the year of 27, the year to Asa”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the year of 27**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the twenty-seventh year of Asa]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 16:15 (#3)

וְהָעָם חֹנִים עַל־גִּבְּתוֹן אֲשֶׁר לַפְּלִשְׁתִּים

“Now the people {were} camping against Gibbethon, which {was} to the Philistines”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 16:15 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַתתֹּ֨ עֶשְׂרִ֜ים וְשֶׁשַׁ֣בַע שָׁנָ֗ה לְאָסָא֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה מָלַ֥ךְ זִמְרִ֖י שִׁבְעַ֣ת יָמִ֑ים בְּתִרְצָ֔ה

“In the year of 27, the year to Asa, the king of Judah, Zimri reigned seven days in Tirzah”

In this verse, the author is reintroducing **Zimri** as a participant in the story, now as the new king of Israel. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 16:16 (#1)

וַיִּשָּׁמַ֤ע הָעָם֙ הַחֹנִ֔ים לֵאמֹ֖ר

“And the people camping heard, saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [And someone reported to the soldiers in the camp]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 16:17 (#1)

וַיַּעֲלֶ֤ה עָמְרִי֙ & מִגִּבְּתוֹן֙

“And Omri went up from Gibbethon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [And Omri went from Gibbethon]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 16:17 (#2)

וַיַּעֲלֶ֤ה עָמְרִי֙ & מִגִּבְּתוֹן֙

“And Omri went up from Gibbethon”

In a context such as this, your language might say “came” instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [And Omri came from Gibbethon]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 16:17 (#3)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֣ל עִמּ֔וֹ

“and all of Israel with him”

Here, **all of Israel** represents the entire Israelite army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the whole Israelite army with him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:18 (#1)

נִלְכְּדָ֖ה הָעִ֑יר

“the city had been taken”

The expression **the city had been taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Omri’s soldiers had captured the city]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 16:18 (#2)

וַיִּשְׂרֹ֤ף עָלָיו֙ אֶת־בֵּ֣ית־מֶ֣לֶךְ בָּאֵ֔שׁ

“And he burned the house of the king over himself with fire”

It might seem that the expression **burned ... with fire** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [And he burned down the house of the king over himself]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 16:18 (#3)

עָלָ֖יו

“over himself”

The author is using **over himself** as a common expression of the culture to indicate “while he was in it.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while he was in it]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:19 (#2)

הָרַ֣ע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 16:19 (#4)

לָלֶכֶת֙ בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ יָרָבְעָ֔ם וּבְחַטָּאת֖וֹ אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֑ה

“by walking in the way of Jeroboam and in his sin that he did”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:26. Alternate translation: [by living as Jeroboam had lived and sinning as he had sinned]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:19 (#1)

חטאתו אֲשֶׁר חָטָא

“his sin that he sinned”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:16. Alternate translation: [the sin that he committed]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 16:19 (#3)

בְּעֵינֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:20 (#2)

וְקִשְׁרֹ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֣ר קָשָׁ֑ר

“and his conspiracy that he conspired”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and the conspiracy that he led]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 16:20 (#1)

וְיֶ֨תֶר֙ דִּבְרֵ֣י זִמְרִ֔י וְקִשְׁרֹ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֣ר קָשָׁ֑ר הֲלֹא־הֵ֗ם כְּתוּבִ֛ים עַל־סֵ֥פֶר דִּבְרֵ֖י הַיָּמִ֥ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Zimri and his conspiracy that he conspired, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Zimri and his conspiracy that he conspired in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 16:21 (#1)

אָ֣ז יֵחָלֵ֗ק הָעָם֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל לַחֵ֥צִי חֲצִ֖י הָעָֽם

“Then the people of Israel were divided in half. Half of the people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:15. Alternate translation: [Then the army of Israel was divided in half. Half of the soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:21 (#3)

חֲצִ֤י הָעָם֙ הָי֣וּ אַחֲרֵ֣י תִבְנִ֔י & וְהַחֲצִ֖י אַחֲרֵ֣י עָמְרִֽי

“Half of the people were behind Tibni & and half {were} behind Omri”

See how you translated the similar expression “helped after Adonijah” in 1:7. Alternate translation: [Half of the soldiers supported Tibni ... and half supported Omri]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:21 (#2)

אָ֣ז יֵחָלֵ֗ק הָעָם֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל לַחֵ֥צִי

“Then the people of Israel were divided in half”

The expression **were divided** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [This divided the people of Israel in half] or [Then the Israelite soldiers took two sides]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 16:23 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֨ת שְׁלֹשִׁ֜ים וְאַחַ֗ת שָׁנָה֙ לְאָסָ֣א מֶֽלֶךְ־יְהוּדָ֔ה מָלַ֖ךְ עָמְרִ֣י עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל שְׁתֵּ֥ים עֶשְׂרֵ֖ה שָׁנָ֣ה בְתִרְצָ֔ה מָלַ֖ךְ שֵׁ֥שׁ־שָׁנִֽים

“In the year of 31, the year to Asa, the king of Judah, Omri reigned over Israel 12 years. In Tirzah he reigned six years”

In this verse, the author is reintroducing **Omri** as a participant in the story, now as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 16:23 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת֨ שְׁלֹשִׁ֜ים וְאַחַ֗ת שָׁנָ֛ה לְאָסָ֥א

“In the year of 31, the year to Asa”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **In the year of 31**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the thirty-first year of Asa]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 16:24 (#2)

וַיִּבֶן

“And he built”

The author is using one person who was involved in this action, Omri, to mean everyone who was involved, including his workers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he had his workers build]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 16:24 (#3)

וַיִּקְרָ֣א אֶת־שֵׁ֣ם הָעִ֔יר

“and he called the name of the city”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and he named the city]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 16:24 (#1)

בְּכִכְּרַ֥יִם כָּ֖סֶף

“for two silver kikkars”

See how you decided in 9:14 to describe weights that the biblical author expresses in terms of **kikkars**.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 16:25 (#3)

וַיָּ֥רַע

“and he did evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and he did evil things]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 16:25 (#1)

הָרַ֛ע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 16:25 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לְפָנָֽיו

“who {were} to his face”

The author is using the expression **to his face** to mean “before him” or “previous to him.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who reigned before him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:25 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:26 (#1)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ בְּכָל־דֶּ֣רֶךְ׀ יָרָבְעָ֣ם בֶּן־נְבָ֗ט וּבְחַטֹּאתָ֛יו אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֶחֱטִ֖יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“And he walked in all of the way of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and in his sins {by} which he caused Israel to sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:26. Alternate translation: [And he lived as Jeroboam had lived, and he continued to commit the sins by which he had led the Israelites to sin]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:26 (#2)

בְּהַבְלֵיהֶם

“with their vapors”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:13. Alternate translation: [with their idols]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:27 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי עָמְרִי אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וּגְבוּרָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Omri, what he did and his might that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Omri, what he did and his might that he did, in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 16:28 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב עָמְרִי עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Omri lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Omri passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 16:28 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“and he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 16:29 (#1)

וְאַחְאָב בֶּן־עָמְרִי מָלַךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וּשְׁמֹנָה שָׁנָה לְאָסָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

“Now Ahab, the son of Omri, reigned over Israel in the year of 38, the year of Asa, the king of Judah”

In this verse, the author is introducing **Ahab** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 16:29 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וּשְׁמֹנָה שָׁנָה לְאָסָא

“in the year of 38, the year of Asa”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the year of 38**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the thirty-eighth year of Asa]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 16:30 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר לְפָנָיו

“who {were} to his face”

The author is using the expression **to his face** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who reigned before him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:30 (#1)

הָרַע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 16:30 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:31 (#1)

וַיְהִי הֲנָקֵל לֶכְתּוֹ בְּחַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט וַיִּקַּח אִשָּׁה אֶת־אִיזֶבֶל

“And it happened (was his walking in the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, trivial?) that he took a wife, Jezebel”

The author has been relating the history of the kings of Israel in a steady narrative, but in this verse he pauses to speak directly to his audience about this particular king, Ahab. The author does this to indicate in a strong way his thoughts and feelings about Ahab and how he acted. If a storyteller in your culture would not pause in the middle of a story to address the audience directly and express an opinion about one of the characters, you can translate this in a way that would be natural in your language and culture. Alternate translation: [And as if walking in the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, was not bad enough, he took a wife, Jezebel]

See: Aside

1 Kings 16:31 (#2)

אֶת־אִיזֶ֙בֶל בַּת־אֶתְבַּ֣עַל מֶ֣לֶךְ צִידֹנִ֔ים

“Jezebel, the daughter of Ethbaal, the king of the Sidonians”

The author is introducing **Jezebel** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 16:31 (#4)

וַיִּשְׁתַּ֖חוּ לֽוֹ

“and he bowed down to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:6. Alternate translation: [and he committed himself to Baal by bowing down to him]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 16:31 (#3)

וַיֵּ֥לֶךְ וַיַּעֲבֹ֖ד אֶת־הַבַּ֑עַל

“And he went and served Baal”

See how you translated the similar expression “and you go and serve other gods” in 9:6. Alternate translation: [And he took action to worship Baal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:32 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית הַבַּ֔עַל

“in} the house of Baal”

The author is speaking of the temple of Baal as if it were a **house** in which Baal lived. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Baal]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 16:32 (#1)

וַיָּ֣קֶם מִזְבֵּ֔חַ לַבָּ֖עַל בֵּ֣ית הַבַּ֑עַל אֲשֶׁ֥ר בָּנָ֖ה בְּשֹׁמְרֽוֹן

“And he set up an altar for Baal {in} the house of Baal that he built in Samaria”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And he built a house of Baal in Samaria, and he set up an altar for Baal there]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 16:33 (#1)

וַיּ֥וֹסֶף אַחְאָ֖ב לַֽעֲשׂ֑וֹת

“and Ahab added to do”

The author is using **added to do** as a common expression of his culture to mean “did more things.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Ahab did yet more] or [and Ahab did more things]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 16:34 (#1)

בְּיָמָ֔יו

“In his days”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time, the time when Ahab was king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [During his reign]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:34 (#2)

בָּנָ֖ה

“built”

The implication is that Hiel rebuilt Jericho, which the Israelites had destroyed earlier. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [rebuilt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 16:34 (#5)

בְּיַ֣ד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 16:34 (#4)

בְּכֹרֹ֔ו & צְעִירֹ֖ו

“his firstborn & his youngest”

The author is using the adjectives **firstborn** and **youngest** as nouns to mean certain sons. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [his firstborn son ... his youngest son]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 16:34 (#3)

בַּאֲבִירָ֣ם בְּכֹרֹ֗ו יְסָדָ֙הּ֙ ובשגיב צְעִירֹ֔ו הִצִּ֖יב דְּלָתֶ֥יהָ

“By Abiram, his firstborn, he founded it, and by Segub, his youngest, he set up its doors”

In both of these cases, the term **By ... by** indicates that the action the author describes (**founded ... set up**) came at the cost or loss to Hiel of the son he names. Alternate translation: [At the cost of Abiram, his firstborn, he founded it, and at the cost of Segub, his youngest, he set up its doors]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Within the overall story of the kings of Israel and Judah, the author describes in detail how prophets challenged the kings and people of those kingdoms to stop worshiping idols and to become devoted to Yahweh once again. This chapter begins the story of one of those prophets, Elijah.

1. Elijah tells Ahab that Yahweh will punish Israel with drought (17:1)
2. Elijah stays for safety by the wadi of Cherith, and ravens feed him (17:2–7)
3. Elijah stays for safety with a widow in Zarephath, and he multiplies her food (17:8–16)
4. The widow’s son dies, but Elijah raises him back to life (17:17–24)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Yahweh punish Israel with drought for worshiping Baal?

Ahab had led the Israelites to worship of Baal, and people thought that Baal was a god who caused rain. When Elijah identified himself as a prophet and servant of Yahweh and said that it would not rain until he said it would, and then it did not rain for three years, this proved that Yahweh was the true God and that Baal really had no power at all.

Why did Elijah stretch himself over the widow’s child three times?

The author says in 17:21 that when Elijah raised the widow’s child from the dead, just before he called out to Yahweh, “he stretched himself out over the child three times.” It is not certain why Elijah did this, but one possibility is that the number three represented completeness and divine action. It may have emphasized Elijah’s complete reliance on God to restore the child’s life. While the text itself does not explicitly state the meaning of Elijah stretching himself out three times, the possible symbolic significance is supported by the wider biblical use of the number three and the context of divine miracles. The threefold action may serve to emphasize the power of God, the earnestness of Elijah’s prayer, and the completeness of the miraculous restoration of life.

1 Kings 17:1 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָמַ֖דְתִּי לְפָנָֽיו

“to whose face I stand”

Here, **face** represents the presence of Yahweh. Elijah is speaking as if he stood in Yahweh’s presence, the way servants stood in the presence of a king, in order to indicate that he serves Yahweh rather than Baal, whom Ahab worshiped. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [whose servant I am]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:1 (#5)

כִּ֣י אִם־לְפִ֔י דְּבָרִֽי

“except by the mouth of my word”

The phrase **by the mouth of my words** represents what Elijah would say by using his mouth to speak words. If it would be clearer in your language, you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [unless I say that there will be]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:1 (#4)

אִם־יִהְיֶ֥ה הַשָּׁנִ֛ים הָאֵ֖לֶּה טַ֣ל וּמָטָ֑ר כִּ֣י אִם־לְפִ֥י דְּבָרִֽי

“if there will be dew or rain these years except by the mouth of my word”

If, in your language, it would appear that Elijah was making a statement here and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [only by the mouth of my word will there be dew or rain these years]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Kings 17:1 (#2)

חַי־יְהוָ֞ה אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָמַ֣דְתִּי לְפָנָ֔יו אִם־יִהְיֶ֥ה הַשָּׁנִ֛ים הָאֵ֖לֶּה טַ֣ל וּמָטָ֑ר כִּ֣י אִם־לְפִ֥י דְּבָרִֽי

“The life of Yahweh, the God of Israel, to whose face I stand, if there will be dew or rain these years except by the mouth of my word”

In order to make a solemn proclamation, following the custom of his culture, Elijah is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. See how you translated the similar expression “if he will kill his servant” in 1:51. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh, the God of Israel, to whose face I stand, that there will not be dew or rain these years except by the mouth of my word]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 17:1 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר֙ אֵלִיָּ֣הוּ הַתִּשְׁבִּ֔י מִתּוֹשָׁבֵ֖י גִּלְעָ֑דָה

“Now Elijah the Tishbite, from the Tishbites of Gilead, said”

The author is introducing **Elijah** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 17:2 (#1)

וַיְהִ֥י דְבַר־יְהוָ֖ה אֵלָֽיו

“And the word of Yahweh was to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh spoke a message to him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 17:3 (#2)

עַל־פְּנֵ֖י הַיַּרְדֵּֽן

“is} on the face of the Jordan”

Here, **on the face of** represents being “near” or “beside” the Jordan River. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language, here and in verse 5. Alternate translation: [near the Jordan River]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:3 (#1)

לֵ֣ךְ מִזֶּ֔ה וּפָנִ֥יתָ לְךָ֖ קֵ֑דְמָה

“Go from here and turn for yourself eastward”

The phrase **for yourself** indicates that this action would be for Elijah’s benefit. The implication is that Elijah should go eastward for his own safety, since he has just angered King Ahab by declaring a drought. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [For your own safety, go from here and travel eastward]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:5 (#1)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ וַיַּ֔עַשׂ & וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ וַיֵּ֔שֶׁב

“And he went and did & And he went and dwelled”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:6. Alternate translation: [And he took action and did ... And he took action and dwelled]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:6 (#1)

לֶ֣חֶם וּבָשָׂ֣ר בַּבֹּ֔קֶר וְלֶ֣חֶם וּבָשָׂ֔ר בָּעֶ֖רֶב

“bread and meat to him in the morning, and bread and meat in the evening”

It might seem that repeating the phrase **bread and meat** would be to express extra information in a way that would not be natural in your language. If so, you could represent the phrase only once in your translation. Alternate translation: [bread and meat to him in the morning and in the evening]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 17:7 (#1)

יָמִים

“some days”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:7 (#2)

וַיִּיבַשׁ הַנַּחַל כִּי לֹא־הָיָה גֶשֶׁם בָּאָרֶץ

“that the wadi dried up because no rain was in the land”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [that because no rain was in the land, the wadi dried up]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 17:8 (#1)

וַיְהִי דְבַר־יְהוָה אֵלָיו

“And the word of Yahweh was to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh spoke a message to him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 17:9 (#4)

שָׁם אִשָּׁה אַלְמָנָה

“a woman, a widow, there”

The author is introducing this **woman** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [a certain woman who is a widow who lives there]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 17:9 (#1)

קוּם

“Arise”

To translate the term **Arise** here and the term “arose” in the next verse, how you translated the term “arose” in 1:50. Alternate translation: [Take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:9 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 17:9 (#3)

צִוִּיתִי שָׁם אִשָּׁה אַלְמָנָה לְכַלְכְּלֶךָּ

“I have commanded a woman, a widow, there to sustain you”

Yahweh does not mean that he has spoken to this widow and **commanded** her to provide food for Elijah. He means that he has commanded for this to happen and will arrange it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I have commanded that a woman, a widow, there is to sustain you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:10 (#1)

וַיֹּאמַר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. See how you translated the same expression in 1:28 and comparable contexts.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 17:10 (#2)

קְחִי

“take”

In a context such as this, a speaker of your language might say “bring” instead of **take** (and similarly in the next verse). Alternate translation: [bring]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 17:10 (#3)

וְאֶשְׁתֶּה

“and I shall drink”

Elijah describing the purpose for which he is asking the woman to bring him **a little water**. Use a verb form in your language that will make this clear. Alternate translation: [so that I can drink]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 17:11 (#2)

בְּיָדֵךְ

“in your hand”

By saying **in your hand**, Elijah is specifically requesting the woman’s hospitality, as a guest in a foreign country. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use here in your translation.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:11 (#1)

פַּת־לֶחֶם

“a piece of bread”

Elijah, using the courteous hospitality language of this culture, is understating what he is requesting. Use a comparable way of speaking from your own language and culture. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 28:22. Alternate translation: [a little bit to eat]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 17:12 (#2)

וְהִנֵּנִי מְקֹשֶׁשֶׁת שְׁנַיִם עֵצִים

“And behold me, gathering two sticks”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [And I am about to gather two sticks]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 17:12 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אִם־יֶשׁ־לִי מְעֻגָה

“The life of Yahweh your God, if {there} is to me a bread-cake”

Following the custom of her culture, the woman is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. See how you translated the similar expression “if he will kill his servant” in 1:51. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh your God that there is not to me a bread-cake] or [I swear by Yahweh your God that I do not have even so much as a bread-cake]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 17:12 (#3)

שְׁנַיִם עֵצִים

“two sticks”

The widow is using **two sticks** as a common expression of her culture to mean “a few sticks” or “just enough sticks to make a small fire.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some sticks]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 17:12 (#4)

וָמָתְנוּ

“and we will die”

By **we will die**, the woman does not mean that there is something wrong with the food she has left and it will therefore kill her. She means that she and her son will die of starvation after eating this last meal. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [and after that we will have nothing to eat, so we will die of starvation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:13 (#2)

כִּדְבָרֵךְ

“according to your word”

Here, **word** represents what the widow said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what you have said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:13 (#1)

בֹּאִי

“Come”

Elijah is not asking the woman to **Come** somewhere. He is using the term **Come** to encourage her to do what he suggests. Your language may have a compa-

rable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Go ahead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:13 (#3)

מִמֶּ֖שָׁם

“from there”

By **from there**, Elijah means from the flour and oil that the widow has in her containers. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from that flour and oil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:14 (#1)

כִּֽי־כֹה֣ אָמַ֗ר יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל כַּ֠כַּד הַקֶּ֨מַח֙ לֹ֣א תִכְלֶ֔ה וְצַפַּ֥חַת הַשֶּׁ֖מֶן לֹ֣א תֶחְסָ֑ר עַ֚ד י֣וֹם תת־יְהוָ֔ה גֶּ֖שֶׁם עַל־פְּנֵ֥י הָאֲדָמָֽה

“For thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, ‘The jar of flour will not finish, and the jug of oil will not lack, up to the day Yahweh gives rain on the face of the ground”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says that the jar of flour will not finish and the jug of oil will not lack up to the day he gives rain on the face of the ground]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 17:14 (#2)

פְּנֵ֥י הָאֲדָמָֽה

“the face of the ground”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:40. Alternate translation: [the surface of the ground]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 17:15 (#1)

כִּדְבַ֖ר אֵלִיָּֽהוּ

“according to the word of Elijah”

Here, **word** represents what Elijah said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Elijah had told her to do]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:15 (#3)

יָמִֽים

“for} days”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a long period of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for a long time]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:15 (#2)

וּבֵיתָ֖הּ

“and her house”

The author is speaking of the people who lived with this widow as if they were her **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and her family] or [and her son]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 17:16 (#1)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:53. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:17 (#2)

לֹא־נוֹתְרָה־בּ֖וֹ נְשָׁמָֽה

“breath did not remain in him”

The author is referring to death in a mild way by using this phrase. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [he passed away] or [he died]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 17:17 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י אַחַר֙ הַדְּבָרִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“And it happened after these things”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 17:18 (#2)

מַה & וְלָ֨ךְ אִ֤ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים֙ & אֵלָ֔י

“What to me and to you, man of God”

The woman is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have done nothing wrong to you, man of God!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 17:18 (#3)

לִ֔י & בָּבָ֣אתָ & לְהַזְכִּ֥יר אֶת־עֲוֹנִ֖י וּלְהָמֵ֣ית אֶת־בְּנִֽי

“Did you come to me to bring my iniquity to remembrance and to kill my son”

The widow is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It seems that you came to me to bring my iniquity to remembrance and to kill my son!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 17:18 (#4)

לְהַזְכִּ֥יר אֶת־עֲוֹנִ֖י וּלְהָמֵ֣ית אֶת־בְּנִֽי

“to bring my iniquity to remembrance and to kill my son”

By this expression, the woman could be speaking of: (1) Elijah bringing her **iniquity** to Yahweh’s **remembrance**. Alternate translation: [so that Yahweh would remember my iniquity and punish me by killing my son] or (2) Elijah bringing her **iniquity** to her own **remembrance**. Alternate translation: [to remind me of my iniquity so that I would realize why Yahweh was punishing me by killing my son]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:18 (#1)

מַה & וְלָ֨ךְ אִ֤ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים֙ & אֵלָ֔י

“What to me and to you, man of God”

The widow is using **What to me and to you** as a common expression of her culture to mean “What do you have against me?” or “What dispute do we have?” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What do you have against me, man of God]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 17:19 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־הוּא֙ יֹשֵׁ֣ב שָׁ֔ם

“where he was dwelling there”

It might seem that the expression **where he was dwelling there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where he was dwelling]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 17:20 (#1)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֗י הַגַּ֤ם עַל־הָאַלְמָנָה֙ אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִ֣י מִתְגּוֹרֵ֔ר עִמָּ֖הּ הֲרֵעוֹתָ֑ לְהָמֵ֖ית אֶת־בְּנָֽהּ

“Yahweh my God, have you even brought harm upon the widow with whom I am sojourning, by killing her son”

Elijah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh my God, you should not have harmed even the widow with whom I am sojourning, by killing her son!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 17:21 (#1)

וַיִּתְמַדַּ֥ד עַל־הַיֶּ֖לֶד שָׁלֹ֣שׁ פְּעָמִ֑ים

“And he stretched himself out over the child three times”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the significance of Elijah stretching himself over the child **three times**.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 17:22 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע יְהוָ֖ה בְּקֹ֣ול אֵלִיָּ֑הוּ

“And Yahweh heard the voice of Elijah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh did what Elijah asked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 17:24 (#1)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָה בְּפִיךְ

“and the word of Yahweh in your mouth”

The woman is using **the word of Yahweh** to represent messages from Yahweh, and she is using Elijah’s **mouth** to represent him speaking those messages. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the messages from Yahweh that you speak]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 17:24 (#2)

אֱמֶת

“is} truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is true]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author continues to describe in detail how one of the great Israelite prophets, Elijah, challenged the king and people of Israel to stop worshiping idols and to become devoted to Yahweh once again. This chapter relates a great contest on Mount Carmel in which Elijah defeated and completely discredited the prophets of Baal.

1. Elijah returns to Israel (18:1–19)
2. Elijah defeats the prophets of Baal in a contest on Mount Carmel (18:20–40)
3. Elijah prays for rain, and Yahweh sends a great storm (18:41–46)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Where would the people have gotten so much water during a severe drought?

In 18:34, during his contest with the prophets of Baal, Elijah tells the people to douse the altar of Yahweh thoroughly with water. They use twelve large jars full of water to do that. But this was during a severe drought. It had not rained in Israel for three years. So where would the people have gotten all that water? One likely source is the Mediterranean Sea. Mount Carmel, the site of the contest, was on the seacoast. Some interpreters also note that there is a shaded spring on Mount Carmel that continues to have water even in dry conditions. So those are two good possibilities. The availability of all that water is not a contradiction or inconsistency in the text.

1 Kings 18:1 (#2)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָה הָיָה֩ אֶל־אֵלִיָּ֜הוּ

“and the word of Yahweh was to Elijah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh spoke a message to Elijah]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי֩ יָמִ֨ים רַבִּ֜ים

“And it was many days”

Here, **many days** represents a long period of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And it was a long time] or [And a long time passed]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:1 (#3)

בַּשָּׁנָ֣ה הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֔ית

“in the third year”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the third year**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [after three years]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 18:1 (#4)

עַל־פְּנֵ֖י הָאֲדָמָֽה

“on the face of the ground”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:14. Alternate translation: [on the surface of the earth]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:2 (#1)

וְהָרָעָ֖ב חָזָ֥ק בְּשֹׁמְרֽוֹן

“Now the famine {was} strong in Samaria”

The author is providing background information about the severity of the famine to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation,

introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 18:3 (#2)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר עַל־הַבָּבֶֽיִת

“who {was} over the house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:9. Alternate translation: [who was in charge of the palace] or [the administrator of his palace]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:3 (#1)

עֹבַדְיָ֖הוּ אֲשֶׁשֶׁר עַל־הַבָּבֶ֑יִת וְעֹבַדְיָ֗הוּ הָיָה֙ יָרֵ֣א אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה מְאֹֽד

“Obadiah, who {was} over the house. (Now Obadiah was fearing Yahweh greatly”

in this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Obadiah** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 18:4 (#1)

בְּהַכְרֵ֣ית אִיזֶ֔בֶל אֵ֖ת נְבִיאֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“when Jezebel cut off the prophets of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:6. Alternate translation: [when Jezebel killed the prophets of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:4 (#2)

חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים אִישׁ֩ בַּמְּעָרָ֨ה

“50 men in the cave”

The author is using **50 men in the cave** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Obadiah hid 50 men in each of two caves. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by fifties in each of two caves]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:4 (#3)

לֶ֔חֶם

“with} bread”

The author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, and in verse 13. Alternate translation: [with food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 18:5 (#2)

וְלֹ֥א נַכְרִ֛ית מֵהַבְּהֵמָֽה

“and we will not cut off from the cattle”

Ahab is speaking as if they might actually **cut off** the cattle, as if they were part of a plant or tree. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and we will not have to kill any of the cattle]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:5 (#1)

סוּס֙ וָפֶ֔רֶד

“a horse or a mule”

In this verse, the terms **horse** and **mule** are singular in form, but they refer to several horses and mules that might be kept alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. Alternate translation: [some of the horses and mules]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 18:6 (#1)

אַחְאָ֗ב הָלַ֤ךְ בְּדֶ֙רֶךְ֙ אֶחָ֔דׇ לְבַדּ֖וֹ וְעֹבַדְיָ֣הוּ הָלַ֔ךְ בְּדֶ֥רֶךְ־אֶחָ֖ד לְבַדּֽוֹ

“Ahab went in one way by himself, and Obadiah went in one way by himself”

It might seem that repeating the expression **by himself** would be to express extra information in a way that would not be natural in your language. If so, you could represent this expression only once. Alternate translation: [Each of them went in a separate way by himself]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 18:7 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה אֵלִיָּ֖הוּ

“and behold, Elijah”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Kings of this sense of the word **behold**. Alternate translation: [and suddenly Elijah]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:7 (#3)

וַיִּפֹּ֥ל עַל־פָּנָ֖יו

“and he fell on his face”

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that Obadiah did not fall down accidentally. He knelt down in front of Elijah, pressing his face to the ground, as a gesture to honor him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and he knelt down and pressed his face to the ground in front of Elijah in order to show him great honor]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 18:7 (#2)

וַיַּכִּרֵ֣הוּ וַיִּפֹּ֥ל עַל־פָּנָ֖יו

“And he recognized him, and he fell on his face”

In each instance, the pronoun **he** refers to Obadiah. The pronoun **him** refers to Elijah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Obadiah recognized Elijah, and Obadiah fell on his face]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:8 (#1)

לֵ֚ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לַאדֹנֶ֔יךָ הִנֵּ֖ה אֵלִיָּֽהוּ

“Go, say to your master, ‘Behold, Elijah”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Go and tell your master that I have returned]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 18:8 (#2)

אֵלִיָּֽהוּ

“Elijah”

If Obadiah said exactly this, he would leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Elijah has returned]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:9 (#2)

כִּֽי־אַתָּ֞ה נֹתֵ֣ן אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֗ בְּיַד־אַחְאָב֙ לַהֲמִיתֵ֔נִי

“that you are putting your servant into the hand of Ahab to kill me”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that you are giving Ahab the occasion to use his power to kill me, your servant]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:9 (#3)

אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֗

“your servant”

Obadiah is speaking of himself in the third person as **your servant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, your servant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 18:9 (#1)

מֶ֣ה חָטָ֔אתִי כִּֽי־אַתָּ֞ה נֹתֵ֣ן אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֗ בְּיַד־אַחְאָב֙ לַהֲמִיתֵ֔נִי

“How have I sinned, that you are putting your servant into the hand of Ahab to kill me”

Obadiah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have not sinned, that you should put your servant into the hand of Ahab to kill me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 18:10 (#1)

חַ֤י ׀ יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ אִם־יֶ֥שׁ־גּ֛וֹי וּמַמְלָכָ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־שָׁלַ֣ח אֲדֹנִ֑י שָׁ֣ם לְבַקֶּשְׁךָ֔

“The life of Yahweh your God, if {there} is a nation or a kingdom where my master has not sent to seek you there”

Following the custom of his culture, Obadiah is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part

of the condition as a negative statement. See how you translated the similar expression “if he will kill his servant” in 1:51. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh your God that there is not a nation or kingdom where my master has not sent to seek you there]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 18:10 (#5)

אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָה֙ וְאֶת־הַגּ֔וֹי

“the kingdom or the nation”

Here, **the kingdom or the nation** represents the ruler of a kingdom or nation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the leader of the kingdom or the nation]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:10 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֨ר לֹא־שָׁלַ֤ח אֲדֹנִי֙ שָׁ֣ם לְבַקֶּשְׁךָ֔

“where my master has not sent to seek you there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where my master has not sent to seek you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 18:10 (#3)

וְאָמְר֣וּ אָ֔יִן

“If they said ‘Not”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [If they said that you were not there]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 18:10 (#4)

אָ֔יִן

“Not”

Obadiah, in summarizing the replies of leaders to Ahab, is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [He is not here]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:11 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה אַתָּ֔ה אֹמֵ֕ר לֵ֖ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לַאדֹנֶ֑יךָ הִנֵּ֥ה אֵלִיָּֽהוּ

“And now you are saying, ‘Go, say to your master, “Behold, Elijah”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Obadiah said, continuing from the previous two verses (level 1). Obadiah is quoting what Elijah said (level 2). This includes something that Elijah wanted Obadiah to tell Ahab (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a second-level or third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 18:11 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֣ה אַתָּ֔ה אֹמֵ֕ר לֵ֖ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לַאדֹנֶ֑יךָ הִנֵּ֥ה אֵלִיָּֽהוּ

“And now you are saying, ‘Go, say to your master, “Behold, Elijah”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [And now you are telling me to go and say to my master that you are here]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 18:12 (#1)

אֲנִ֗י וְ֠אֵלֶךְ מֵאִתָּ֨ךְ

“that I, I will go from with you”

Obadiah is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will go** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize a contrast between what he will do and what he expects the **Spirit of Yahweh** will do. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [For my part, I will go from with you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:13 (#1)

הֲלֹ֣א־הֻגַּ֔ד לַאדֹנִ֕י אֵ֚ת אֲשֶׁר־עָשִׂ֣יתִי בַּהֲרֹ֣ג אִיזֶ֔בֶל אֵ֖ת נְבִיאֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה וָאַחְבִּ֞א מִנְּבִיאֵ֣י יְהוָ֗ה מֵמָ֤אָה אִישׁ֙ חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים חֲמִשִּׁ֔ים אִישׁ֙ בַּמְּעָרָ֔ה וְאֲכַלְכְּלֵ֖ם לֶ֥חֶם וָמָֽיִם

“Has it not been declared to my lord what I did when Jezebel killed the prophets of Yahweh, that I hid 100 men from the prophets of Yahweh, 50, 50 men in the cave, and I sustained them with bread and water”

Obadiah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly it has been declared to my master what I did when Jezebel killed the prophets of Yahweh, that I hid 100 men from the prophets of Yahweh, 50, 50 men in the cave, and I sustained them with bread and water!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 18:13 (#2)

לַאדֹנִי׃

“to my lord”

Even though Obadiah is addressing Elijah directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **my lord** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [to you, my lord,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 18:13 (#3)

חֲמִשִּׁשִּׁים חֲמִשִּׁשִּׁים אִישׁ בַּמְּעָרָה

“50, 50 men in the cave”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:4. Alternate translation: [by fifties in each of two caves]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:14 (#1)

וְעַתָּה֙ אַתָּ֣ה אֹמֵ֔ר לֵ֖ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לַאדֹנֶ֑יךָ הִנֵּ֥ה אֵלִיָּ֖הוּ וַהֲרָגָֽנִי

“And now you are saying, ‘Go, say to your master, “Behold, Elijah,”’ and he will kill me”

See how you punctuated the similar sentence in 8:11.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 18:14 (#2)

וְעַתָּה֙ אַתָּ֣ה אֹמֵ֔ר לֵ֖ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לַאדֹנֶ֑יךָ הִנֵּ֥ה אֵלִיָּ֖הוּ

“And now you are saying, ‘Go, say to your master, “Behold, Elijah”

You may have chosen to translate the similar sentence in 8:11 so that there would not be quotations within quotations. If so, you can do the same thing here. Alternate translation: [And now you are telling me to go and say to my master that you are here]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 18:15 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָמַ֖דְתִּי לְפָנָֽיו

“to whose face I stand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:1. Alternate translation: [whose servant I am]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:15 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָ֥ה צְבָאֹ֖ות

“The life of Yahweh of Armies”

Following the custom of his culture, Elijah is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred. **The life of Yahweh of Armies** is a way of swearing by Yahweh himself, indicating that Elijah is making a solemn promise that he considers binding and sacred. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh of Armies]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 18:18 (#4)

הַבְּעָלִֽים

“the Baals”

Elijah is probably using the plural term **Baals** because the Israelites were worshiping multiple manifestations or representations of Baal. Various places had their own shrines or temples in which they worshiped local representations, such as Baal of Tyre, Baal of Peor, etc. Since the name is singular in the rest of the book, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the singular here as well. Alternate translation: [Baal]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Kings 18:18 (#1)

כִּ֚י אִם־אַתָּ֣ה וּבֵֽית־אָבִ֔יךָ

“but rather you and the house of your father”

Elijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but rather you and the house of your father have troubled Israel]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:18 (#2)

וּבֵ֖ית אָבִ֥יךָ

“and the house of your father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:31. Alternate translation: [your extended family]

See: Kinship

1 Kings 18:18 (#3)

וַתֵּ֣לֶךְ אַחֲרֵ֔י

“and going after”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:5. Alternate translation: [and worshiping]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:19 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce their main topic. See how you have been translating it in contexts such as 1:12 and 2:16.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 18:19 (#4)

אֹכְלֵ֣י שֻׁלְחַ֔ן אִיזֶ֖בֶל

“eaters at the table of Jezebel”

Here, **eaters at the table of Jezebel** represents prophets whom Jezebel supported. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [whom Jezebel supports] or [for whom Jezebel provides from the royal treasury]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:19 (#2)

שְׁלַ֤ח קְבֹץ֙

“send, gather”

Elijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [send messengers and gather]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:19 (#3)

אֶת־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל

“all of Israel”

Elijah is saying **all Israel** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [representatives from throughout Israel]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 18:20 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֤ח אַחְאָב֙ בְּכָל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“And Ahab sent among all of the sons of Israel”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Ahab sent messengers among all of the sons of Israel to summon their leaders]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:20 (#2)

בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:21 (#3)

לְכֹ֥ו אַחֲרָ֖יו & לְכֹ֥ו אַחֲרָֽיו

“go after him & go after him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:18. Alternate translation: [worship him ... worship him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:21 (#4)

וְלֹא־עָנ֥וּ הָעָ֖ם אֹתֹ֥ו דָּבָֽר

“But the people did not answer him a word”

Here, **a word** represents something the people might have said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But the people did not say anything in response to him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:21 (#1)

עַד־מָתַ֣י אַתֶּ֔ם פֹּסְחִ֖ים עַל־שְׁתֵּ֣י הַסְּעִפִ֑ים

“Until when {will} you {be} limping on two opinions”

Elijah is using the question form to challenge and rebuke the people of Israel. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You have been limping on two opinions for long enough!] or [You should not be limping on two opinions any longer!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 18:21 (#2)

אַתֶּ֔ם פֹּסְחִ֖ים עַל־שְׁתֵּ֣י הַסְּעִפִ֑ים

“will} you {be} limping on two opinions”

Elijah is speaking as if the people were actually **limping** on these **opinions**, shifting their weight back and forth between them as a limping person does with his legs. He means that they are being indecisive about whether to worship Yahweh or Baal. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will you be wavering back and forth between two faiths]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:22 (#1)

אֲנִ֣י נוֹתַ֔רְתִּי נָבִ֖יא לַיהוָ֑ה

“I, I remain a prophet of Yahweh”

Elijah is stating the pronoun **I** separately in order to emphasize a contrast between himself and the prophets of Baal. To translate this expression and the similar ones in the next two verses, see how you translated the expression “I, I will go” in 18:12, which similarly emphasizes a contrast. Alternate translation: [For my part, I remain a prophet of Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:23 (#1)

וְיִתְּנ֤וּ־לָ֙נוּ֙ שְׁנַ֣יִם פָּרִ֔ים

“Now let them give two bulls to us”

Elijah is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Now let two bulls be given to us]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:23 (#2)

וְיִבְחֲר֥וּ

“and let them choose”

The pronoun **them** refers to the prophets of Baal. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and let the prophets of Baal choose]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:24 (#2)

וּקְרָאתֶ֖ם

“And you will call”

Elijah had been speaking to the gathered Israelite leaders, but here he turns to address the prophets of Baal, so the pronoun **you** refers to them. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And you prophets of Baal will call]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:24 (#1)

וּקְרָאתֶ֖ם בְּשֵׁ֣ם אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֑ם וְאָנִי֙ אֶקְרָ֣א בְשֵׁם־יְהוָ֔ה

“And you will call on the name of your god, and I, I will call on the name of Yahweh”

Elijah is using **call on the name of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “pray to by name.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you will call upon your god by name, and for my part, I will call upon Yahweh by name] or [And you will pray to your god by name, and for my part, I will pray to Yahweh by name here and in the next verse]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:24 (#3)

טֽוֹב הַדָּבָ֖ר

“The word {is} good”

Here, **word** represents what Elijah said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What you have said is good]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:25 (#1)

בַּחֲרוּ לָכֶם הַפָּר הָאֶחָד וַעֲשׂוּ רִאשֹׁנָה כִּי אַתֶּם הָרַבִּים

“Choose for yourselves one bull, and prepare {it} first, for you are many”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you are many, choose for yourselves one bull, and prepare it first]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 18:26 (#5)

וַיְפַסְּחוּ

“And they limped”

In this context, the word **limped** probably describes an ecstatic, rhythmic, and jerky or hopping dance that was part of the worship ritual of the prophets of Baal. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And they danced jerkily]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:26 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־נָתַן לָהֶם׃

“that one gave to them”

The author is using the pronoun **one** in a general sense, not to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that was given to them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:26 (#4)

וְאֵין קֹל וְאֵין עֹנֶה

“But {there was} no voice, and {there was} no answering”

Here, **voice** represents someone speaking or responding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But no one said anything or did anything in response]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:26 (#6)

עָשָׂה

“one had made”

Some ancient manuscripts read “one had made.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “they had made.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 18:26 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־נָתַן לָהֶם׃

“that one gave to them”

The author that readers will know that he means someone **gave** this **bull** to the prophets of Baal when they chose it. An important aspect of this contest was allowing those prophets every advantage. No one chose a bull for them and **gave** it to them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [that one gave to them when they chose it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:26 (#3)

וְאֵין קֹל וְאֵין עֹנֶה וַיְפַסְּחוּ עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה

“But {there was} no voice, and {there was} no answering. And they limped beside the altar that one had made”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that **they limped beside the altar** before the information that there was **no voice, and no answering**, since these prophets were limping around the altar as they **called** to Baal. Alternate translation: [And they limped beside the altar that one had made. But there was no voice, and there was no answering]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 18:27 (#1)

קִרְאוּ בְקוֹל־גָּדוֹל כִּי־אֱלֹהִים הוּא

“Call out with a great voice, for he is a god”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he is a god, call out with a great voice]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 18:27 (#3)

שִׂיחַ

“he is in} contemplation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **contemplation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he is contemplating something]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 18:27 (#4)

שִׂיג לוֹ

“he has} a withdrawal for himself”

Elijah is using this phrase as a polite way of referring to an activity that is done in private. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [he is going to the bathroom]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 18:27 (#5)

דֶּרֶךְ לוֹ

“a way {is} to him”

Here, **a way** represents “a journey.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [he is on a journey]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:27 (#2)

כִּי־אֱלֹהִים הוּא

“for he is a god”

Elijah actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying. He does not believe that Baal is really a god, and he is mocking the prophets for thinking that he is. If a speaker of your language would not say the opposite of what he meant for such a purpose, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [since you think that he is a god]

See: Irony

1 Kings 18:29 (#1)

וַיִּתְנַבְּאוּ

“that they prophesied”

In this context, the word **prophesied** does not indicate that these prophets of Baal said things that Baal inspired them to say. Instead, the word describes people being in a raving state in which they are not in full control of their actions. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the same term in 1 Samuel 18:10, where it describes Saul attempting to use violence against David while out of control. Alternate translation: [that they raved]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:29 (#2)

עַד לְעֲלוֹת הַמִּנְחָה

“until the offering of the grain offering”

Here, **the offering of the grain offering** represents the time when the grain offering was customarily made. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until the time when it was customary to offer the grain offering]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:29 (#3)

עַד לְעֲלוֹת הַמִּנְחָה

“until the offering of the grain offering”

The author assumes that readers will know that the time when the daily grain offering was made was in the middle of the afternoon. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [until the middle of the afternoon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:29 (#4)

וְאֵין־קֹל וְאֵין־עֹנֶה וְאֵין קָשֶׁב

“But {there was} no voice, and {there was} no answering, and there was no attention”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:26. Alternate translation: [But no one said anything or did anything or paid any attention in response]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:30 (#1)

אֶת־מִזְבַּח יְהוָה הֲהָרוּס

“the broken-down altar of Yahweh”

The term **broken-down** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that

is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the altar of Yahweh that people had broken down]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 18:31 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר֙ הָיָ֣ה דְבַר־יְהוָ֔ה אֵלָ֖יו

“to whom the word of Yahweh had been”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [to whom Yahweh had spoken a message]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:32 (#1)

בְּשֵׁ֥ם יְהוָ֖ה

“in the name of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [for the worship of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:32 (#3)

סְאָתַ֥יִם זָֽרַע

“two seahs {of} seed”

Each of these **seahs** was equivalent to nearly eight liters or about a quarter of a bushel. In your translation, you could use the ancient measurement and spell the word “seah” the way it sounds in your language. You could also use the metric measurement given in the UST or use the measurement that your language and culture customarily use. Alternatively, you could use the ancient measurement and put a modern measurement in parentheses in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Kings 18:32 (#2)

כְּבֵית֙ סְאָתַ֣יִם זָֽרַע

“like the house of two seahs {of} seed”

The author is using **like the house of two seahs of seed** as a common expression of his culture to mean that this trench was big enough to hold two seahs of seed. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [big enough to hold two seahs of seed]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:34 (#1)

וְעַל־הָעֵצִֽים

“and on the wood”

The implication is that the people obeyed Elijah’s command and poured the water on the sacrifice and on the wood. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and on the wood.” And they did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:34 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁנ֑וּ

“and they did a second time”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone did that a second time] or [and that was done again]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:36 (#2)

יִוָּדַ֣ע

“let it be known”

The expression **let it be known** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [make known]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 18:36 (#1)

בַּעֲל֣וֹת הַמִּנְחָ֔ה

“at the offering of the grain offering”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:29. Alternate translation: [at the time when it was customary to offer the grain offering]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:36 (#3)

ובדבריך

“and by your word”

Here, **word** represents what God had commanded by using words. If it would be clearer in your language,

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and at your command]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:37 (#1)

עֲנֵנִי

“Answer me”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please answer me]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 18:37 (#2)

וְאַתָּה֙ הֲסַבּ֣וֹתָ אֶת־לִבָּ֔ם אֲחֹרַ֖נִּית

“and you, you have turned their heart back”

Elijah is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you have turned** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the personal role of Yahweh in turning the **heart** of the **people** back to himself. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [you are the one who has turned their heart back]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:37 (#3)

וְאַתָּה֙ הֲסַבּ֣וֹתָ אֶת־לִבָּ֔ם אֲחֹרַ֖נִּית

“and you, you have turned their heart back”

Elijah is using the past tense to describe something that is ongoing in the present. He is doing that in order to show that it will certainly be accomplished. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a different tense. Alternate translation: [you are the one who is turning their heart back]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Kings 18:37 (#4)

וְאַתָּה֙ הֲסַבּ֣וֹתָ אֶת־לִבָּ֔ם אֲחֹרַ֖נִּית

“and you, you have turned their heart back”

Elijah is speaking as if Yahweh had actually **turned the heart** of the people in a different direction, as if the heart were an object that could be physically rotated. He means that God has caused the people to trust in him again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you have caused them to trust in you again] or [and you are the one who is causing them to trust in you again]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:37 (#5)

אֶת־לִבָּ֔ם

“their heart”

In this verse, the word **heart** is singular in form, but it refers to the hearts of all the people. If it would be helpful in your language, if you decide to retain this image, you could use the plural form of “heart.” Alternate translation: [their hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 18:38 (#1)

וְאֶת & לְחֵכָה

“And it licked up”

The author is speaking as if the fire actually **licked up** the water. The image suggests that the fire consumed the water completely, just as an animal might lick up liquid. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it evaporated]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:39 (#1)

וַיִּפְּל֥וּ עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֖ם

“and they fell on their faces”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:7. Alternate translation: [and they knelt down and pressed their faces to the ground in order to show Yahweh great honor]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 18:39 (#2)

יְהוָ֥ה הוּא֙ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים יְהוָ֥ה הוּא֙ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים

“Yahweh, he {is} God! Yahweh, he {is} God”

The author is repeating the phrase **Yahweh, he is God!** to depict people throughout the crowd of Israelites

coming to this realization and shouting it out. The people are not chanting the quoted phrase all at the same time, but rather one after another in the crowd is shouting it. If the repetition would instead suggest to your readers that the people were chanting this repeatedly, you could express the meaning in another way. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:40 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁחָטֵם שָׁם

“and he slaughtered them there”

The author is using one person who was involved in this action, Elijah, calling him **he**, to represent everyone who was involved. The people seized and killed the prophets, but Elijah, as the one who ordered this, is credited with the action. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he had the people slaughter them there]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 18:41 (#1)

עֲלֵה אֱכֹל וּשְׁתֵה כִּי־קוֹל הֲמוֹן הַגָּשֶׁם

“Go up, eat and drink, for {there is} the sound of the roar of a shower”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since there is the sound of the roar of a shower, go up, eat and drink]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 18:42 (#1)

רֹאשׁ הַכַּרְמֶל

“the head of Carmel”

The author is using the term **head** to mean the “top” of Mount **Carmel**. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the top of Mount Carmel]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:42 (#2)

וַיִּגְהַר אַרְצָה וַיָּשֶׂם פָּנָיו בֵּין בִּרְכָּיו

“and he bowed down to the ground, and he put his face between his knees”

Elijah **bowed down to the ground** and **put his face between his knees** as a symbolic action by which he showed humility and earnestness in prayer before Yahweh while waiting for rain. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he bowed down low in earnest prayer, not even looking around]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 18:43 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר שֻׁשָּׁב

“And he said, “Return”

The pronoun **he** refers to Elijah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Elijah said, “Return,”]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 18:44 (#6)

אֱסֹר

“Harness”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a respectful recommendation rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a respectful recommendation. Alternate translation: [You should harness your horses to your chariot] or [You should have your servants harness your horses to your chariot]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 18:44 (#1)

בַּשִּׁבְעִית

“on the seventh time”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the seventh time**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [on time seven] or [on the last time]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 18:44 (#2)

עֹלָה מַיִם

“is coming up from the sea”

The implication is that the cloud was appearing at the distant horizon where the sea met the sky, so it appeared to be **coming up from the sea**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [is now visible just above the horizon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 18:44 (#4)

אֱסֹ֣ר וֵרֵ֔ד וְלֹ֥א יַעַצָרְכָ֖ה הַגָּֽשֶׁם

“Harness and go down so the rain does not stop you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [So the rain does not stop you, harness and go down]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 18:44 (#3)

עֲלֵ֣ה אֱמֹ֗ר אֶל־אַחְאָב֙ אֱסֹ֣ר וֵרֵ֔ד וְלֹ֥א יַעַצָרְכָ֖ה הַגָּֽשֶׁם

“Go up, say to Ahab, ‘Harness and go down so the rain does not stop you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Go up and tell Ahab to harness and go down so the rain does not stop him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 18:44 (#5)

אֱסֹ֣ר

“Harness”

Elijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Harness your horses to your chariot]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:45 (#2)

עָבִ֖ים וְרֽוּחַ

“with} clouds and wind”

The phrase **clouds and wind** expresses a single idea. The word **wind** tells more about these **clouds**, specifically, that the wind drove them in from the sea. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [with wind-driven clouds]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 18:45 (#1)

עַד־כֹּ֔ה וְעַד־כֹּ֖ה

“to thus and to thus”

The author is using **to thus and to thus** as a common expression of his culture to mean that what he describes happened very quickly. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [very quickly]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:45 (#3)

וַיִּרְכַּ֥ב אַחְאָֽב

“And Ahab rode”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Ahab rode in his chariot]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 18:46 (#4)

עַד־בֹּאֲךָ֖ יִזְרְעֶאלָֽה

“to your coming {to} Jezreel”

The author is using **your coming to Jezreel** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the entrance of Jezreel.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the entrance of Jezreel]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 18:46 (#2)

הָיְתָ֥ה אֶל־אֵלִיָּ֖הוּ

“was on Elijah”

The author is speaking as if the hand of Yahweh was actually **on** Elijah. He means that Yahweh gave Elijah supernatural strength and power. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [empowered Elijah]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 18:46 (#3)

לִפְנֵי אַחְאָב

“to the face of Ahab”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Ahab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [ahead of Ahab]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 18:46 (#1)

וְיַד־יְהוָה

“And the hand of Yahweh”

Here, **hand** represents the power of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the power of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author describes how Elijah had to flee for his life to escape from Jezebel, Ahab’s queen, who refused to stop worshiping Baal even after Elijah defeated all the prophets of Baal. Elijah went to Mount Horeb (also known as Mount Sinai), where Yahweh had made a covenant with the Israelites, to report that they had broken his covenant. But Yahweh reassured Elijah that many Israelites were still faithful, and he told him to appoint various leaders who would accomplish his purposes.

1. Elijah flees for his life from Jezebel (19:1–8)
2. Elijah speaks with Yahweh at Mount Horeb (19:9–18)
3. Elijah appoints Elisha as his successor (19:19–21)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Elijah not anoint the people whom Yahweh told him to anoint?

In 19:15–16, Yahweh tells Elijah to anoint Hazael as king of Aram, Jehu as king over Israel, and Elisha as his own successor. Elijah first goes to see Elisha, but he does not anoint him. Instead, he throws his cloak over him. And the subsequent narrative does not record Elijah anointing Hazael or Jehu either. Instead, somewhat later, Elisha speaks with Hazael, and he sends a messenger to speak with Jehu. So it might appear that Elijah did not obey what Yahweh told him to do. However, it seems best to understand the term “anoint” to represent the idea of “appoint.” Yahweh was not so much specifying a specific way in which Elijah was to appoint these new leaders as he was simply telling him to appoint them. The new kings would punish those who had worshiped idols, and Elisha would carry on the prophetic ministry of Elijah.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“bread-cake” and “jug”

In 19:6, when the angel awakens Elijah and tells him to have some food and drink to strengthen himself for his journey, Elijah discovers that there is a “bread-cake” and a “jug” of water by his head. These are the same two terms that the widow in Zarephath used in 17:12 when she told Elijah that she did not have so much as a bread-cake, only a handful of flour and a little bit of oil in a jug. These details seem to be significant. They illustrate how Yahweh provided for Elijah, and for other people through Elijah, throughout his ministry. To show this to your readers, we recommend that you use the same words for “bread-cake” and “jug” in this chapter as in chapter 17.

1 Kings 19:1 (#1)

וְאֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר הָרַג

“and all that he had killed”

The author is using **all that he had killed** as a common expression of his culture to mean “all about how he had killed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and all about how he had killed]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 19:1 (#2)

הָרַג

“he had killed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:40. Alternate translation: [and had had the people kill]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 19:2 (#2)

וְכֹה יוֹסִפוּן

“and thus may they add”

See how you translated the similar expression “and thus may he add” in 2:23. Alternate translation: [and may they do even worse]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 19:2 (#1)

כֹּה־יַעֲשׂוּן אֱלֹהִים֙ וְכֹ֣ה יוֹסִפ֔וּן כִּי־כָעֵ֛ת מָחָ֖ר אָשִׂ֣ים אֶת־נַפְשְׁךָ֑ כְּנֶ֥פֶשׁ אַחַ֖ד מֵהֶֽם

“Thus may the gods do, and thus may they add, unless about {this} time tomorrow I make your life like the life of one of them”

Following the custom of this culture, Jezebel is swearing an oath by stating a condition and the consequence she is asking the gods to make happen if the condition is met. She is stating the consequence before the condition. If it would be helpful to your readers, in your translation, you could state the condition before the consequence. Alternate translation: [Unless I have made your life like the life of one from them by this time tomorrow, thus may the gods do, and thus may they add]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 19:3 (#3)

וַיָּ֖קָם

“and he arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:40. Alternate translation: [and he took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 19:3 (#1)

וַיַּ֣רְא

“And he saw”

Some ancient manuscripts read “And he saw.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “And he was afraid.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 19:3 (#2)

וַיַּ֣רְא

“And he saw”

The author is speaking as if Elijah actually **saw** something. He means that Elijah realized something. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he saw how things stood] or [And he realized what would happen if he stayed in Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 19:3 (#4)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ אֶל־נַפְשׁ֔וֹ

“and went for his life”

The author is using **went for his life** as a common expression of his culture to mean “fled to save his life” or “ran away to avoid being killed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and ran for his life] or [and fled for safety]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 19:3 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֖ר לִֽיהוּדָ֑ה

“which is to Judah”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. He is specifying that Beersheba was within the kingdom of **Judah**, not within Jezebel’s kingdom of Israel, to help readers understand that Elijah knew his servant would be safe if he left him there. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 19:4 (#4)

לֹא־טֹ֥וב אָנֹכִ֖י מֵאֲבֹתָֽי

“I am not better than my fathers”

Elijah could be using the term **fathers** to mean: (1) his ancestors. Since they have died, he accepts that a time will come for him to die too, and it may as well be now. Alternate translation: [I do not need to keep living; after all, my ancestors have all died] or (2) the prophets who came before him, who had not gotten the people of Israel to worship Yahweh any more than he apparently had. (In 2 Kings 2:12, Elisha calls Elijah “my father,” suggesting that this was a term that prophets used to describe their predecessors.) Alternate translation: [I have been no more successful than the prophets who came before me]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 19:4 (#2)

רַ֣ב

“Enough”

Elijah is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling of despair and exhaustion. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what Elijah was feeling, or you could say what made him feel despair and exhaustion. Alternate translation: [I am as tired and discouraged as I can bear]

See: Exclamations

1 Kings 19:4 (#3)

עַתָּ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה קַח־נַפְשִׁ֑י כִּי־לֹא־טֹ֥וב אָנֹכִ֖י מֵאֲבֹתָֽי

“Take my life now, Yahweh, for I am not better than my fathers”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since I am not better than my fathers, take my life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 19:4 (#1)

וְהוּא־הָלַ֥ךְ

“And he, he went”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:8. Alternate translation: [And for his part, he went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 19:5 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה־זֶ֥ה מַלְאָ֛ךְ נֹגֵ֥עַ בּ֖וֹ

“And behold this, an angel was touching him”

See how you translated the comparable expression “behold” in 18:7, where it similarly indicates that something happened suddenly. Alternate translation: [And suddenly an angel was touching him]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 19:6 (#3)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב וַיִּשְׁכָּ֔ב

“and he returned and lay down”

The phrase **returned and lay down** expresses a single idea. The word **returned** indicates in what way Elijah **lay down**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and he lay down again]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 19:6 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֨ה

“and behold”

In this context, the author is using the term **behold** to focus the attention of his audience on what he is about to say. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 19:6 (#2)

עֻגַ֣ת רְצָפִ֔ים

“was} a bread-cake of hot stones”

The author is using the possessive form to describe a **bread-cake** that someone, probably the angel, had baked on **hot stones**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [was a bread-cake baked on hot stones]

See: Possession

1 Kings 19:7 (#2)

קוּם֙ אֱכֹ֔ל כִּֽי־רַ֥ב מִמְּךָ֖ הַדָּֽרֶךְ

“Arise, eat! For the journey {will be} too much for you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the journey will be too much for you, arise, eat!]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 19:7 (#1)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב ׀ מַלְאַ֣ךְ יְהוָ֗ה שֵׁנִ֛ית

“And the angel of Yahweh returned a second time”

It might seem that the expression **returned a second time** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [And the angel of Yahweh returned] or [And the angel of Yahweh came a second time]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 19:7 (#3)

רַב מִמְּךָ הַדָּרֶךְ

“the journey {will be} too much for you”

The angel means that the journey will require more strength than Elijah has if he does not eat something more. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the journey will be too much for you if you do not eat something more]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 19:9 (#1)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה אֵלָיו

“the word of Yahweh was to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [Yahweh spoke a message to him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 19:9 (#2)

מַה־לְּךָ פֹּה

“What to you here”

Yahweh is using **What to you here** as a common expression of his culture to mean “What are you doing here?” or “Why have you come here?” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What are you doing here] or [Why have you come here]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 19:10 (#1)

קַנֵּא קִנֵּאתִי לַיהוָה ׀ אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאוֹת כִּי־עָזְבוּ בְרִיתְךָ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־מִזְבְּחֹתֶיךָ הָרָסוּ וְאֶת־נְבִיאֶיךָ הָרְגוּ בֶחָרֶב

“Being jealous, I have been jealous for Yahweh, the God of Armies, for the sons of Israel have forsaken your covenant, they have torn down your altars, and they have killed your prophets with the sword”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because the sons of Israel have forsaken your covenant, torn down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword, being jealous, I have been jealous for Yahweh, the God of Armies]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 19:10 (#3)

לַיהוָה

“for Yahweh”

Even though Elijah is speaking to Yahweh directly, he is speaking of him in the third person to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this with a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [you, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 19:10 (#4)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 19:10 (#5)

וְאִוָּתֵר אֲנִי לְבַדִּי

“And I am left, I alone”

Elijah is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I am left** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he feeling isolated. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And I am the only one who is left]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 19:10 (#2)

קַנֵּא קִנֵּאתִי

“Being jealous, I have been jealous”

Elijah is repeating forms of a verb that means “to be jealous” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I have been very jealous]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 19:11 (#4)

וְרַ֣רוּחַ גְּדוֹלָ֗ה וְחָזָק֙

“and a great and strong wind”

The terms **great** and **strong** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [a very strong wind]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 19:11 (#1)

צֵ֤א וְעָמַדְתָּ֙ בָּהָ֔ר לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה וְהִנֵּ֤ה יְהוָה֙ עֹבֵ֔ר וְרַ֣רוּחַ גְּדוֹלָ֗ה וְחָזָק֙

“Go out, and you shall stand on the mountain to the face of Yahweh.” And behold, Yahweh was passing over, and a great and strong wind”

The direct quotation from Yahweh may continue through the expression **passing by**. Alternate translation: [“Go out, and you shall stand on the mountain to the face of Yahweh, for behold, Yahweh will be passing by.” And a great and strong wind]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Kings 19:11 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֖י & יְהוָ֑ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 19:11 (#5)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of Yahweh] or [as Yahweh approached]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 19:11 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֖י & יְהוָ֑ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person, probably because he is giving an authoritative command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [in my presence]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 19:12 (#1)

קֹ֖ול דְּמָמָ֥ה דַקָּֽה

“there was} a voice of small stillness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **stillness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [there was a still, small voice] or [there was a soft, quiet voice]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 19:13 (#2)

מַה־לְּךָ֥ פֹ֖ה

“What to you here”

See how you translated the similar expression in 19:9. Alternate translation: [What are you doing here] or [Why have you come here]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 19:13 (#1)

וַיֶּ֤לֶט פָּנָיו֙ בְּאַדַּרְתֹּ֔ו

“that he wrapped his face in his cloak”

Wrapping his face in his cloak was a symbolic action by which Elijah showed reverence and humility before God. He did not consider himself holy enough or worthy enough to look directly at Yahweh while Yahweh was speaking to him. (At the burning bush, Moses similarly hid his face and did not look at God, Exodus 3:6.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [that he reverently covered his face with his cloak]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 19:14 (#1)

קַנֵּ֣א קִנֵּ֔אתִי

“Being jealous, I have been jealous”

What Elijah says here is identical to what he says in verse 10. See how you translated this expression and

the rest of this statement there. Alternate translation: [I have been very jealous]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 19:17 (#1)

מֵחֶ֣רֶב חֲזָאֵ֔ל & מֵחֶ֥רֶב יֵה֖וּא

“from the sword of Hazael & from the sword of Jehu”

Here, the **sword** of a person represents their attempt to kill someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from Hazael’s attempt to kill him ... from Jehu’s attempt to kill him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 19:18 (#1)

שִׁבְעַ֣ת אֲלָפִ֔ים

“7,000”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [7,000 people]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 19:18 (#2)

שִׁבְעַ֣ת אֲלָפִ֔ים

“7,000”

This may be a rounded or symbolic number. It was conventional in this culture to use the number seven and multiples of ten to indicate completeness. However, rather than represent the number **7,000** in your translation with a phrase such as “a full number of people,” we recommend that you express the number and explain its possible symbolic meaning in a footnote.

See: Numbers

1 Kings 19:18 (#3)

כָּל־הַבִּרְכַּ֔יִם אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־כָרְע֖וּ לַבַּ֑עַל וְכָל־הַפֶּ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֔ר לֹא־נָשַׁ֥ק לֽוֹ

“all of the knees that have not bowed to Baal and every mouth that has not kissed him”

Yahweh is using part of people, their **knees** and **mouth**, to represent all of them in the action of remaining faithful to him and not worshiping Baal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the people who have not bowed their knees to Baal and everyone who has not kissed him with his mouth]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 19:18 (#4)

כָּל־הַבִּרְכַּ֔יִם אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־כָרְע֖וּ לַבַּ֑עַל וְכָל־הַפֶּ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֔ר לֹא־נָשַׁ֥ק לֽוֹ

“all of the knees that have not bowed to Baal and every mouth that has not kissed him”

When people **bowed** to Baal and **kissed** his statue, these were symbolic actions by which they were expressing worship and devotion to Baal. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [all of the people who have not bowed down to worship Baal and everyone who has not kissed his statue as an act of devotion]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 19:19 (#4)

וַיַּשְׁלֵ֥ךְ אַדַּרְתּ֖וֹ אֵלָֽיו

“and he threw his cloak on him”

When Elijah **threw his cloak** on Elisha, this was a symbolic action by which he showed that he was appointing Elisha to be his successor as a prophet. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he threw his cloak on him to show that he was appointing him as his successor]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 19:19 (#2)

שְׁנֵים־עָשָׂ֣ר צְמָדִ֔ים

“with} 12 pairs”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [with 12 pairs of oxen]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 19:19 (#1)

וְה֥וּא חֹרֵ֖שׁ

“And he was plowing”

The author is using one person who was involved in this **plowing**, Elisha, to represent him and everyone else who was involved. The context suggests that the others were servants and Elisha was directing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he was directing the plowing]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 19:19 (#3)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

Here, **to his face** represents the other people who were plowing being in front of Elisha, where he could see them and supervise them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of him] or [under his supervision]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 19:20 (#1)

אֶשְּׁקָה & לְאָבִי וּלְאִמִּי

“let me kiss my father and my mother”

Elisha is using one action that would be part of a ceremonial goodbye, a **kiss**, to represent the entire action of saying a proper goodbye to his parents. (The context shows that this involved a ceremonial meal.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [let me say a proper goodbye to my father and my mother]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 19:20 (#3)

מָה־עָשִׂיתִי לָךְ

“what have I done to you”

Elijah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have done nothing to you that would prevent that]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 19:20 (#2)

לֵךְ שׁוּב כִּי

“Go, return, for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [Go, return. After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 19:21 (#2)

בִּשְׁלָם הַבָּשָׂר

“he boiled them, the flesh”

The author is first indicating generally that Elisha boiled the oxen, and he is then indicating specifically what part of them he boiled. It may be natural in your language to use a possessive form here. Alternate translation: [their flesh]

See: Possession

1 Kings 19:21 (#1)

וּבִכְלֵי הַבָּקָר בִּשְּׁלָם

“And with the equipment of the oxen he boiled them”

The implication is that Elisha used the wooden plowing **equipment** to make a fire, on which he could put a pot of water and boil the meat from the oxen. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with the equipment of the oxen he made a fire and boiled them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author relates how King Ben Hadad of Aram twice invaded the kingdom of Israel and how Yahweh enabled the Israelites to defeat him both times, even though they were greatly outnumbered. In the first battle, Yahweh had the youngest and least experienced Israelite soldiers lead the attack, and he enabled the Israelites to defeat the Arameans anyway. Yahweh did this to continue to show Ahab that he was the true God. But Ahab nevertheless disobeyed Yahweh and made a treaty with Ben Hadad.

1. Ben Hadad besieges the city of Samaria but is defeated (20:1–21)
2. Ben Hadad attacks Israel in the Valley of Aphek and is defeated again (20:22–30)
3. Ahab spares Ben Hadad’s life and makes a treaty with him (20:31–43)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Ben Hadad say to seize alive the Israelites who were coming out of Samaria?
In 20:18, after receiving a report that some Israelite men are coming out of the besieged city of Samaria, Ben Hadad tells his soldiers to capture them alive, whether they are coming out to negotiate for peace or to start an attack. Both of these things would not have been usual. Ancient armies respected messengers who were negotiating for peace. They allowed them to travel back and forth between opposing armies. So making these Israelites prisoners, if they were peace negotiators, would have violated the standards of this culture. But Ahab had already refused Ben Hadad's demands, mocking his overconfidence (20:11), so Ben Hadad apparently would not conduct any further negotiations. Telling his soldiers to capture the Israelites alive if they were coming out to fight imprudently put his soldiers at risk, as that would be much more difficult and dangerous than seeking to kill them. Ben Hadad may have wanted to interrogate the men and find out the conditions in Samaria. But both of these orders reflect Ben Hadad's overconfidence and complacency, which are also evident from the way he is getting drunk at midday even with a battle looming. This illustrates what a great military advantage he knew he had over the Israelites, and so it also shows the greatness of Yahweh's power, since he enabled the Israelites to defeat Ben Hadad and his army.

1 Kings 20:1 (#2)

וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים וּשְׁנַ֔יִם מְלָכִ֖ים אִתּ֑וֹ

"and 32 kings with him"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and there were 32 kings with him]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 20:1 (#3)

וְסוּס֥ וָרָֽכֶב

"and horse and chariot"

In this verse, the words **horse and chariot** are singular in form, but they refer to all of Ben Hadad's horses and chariots as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms in your translation. Alternate translation: [and horses and chariots]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 20:1 (#1)

אֶת־כָּל־חֵילֹ֗ו וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים וּשְׁנַ֔יִם מְלָכִ֖ים אִתּ֑וֹ וְסוּס֥ וָרָֽכֶב

"all of his army, and 32 kings with him, and horse and chariot"

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that Ben Hadad brought his horses and chariots with the information that he gathered **all of his army**. Alternate translation: [all of his army and horse and chariot, and 32 kings with him]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 20:1 (#4)

וַיַּ֥עַל

"And he went up"

See how you translated the similar expression "he has gone down" in 1:25. Alternate translation: [And he went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 20:1 (#5)

וַיִּלָּ֥חֶם בָּ֖הּ

"and he fought with it"

While the pronoun **it** refers to the city of Samaria, the author is using that city to represent its defenders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and he fought with the Israelite soldiers who were defending it]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:3 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר לֹ֑ו

"and he said to him"

Ben Hadad did not personally speak the words that follow. His messengers spoke them on his behalf. It may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun to indicate this. Alternate translation: [and they said to him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:3 (#2)

כֹּ֥ה אָמַ֖ר בֶּן־הֲדַ֣ד כַּסְפְּךָ֥ וְזָהְבְּךָ֖ לִ֣י־הֽוּא וְנָשֶׁ֙יךָ֙ וּבָנֶ֔יךָ הַטּוֹבִ֖ים לִי־הֵֽם

“Thus says Ben Hadad, ‘Your silver and your gold, it {is} to me, and your wives and your sons, the best ones, they {are} to me”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Ben Hadad says that your silver and your gold are his, and your best wives and sons are his]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:3 (#4)

וּבָנֶיךָ

“and your sons”

Here the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense that includes both male and female children. If it would be helpful to your readers, here and in verses 5 and 7 you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both male and female children. Alternate translation: [and your sons and daughters] or [and your children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Kings 20:3 (#3)

כַּסְפְּךָ וְזָהְבְּךָ לִי־הוּא וְנָשֶׁיךָ וּבָנֶיךָ הַטּוֹבִים לִי־הֵם

“Your silver and your gold, it {is} to me, and your wives and your sons, the best ones, they {are} to me”

Ben Hadad assumes that King Ahab will know that he is making a demand backed by the threat of military force. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [If you do not give me your silver and your gold and your best wives and sons, I will destroy this city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:4 (#1)

וַיַּ֫עַן & וַיֹּ֥אמֶר

“And & answered and said”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:28. Alternate translation: [answered]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 20:4 (#2)

כִּדְבָרְךָ

“According to your word”

Here, **word** represents what Ben Hadad said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Just as you have said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:5 (#2)

כֹּה־אָמַר בֶּן־הֲדַד לֵאמֹר כִּי־שָׁלַחְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ לֵאמֹר כַּסְפְּךָ וְזָהְבְּךָ וְנָשֶׁיךָ וּבָנֶיךָ לִּלְי תִתֵּן

“Thus says Ben Hadad, saying, ‘Indeed I sent to you, saying, “Your silver and your gold and your wives and your sons, you shall give to me”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Ben Hadad says that he indeed sent to you and told you that you were to give him your silver and your gold and your wives and your sons]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:5 (#1)

כֹּה־אָמַר בֶּן־הֲדַד לֵאמֹר כִּי־שָׁלַחְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ לֵאמֹר כַּסְפְּךָ וְזָהְבְּךָ וְנָשֶׁיךָ וּבָנֶיךָ לִּלְי תִתֵּן

“Thus says Ben Hadad, saying, ‘Indeed I sent to you, saying, “Your silver and your gold and your wives and your sons, you shall give to me”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what the messengers said (level 1). The messengers are quoting what Ben Hadad has told them to say (level 2). This includes a quotation of something that Ben Hadad said previously (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a second-level or third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 20:6 (#1)

כָּל־מַחְמַד עֵינֶיךָ

“every desire of your eyes”

Ben Hadad is using one part of Ahab, his **eyes**, to mean all of him in the act of desiring valuable possessions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every desire of yours]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 20:6 (#2)

כָּל־מַחְמַד עֵינֶ֖יךָ

“every desire of your eyes”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [everything that you desire] or [everything in which you delight]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 20:6 (#3)

יָשִׂ֣ימוּ בְיָדָ֔ם

“they will put in their hand”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they will take into their possession] or [they will seize]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:7 (#2)

כִּ֣י

“for”

Here, the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 20:7 (#1)

דְּעוּ & וּרְאוּ

“know and see”

Ahab is using **know and see** as a common expression of his culture to mean “consider carefully.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 24:13. Alternate translation: [consider carefully]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:8 (#1)

אַל־תִּשְׁמַ֥ע וְלֹ֖א תֹּאבֶֽה

“Do not hear and do not consent”

The terms **hear** and **consent** mean similar things, since in this context “hear” means “agree.” The elders and people are using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Do not agree at all]

See: Doublet

1 Kings 20:9 (#1)

אִמְרוּ֙ לַאדֹנַ֣י הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ כֹּ֖ל אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַ֣חְתָּ אֶל־עַבְדְּךָ֗ בָּרִאשֹׁנָה֙ אֶעֱשֶׂ֔ה וְהַדָּבָ֥ר הַזֶּ֖ה לֹ֣א אוּכַ֑ל לַעֲשׂ֔וֹת

“Say to my lord the king, ‘All that you sent to your servant at first, I will do, but this thing I am not able to do”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Tell my lord the king that all he sent to his servant at first, I will do, but this thing I am not able to do]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:9 (#3)

בָּרִאשֹׁנָה

“at first”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **first**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [originally]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 20:9 (#4)

וַיְשִׁבֻ֖הוּ דָּבָֽר

“and returned him word”

Here, **word** represents what the messengers said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and reported to Ben Hadad what Ahab had said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:9 (#2)

עַבְדְּךָ

“your servant”

Ahab is speaking of himself in the third person as **your servant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, your servant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 20:10 (#2)

וְכֹ֖ה יוֹסִ֑פוּ

“and thus may they add”

See how you translated the similar expression “and thus may he add” in 2:23. Alternate translation: [and may they do even worse]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:10 (#3)

הָעָֽם

“the people”

In this context, the term **people** refers to the soldiers in Ahab’s army. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:10 (#1)

כֹּה־יַֽעֲשׂ֨וּן לִ֜י אֱלֹהִ֗ים וְכֹ֤ה יוֹסִ֙פוּ֙ אִם־יִשְׁפֹּ֣קְ עֲפַ֔ר שֻׁמְרוֹן֙ לְשׁ֣וּעָלִ֔ים לְכָל־הָעָ֖ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר בְּרַגְלָֽי

“Thus may the gods do to me, and thus may they add, if the dust of Samaria is enough for handfuls for all of the people who {are} at my feet”

Following the custom of this culture, Ben Hadad is swearing an oath by stating a condition and the consequence he is asking the gods to make happen if the condition is met. He is stating the consequence before the condition. If it would be helpful to your readers, in your translation, you could state the condition before the consequence. See how you translated the similar expression in 19:2. Alternate translation: [If the dust of Samaria is enough for handfuls for all of the people who are at my feet, thus may the gods do to me, and thus may they add]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 20:10 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר בְּרַגְלָֽי

“who {are} at my feet”

Ben Hadad is using his **feet** to represent his soldiers walking where he has just walked. In other words, they are following him, and this represents that he is their military commander. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. If you have already translated the book of Judges, see how you translated the similar expression in Judges 4:10. Alternate translation: [who are under my command]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:11 (#2)

דַּבְּר֣וּ

“Tell {him”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Tell** is plural here because Ahab is addressing the messengers of Ben Hadad. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 20:11 (#1)

דַּבְּר֣וּ אַל־יִתְהַלֵּ֔ל חֹגֵ֖ר כְּמַפְתֵּֽחַ

“Tell {him}, ‘Let one girding not boast like one ungirding”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Tell him that one girding should not boast like one ungirding]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:12 (#1)

אֶת־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה

“this word”

Here, **this word** represents what Ahab had the messengers tell Ben Hadad said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this reply]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:12 (#2)

וְה֥וּא שֹׁתֶ֖ה הוּא֙ וְהַמְּלָכִ֔ים בַּסֻּכּ֑וֹת

“and he was drinking, he and the kings, in huts”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. Ben Hadad’s overconfidence and complacency help lead to his defeat in this battle. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 20:12 (#3)

שֻׂ֣שׂ֔וּ וַיָּשִׂ֖ימוּ עַל־הָעִֽיר

“Set!” And they set against the city”

Ben Hadad is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [“Set yourselves in array!” And they set themselves in array against the city] or [“Form battle lines!” And they formed battle lines against the city]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 20:13 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:7. Alternate translation: [And just then]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 20:13 (#2)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הֲרָאִיתָ אֵת כָּל־הֶהָמוֹן הַגָּדוֹל הַזֶּה הִנְנִי נֹתְנוֹ בְיָדְךָ הַיּוֹם וְיָדַעְתָּ כִּי־אֲנִי יְהוָה

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Have you seen all of this great multitude? Behold me, giving it into your hand today, and you will know that I {am} Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that though you have certainly seen all of this great multitude, behold him, giving it into your hand today, and you will know that he is Yahweh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:13 (#3)

הֲרָאִיתָ אֵת כָּל־הֶהָמוֹן הַגָּדוֹל הַזֶּה

“Have you seen all of this great multitude”

The prophet is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You have certainly seen all of this great multitude]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 20:13 (#5)

בְיָדְךָ

“into your hand”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your power]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:13 (#4)

הִנֵּנִי נֹתְנוֹ

“Behold me, giving it”

See how you translated the similar expression “behold you, seeking” in 11:22. Alternate translation: [I am about to give it]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:14 (#3)

בְּנַעֲרֵי שָׂרֵי הַמְּדִינוֹת

“By the servants of the leaders of the districts”

Having the **servants of the leaders of the districts** lead the attack was a symbolic action that showed that Yahweh would win this battle for the Israelites, since these were the youngest and least experienced soldiers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [By the young, inexperienced servants of the district leaders, so that it will be clear that I am winning this battle for you]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 20:14 (#1)

בְּמִי & בְּנַעֲרֵי שָׂרֵי הַמְּדִינוֹת

“By whom & By the servants of the leaders of the districts”

Ahab and the prophet are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [By whom will Yahweh give this multitude into my hand ... I will give it into your hand by the servants of the leaders of the districts]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 20:14 (#2)

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה בְּנַעֲרֵי שָׂרֵי הַמְּדִינוֹת

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘By the servants of the leaders of the districts”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that he will do that by the servants of the leaders of the districts]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:14 (#4)

מִי־יֶאְסֹר הַמִּלְחָמָה

“Who will bind the battle”

Ahab is using **Who will bind the battle** as a common expression of his culture to mean “Who will begin the battle” or “Who will start the attack.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Who will begin the engagement] or [Who will attack first]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:15 (#1)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the same expression in 6:1. In this case, the phrase refers specifically to Israelite soldiers, not to the Israelites generally. Alternate translation: [the Israelite soldiers]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 20:17 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח בֶּן־הֲדַד

“And Ben Hadad sent”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Ben Hadad sent men to investigate]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 20:17 (#2)

אֲנָשִׁים יָצְאוּ מִשֹּׁמְרוֹן

“Men have gone out from Samaria”

In a context such as this, here and through verse 21, your language might say “came” instead of **gone**. Alternate translation: [Men have come out from Samaria]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 20:20 (#1)

וַיַּכּוּ אִישׁ אִישׁוֹ

“And they struck, a man his man”

The author is using **a man his man** as a common expression of his culture to mean that each of the young Israelite soldiers killed an enemy soldier who confronted him. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And each one struck his opponent]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:20 (#2)

וַיַּכּוּ

“And they struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:15. Alternate translation: [And they killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:21 (#2)

וְהִכָּה בַאֲרָם מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה

“And he struck Aram a great striking”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. See how you translated the term “struck” in 8:33. Alternate translation: [And he inflicted a severe defeat on Aram]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 20:21 (#1)

וַיַּךְ אֶת־הַסּוּס וְאֶת־הָרָכֶב

“and he struck the horse and the chariot”

In this verse, the words **horse** and **chariot** are singular in form, but they refer to all of Ben Hadad’s horses and chariots. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms in your translation. Alternate translation: [and he struck the horses and the chariots]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 20:22 (#1)

הַנָּבִיא

“the prophet”

The author assumes that readers will know **the prophet** refers to the same prophet who earlier told King Ahab how to defeat the Aramean army. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the prophet who had spoken to Ahab earlier]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:22 (#2)

לֵךְ

“Go”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [Take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:22 (#3)

וְדַע וּרְאֵה

“and know and see”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:7. Alternate translation: [and consider carefully]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:22 (#4)

לִתְשׁוּבַת הַשָּׁנָה

“at the return of the year”

The prophet is using **at the return of the year** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in the spring” or “at the beginning of the new agricultural year.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [next spring]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:23 (#1)

חָזְקָנוּ מִמֶּנּוּ & נֶחֱזַק מֵהֶם

“they were stronger than us & we will be stronger than them”

The servants are using these phrases to represent that the Israelites, supposedly because **gods of the hills** made them **stronger** than the Arameans, defeated them in the recent battle, but that if they fought on a **plain**, the Arameans would be **stronger** and so defeat them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language here and in verse 25. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 17:50. Alternate translation: [they defeated us ... we will defeat them]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:24 (#1)

אִישׁ מִמְּקֹמֹו

“a man from his place”

Ben Hadad’s officials are using **a man from his place** as a common expression of their culture to mean “each one from his position.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each one from his position]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:25 (#1)

וְאַתָּה תִּמְנֶה

“And you, you shall muster”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [And for your part, you shall muster`]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:25 (#2)

כַּחֵיל֨ הַנֹּפֵ֜ל מֵאוֹתָ֗ךְ

“like the army having fallen from with you”

The officials are speaking of Ben Hadad’s previous army as **having fallen** as a common expression of their culture to mean that this army was destroyed. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like the army that you lost] or [like the army that the Israelites destroyed]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:25 (#3)

וַיִּשְׁמַע לְקֹלָם

“And he listened to their voice”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And he agreed with what they said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:26 (#1)

וַיְהִי׀

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase translated as **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 20:26 (#2)

לִתְשׁוּבַ֖ת הַשָּׁנָֽה

“at the return of the year”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:22. Alternate translation: [the next spring]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:27 (#1)

וּבְנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל הָתְפָּקְד֖וּ וְכָלְכְּל֑וּ

“And the sons of Israel were mustered and were sustained”

The expressions **were mustered** and **were sustained** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use those forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Ahab mustered the sons of Israel and sustained them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 20:27 (#3)

וַֽאֲרָ֖ם מִלְא֥וּ אֶת־הָאָֽרֶץ

“but Aram filled the land”

The author says **Aram filled the land** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the Aramean army spread out over much of the land]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 20:27 (#2)

כִּשְׁנֵי֙ חֲשִׂפֵ֣י עִזִּ֔ים

“like two little flocks of goats”

The point of this comparison is that just as **two little flocks of goats** are small in number, so the Israelite army was small in number compared to the large Aramean army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [in relatively small numbers, like two little flocks of goats]

See: Simile

1 Kings 20:28 (#3)

בְּיָדֶ֑ךָ

“into your hand”

Here, **hand** represents the power of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your power]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:28 (#1)

כֹּֽה־אָמַ֞ר יְהוָ֗ה יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר אָמְר֔וּ אֲרָ֖ם אֱלֹהֵ֣י הָרִ֑ים יְהוָ֥ה וְלֹא־אֱלֹהֵ֖י עֲמָקִ֥ים הֽוּא׃ וְנָתַתִּ֞י אֶת־כָּל־הֶהָמ֤וֹן הַגָּדוֹל֙ הַזֶּ֔ה בְּיָדֶ֑ךָ וִֽידַעְתֶּ֖ם כִּי־אֲנִ֥י יְהוָֽה

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Because Aram has said, “Yahweh {is} a god of the hills, but he {is} not a god of the valleys,” I will give all of this great multitude into your hand, and you will know that I {am} Yahweh”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what the **man of God** said to Ahab. (level 1). The man of God is quoting what Yahweh told him to tell Ahab. (level 2). This includes a quotation of something that the Arameans have said previously (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a second-level or third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 20:28 (#2)

כֹּֽה־אָמַ֞ר יְהוָ֗ה יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר אָמְר֔וּ אֲרָ֖ם אֱלֹהֵ֣י הָרִ֑ים יְהוָ֥ה וְלֹא־אֱלֹהֵ֖י עֲמָקִ֥ים הֽוּא׃ וְנָתַתִּ֞י אֶת־כָּל־הֶהָמ֤וֹן הַגָּדוֹל֙ הַזֶּ֔ה בְּיָדֶ֑ךָ וִֽידַעְתֶּ֖ם כִּי־אֲנִ֥י יְהוָֽה

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Because Aram has said, “Yahweh {is} a god of the hills, but he {is} not a god of the

valleys," I will give all of this great multitude into your hand, and you will know that I {am} Yahweh"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that because Aram has said that he is a god of hills but not a god of valleys, he will give all of this great multitude into your hand, and you will know that he is Yahweh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:29 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

"on the seventh day"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **seventh**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [on day seven] or [after seven days]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 20:29 (#4)

וַיַּכּוּ

"and & struck"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:33. Alternate translation: [defeated]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:29 (#1)

וַיַּחֲנוּ אֵלֶּה נֹכַח אֵלֶּה שִׁבְעַת יָמִים

"And they camped, these opposite these, seven days"

The author is using **these opposite these** as a common expression of his culture to mean "opposite each other" or "in opposing positions." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they camped opposite each other for seven days]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:29 (#3)

וַתִּקָּרֶבְ הַמִּלְחָמָה

"that the battle approached"

The author is using **the battle approached** as a common expression of his culture to mean "the armies advanced against each other" or "the battle began." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that the battle was joined] or [that the armies advanced against each other]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:29 (#5)

מֵאָה־אֶ֣לֶף רַגְלִ֔י בְּי֖וֹם אֶחָֽד

"100,000 foot soldiers in one day"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they killed 100,000 foot soldiers in one day]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 20:30 (#1)

חֶדֶר בְּחָדֶר

"a chamber in a chamber"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he hid in a chamber in a chamber]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 20:30 (#2)

חֶדֶר בְּחָדֶר

"a chamber in a chamber"

The phrase **a chamber in a chamber** describes an inner room within another room, likely referring to the most secluded or private area of a building. If your readers would not be familiar with rooms that have other rooms inside them, you could use a more general term or explain the arrangement in a footnote. Alternate translation: [an inner room] or [a private room]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 20:31 (#2)

נָשִׂשִׂימָה & שַׂקִּים בְּמָתְנֵינוּ וַחֲבָלִים בְּרֹאשֵׁנוּ

"let us put sackcloth on our loins and ropes on our heads"

Wearing **sackcloth** was a symbolic action by which Ben Hadad's officials showed humility before the king of Israel. Putting **ropes** on their **heads** was a symbolic action by which they showed that they were willing to become his captives. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [let us put sackcloth on our loins to show humility and ropes on our heads to show that we are willing to become captives]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 20:31 (#3)

יְחַיֶּיה אֶת־נַפְשֶׁךָ

"he will let your soul live"

The officials are using one part of Ben Hadad, his **soul**, to mean all of him in the act of having his life spared. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [he will let you live]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 20:31 (#1)

מַלְכֵי חֶסֶד

"are} kings of mercy"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mercy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [are merciful kings]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 20:32 (#1)

עַבְדְּךָ בֶן־הֲדַד אָמַר תְּחִי־נָא נַפְשִׁי

"Your servant Ben Hadad says, 'Please let my soul live"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Your servant Ben Hadad asks you please to let his soul live]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:32 (#2)

אָחִי הוּא

"He {is} my brother"

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:13. Alternate translation: [He is my fellow king] or [He is my ally]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 20:33 (#1)

וְהָאֲנָשִׁים יְנַחֲשׁוּ

"And the men were observing signs"

The author is speaking of Ben Hadad's officials as if they were actually **observing signs**, that is, trying to tell fortunes or see omens, when they were listening carefully to Ahab's words to determine his attitude toward their king. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the men were watching Ahab closely]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 20:33 (#2)

וַיְמַהֲרוּ וַיַּחְלְטוּ

"and they hastened and caught"

The phrase **hastened and caught** expresses a single idea. The word **hastened** tells in what way the officials **caught** or noticed and repeated what Ahab said. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and they quickly caught]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 20:33 (#3)

אָחִיךָ & הֲדַד & בֶּן

"Your brother Ben Hadad"

The implication is that Ben Hadad's officials are quickly correcting their earlier description of Ben Hadad as Ahab's "servant" based on Ahab's reference to him as his "brother." You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yes, we meant your brother Ben Hadad]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:33 (#4)

בֹּאוּ

"Come"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [Go ahead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:33 (#5)

וַיַּעֲלֵהוּ עַל־הַמֶּרְכָּבָה

“and he brought him up onto the chariot”

Bringing Ben Hadad up onto his **chariot** was a symbolic action by which Ahab showed that he was treating Ben Hadad as an equal and an honored guest rather than as a defeated enemy. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he brought him up onto his chariot to welcome and honor him]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 20:34 (#1)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר אֵלָ֜יו

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Ben Hadad, while the pronoun **him** refers to Ahab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Ben Hadad said to Ahab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:34 (#5)

וַיִּכְרָת־לֹ֥ו בְרִ֖ית

“And he cut a covenant with him”

The author is using **cut a covenant** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Ben Hadad made a covenant with Ahab. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 5:12. Alternate translation: [And he made a covenant with him]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:34 (#3)

וַאֲנִ֕י & אֲשַׁלְּחֲךָ֖

“And I, I will send you away”

See how you translated the similar expression “I, I will do” in 5:8. Alternate translation: [And for my part, I will send you away]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:34 (#4)

וַיִּכְרָת־לֹ֥ו בְרִ֖ית וַיְשַׁלְּחֵֽהוּ

“And he cut a covenant with him, and he sent him away”

In the first clause, the pronoun **he** refers to Ben Hadad, while the pronoun **him** refers to Ahab. In the second clause, the pronoun **he** refers to Ahab, while the pronoun **him** refers to Ben Hadad. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Ben Hadad cut a covenant with Ahab, and Ahab sent Ben Hadad away]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:34 (#2)

וַאֲנִ֕י בַּבְּרִ֖ית אֲשַׁלְּחֲךָ֑

“And I, I will send you away with a covenant”

This is a direct quotation of what Ahab said in response to Ben Hadad. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [And Ahab replied, “And I, I will send you away with a covenant.”]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 20:35 (#1)

מִבְּנֵ֣י הַנְּבִיאִ֔ים

“from the sons of the prophets”

The phrase **sons of the prophets** refers to a group of young men whom experienced prophets were training to become prophets. If your readers would not be familiar with what this phrase means, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [from a group of young prophets in training] or [from the prophetic community]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 20:35 (#3)

בִּדְבַ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה

“By the word of Yahweh”

Here, **word** represents what Yahweh commanded by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [By the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:35 (#2)

אָמַ֤ר אֶל־רֵעֵ֙הוּ֙ בִּדְבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה הַכֵּ֥נִי נָ֖א

“said to his fellow, “By the word of Yahweh, strike me, please”

The direct quotation may begin after the word **Yahweh** rather than after the word **fellow**. Alternate

translation: [said to his fellow by the word of Yahweh, “Strike me, please.”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Kings 20:36 (#1)

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר לֹ֖ו

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to the first prophet, while the pronoun **him** refers to the second prophet. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the first man said to the second man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:36 (#6)

וַיִּמְצָאֵ֖הוּ הָאַרְיֵֽה

“and a lion found him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:29. Alternate translation: [and a lion met him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:36 (#2)

לֹֽא־שָׁמַ֣עְתָּ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֔ה

“you did not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:8. Alternate translation: [you did not obey the voice of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:36 (#3)

לֹֽא־שָׁמַ֣עְתָּ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֔ה

“you did not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

Here, **voice** represents what Yahweh commanded by using his voice to speak to the first prophet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [you did not obey the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:36 (#4)

הִנְּךָ֙ הֹולֵ֣ךְ מֵֽאִתִּ֔י וְהִכְּךָ֖ הָאַרְיֵ֑ה

“behold you, going from with me, and a lion will strike you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:22. Alternate translation: [as you leave me, a lion will strike you]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:36 (#5)

וְהִכְּךָ֖ הָאַרְיֵֽה

“and a lion will strike you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:15. Alternate translation: [and a lion will kill you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:39 (#1)

הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ עֹבֵ֖ר וְה֣וּא צָעַ֑ק

“the king was passing by, and he, he cried out”

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he cried out** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to indicate that this action took place at the same time as **the king was passing by**. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and just as the king was passing by, he cried out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:39 (#2)

עַבְדְּךָ֖

“Your servant”

The prophet is speaking of himself in the third person as **your servant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [I, your servant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 20:39 (#3)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר֮ שָׁמֹ֣ר׀ אֶת־הָאִ֣ישׁ הַזֶּ֗ה אִם־הִפָּקֵד֙ יִפָּקֵ֔ד וְהָיְתָ֥ה נַפְשְׁךָ֖ תַּ֣חַת נַפְשֹׁ֑ו אֹ֚ו כִּכַּר־כֶּ֣סֶף תִּשְׁקֹֽול

“And he said, ‘Guard this man. If missing, he is missing, then your life will be in place of his life, or you shall pay a kikkar of silver”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And he told me to guard that man. He said that if missing, he was missing, then my life would be in place of his life, or I should pay a kikkar of silver.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:39 (#5)

וְהָיְתָה נַפְשְׁךָ֙ תַּ֣חַת נַפְשׁ֔וֹ

“then your life will be in place of his life”

The soldier in the story is using **your life will be in place of his life** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the prophet would forfeit his own life for allowing the prisoner to escape. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then you will pay for that with your life] or [then we will execute you for letting him get away]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:39 (#4)

אִם־הִפָּקֵד֙ יִפָּקֵ֔ד

“If missing, he is missing”

In the story that the prophet is telling, the soldier is repeating forms of the verb **missing** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [If for any reason he is missing]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 20:39 (#6)

כִּכַּר־כֶּ֖סֶף

“a kikkar of silver”

See how you chose to represent the term “kikkars” in 9:14.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Kings 20:40 (#1)

עֹשֶׂ֥ה הֵנָּ֖ה וְהֵנָּ֑ה

“was doing here and there”

The prophet is saying that he was **doing here and there** as a common expression of his culture to mean that he was “busy with various tasks” or “occupied with other matters.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was doing this and that] or [became preoccupied with other tasks]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:40 (#2)

כֵּ֚ן מִשְׁפָּטֶ֔ךָ

“Thus {is} your judgment”

By **Thus is your judgment**, the king means that the prophet has pronounced his own judgment by acknowledging that he did exactly what the soldier said would deserve punishment. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I judge you guilty based on your own testimony]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:40 (#3)

אַתָּ֥ה חָרָֽצְתָּ

“you, you have decided”

Ahab is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you have decided** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the personal role of this prophet in presenting the facts of the case in a way that shows he is guilty. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “you, you swore” in 1:17. Alternate translation: [you are the one who has decided]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 20:41 (#1)

וַיְמַהֵּ֣ר וַיָּ֔סַר

“And he hurried and removed”

The phrase **hurried and removed** expresses a single idea. The word **hurried** in what way the prophet **removed** the covering from his eyes. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And he hurriedly removed]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 20:42 (#1)

כֹּ֚ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה יַ֚עַן שִׁלַּ֣חְתָּ אֶת־אִ֔ישׁ חֶרְמִ֖י מִיָּדֶ֑ךָ וְהָיְתָ֤ה נַפְשְׁךָ֙ תַּ֣חַת נַפְשׁ֔וֹ וְעַמְּךָ֖ תַּ֥חַת עַמּֽוֹ

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Because you have sent away a man of my devotion from {your} hand, so it will be your life in place of his life and your people in place of his people”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that because you have sent away a man of his devotion from your hand, so it will be your life in place of his life and your people in place of his people]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 20:42 (#2)

אֶת־אִישׁ־חֶרְמִּי

“a man of my devotion”

Yahweh, speaking through the prophet, is using this possessive form to mean a man whom he had devoted to destruction. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [a man whom I had devoted]

See: Possession

1 Kings 20:42 (#3)

אֶת־אִישׁ־חֶרְמִּי

“a man of my devotion”

The word that the ULT translates as **devotion** was a specialized term that described the cultural practice of giving something over to Yahweh so that humans would no longer be able to use it. The context indicates that in this case, this was to be accomplished through the total destruction of this **man**. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a man whom I wanted you to destroy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 20:42 (#5)

וְהָיְתָה נַפְשְׁךָ֙ תַּ֣חַת נַפְשׁ֔וֹ וְעַמְּךָ֖ תַּ֣חַת עַמּֽוֹ

“so it will be your life in place of his life and your people in place of his people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:39. Alternate translation: [so you will pay for that with your life, and your people will pay for that with their lives]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 20:42 (#4)

מִיָּדֶ֑ךָ

“from {your} hand”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you had him in your power] or [when you had him as your prisoner]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 20:43 (#1)

וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ מֶֽלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ עַל־בֵּיתוֹ֔ סַ֖ר וְזָעֵ֑ף וַיָּבֹ֖א שֹׁמְרֹֽנָה

“And the king of Israel went to his house sullen and angry, and he came to Samaria”

The author is describing one event, **the king of Israel went to his house**, before describing another event that preceded it, **he came to Samaria**. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And the king of Israel came to Samaria, and he went to his house sullen and angry]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

The story of Elijah continues in this chapter.

1. Naboth refuses to sell his vineyard to Ahab (21:1–4)
2. Jezebel has Naboth unjustly convicted and executed (21:5–16)
3. Elijah announces Yahweh’s judgment against Ahab and Jezebel (21:17–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Naboth refuse to sell his vineyard to Ahab or trade it for a better one?

Naboth refused to sell or trade his vineyard to King Ahab because it was the inheritance from his ancestors, and according to the law of Moses, such land was not to be sold permanently or transferred out of the family or tribe. Leviticus 25:23 states, “The land must not be sold permanently, because the land is mine and you reside in my land as foreigners and strangers.” Numbers 36:7 commands, “No inheritance in Israel is to pass from one tribe to another.” So Naboth understood that parting with this land would be a violation of God’s commands. This shows that Naboth continued to honor and obey Yahweh. He was one of the faithful Israelites whom Yahweh described

to Elijah in 19:18. Yahweh had been patient with Ahab and Jezebel, continually proving to them that he was the true God. But when Jezebel corrupted the Israelite process of justice in order to have Naboth convicted and executed so that Ahab could seize his vineyard, this showed that they were hardened in their resistance to Yahweh and his righteous ways. Yahweh then announced a judgment of destruction against Jezebel and Ahab.

1 Kings 21:1 (#1)

מֶ֖לֶךְ שֹׁמְרֽוֹן

“the king of Samaria”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the king of Samaria**, he is not referring to a king who ruled the city of Samaria, but to Ahab, the king who ruled Israel from Samaria as his capital city. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the king who ruled Israel from the city of Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:2 (#2)

תְּנָה־לִּ֤י אֶת־כַּרְמְךָ֙ וְיִהְיֶה־לִּ֣י לְגַן־יָרָ֔ק כִּֽי־הוּא֙ קָרוֹבׇ֔ אֵאֶצְלׇ֖ בֵּיתִ֑י

“Give your vineyard to me, and it will be to me for a garden of vegetables, for it is near beside my house”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since your vineyard is near beside my house, give it to me, and it will be to me for a garden of vegetables]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 21:2 (#1)

בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“in your eyes”

Ahab is using **in your eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in your judgment” or “in your opinion.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:3 (#1)

חָלִ֥ילָה לִּ֛יׇ מֵיהוָ֖ה מִתִּתִּ֣י

“Profane to me from Yahweh, from my giving”

Naboth is using a common expression of this culture to express his horror at the idea that Ahab has just described. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 24:6. Alternate translation: [Far be it from me to sin against Yahweh by giving]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:3 (#2)

אֲבֹתָ֑י

“my fathers”

To translate this expression here and in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [my ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 21:4 (#1)

הַדָּבָ֗רׇ אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּ֤ר אֵלָיו֙ נָב֣וֹתׇ הַיִּזְרְעֵאלִ֔י

“the word that Naboth the Jezreelite had spoken to him”

Here, **the word** represents what Naboth said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Naboth the Jezreelite had said to him]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 21:4 (#2)

לָ֔חֶם

“bread”

The author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in verses 5 and 7. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 21:5 (#1)

מַה־זֶּ֔הׇ

“What is this”

Jezebel is using **What is this** as a common expression of her culture to ask Ahab to explain his conduct. If

this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What's going on here?]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:6 (#2)

וָאֹמַר לוֹ תְּנָה־לִּי אֶת־כַּרְמְךָ בְּכֶסֶף אִם־חָפֵץ אַתָּה אֶתְּנָה־לְךָ כֶּרֶם תַּחְתָּיו וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא־אֶתֵּן לְךָ אֶת־כַּרְמִי

"and I said to him, 'Give your vineyard to me for silver or, if you are desiring, let me give a vineyard to you in its place.' But he said, 'I will not give my vineyard to you"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and I asked him to give me his vineyard for silver and told him that if he preferred, I would give a vineyard to him in its place. But he said that he would not give his vineyard to me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 21:6 (#1)

כִּי

"Because"

Ahab is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I am sullen and not eating bread because]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 21:7 (#1)

אַתָּה & תַּעֲשֶׂה מְלוּכָה עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"you, you do the kingship over Israel"

Jezebel is repeating the pronoun **you** in order to stress Ahab's personal role as king **over Israel**. See how you translated the similar expression "you, you swore" in 1:17. Alternate translation: [you are the one who is king over Israel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 21:7 (#3)

אֲנִי אֶתֵּן לְךָ אֶת־כֶּרֶם נָבוֹת

"I, I will give to you the vineyard of Naboth"

Jezebel is repeating the pronoun **I** in order to stress the personal role that she will take in getting **the vineyard of Naboth** for Ahab. Alternate translation: [I will personally get the vineyard of Naboth for you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 21:7 (#2)

וְיִטַב לִבֶּךָ

"and let your heart be good"

Here, the **heart** represents a person's feelings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and feel happy]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 21:8 (#1)

בְּשֵׁשֵׁם אַחְאָב

"in the name of Ahab"

The statement that Jezebel wrote these letters **in the name of Ahab** indicates that she signed his name to them, but it also means more than that. Ahab's **name** also represents his person, so the statement means that Jezebel wrote these letters as if Ahab had written them himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pretending that Ahab himself had written them]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 21:8 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר בְּעִירוֹ הַיֹּשְׁבִים אֶת־נָבוֹת

"who {were} in his city, the dwellers with Naboth"

The author is using these phrases to specify that Jezebel sent these letters specifically to the **elders** and **nobles** who lived in the same city as Naboth did, not to Israelite elders and nobles generally. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who lived in the same city as Naboth did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:9 (#1)

קִרְאוּ־צוֹם

"Proclaim a fast"

Proclaiming a **fast** was a symbolic action by which the leaders of a community called its members to attend to something that was very important, even more important than eating on that day. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the signifi-

cance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Proclaim that on a certain day the people of your city should not eat, because they have a very important matter to address]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 21:9 (#2)

וְהוֹשִׁ֥יבוּ אֶת־נָבוֹת֖ בְּרֹ֥אשׁ הָעָֽם

“and seat Naboth at the head of the people”

Jezebel was using the term **head** to mean the front of the crowd of **people** whom the elders and nobles would gather. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly, here and in verse 12. Alternate translation: [and seat Naboth in front of the crowd of people you gather]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:9 (#3)

וְהוֹשִׁ֥יבוּ אֶת־נָבוֹת֖ בְּרֹ֥אשׁ הָעָֽם

“and seat Naboth at the head of the people”

Jezebel could mean: (1) that she wants the elders and nobles to put Naboth in the position of a criminal defendant. Alternate translation: [and seat Naboth in front of the crowd as an accused person] or (2) that she wants the elders and nobles to put Naboth in a seat of honor to suggest that, if not for the accusations that would then be brought against him, they would consider him a leading member of the community. In other words, this was to be a false show of impartiality. Alternate translation: [and seat Naboth in a place of honor to show that you have nothing against him personally]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:10 (#1)

בְּנֵי־בְלִיָּעַ֣ל

“sons of wickedness”

To translate this expression here and in verse 13, see how you translated the similar expression in 1:52. Alternate translation: [very wicked men]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:10 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֔ר בֵּרַ֖כְתָּ אֱלֹהִ֣ים וָמֶ֑לֶךְ

“saying, ‘You blessed God and the king”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [saying that he blessed God and the king]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 21:10 (#3)

בֵּרַ֖כְתָּ אֱלֹהִ֣ים וָמֶ֑לֶךְ

“You blessed God and the king”

It is likely that the original reading here was “cursed” and that scribes changed it to **blessed** in order to avoid the uncomfortable language of a person cursing God. (It would not have been a capital crime if Naboth had blessed God and the king, but it would have been a capital crime if he had cursed them.) Many versions of the Bible read “cursed” here, since this is the kind of change that scribes are known to have made in similar cases. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses, here and in verse 13. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [You cursed God and the king]

See: Textual Variants

1 Kings 21:11 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר כָּתוּב֙

“just as was written”

The expression **was written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as she had written]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 21:13 (#1)

וַיִּסְקְלֻ֥הוּ בָאֲבָנִ֖ים

“and they stoned him with stones”

This expression may seem to contain extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and they stoned him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 21:14 (#1)

סֻקַּ֖לוּ נָבוֹ֑ת

“Naboth has been stoned”

The expression **has been stoned** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [We have stoned Naboth]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 21:15 (#2)

קוּם

“Arise”

To translate this expression and the similar ones in verses 16 and 18, see how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [Take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:15 (#1)

סֻקַּל נָבוֹת וַיָּמֹת

“Naboth had been stoned and had died”

The expression **had been stoned** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Jezreelites had stoned Naboth, and he had died]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 21:15 (#4)

אֵין נָבוֹת חַי כִּי־מֵת

“Naboth {is} not alive, but he is dead”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Naboth is certainly dead]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 21:15 (#3)

רֵ֚שׁ אֶת־כֶּ֣רֶם ׀ נָבוֹת֮ הַיִּזְרְעֵאלִי֒ אֲשֶׁ֣ר מֵאֵ֗ן לָתֵת־לְךָ֙ בְּכֶ֣סֶף כִּ֔י אֵין נָבוֹת חַי כִּי־מֵת

“Possess the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite that he refused to give to you for silver, for Naboth {is} not alive, but he is dead”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Naboth is not alive, but he is dead, possess the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite that he refused to give to you for silver]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 21:17 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ דְּבַר־יְהוָ֔ה אֶל־אֵלִיָּ֖הוּ

“And the word of Yahweh was to Elijah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [Then Yahweh spoke a message to Elijah]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:18 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 21:18 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־יֵרַד שָׁ֣מָּה

“where he has gone down there”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [where he has gone]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 21:18 (#1)

מֶלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר בְּשֹׁמְר֔וֹן

“the king of Israel, who {is} in Samaria”

By **the king of Israel, who is in Samaria**, Yahweh means Ahab, who was the king of Israel and whose capital city was Samaria. He does not mean that Ahab is in Samaria at the time he is speaking to Elijah, since Ahab is in Jezreel at this time. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the king who rules Israel from Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:19 (#1)

וְדִבַּרְתָּ֣ אֵלָ֔יו לֵאמֹ֖ר כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֑ה הֲרָצַ֣חְתָּ וְגַם־יָרָ֔שְׁתָּ וְדִבַּרְתָּ֣ אֵלָ֔יו לֵאמֹ֖ר כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֑ה בִּמְק֗וֹם אֲשֶׁ֤ר לִקְקוּ֙ הַכְּלָבִ֔ים אֶת־דַּ֖ם נָבוֹת֙ יְלַקְּק֣וּ הַכְּלָבִ֔ים אֶת־דָּמְךָ֖ גַּם־אָֽתָּה

“And you shall speak to him, saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “Have you murdered and also taken possession?”’ And you shall speak to him, saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “In the place where the dogs licked the blood of Naboth, the dogs will lick your blood, even you”

There are three levels of quotation in each sentence here. The author is quoting what Yahweh said to Elijah (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. Yahweh tells Elijah what he wants him to say to Ahab (level 2). This includes direct quotations from Yahweh himself (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations (see the Quotes within Quotes note).

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 21:19 (#2)

וְדִבַּרְתָּ֣ אֵלָ֔יו לֵאמֹ֖ר כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה הֲרָצַ֖חְתָּ וְגַם־יָרָ֑שְׁתָּ וְדִבַּרְתָּ֣ אֵלָ֔יו לֵאמֹ֖ר כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה בִּמְק֗וֹם אֲשֶׁ֤ר לָקְקֻ֙ו֙ הַכְּלָבִ֔ים אֶת־דַּ֖ם נָבֹ֑ת יְלַקְּק֥וּ הַכְּלָבִ֖ים אֶת־דָּמְךָ֥ גַּם־אֶתָּֽה

“And you shall speak to him, saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “Have you murdered and also taken possession?”’ And you shall speak to him, saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “In the place where the dogs licked the blood of Naboth, the dogs will lick your blood, even you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you shall tell him that I say that he has murdered and also taken possession. And you shall tell him that I say that in the place where the dogs licked the blood of Naboth, the dogs will lick his blood, even his]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 21:19 (#4)

הֲרָצַ֖חְתָּ וְגַם־יָרָ֑שְׁתָּ

“Have you murdered and also taken possession”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [You have murdered a man and also taken possession of his property!]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 21:19 (#5)

גַּם־אָתָּה

“even you”

By **even you**, Yahweh is stressing to Ahab that the punishment he describes will indeed happen to him. One possible implication is that even though Ahab is a king, he will not escape this judgment. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [even though you are a king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:19 (#3)

הֲרָצַ֖חְתָּ וְגַם־יָרָ֑שְׁתָּ

“Have you murdered and also taken possession”

Yahweh is using the question form to express strong condemnation and accusation rather than to ask for information. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You have murdered and also taken possession!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 21:20 (#1)

הֲמְצָאתַ֖נִי אֹיְבִֽי

“Have you found me, my enemy”

Ahab is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So, you have found me, my enemy!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 21:20 (#2)

הֲמְצָאתַ֖נִי

“Have you found me”

Ahab is using **Have you found me** as a common expression of his culture to mean “So, you have caught me” or “You have discovered what I have done.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Have you apprehended me] or [Have you discovered what I did]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:20 (#5)

הָרַ֥ע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 21:20 (#4)

הִתְמַכָּרְךָ֖ לַעֲשׂ֣וֹת הָרַ֑ע

“you have sold yourself to do evil”

Elijah is using **you have sold yourself** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Ahab has allowed doing evil to take complete control of his life. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you have surrendered yourself completely to doing evil] or [you have given in completely to doing evil]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:20 (#3)

אֹיְבִ֔י

“my enemy”

Ahab is calling Elijah **my enemy** to mean that Elijah has come as the avenger of Ahab’s crime against Naboth. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [my avenger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 21:20 (#6)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:21 (#1)

הִנְנִ֨י

“Behold me”

This is the beginning of a direct quotation from Yahweh. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [Thus says Yahweh, ‘Behold me]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Kings 21:21 (#2)

הִנְנִ֨י מֵבִ֤יא עָלֶ֙יךָ֙ רָעָ֔ה וּבִעַרְתִּ֖י אַחֲרֶ֑יךָ וְהִכְרַתִּ֤י לְאַחְאָב֙ מַשְׁתִּ֣ין בְּקִ֔יר וְעָצ֥וּר וְעָזּ֖וּב בְּיִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Behold me, bringing harm on you, and I will burn after you, and I will cut off from Ahab one pissing against a wall, both one restrained and one set free in Israel”

See how you translated all of the similar expressions in 14:10. Alternate translation: [I am about to bring harm on you, and I will destroy you completely, yes, I will cause someone to kill every single one of the men in your family]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:21 (#3)

הִנְנִ֨י מֵבִ֤יא עָלֶ֙יךָ֙ רָעָ֔ה וּבִעַרְתִּ֖י אַחֲרֶ֑יךָ וְהִכְרַתִּ֤י לְאַחְאָב֙ מַשְׁתִּ֣ין בְּקִ֔יר וְעָצ֥וּר וְעָזּ֖וּב בְּיִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Behold me, bringing harm on you, and I will burn after you, and I will cut off from Ahab one pissing against a wall, both one restrained and one set free in Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that he is about to bring harm on you, and he will destroy you completely, yes, he will cause someone to kill every single one of the men in your family]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 21:21 (#4)

לְאַחְאָב֙

“from Ahab”

Yahweh is speaking of **Ahab** in the third person, even though he is addressing him directly through Elijah. Yahweh is doing that because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [from you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 21:22 (#2)

אֶת־בֵּיתְךָ֙ כְּבֵ֣ית יָרָבְעָ֔ם & וּכְבֵ֖ית בַּעְשָׁ֑א

“your house like the house of Jeroboam & and like the house of Baasha”

Yahweh is speaking as if the families of Ahab, Jeroboam, and Baasha were each actually a **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your family like the family of Jeroboam ... and like the family of Baasha]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 21:22 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּי֙ אֶת־בֵּיתְךָ֔ כְּבֵ֖ית יָרָבְעָ֣ם בֶּן־נְבָ֑ט וּכְבֵ֖ית בַּעְשָׁ֣א בֶן־אֲחִיָּ֔ה אֶל־הַכַּעַסְ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִכְעַסְתָּ֑ וַתַּחֲטִ֖יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל׃

“And I will make your house like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha, the son of Ahijah, because of the provocation {by} which you have provoked {me}, and you have caused Israel to sin”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He says that he will make your house like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha, the son of Ahijah, because of the provocation by which you have provoked him, and you have caused Israel to sin]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 21:22 (#3)

אֶל־הַכַּעַסְ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִכְעַסְתָּ֑

“because of the provocation {by} which you have provoked {me”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:30. Alternate translation: [because you have provoked me so severely]

See: Poetry

1 Kings 21:23 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֔ר הַכְּלָבִ֗ים יאכְלוּ֙ אֶת־אִיזֶ֔בֶל בְּחֵ֖ל יִזְרְעֶֽאל׃

“saying, ‘Dogs will eat Jezebel at the rampart of Jezreel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [saying that dogs will eat Jezebel at the rampart of Jezreel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 21:24 (#1)

הַמֵּ֥ת לְאַחְאָ֖בְ

“The one to Ahab dying”

Yahweh is once again speaking of **Ahab** in the third person, even though he is addressing him directly, because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [the who belongs to you who dies]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 21:24 (#2)

בַּשָּׂדֶ֖ה

“in the field”

See how you translated this expression in 14:11 and 16:4. Alternate translation: [out in the open]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 21:25 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִתְמַכֵּ֔ר לַעֲשׂ֖וֹת הָרַ֣ע בְּעֵינֵ֑י יְהוָֽה

“who sold himself to do evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated all of the similar expression in 21:20. Alternate translation: [who surrendered himself completely to do what was evil in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:26 (#1)

לָלֶ֖כֶת אַחֲרֵ֣י הַגִּלֻּלִ֑ים

“by walking after idols”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [by living the way idol-worshipers live]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 21:26 (#2)

הָאֱמֹרִ֔י

“the Amorite”

In this verse, the word **Amorite** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Amorites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “Amorite.” Alternate translation: [the Amorites]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Kings 21:26 (#4)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 21:26 (#3)

מִפְּנֵי

“from the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:24. Alternate translation: [for the sake of]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:27 (#1)

אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה

“these words”

Here, the expression **these words** represents what Elijah said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Elijah said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 21:27 (#2)

וַיִּקְרַע בְּגָדָיו וַיָּשֶׂם־שַׂק עַל־בְּשָׂרוֹ וַיָּצוֹם וַיִּשְׁכַּב בַּשָּׂק וַיְהַלֵּךְ אָט

“that he tore his garments and put sackcloth upon his flesh, and he fasted. And he lay down in sackcloth, and he walked softly”

Ahab’s actions of tearing his garments, wearing sackcloth day and night, fasting, and walking softly were symbolic actions by which he showed his repentance and mourning for his sins. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [that to show his sorrow for his sins, he tore his garments, put sackcloth upon his flesh, fasted, lay down in sackcloth, and walked humbly]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 21:28 (#1)

וַיְהִי דְּבַר־יְהוָה אֶל־אֵלִיָּהוּ

“And the word of Yahweh was to Elijah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:11. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh spoke a message to Elijah]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:29 (#1)

הֲרָאִיתָ כִּי־נִכְנַע אַחְאָב מִלְּפָנָי

“Have you seen that Ahab has humbled himself from to my face”

Here Yahweh is using the question form to draw Elijah’s attention to what has happened. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You must have seen that Ahab has humbled himself from to my face.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 21:29 (#2)

מִלְּפָנָי & מִפָּנַי

“from to my face & from my face”

Yahweh is using **from my face** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in my presence.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in my presence ... in my presence]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 21:29 (#3)

בְּיָמָיו בִּימֵי בְנוֹ

“in his days. In the days of his son”

In each instance here, **days** represents a period of time, specifically the lifetime of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during his lifetime. During the lifetime of his son]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 21:29 (#4)

בֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

Here, **house** represents the family of Ahab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his family]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter describes the death of Ahab, whom the author had said in 21:25 was the worst of all the Israelite kings. Yahweh warned Ahab through the prophet Micaiah that if he went to battle against Ramoth Gilead, he would be killed there. But Ahab listened instead to the false prophets who promised he would win a great victory there. He attacked the city and was mortally wounded, bled profusely, and died. When his soldiers brought his chariot back to Samaria, the dogs licked up his blood, just as Yahweh had told Elijah to predict in 21:19. The chapter concludes with brief accounts of two other kings.

1. Micaiah predicts that Ahab will die at the battle of Ramoth Gilead (22:1–28)
2. Ahab is killed at the battle of Ramoth Gilead (22:29–40)
3. Summary of the reign of Jehoshaphat (22:41–50)
4. Introduction to the reign of Azariah (22:51–53)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

What did Jehoshaphat shout out?

In 22:32–33, the author describes how the Aramean soldiers saw Jehoshaphat in his royal robes and thought he was Ahab, whom they had specific orders to pursue and kill. But Jehoshaphat shouted something out, and when the Arameans heard it, they realized he was not Ahab, so they left him and continued to look for Ahab. What would Jehoshaphat have shouted out that made the Arameans realize this? Many interpreters suggest that he shouted out the Judean battle cry in order to rally his soldiers in his defense. The historical narrative in the Bible records how armies of this time had their battle cries. For example, in Judges 7:20, the Israelite soldiers under Gideon's command shout out, "A sword for Yahweh and for Gideon!" So Jehoshaphat likely shouted out something that the Arameans recognized or understood as the Judean battle cry, and this indicated to them that this king was Jehoshaphat, not Ahab.

1 Kings 22:1 (#1)

וַיֵּשְׁבוּ שָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים אֵין מִלְחָמָה בֵּין אֲרָם וּבֵין יִשְׂרָאֵל

"And they continued three years without war between Aram and between Israel"

The pronoun **they** refers to the kingdoms of **Aram** and **Israel**. It may be more natural in your language to use their names at the beginning of the sentence and a pronoun at the end. Alternate translation: [And Aram and Israel continued three years without war between them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:2 (#2)

בַּשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁלִישִׁית

"in the third year"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **third**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in year three] or [after those three years]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 22:2 (#3)

וַיֵּרֶד יְהוֹשָׁפָט מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה

"that Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, went down"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:25. Alternate translation: [that Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Kings 22:2 (#1)

וַיְהִי

"And it happened"

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Kings 22:3 (#1)

הֲיְדַעְתֶּם כִּי־לָנוּ רָמֹת גִּלְעָד וַאֲנַחְנוּ מַחְשִׁשִׁים מִקַּחַת אֹתָהּ מִיַּד מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם

"Do you know that Ramoth Gilead is to us, but we are being silent from taking it from the hand of the king of Aram"

Ahab is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Since Ramoth Gilead rightfully belongs to us, we

should not be silent from taking it from the hand of the king of Aram!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 22:3 (#2)

וַאֲנַחְנוּ מַחְשִׁשִׁים מִקַּקַּחַת אֹתָהּ

“but we are being silent from taking it”

Ahab is speaking as if the Israelites were actually **being silent**. He means that they are doing nothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Judges, see how you translated the similar expression in Judges 18:9. Alternate translation: [but we are doing nothing to take it]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:3 (#3)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

Here, **hand** represents a person’s possession of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the possession of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:4 (#3)

כְּעַמִּי כְעַמֶּךָ

“Like my people, like your people”

In this context, the word **people** means “soldiers.” It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Like my soldiers, like your soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 22:4 (#2)

כָּמֹנִי כָמוֹךָ כְּעַמִּי כְעַמֶּךָ כְּסוּסַי כְּסוּסֶיךָ

“Like me, like you. Like my people, like your people. Like my horses, like your horses”

Jehoshaphat is using a common expression of his culture to agree to join Ahab in an attack on Ramoth Gilead. If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I and my army with its horses will fight alongside you and your army with its horses]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:4 (#1)

הֲתֵלֵךְ אִתִּי

“Will you go with me”

Ahab is using one Judean who would be involved, Jehoshaphat, addressing him as **you**, to mean all the Judeans who would be involved. He is also using one Israelite who would be involved, himself, to mean all the Israelites who would be involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Will your army go with my army]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 22:5 (#1)

כַּיּוֹם

“as today”

Jehoshaphat is using **as today** as a common expression of his culture to mean “first” or “right now.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [first]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:5 (#2)

אֶת־דְּבַר יְהוָה

“the word of Yahweh”

Jehoshaphat is using the **word** of Yahweh to represent what Yahweh would say by using word. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [guidance from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:6 (#1)

אֲדֹנָי

“the Lord”

These prophets are referring to Yahweh by a title rather than by a name. (Jehoshaphat recognizes this, and that is why he asks in the next verse to inquire of a “prophet of Yahweh.”) Some translations, following traditional Jewish usage, represent the divine name Yahweh as “the Lord,” often using small caps or all caps to indicate what they are doing. If you have cho-

sen to do that in your translation, be sure not to use caps here. That way it will be clear that these prophets are not speaking in the name of Yahweh. (Another way to make this clear would be to use the term "God," as the UST does.)

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 22:6 (#2)

בְּיַד הַמֶּלֶךְ

"into the hand of the king"

See how you translated the similar expression in 22:3. Alternate translation: [into the possession of the king]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:6 (#3)

בְּיַד הַמֶּלֶךְ

"into the hand of the king"

Even though the prophets are addressing the king of Israel directly, they are speaking of him in the third person as **the king** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [into your hand, O king] or [into your possession, O king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 22:7 (#1)

וְנִדְרְשָׁה מֵאוֹתוֹ

"that we may seek from him"

Jehoshaphat is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that we may seek a message from Yahweh from him]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 22:8 (#3)

וַאֲנִי שְׂנֵאתִיו

"but I, I hate him"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:17. Alternate translation: [but, personally, I hate him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:8 (#2)

טוֹב & רָע

"good & evil"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good** and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [good things ... bad things]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:8 (#4)

אַל־יֹאמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ כֵּן

"May the king not say thus"

Even though Jehoshaphat is addressing Ahab directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **the king** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [May you not say thus, O king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 22:8 (#5)

כִּי אִם־רָע

"but rather evil"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but rather he prophesies evil about me]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 22:8 (#6)

אַל־יֹאמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ כֵּן

"May the king not say thus"

Jehoshaphat is politely and tactfully disagreeing with Ahab and suggesting that Micaiah will not necessarily prophesy something evil. In your translation, express this in the way that a speaker of your language would politely disagree with someone. Alternate translation: [I do not think you need to speak that way]

See: Politeness

1 Kings 22:8 (#1)

וַאֲנִי שְׂנֵאתִיו כִּי לֹא־יִתְנַבֵּא עָלַי טוֹב כִּי אִם־רָע

"but I, I hate him because he does not prophesy good about me, but rather evil"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second

phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [but because he does not prophesy good about me but rather evil, I, I hate him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 22:10 (#1)

וּמֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל וִיהוֹשָׁפָט֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ־יְהוּדָ֔ה יֹשְׁבִ֥ים אִ֛ישׁ עַל־כִּסְא֖וֹ מְלֻבָּשִׁ֣ים בְּגָדִ֑ים

“Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, were sitting, a man on his throne, clothed {in} robes”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. Micaiah demonstrated courage and faithfulness to Yahweh by speaking a difficult message truthfully despite the intimidating appearance of these kings. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 22:10 (#2)

אִ֛ישׁ עַל־כִּסְא֖וֹ

“a man on his throne”

The author is using **a man on his throne** as a common expression of his culture to mean “each on his own throne.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each on his own throne]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:10 (#3)

וְכָל־הַנְּבִיאִ֔ים

“And all of the prophets”

The author says **all the prophets** as a generalization for emphasis. He may not mean that all 400 of Ahab’s prophets were present at this location. He may mean that many of them were present and were prophesying. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And all the prophets who were there]

See: Hyperbole

1 Kings 22:10 (#4)

לִפְנֵיהֶ֑ם

“to their faces”

Here, **to their faces** represents being in the presence of these kings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in their presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:11 (#1)

כֹּה־אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה בְּאֵ֖לֶּה תְּנַגַּ֣ח אֶת־אֲרָ֑ם עַד־כַּלֹּתָֽם

“Thus says Yahweh: ‘With these you will gore Aram until their finishing”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that with these you will gore Aram until their finishing]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:11 (#2)

יְהוָ֔ה

“Yahweh”

Now that Ahab’s prophets know that Jehoshaphat wants to hear a message from Yahweh, they are using his name rather than a title. Here and in the next verse, show that the prophets are using the name of Yahweh by representing it in the way that you have decided to do that regularly in your translation.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Kings 22:11 (#3)

בְּאֵ֖לֶּה תְּנַגַּ֣ח אֶת־אֲרָ֑ם עַד־כַּלֹּתָֽם

“With these you will gore Aram until their finishing”

Zedekiah is speaking as if Ahab’s army were actually an ox with iron horns that could gore its enemies. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You will defeat Aram completely, as if you had been an ox goring them with horns like these]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:12 (#1)

עֲלֵ֣ה רָמֹ֔ת גִּלְעָד֖ וְהַצְלֵ֑ח וְנָתַ֥ן יְהוָ֖ה בְּיַ֥ד הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“Go up {to} Ramoth Gilead and prosper, for Yahweh will give {it} into the hand of the king”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh will give it into the hand of the king, go up to Ramoth Gilead and prosper]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 22:12 (#2)

וְהַצְלֵֽח

“and prosper”

This is an imperative, but it describes a result rather than giving a command. Use a form in your language that describes a result, here and in verse 15. Alternate translation: [and you will prosper] or [and you will succeed]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Kings 22:13 (#1)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [Listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:13 (#3)

פֶּה־אֶחָד

“with} one mouth”

The messenger is using the term **mouth** to represent speaking. He is using the idea of all the prophets using **one mouth** to speak to mean that they are saying the same thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [unanimously]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:13 (#2)

נָּא דִּבְרֵי הַנְּבִיאִים & דבריך כִּדְבַר אַחַד מֵהֶם

“please, the words of the prophets & your word & like the word of one from them”

The messenger is using the term **word** to represent what the prophets have been saying and what he hopes Micaiah will say by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the things the prophets are saying ... what you say ... what one of them is saying]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:14 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָ֔ה

“The life of Yahweh”

Following the custom of his culture, Micaiah is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Kings 22:15 (#1)

עֲלֵ֥ה וְהַצְלַ֖ח וְנָתַ֣ן יְהוָ֔ה בְּיַ֖ד הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“Go up and prosper, for Yahweh will give {it} into the hand of the king”

Micaiah actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here. (This is indicated by the way that he is imitating exactly what the other prophets have been saying.) If a speaker of your language would not say the opposite of what he meant, you could indicate what Micaiah is doing. Alternate translation: [I was told to say the same thing as the other prophets, so go up and prosper, for Yahweh will give it into the hand of the king]

See: Irony

1 Kings 22:16 (#1)

עַד־כַּמָּ֥ה פְעָמִ֖ים אֲנִ֣י מַשְׁבִּיעֶ֑ךָ אִ֚ם־לֹ֣א תְדַבֵּ֤ר אֵלַי֙ רַ֣ק־אֱמֶ֔ת בְּשֵׁ֖ם יְהוָֽה

“Up to how many times have I been making you swear that you would not speak about me except truth in the name of Yahweh”

King Ahab is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have made you swear many times before that you would not speak about me except truth in the name of Yahweh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 22:16 (#3)

אֱמֶ֔ת

“truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [things that are true]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:16 (#2)

לֹא־תְדַבֵּר אֵלַי רַק־אֱמֶת

“you would not speak about me except truth”

If it would appear in your language that the king was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [you would only speak truth about me]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Kings 22:16 (#4)

בְּשֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה

“in the name of Yahweh”

Here, **the name of Yahweh** represents the authority of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when speaking with Yahweh’s authority] or [when speaking on behalf of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:17 (#1)

אֶת־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the Israelite army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the whole Israelite army]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:17 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה לֹא־אֲדֹנִים לָאֵלֶּה יָשֻׁבוּ אִישׁ־לְבֵיתוֹ בְּשָׁלוֹם

“And Yahweh said, ‘No masters {are} to these. Let them return, a man to his house, in peace”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh said that no masters were to these, so they should return, a man to his house, in peace]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:17 (#3)

יָשֻׁבוּ אִישׁ־לְבֵיתוֹ

“Let them return, a man to his house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:24. Alternate translation: [Let each of them leave the army and return to his home]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:17 (#4)

בְּשָׁלוֹם

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:18 (#2)

הֲלוֹאאָמַרְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ לוֹא־יִתְנַבֵּא עָלַי טּוֹב כִּי אִם־רָע

“Did I not say to you, ‘He will not prophesy good about me, but rather evil”

Ahab is using the question form to remind Jehoshaphat of what he had already told him and to emphasize that he was right. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I told you that he would not prophesy good about me but rather evil!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 22:18 (#3)

טּוֹב & רָע

“good & evil”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good** and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [good things ... bad things]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:18 (#4)

כִּי אִם־רָע

“but rather evil”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [but rather he will prophesy evil about me]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 22:18 (#1)

הֲלוֹאאָמַרְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ לֹוא־יִתְנַבֵּא עָלַי טֹוב כִּי אִם־רָע

“Did I not say to you, ‘He will not prophesy good about me, but rather evil”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Did I not tell you that he would not prophesy good about me, but rather evil]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:19 (#4)

מִימִינֹו וּמִשְּׂמֹאלֹו

“on his right and on his left”

The author is using the adjectives **right** and **left** as nouns to mean certain sides. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [on his right side and on his left side]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Kings 22:19 (#1)

לָכֵן

“Therefore”

Here the word **Therefore** introduces not a reason but an explanation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [Since you have asked me to speak only truth in the name of Yahweh]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 22:19 (#2)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה

“the word of Yahweh”

Here, **word** represents what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh has said]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:19 (#3)

וְכָל־צְבָא הַשָּׁמַיִם עֹמֵד

“and all of the army of the heavens was standing”

Micaiah is speaking of heavenly beings as if they were an **army**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and all of the heavenly beings were standing]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:20 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה מִמִּי יְפַתֶּה אֶת־אַחְאָב וְיַעַל וְיִפֹּל בְּרָמֹת גִּלְעָד וַיֹּאמֶר זֶה אֹמֵר בְּכֹה וְזֶה אֹמֵר בְּכֹה

“And Yahweh said, ‘Who will deceive Ahab so that he may go up and fall {at} Ramoth Gilead?’ And this {one} said, ‘By thus,’ and that {one} was saying, ‘By thus”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh asked who would deceive Ahab so that he would go up and fall at Ramoth Gilead. And one angel suggested one thing while another angel was suggesting something else]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:20 (#2)

וְיִפֹּל

“and fall”

Here, **fall** represents “die.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and die]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:21 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:21 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֲנִי אֲפַתֶּנּוּ

“And he said, ‘I, I will deceive {him”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a

quotation. Alternate translation: [And he said that he would be the one who deceived him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:21 (#5)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר יְהוָ֔ה אֵלָ֖יו בַּמָּ֑ה

“And Yahweh said to him, ‘By what”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh asked him by what means he would deceive him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:21 (#2)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֲנִ֔י אֲפַתֶּ֖נּוּ

“And he said, ‘I, I will deceive {him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:17. Alternate translation: [And he said, ‘I will be the one who deceives him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:21 (#4)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר יְהוָ֔ה אֵלָ֖יו בַּמָּ֑ה

“And Yahweh said to him, ‘By what”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh said to him, ‘By what means will you deceive him]

See: Ellipsis

1 Kings 22:22 (#3)

בְּפִ֖י כָּל־נְבִיאָ֑יו

“in the mouth of all of his prophets”

Here, **mouth** represents what the prophets would say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to influence what all of his prophets say]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:22 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֵצֵא֮ וְהָיִ֣יתִי֒ רוּחַ֙ שֶׁ֣קֶר בְּפִ֔י כָּל־נְבִיאָ֖יו וַיֹּ֣אמֶר תְּפַתֶּ֑ה גַּם־תּוּכָ֣ל צֵ֔א וַעֲשֵׂה־כֵֽן

“And he said, ‘I will go out and be a spirit of falsehood in the mouth of all of his prophets.’ And he said, ‘You will deceive and also you will be able. Go out and do thus”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [And the spirit said that he would go out and be a spirit of falsehood in the mouth of all of Ahab’s prophets. And Yahweh told him that he would be able to deceive Ahab, so he should go out and do what he had suggested]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:22 (#4)

תְּפַתֶּ֑ה גַּם־תּוּכָ֣ל

“You will deceive and also you will be able”

The verbs **deceive** and **be able** express a single idea. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [You will be able to deceive him]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 22:22 (#2)

רוּחַ֙ שֶׁ֣קֶר

“a spirit of falsehood”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **falsehood**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a lying spirit]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:23 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֔ה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce their main topic. See how you have been translating it in contexts such as 1:12 and 2:16.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Kings 22:24 (#1)

וַיַּכֶּ֣ה אֶת־מִיכָ֔יְהוּ עַל־הַלֶּ֖חִי

“and struck Micaiah on the cheek”

Striking someone **on the cheek** was a symbolic action by which Zedekiah showed contempt for Micaiah and his prophetic message. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this

action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and struck Micaiah on the cheek to show contempt for him and what he had said] or [and slapped Micaiah on the cheek as an insult]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 22:24 (#2)

אֵי־זֶ֣ה עָבַ֗ר רוּחַ־יְהוָה֙ מֵאִתִּ֔י לְדַבֵּ֖ר אוֹתָֽךְ

“What {is} this, the Spirit of Yahweh has passed over from with me to speak to you”

Zedekiah is using the question form for emphasis and to express his indignation. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [How dare you claim that the Spirit of Yahweh has passed over from with me to speak to you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Kings 22:25 (#1)

הִנְּךָ֥ רֹאֶ֛ה

“Behold you, seeing”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:22. Alternate translation: [You are about to see,]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:25 (#2)

חֶ֥דֶר בְּחֶדֶ֖ר

“a chamber in a chamber”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:30. Alternate translation: [an inner room] or [a private room]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Kings 22:26 (#1)

קְח֔וּ

“Take”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Take** is singular because Ahab is speaking to the messenger who brought Micaiah to him. So use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 22:26 (#2)

בֶּן־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“the son of the king”

Even though the king is referring to his own son, he is speaking of him in the third person as **the son of the king** because he is making a formal announcement. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [my son]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 22:27 (#3)

שִׁ֣ימוּ & וְהַאֲכִ֣ילֻ֔הוּ

“Put & and feed him”

The implied “you” in the imperatives **Put** and **feed** is plural because the messengers would be addressing Amon and Joash, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Kings 22:27 (#5)

לֶ֚חֶם לַ֣חַץ וּמַ֔יִם לָ֖חַץ

“bread of affliction and water of affliction”

The king is using **bread of affliction and water of affliction** as a common expression of his culture to mean the scanty food and drink that people would have during a time of **affliction**, such as during a siege. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [scanty food and drink]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:27 (#1)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֗ כֹּ֤ה אָמַ֙ר הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ שִׁ֥ימוּ אֶת־זֶ֖ה בֵּ֣בֵית הַכֶּ֑לֶא וְהַאֲכִ֣ילֻ֔הוּ לֶ֚חֶם לַ֣חַץ וּמַ֔יִם לָ֖חַץ עַ֣ד בֹּאִ֥י בְשָׁלֽוֹם

“And you shall say, ‘Thus says the king, “Put this {one} in the house of imprisonment and feed him bread of affliction and water of affliction until my coming in peace”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Ahab told his officials (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. Ahab tells his officials what to say to Amon and Joash (level 2). That includes a direct quotation from Ahab himself (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or

third-level quotations (see the Quotes within Quotes note).

See: Quote Markings

1 Kings 22:27 (#4)

בְּבֵית הַכֶּלֶא

“in the house of imprisonment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **imprisonment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the prison building]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:27 (#2)

וְאָמַרְתָּ כֹּה אָמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ שִׂשְׂימוּ אֶת־זֶה בְּבֵית הַכֶּלֶא וְהַאֲכִילֻהוּ לֶחֶם לַלַּחַץ וּמַיִם לַלַּחַץ עַד בֹּאִי בְשָׁלוֹם

“And you shall say, ‘Thus says the king, “Put this {one} in the house of imprisonment and feed him bread of affliction and water of affliction until my coming in peace”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you shall tell them that I say that they are to put this one in the house of imprisonment and feed him bread of affliction and water of affliction until my coming in peace]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Kings 22:27 (#6)

בְשָׁלוֹם

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:28 (#1)

שׁוֹב תָּשׁוּבוֹ

“returning, you return”

Micaiah is repeating forms of the verb **return** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you indeed return]

See: Reduplication

1 Kings 22:28 (#3)

כֻּלָּם

“all of them”

Since Micaiah is referring to people who are present, it may be more natural in your language to use a second-person pronoun here. Alternate translation: [all of you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Kings 22:28 (#2)

עַמִּים כֻּלָּם

“peoples, all of them”

By **peoples**, Micaiah means the tribes of Israel, and he is using **them** to represent the Israelites from various tribes who were present in Samaria to hear his prophecy. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you tribes of Israel, all of you] or [you Israelites, all of you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 22:30 (#1)

וְבֹא בַמִּלְחָמָה & וַיָּבֹא בַּמִּלְחָמָה

“and come into the battle & and he came into the battle”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [and go into the battle … and he went into the battle]

See: Go and Come

1 Kings 22:30 (#2)

וְאַתָּה לְבַשׁ בְּגָדֶיךָ

“but you, wear your robes”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [but for your part, wear your robes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:31 (#1)

לֹא תִלָּחֲמוּ אֶת־קָטֹן וְאֶת־גָּדוֹל כִּי אִם־אֶת־מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַדּוֹ

“You shall not fight with small or with great except with the king of Israel alone”

The king of Aram is referring to all the soldiers his troops might encounter by naming two extremes,

small and **great**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [You shall not fight with anyone except with the king of Israel alone]

See: Merism

1 Kings 22:31 (#2)

לֹ֣א תִלָּחֲמ֗וּ אֶת־קָטֹן֙ וְאֶת־גָּדֹ֔ול כִּ֚י אִם־אֶת־מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל לְבַדּ֖וֹ

“You shall not fight with small or with great except with the king of Israel alone”

If it would appear in your language that the king of Aram was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [You shall only fight with the king of Israel himself, not with anyone else]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Kings 22:32 (#1)

וְהֵ֣מָּה אָמְר֔וּ

“that they, they said”

The author is stating the pronoun **they** separately, even though the verb translated as **they said** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to indicate that this action took place at the same time as when they **saw Jehoshaphat**. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [that right away they said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:34 (#1)

מָשַׁ֥ךְ בַּקֶּ֖שֶׁת

“drew the bow”

The author is using **drew with the bow** as a common expression of his culture to mean “shot an arrow.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [shot an arrow]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:34 (#2)

לְתֻמֹּ֑ו

“in his innocence”

The author is using **in his innocence** as a common expression of his culture to mean “without knowing at whom he was shooting” or “without aiming intentionally.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at random] or [without aiming]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:34 (#5)

הֲפֹ֤ךְ יָדְךָ֙

“Turn your hand”

Here, **hand** represents the driver’s direction or control of the chariot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Turn the chariot around]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:34 (#3)

בֵּ֣ין הַדְּבָקִ֔ים וּבֵ֖ין הַשִּׁרְיֹ֑ן

“between the joints and between the armor”

The terms **joints** and **armor** together express a single idea. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [between the joints of his armor]

See: Hendiadys

1 Kings 22:34 (#4)

הֲפֹ֤ךְ יָדְךָ֙ וְהוֹצִיאֵ֣נִי מִן־הַמַּחֲנֶ֔ה כִּֽי־הָחֳלֵ֖יתִי

“Turn your hand and bring me out from the camp, for I am wounded”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [I am wounded, so turn your hand and bring me out from the camp]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 22:34 (#6)

מִן־הַמַּחֲנֶ֔ה

“from the camp”

Here, **the camp** represents the soldiers who would stay in a **camp** near a battlefield. Ahab wants his driver to bring him out from the midst of the army, but the

context makes clear that he wants to stay on the battlefield, though at a safe distance from the fighting. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the ranks] or [from the midst of our soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:35 (#4)

וַיָּ֥מָת בָּעָ֖רֶב וַיִּיצַ֣ק דַּם־הַמַּכָּ֑ה אֶל־חֵ֖יק הָרָֽכֶב

“And he died in the evening, and the blood of the wound poured out onto the bosom of the chariot”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And the blood of the wound poured out onto the bosom of the chariot, and he died in the evening]

See: Order of Events

1 Kings 22:35 (#5)

חֵ֖יק הָרָֽכֶב

“the bosom of the chariot”

The author is using the term **bosom** to mean the interior of Ahab’s **chariot**. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the interior of the chariot]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:35 (#2)

וְהַמֶּ֙לֶךְ הָיָ֣ה מָעֳמָ֔ד בַּמֶּרְכָּבָ֖ה נֹנַכַּ֣ח אֲרָ֑ם

“and the king was propped up in the chariot opposite Aram”

Being **propped up in the chariot** facing the enemy army was a symbolic action by which Ahab wanted to depict that he was still in command of his army despite being wounded. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and the king was propped up in the chariot opposite Aram so that he would still appear to be in command]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Kings 22:35 (#3)

וְהַמֶּ֙לֶךְ הָיָ֣ה מָעֳמָ֔ד

“and the king was propped up”

The expression **was propped up** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the king’s soldiers propped him up]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 22:35 (#1)

וַתַּעֲלֶ֥ה הַמִּלְחָמָ֖הוּ

“And the battle went up”

The author is saying **the battle went up** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the fighting became more intense or severe. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the tide of battle rose higher] or [And the fighting became fiercer]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:36 (#1)

וַיַּעֲבֹ֥ר הָרִנָּ֖הוּ בְּמַחֲנֶֽה

“And a cry passed through in the camp”

The author is speaking of this **cry** as if it were a living thing that could have **passed through** the Israelite **camp**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And throughout the camp one soldier shouted to another]

See: Personification

1 Kings 22:36 (#3)

אִ֚ישׁ אֶל־עִירׇ֔ן וְאִ֖ישׁ אֶל־אַרְצֽוֹ

“A man to his city, and a man to his land”

These two phrases **A man to his city** and **a man to his land** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases in a way that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A man to his city, yes, a man to his land]

See: Parallelism

1 Kings 22:36 (#4)

אִ֣ישׁ אֶל־עִירׇ֔וֹ וְאִ֖ישׁ אֶל־אַרְצֽוֹ

“A man to his city, and a man to his land”

The phrase **A man to his city, and a man to his land** was a common expression meaning “Let each soldier leave the army and return to his home.” When the Israelite soldiers said this, it was a fulfillment of what Micaiah predicted in 22:17. See how you translated the similar expression there. Alternate translation: [Let each of us leave the army and return to his home]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:36 (#2)

כְּב֥וֹא הַשֶּׁ֖מֶשׁ

“about the going of the sun”

The author is using **the going of the sun** as a common expression of his culture to mean “at sunset.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at sunset] or [at sundown]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:37 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֥א שֹׁמְר֑וֹן

“and he came to Samaria”

The implication is that Ahab’s soldiers brought his body back to Samaria. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and his soldiers brought his body back to Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Kings 22:37 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּר֖וּ אֶת־הַמֶּ֥לֶךְ

“And they buried the king”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites buried the king] or [And the king was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:38 (#3)

וְהַזֹּנוֹת֙ רָחֲצ֔וּ

“now the prostitutes bathed {there”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand the nature of the location where these events took place. Together with the information that dogs licked up Ahab’s blood, this information associates the death of Ahab, who was once a proud king, with shameful circumstances. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Kings 22:38 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁטֹ֤ף אֶת־הָרֶ֙כֶב֙ עַ֣ל ׀ בְּרֵכַ֣ת שֹׁמְר֔וֹן וַיְלַקְּק֖וּ הַכְּלָבִ֑ים אֶת־דָּמ֣וֹ וְהַזֹּנ֥וֹת רָחָ֖צוּ

“And one washed the chariot at the pool of Samaria. And dogs licked up his blood (now the prostitutes bathed {there”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that **the prostitutes bathed there** with the information that Ahab’s chariot was washed at **the pool of Samaria**. Alternate translation: [And one washed the chariot at the pool of Samaria (now the prostitutes bathed there). And dogs licked up his blood]

See: Information Structure

1 Kings 22:38 (#4)

כִּדְבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֖ר דִּבֵּֽר

“according to the word of Yahweh that he had spoken”

Here, the term **word** represents what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what Yahweh said when he spoke through Micaiah]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:38 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁטֹ֤ף אֶת־הָרֶ֙כֶב֙

“And one washed the chariot”

The author is using the pronoun **one** in a general sense, not to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the chariot was washed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:39 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר֨ דִּבְרֵ֤י אַחְאָב֙ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֔ה וּבֵ֥ית הַשֵּׁ֖ן אֲשֶׁ֣ר בָּנָ֑ה וְכָל־הֶ֣עָרִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר בָּנָ֖ה הֲלֹ֥וא־הֵ֛ם כְּתוּבִ֥ים עַל־סֵ֖פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֑ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Ahab and all that he did, and the house of ivory that he built, and all of the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Ahab and all that he did and the house of ivory that he built and all of the cities that he built in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 22:40 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב אַחְאָ֖ב עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

“And Ahab lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Ahab passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 22:41 (#1)

וִיהוֹשָׁפָ֛ט בֶּן־אָסָ֥א מָלַ֖ךְ עַל־יְהוּדָ֑ה בִּשְׁנַ֣ת אַרְבַּ֔ע לְאַחְאָ֖ב מֶ֥לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“And Jehoshaphat, the son of Asa, reigned over Judah in year four of Ahab, the king of Israel”

In this verse, the author is introducing **Jehoshaphat** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 22:41 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֥ת אַרְבַּ֖ע

“in year four of”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **four** in a context like this one, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the fourth year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 22:42 (#1)

בֶּן־שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים וְחָמֵ֖שׁ שָׁנָ֑ה

“was} a son of 35 years”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:21. Alternate translation: [was 35 years old]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:43 (#1)

וַיֵּ֗לֶךְ בְּכָל־דֶּ֙רֶךְ֙ אָסָ֣א אָבִ֔יו לֹא־סָ֥ר מִמֶּ֖נּוּ

“And he walked in every way of Asa his father, he did not turn from it”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:26. Alternate translation: [And he lived just as Asa his father had lived, without ever ceasing to live that way]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:43 (#2)

הַיָּשָׁ֖ר

“right”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **right**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was right]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:43 (#3)

בְּעֵינֵ֥י יְהוָ֑ה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:43 (#4)

הַבָּמ֖וֹת לֹא־סָ֣רוּ

“they did not remove the high places”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one removed the high places] or [the high places were not removed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Kings 22:44 (#1)

וַיַּשְׁלֵם

“And & made peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [established peaceful relations]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:45 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יְהוֹשָׁפָט וּגְבוּרָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה וַאֲשֶׁר נִלְחָם
הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Jehoshaphat, and his mighty things that he did and how he fought, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and in verse 50, the author is using phrases that he regularly uses to conclude accounts of kings’ reigns. See how you translated the similar phrases in 11:41–43 and other comparable contexts in the book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the matters of Jehoshaphat and his mighty things that he did and how he fought in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah]

See: End of Story

1 Kings 22:46 (#3)

בִּעֵר מִן־הָאָרֶץ

“he burned from the land”

The author is speaking of removing the cultic prostitutes as if Jehoshaphat had actually **burned** them. He means that Jehoshaphat completely removed them from the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he completely removed from the land]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:46 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁאַר בִּימֵי אָסָא אָבִיו

“who were left in the days of Asa his father”

The expression **were left** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom Asa his father left in his days]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 22:46 (#2)

בִּימֵי

“in the days of”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time period. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during the reign of]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:48 (#4)

כִּי־נשברה אֳנִיּוֹת

“because the ships were broken”

The expression **were broken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [because a storm broke up the ships]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 22:48 (#1)

אֳנִיּוֹת תַּרְשִׁישׁ

“ships of Tarshish”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:22. Alternate translation: [a fleet of long-range ships]

See: Metonymy

1 Kings 22:48 (#2)

וְלֹא הָלְכָה כִּי־נשברה אֳנִיּוֹת בְּעֶצְיוֹן גָּבֶר

“but he did not go, because the ships were broken at Ezion Geber”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [but because the ships were broken at Ezion Geber, he did not go]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Kings 22:48 (#3)

וְלֹא הָלְכָה

“but he did not go”

The author is using one person who was involved in this action, Jehoshaphat, referring to him as **he**, to represent everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent

expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but they never set sail]

See: Synecdoche

1 Kings 22:50 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יְהוֹשָׁפָט עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Jehoshaphat lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [And Jehoshaphat passed away]

See: Euphemism

1 Kings 22:50 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“and he was buried”

The expression **he was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Kings 22:50 (#3)

עִם־אֲבֹתָיו & אָבִיו

“with his fathers & his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [with his ancestors ... his ancestor]

See: Metaphor

1 Kings 22:51 (#1)

אֲחַזְיָהוּ בֶן־אַחְאָב מָלַךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן בִּשְׁנַת שְׁבַע עֶשְׂרֵה לִיהוֹשָׁפָט מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

“Ahaziah, the son of Ahab, reigned over Israel in Samaria in year 17 of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah”

In this verse, the author is introducing **Ahaziah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar phrases in 15:1–2 and other comparable contexts in the book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Kings 22:51 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁבַע עֶשְׂרֵה

“in year 17 of”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **17** in a context like this one, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the seventeenth year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Kings 22:52 (#1)

הָרַע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what was evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Kings 22:52 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Kings 22:52 (#3)

וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ אָבִיו וּבְדֶרֶךְ אִמּוֹ וּבְדֶרֶךְ יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט אֲשֶׁר הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And he walked in the way of his father and in the way of his mother and in the way of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:26. Alternate translation: [And he lived as his father and his mother had lived and as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, had lived, who had led the Israelites to sin]

See: Metaphor